to recreate himself on the Ganges; and in a very short time was landed at a small distance from Tondah*, where he was met by Balund Akhter, the son, and several officers, of Shujaa.

In the mean time, the Prince's quondam friends returned to their tents; and each man, solicitous of gaining favour with the Imperial General, sent off an express, to inform Meer Jumla of the folly of Mohammed, and the necessity of his immediate return to the army.

When Jumla received this intelligence, he was struck with astonishment at the madness of the Prince; but supposed it impossible that, without having secured the allegiance of a large portion of the army, he could have been guilty of such an act of folly: he was therefore doubtful whether he might venture to return to Rajemahel, fearing that the troops only waited to secure his person, before they went over to Mohammed. He at length resolved to do his duty, as a faithful officer, and hastened back to Rajemahel. Here he found every thing in the greatest confusion; some of the troops disposed to plunder the quarters of those chiefs who retained their loyalty, and others desirous of seizing the property of the Prince; and the whole in a mutinous state, and wavering in their intentions.

The appearance of the General, for a time, silenced the storm: he mounted his elephant, and rode into the midst of the army: he then harangued them, and pointed out the folly of Mohammed, whom he stigmatized as a weak young man, governed only by his passion; that the cause he had espoused was desperate; and should any of the troops be rash enough to follow him, they might be assured they were devoting themselves to destruction. He concluded by saying, he should

* See Note, page 149.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1660.

march against the enemy as soon as the rainy season was over; and trusted, that before the end of that campaign he should be completely master of all Bengal. This speech had the desired effect; the majority were convinced by his reasoning; and the few who were inclined to support Mohammed were afraid to avow their sentiments, on account of the paucity of their numbers: every man returned quietly to his home; and the General, in order to put a stop to further cabal, and to give employment to their minds, sent out parties to seize all the boats they could collect, and to make every preparation for the construction of a bridge over the river, as soon as the season would permit.

Whilst such was the state of affairs at Rajemahel, the city of Tondah was a scene of festivity and rejoicing: the arrival of Mohammed communicated hope and delight to every heart: Shujaa received him with raptures, and the females hastened the preparations for the wedding. No thoughts of danger, or anticipation of future events, were allowed to damp the joys of the present moment. The nuptials were celebrated with great pomp and rejoicings; but, alas! the festivities were scarcely concluded, when they were awoke from their dream of happiness, by intelligence of the approach of the Imperial forces.

Shujaa, disdaining or fearing to trust to the fortifications of Tondah, encamped his army on the plain, some miles distant from the city, and resolved once more to try his fortune in a pitched battle. He had great confidence in his own troops; and was led to believe, from the assertions of Mohammed, that part of the Imperial army would join him the first opportunity; on which account he assigned to that prince a conspi-

Digitized by Google

cuous post in the centre of the first line, whence his standard could be easily distinguished by his friends, as they advanced.

The Imperial General, having completed his bridge of boats, or discovered a ford, crossed the river near Sooty; and, convinced of the superiority of his hardy veterans of the north over the newly-raised levies of Shujaa, he was delighted to find the enemy in the field. He advanced with impatience: and when he beheld, from a distance, the standard of Mohammed, he selected one of his most trust-worthy officers to attack that post, with directions, if possible, to secure the Prince. The battle commenced by a distant cannonade, in which, probably, the army of Shujaa had the advantage: Meer Jumla, therefore, directed his cavalry to advance; and, when sufficiently near, ordered his select corps to make a charge upon Mohammed: his orders were rapidly obeyed; and the misguided Prince, supposing it was a body of his friends coming to join him, directed his artillery to cease firing. The mode of their attack convinced him of his error, but it was too late: the first line was thrown into confusion; they fled, and communicated their panic to the second line, when the route became general. The eldest son of Shujaa was severely wounded; and an immense number of the Bengal troops were slaughtered by the Moghul cavalry.

Shujaa's army defeated.

Shujaa, and his unfortunate son-in-law, effected their escape to the city; but fearing to trust to its strength, embarked that night, with their families and treasures, on board swift-rowing boats, and made the best of their way to Dacca, whilst the troops dispersed themselves in all quarters.

Jumla was surprised at his own success; and the following morning, ignorant of the flight of the Princes, advanced against

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1660.

Tondah. Upon his arrival, the gates were thrown open, and he took quiet possession of the Sultan's palace.

He was now convinced that the hopes and resources of Shujaa were annihilated, and that he had nothing to apprehend from him: he therefore did not immediately pursue him, but spent some time in settling the country, of which he had, at that time, the commission of Governor from the Emperor.

When the first intelligence of Mohammed's desertion reached Aurungzebe, he was overwhelmed with rage and astonishment, and concluded that the whole army would follow the example of the Prince: he feared, not only that Bengal was lost, but that Shujaa would again be enabled to contend with him for the empire.

But as, notwithstanding his numerous faults, that monarch possessed the quality of bravery in a superior degree, he gave instant orders for his army to take the field; and had actually marched several days on the route to Bengal, when he received the agreeable news of the success of his arms at Tondah. This event satisfied him that he had little to fear from his brother: he therefore returned to Dehly; where, reflecting on the strange conduct of his son, to whom he partly owed the crown*, he devised the following stratagem to break that connection the youth had so hastily formed. He wrote a letter as if addressed secretly to Mohammed; and sent it by a special messenger, with directions to throw himself in the way of Shujaa's spies, so that he should be discovered, and the letter taken from him. The contents were as follow:

---

* See *History of Hindoostan*, vol. III. p. 251

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1660.

"To our beloved son Mohammed, whose happiness and safety are joined with our life. It was with regret and sorrow that we parted with our son, when his valour became necessary to carry on the war against Shujaa. We hoped, from the love we bear to our first-born, to be gratified soon with his return; and that he would have brought the enemy captive to our presence in the space of a month, to relieve our mind from anxiety and fear. But seven months passed away, without the completion of the wishes of Aurungzebe. Instead of adhering to your duty, Mohammed, you betrayed your father, and threw a blot on your own fame. The smiles of a woman have overcome filial piety. Honour is forgotten in the brightness of her beauty; and he who was destined to rule the empire of the Moghuls, has himself become a slave. But, as Mohammed seems to repent of his folly, we forget his crimes. He has invoked the name of God to vouch for his sincerity; and our parental affection returns: he has already our forgiveness; but the execution of what he proposes is the only means to regain our favour."

The letter made an impression on the mind of Shujaa, which all the protestations of Mohammed could not remove: he became silent and discontented. He had an affection for the Prince; and he was more enraged at being disappointed in the judgment which he had formed, than at the supposed treachery. Having continued three days in this agitation of mind, he at last sent for the Prince: he told him, in the presence of his council, that, after all the struggles of affection with suspicion, the latter had prevailed; that he could no longer behold Mohammed with an eye of friendship, should he even swear to his innocence in the holy temple of Mecca; that the bond

Digitized by Google

SECT VI.

A. D. 1660.

of union and confidence, which had lately subsisted between them, was broken; and that, instead of a son and a friend, he beheld him in the light of an enemy. 'It is therefore necessary, for the peace of both,' continued Shujaa, 'that Mohammed should depart. Let him take away his wife, with all the wealth and jewels which belong to her rank. The treasures of Shujaa are open; he may take whatever he pleases. Go.—Aurungzebe should thank me for sending away his son, before he has committed a crime.'

Shujaa dismisses his Son-in-law.

Mohammed, on this solemn occasion, could not refrain from tears. He felt the injustice of the reproach; he admired the magnanimity of Shujaa; he pitied his misfortunes; but his own condition was equally deplorable. He knew the stern rigour of his father, who never trusted any man twice: he knew that his difficulty of forgiving was equal to his caution. The prospect was gloomy on either side: distrust and misery were with Shujaa, and a prison was the least punishment to be expected from Aurungzebe. He took leave, the next day, of his father-in-law: that prince presented his daughter with jewels, plate, and money, to a great amount; and the unfortunate pair pursued their journey to the Imperial camp.

Mohammed, accompanied by his spouse, the daughter of Shujaa, moved slowly towards the camp of Jumla. His melancholy increased as he advanced: but whither could he fly? No part of the vast empire of India was impervious to the arms of Aurungzebe; and he was not possessed of the means of escaping beyond the limits of his father's power: he was even ashamed to shew himself among troops whom he had deserted. Regret succeeded to folly; and he scarce could reflect with patience on the past, though the fair cause of his mis-

Digitized by Google

fortunes still kept her dominion over his mind. Having approached within a few miles of the Imperialists, he sent to announce his arrival to the Vizier. That minister hastened to receive him with all the honours due to his rank: a squadron with drawn swords formed around his tent; but they were his keepers rather than guards. Jumla, the very next day, received a packet from Court, which contained orders to send Mohammed, should he fall into his hands, under a strong escort to Dehly. The officer who commanded the party was ordered to obey the commands of the Prince; but he, at the same time, received instructions to watch his motions, and to prevent his escape.

Mohammed, though brave and enterprising like his father, was destitute of his policy and art. Precipitate, full of fire, and inconsiderate, he was more fitted for acting as a partisan than as a general, and was therefore less adapted for war than for battle. Haughty in his temper, yet easy in his address, and an enemy to cruelty. An absolute stranger to fear, he was daring and active on occasions of danger; but he knew his own merit; and his self-conceit induced him to ascribe to his own decisive valour the whole success of his father. He had been often known to say, that he placed Aurungzebe on the throne, when he might have possessed it himself. Naturally open and generous, he despised the duplicity of his father, and disdained power that must be preserved by art. His free conversations upon these subjects estranged from him the affections of his father, who seems to have confessed his merit by his own fears. Had Mohammed accepted of the offer of Shah Jehan*, when he seized that prince, he had

* See *Dow's History of Hindoostan*, vol. III. p. 251.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. courage and activity sufficient to have kept possession of the throne of the Moghuls: but he neglected the golden opportunity; and shewed his love of sway, when he was not possessed of any rational means to acquire the empire. His misfortunes, however, were greater than his folly: he passed seven years in a melancholy prison at Gualiar, till death put a period to his misery*.

Such is the account given of this transaction in the History of Hindoostan, which varies considerably from the authorities I have had an opportunity of consulting. It is stated, both in the *Muntekhub al Lebab*, and the *Muasir al Omrah*, that Mohammed, ashamed of his own conduct, or dissatisfied with his uncle, returned, of his own accord, to the Imperial army, previous to the battle of Tondah, after an absence of
A. D. 1660. nearly nine months. This event occurred in the year 1070.

* As the above statement is erroneous, and as it may be interesting, to many of the readers of this work, to know the fate of this gallant young man, some extracts from the *Muasir Alumgiery* (*History of Aurungzebe*), respecting him, are subjoined.

"Upon his arrival at Dehly, he was confined in the Castle of Selimghur: he was thence sent to Gualiar, where he remained till A. D. 1672; and was then brought back to Selimghur, and an allowance of 1000 rupees per month assigned him for his private expenses.

"In the following year, the Prince was allowed to take the air upon an elephant, and to visit the tombs and shrines in the vicinity of Dehly.

"In the year 1674, the Emperor marched towards Hussein Abdal, and was accompanied by the Prince Mohammed, still under confinement.

"In the following year, Sultan Mohammed was promoted to the rank of commander of 20,000, and presented with a lac of rupees.

"In the year 1676, the Prince Mohammed was married to the daughter of the Raja of Kishtavur. The following year, jewels, to the amount of seven lacs of rupees, were presented to the Prince. The same year a son was born to the Prince, and named Musaud Bukht.

"In the year 1678, the Prince Mohammed died, and was buried close to the tomb of the celebrated saint Cuttub Addeen, near Dehly."

It is therefore probable, that, if he had survived his father, he might have succeeded to, or, at all events, would have been one of the competitors for the throne.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Meer Jumla, having settled the affairs of the western Bengal, marched with his forces towards Dacca; and the unfortunate Shujaa, whose treasures were now nearly exhausted, and his army reduced to fifteen hundred horse, finding opposition vain, resolved, in order to spare the further effusion of blood, to abandon his country,—by embarking on board a ship at the port of Chittagong†, and proceeding from thence to the sacred shrines of Arabia, where he might spend the remainder of his life in acts of devotion, either at the temple of Mecca, or in the vicinity of the tomb of his Prophet. If this measure failed him, he still had the alternative of proceeding to Arracan, and of soliciting the protection of the prince of that country. A. D. 1660.

Having thus reconciled himself to his adverse fate, he placed his family and valuables upon elephants; and, attended by a small body of cavalry, and a few of his friends, who generously refused to leave him in his distress, he crossed the river Burhampooter; and, having entered the wild mountains of Tipperah, after a long and wearisome journey, he reached Chittagong. At this place he had the mortification to learn, that there was not a ship in the port; and that, as the monsoon was raging with violence, no vessel could have attempted the voyage to Arabia at that season of the year. He had now no option left, but of proceeding to Arracan, or falling into the hands of his pursuers, of whose approach he received too well-grounded intelligence. He therefore discharged all his troops; and, accompanied only by his family, and forty A. D. 1661.

† Chittagong, at that period, had not been taken possession of by the Moghuls, but was dependent on Arracan, and was frequented by Portuguese, Arabian, and Malabar ships. It was called, by the former, *Porto Grando.*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1661. Shujaa seeks refuge at Arracan.

domestics or friends, he continued his journey along the sea-shore; and at length crossed the river Naaf, which separates Arracan from Bengal. As he had taken the precaution of sending forward an envoy, to explain to the Raja his situation, and to solicit his hospitality and protection, he was met on the frontier by an officer from that prince, with assurances of his protection and friendship.

These were the first consolatory words Shujaa had heard for a long time. He and his family were delighted to think their wanderings were now at an end; and, as they had still a considerable quantity of gold and jewels with them, they hoped to pass their lives in comfort in that retired part of the world; or that some revolution in the politics of Hindoostan might enable them to return thither, as their ancestor Homayon had done from Persia.

The Royal fugitives were met, at some distance from the city of Arracan, by a cavalcade, and escorted to a house prepared for their reception. There the assurances of the Raja were again repeated; and, as a proof of his hospitality, a large supply of provisions, fruit, &c. was presented, as a welcome offering.

For some time the conduct of the Raja was unexceptionable; but, whether alarmed by the threats, or won by the bribes, of the Governor of Bengal, his behaviour suddenly changed: he became cold and reserved; and his servants no longer attended to the rights of hospitality. At length he sent Shujaa a verbal message, that he must either give him his daughter in marriage, or immediately quit his kingdom. The first of these demands was an insult the unfortunate Prince did not expect. He replied, in haughty terms, that the race of Timour would

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1661.

never submit to dishonour themselves by so inferior a connection; that as soon as the monsoon changed, and a ship could be procured, he would quit the country, and recompense him liberally for the trouble he had given him; but that the Raja must be well convinced it was impossible for him to depart at that season of the year. The Raja was highly offended at the haughtiness of this answer; and repeated his orders for Shujaa immediately to quit his territory. The unfortunate Prince was then convinced that the mind of the Raja was actuated by the combined passions of lust and avarice, and that certain death awaited him and his sons: but, as there was yet a possibility of saving the lives of his domestics and friends, he summoned them to his presence; and having laid open to them his situation, conjured them to leave him to his fate, and to throw themselves on the mercy of Aurungzebe, who, he doubted not, would forgive their attachment to him, when assured that he no longer existed. His speech was heard with melancholy attention and silence; but, when concluded, the whole assembly declared their only ambition was to shed their blood in his defence.

In the mean time, the Raja, having assembled his council, alarmed them by the circumstantial detail of a plot, which he pretended Shujaa had laid, to assassinate him, and to take possession of the throne of Arracan. Notwithstanding the story was in the highest degree improbable, some of the council affected to believe it; and gave it as their opinion, that the foreigners should be immediately sent out of the country: but, as the followers of Boodh are prohibited from shedding blood, except in battle, the council would not authorize the Raja to touch the life of his prisoner; and although the princes of Arracan were

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1661.

despotic in their power, they wished to have all their acts sanctioned by the council, which consisted of a certain number of their principal officers and ministers*.

The Raja was therefore obliged to limit his orders to his troops, to remove the Moghuls from their present residence, and compel them to take the route of Chittagong: but if, in so doing, the life of one of his subjects should be lost, the officer, commanding, was at liberty to satiate his revenge. Such a subterfuge was unworthy even of an Eastern despot, who in his own mind had fully determined the fate of his devoted captives.

The spot on which was situated the temporary house fitted up for Shujaa, was a narrow bank, with the river in the front, and stupendous cliffs behind: the only approach was, therefore, by one or other flank: these Shujaa had taken care to barricade in the best manner he could; and placed his son, with twenty of his friends, at one end of the pass, while he, with the remainder of his adherents, defended the other.

The favourite arms of the Arracanners were a short sword and buckler: with these they advanced, with horrible shouts, towards the residence of Shujaa, but without discharging any missile weapons; whilst the Moghuls, ignorant of their prejudices and instructions, received them with a volley of arrows, which laid many of the assailants level with the ground. The object of the Raja was accomplished: his people now sought revenge; and, terrible as assailants, they clambered to the top of the precipice, and hurled down huge stones on the

* For a description of Arracan, and an account of the manners of the inhabitants of the Eastern Peninsula, see *Symes's Embassy to Ava.*

Digitized by Google

heads of Shujaa and his friends, whose attention was occupied in defending the flanks of their position. The contest was no longer equal: the Arracanners, supported every moment by fresh troops, were incessant in their attacks; whilst the Moghuls, wearied by the slaughter of their enemies, were at length overpowered, and the greater number of them hewn to pieces.

Shujaa taken prisoner, and drowned.

Shujaa was one of the last who fell; he was stunned by a large stone thrown from the precipice. He was instantly seized, disarmed, and bound; and was afterwards placed in a small canoe, with two of his attendants, who insisted upon accompanying him. They were carried into the middle of the stream; when the boatmen, having pulled out some plugs from the bottom of the vessel, jumped overboard, and were soon picked up by another boat. The Prince, being fast bound, sunk without a struggle; but his two friends made a vain effort to save themselves, by swimming: the breadth of the river, or the opposition of their enemies, prevented their reaching the shore; and they obtained that death which, according to the regulations of Arracan, was the exclusive privilege of the Royal family†.

The wife and daughters of Shujaa, in a fit of despair, threw themselves into the river: they were not, however, permitted to escape so easily; they were seized, and carried, with all the other females, to the Raja's palace.

When the Raja had the insolence to wait upon Piaree Banu (the Beloved Princess), who was celebrated in Bengal for her wit and beauty, she drew a dagger, and attempted to

† See *Symes's Embassy to Ava*,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. stab the wretch; but failing in her design, she turned it against herself, and fell by her own hand. Of the three daughters, two are said to have put an end to their misfortunes by poison: the third was forcibly married to the Raja, but did not long survive her disgrace.

Of the sons of Shujaa, the eldest, sixteen years of age, was wounded severely in the battle; the other was still an infant: they were kept as prisoners for a short time, and then committed to a watery grave. Such was the melancholy end of Shujaa and his family; a prince deserving a milder fate: but his virtues were better adapted for private than for public life. He might have filled with credit the throne of a well-regulated and established kingdom; but he had not energy or ability to contend with such a rival as Aurungzebe; nor prudence to remain content with a province, while he thought himself entitled to the empire. No prince was ever more beloved than Shujaa: misfortune, and even death itself, could not deprive him of his friends: and though his fate was not known in Hindoostan for some years after his death, it filled every eye with tears: and when the melancholy intelligence was communicated to Shah Jehan, he exclaimed, "Could not the cursed infidel have left one son of Shujaa alive, to avenge the wrongs of his grandfather?" These events occurred in the year 1071.

A. D. 1661.

MOHAMMED SAIYD MEER JOOMLA, NUWAB, MUAZIM KHAN, KHAN KHANAN, SEPAH SELAR.

Origin of Meer Joomla—He arrives at Golcondah—Obtains the command of an army—Subdues Carnatic Bala Ghaut, and amasses great wealth—Suspected of treacherous intentions—Makes overtures to the Moghul prince Aurungzebe—The Emperor Shah Jehan demands his release from Sultan Abdallah—The Sultan refuses compliance—An army

Digitized by Google

of Moghuls, under the command of Mohammed, the son of Aurungzebe, enters Telingana, and compels the Sultan to comply with their demands —Meer Joomla proceeds to Dehly, and is most graciously received— Obtains the title of Muazim Khan—Appointed Vizier—In the civil war, takes part with Aurungzebe—Joins that prince at Kudjwa— Appointed to carry on the war against Shujaa, with the title of Khan Khanan—Proceeds to Dacca, and re-establishes it as the capital of Bengal—Invades Couch Beyhar, and changes the name of its capital to Alumgeernagur—Political conduct of Meer Joomla—The son of the Raja becomes a convert to the Mohammedan faith—Meer Joomla proceeds towards Assam—Difficulties of the march described—Defeats the fleet of the enemy, and takes the fort of Semyle—Takes possession of Ghergong, the capital of Assam, without opposition—Cantons his army for the rainy season—Writes to the Emperor that he had opened a road to China, and hoped to arrive there in another campaign— The rains set in with great violence, and overflow the whole country— The Raja surrounds the Moghuls with his army, and cuts off all their supplies—A pestilence breaks out among the troops—Meer Joomla in the greatest distress—The rains abate; and the Moghuls, again enabled to act, compel the Raja to return to the mountains, whence he sends an envoy to solicit peace; to which Joomla consents—The officers who had been left in charge of Couch Beyhar having given disgust to the natives, the latter rebel, and expel the Moghuls, who take post at Ghowhatty— Meer Joomla commences his retreat—Arrives at Ghowhatty—Detaches an army to reconquer Couch Beyhar—Proceeds towards Dacca— Dies—His character.

As this officer has made, and will still make, a conspicuous figure in this history, it is thought requisite to give some account of his origin, and rise in life.

Mohammed, generally called Meer Joomla, was born in the vicinity of Ispahan, a city for many years the capital of Persia. When arrived at the age of manhood, he imitated the example of a number of his successful countrymen, and went to seek his fortune in India. His propitious stars led him to Golcondah;

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1650.

where, about the year A. H. 1060, he obtained an employment, in the service of the Sultan Abdallah Koottub Shah, sovereign of Telingana; and, by degrees, rose to the command of the army. Whilst in this situation, he subdued the country called Carnatic Bala Ghaut, which yielded a revenue of forty lacs (4,000,000) of rupees per annum, and comprehended the strong fortresses of Gunjy Kotta and Sudhoot. As this district is very rich, and contains several diamond mines, Meer Joomla was supposed to have collected great wealth for himself: in proof of this fact, he raised a select corps of 5000 cavalry, which he maintained at his own expense. This circumstance shortly rouzed the envy and jealousy of all the courtiers, and caused suspicion in the mind of the Sultan.

During the period that Meer Joomla was employed in the Carnatic, he left his son, Meer Mohammed Ameen, to be his agent at Court; but the youth, puffed up with pride at the success of his father, conducted himself in a very dissolute and disrespectful manner; and had the audacity to come to Court one day in a state of intoxication, and to fall asleep on the Prince's musnud*: such behaviour could not pass unnoticed; he was severely reprimanded, and forbidden to appear in the presence of the Sultan.

When this intelligence reached Meer Joomla, he was convinced that his enemies were plotting his ruin, and that it would be unsafe for him to return to Golcondah. He therefore made overtures to the Prince Aurungzebe, who then commanded the Imperial army in the Dekkan, which were favourably received; and the Prince having recommended him to the Emperor Shah

* An inferior kind of throne.

Digitized by Google

Jehan, an envoy was (A. H. 1066) sent from Dehly, to the Court of Koottub Shah, to demand the discharge of both father and son: for the former of whom the envoy carried a commission of Commander of 5000 horse, and for the son the rank of Colonel of 2000, in the Imperial service. SECT. VI. A. D. 1655.

Before the arrival of the envoy, Koottub Shah, having learnt the object of his mission, confined Mohammed Ameen, and seized all the property of the father that he could discover. This conduct drew on the Sultan the vengeance of Aurungzebe: an army, under the command of his son Mohammed, entered Telingana; and, having laid waste the country, and plundered the city of Hyderabad, compelled the Sultan to deliver up Meer Joomla and his son, with all their wealth; and to purchase his own pardon by a present of one million sterling, and by giving his daughter in marriage to Mohammed †.

On the 12th of the month Jummad al Akhir, A. H. 1067, Meer Joomla, with his son, arrived in the camp of the Prince Mohammed, and were most graciously received: they thence proceeded to join Aurungzebe, by whom they were treated with great respect, and an intimacy was cemented between the parties. On the 25th of Ramzan they reached Dehly, and had the honour of being introduced to the Emperor. On this occasion Meer Joomla presented his Majesty with a large diamond, worth two lacs, and sixteen thousand rupees; also sixty elephants, and other valuable commodities; amounting, in all, to the value of fifteen lacs of rupees. A. D. 1657.

In return, Joomla was honoured with the title of Muazim Khan, the rank of Commander of 6000 horse, with the insignia of standards and kettle-drums; the office of Dewan, and a present

† See *History of Hindoostan*, and *Scott's History of the Dekkan.*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1657.

of five lacs of rupees in specie. The knowledge and abilities of Joomla recommended him, in a high degree, to the Emperor; and the place of Vizier having soon after become vacant, by the death of Saadulla Khan, notwithstanding all the opposition of the Prince Dara, who was averse to Joomla, from his connection with Aurungzebe, that officer was appointed to the highest office in the empire.

In the civil wars between the brothers, for the throne, Joomla took part with his patron, Aurungzebe; joined his camp, near Kudjwa, the day preceding the battle with Shujaa; and, by his abilities and courage, contributed much to the success of that day. The high opinion entertained of him by Aurungzebe is evinced by his having been selected to carry on the war against Shujaa; and his conduct on that occasion gained for him the applause and esteem of his sovereign. He was promoted to the rank of Generalissimo of the armies, and the high title of Khan Khanan (Chief of the Nobles).

Meer Joomla makes Dacca the capital of Bengal.

It has been before mentioned, that Meer Joomla, having settled the affairs of the western part of Bengal, pursued the unfortunate Shujaa to Dacca. In that city he fixed his residence, and again rendered it the capital of the province.

The English seize on one of his vessels, A. D. 1660.

During the period that the army of Meer Joomla had occupied Rajemahel, he had stopt the boats, laden with saltpetre, belonging to the English, and much injured their trade at Patna: in consequence of which, the English had the audacity, in the year 1071, to seize one of his vessels, for which he threatened to expel them the country: but early in the following year, on their making an apology, and restoring the vessel, he forgave them, and, during the remainder of his government, treated them with lenity. He, however, insisted upon their continuing

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1659.

to pay the *peishkush*, or annual offering of 3000 rupees, which had been established, by the Foujdar of Hoogly, during the late civil war.

Whilst the empire of Hindoostan was convulsed by the contentions of Aurungzebe and his brothers for the throne, several of the bordering Zemindars and tributary Rajas withdrew their necks from the collar of obedience; and not only neglected to send any part of their revenues to the Imperial treasury, but even invaded the provinces. Amongst the most prominent of these was Beemnarain, the Raja of Couch Beyhar, whose country, although frequently plundered by the Mohammedans, and compelled to pay tribute, was never absolutely subdued. This chief, taking advantage of the absence of the Moghul army, seized upon Kamroop, and several other of the Imperial districts which adjoined his territories.

To the north-east of Bengal is situated the extensive, and the once powerful, kingdom of Assam. This country is, generally speaking, a valley, 700 miles in length by 80 in breadth, through the middle of which runs the great river Burhampooter, which, after entering Bengal, joins the Ganges: these rivers pour their united streams into the ocean near Deccan Shabazpore*.

The prince of this country, named Jydej Sing, had, during the civil wars, sent an army down the Burhampooter; which had plundered and laid waste the country as far as Dacca, and carried away with them a number of the inhabitants as slaves.

To avenge these insults, and to re-establish the fame of the

* For a further description of this country, see Mr. Vansittart's Translation of part of the *History of Aurungzebe*, published in the *Asiatic Researches* for 1800; also Doctor Wade's account of Assam, in the above work for 1805.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. Moghul government, was an object of great solicitude to Meer Joomla; who, as soon as he was satisfied with regard to the
A. D. 1661. Prince Shujaa, in the year 1071, collected, in the neighbourhood of Dacca, a numerous army, well equipped with artillery and warlike stores, and accompanied by a strong fleet of war-boats.

Invades Couch Beyhar, A. D. 1661. Meer Joomla, having previously obtained the sanction of the Emperor, early in the year 1072, marched, at the head of his forces, from Dacca. As he had embarked his heavy artillery and stores on board the fleet, he directed his march along the bank of the Burhampooter; but as there was no regular road by this route, he was frequently obliged to cut his way through woods, and to form causeways over the swamps. Although this measure delayed his progress, it, in the end, facilitated his conquest; for the Raja of Couch Beyhar, not expecting the invasion from that quarter, had directed all his attention to fortify and defend the two other roads which led to his capital. Such were the difficulties that occurred in this route, that the General was himself obliged to set an example to his troops, by taking the axe in his own hands, and cutting down a tree. On seeing this action, the proud Moghuls, who, previous to that time, had considered fighting as their only duty, alighted from their horses, and exerted themselves in clearing the way. By their endeavours, and the co-operation of a number of elephants, a road was at length formed; which enabled Meer Joomla to approach, with little opposition, the city of Beyhar; and the Raja, sensible of his inability to oppose so formidable an enemy, took to flight, and concealed himself in the woods and hills.

December, A. D. 1661. On the 27th of Rubby al Avul (third month), Meer Joomla

Digitized by Google

took possession of the capital of Couch Beyhar; and, in compliment to the reigning Emperor, changed its name to Alumgeernagur. SECT. VI. A. D. 1661.

As it was the intention of Meer Joomla to retain possession of that district, he appointed Syed Mohammed Saduc to be chief judge; with directions to destroy all the idolatrous temples, and to erect mosques in their stead. He, however, issued orders to his troops not to plunder, or injure, any of the inhabitants; but to seize upon all the property of the Raja, wherever it could be found. To evince his zeal for religion, the General himself, with a battle-axe, broke the celebrated image of Narain (the principal object of worship of the Hindoos of that province), and afterwards, ascending to the roof of the temple, proclaimed the Mohammedan call to prayers. With this exception on the article of religion, Meer Joomla would not permit his troops to be guilty of any injustice to his new subjects; and instituted a court for the express punishment of plunderers, or other offenders.

By these means, the inhabitants of Couch Beyhar became reconciled to their invaders; and many of them, who had fled from the city, returned to their habitations. At length, Bishen Narain, the son of the Raja, who was on bad terms with his father, came in: at the instance of Meer Joomla, he was converted to the Mohammedan faith; and on the promise of being raised immediately to the Raje, undertook to seize his father.

To effect this impious undertaking, a considerable force, under the command of Isfundiar Beg, was sent with Bishen Narain, who entered the woods, and, having pursued the Raja for some time, compelled him to take refuge in a hill fort of Bootan; the only entrance to which was by a bridge composed of iron chains, and which was easily taken to pieces on the approach of an enemy. Although disappointed in seizing the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1661. Raja, they captured his principal minister, with all his family and wealth: they also found, in the wood, 250 guns, great and small, and much other property; all of which was forwarded to Dacca.

Meer Joomla, having settled the revenues of Couch Beyhar at ten lacs of Narain rupees, and made his arrangements, left fourteen hundred horse, and two thousand musqueteers, under the command of Isfundiar Beg, to support the new government; and proceeded to the conquest of Assam.

As Meer Joomla was resolved not to quit sight of his fleet, on which were embarked his stores and depôt of provisions, he regained the banks of the Burhampooter; and, having
A. D. 1662. crossed that river, near Rangamutty, at the expense of great labour and much delay he formed a road which enabled him to proceed by short stages. During this march, as the Imperial army was obliged to drag the boats against a strong current, and the troops were necessitated to cross rivers and to clamber over precipices, it frequently happened that their day's journey did not exceed one or two miles; during which time, although not opposed by the enemy in front, they were often annoyed on their flanks, by small parties of the Assamese firing on them, from behind trees, or wherever the nature of the ground permitted them to approach unseen: but as the General shared in all the fatigues and danger, frequently walking the whole way, the troops continued to advance without murmuring, although their rest was often broken, after a most fatiguing day's journey, by the night attacks of the enemy.

After a most wearisome march, the Moghul army came in sight of the fort of Semyle*, built upon a hill, which com-

* Called, by other authors, *Axo*.

Digitized by Google

manded the river, and was garrisoned by 20,000 men, supported by a fleet of war-boats, anchored across the stream. Meer Joomla immediately gave orders for his boats to attack those of the enemy, while he invested the fortress by land. His cannon, which were probably served by Europeans, quickly dispersed the Assamese fleet; and the garrison, dispirited by their retreat, abandoned the post during the night. SECT. VI.

The Moghul General, having taken possession of the fortress, which he named Atta Allah (the Gift of God), placed a garrison therein: he then proceeded on his route; and, after capturing a number of other places, on the sixth of Shaban (8th month) A. D. 1662. took possession of Ghergong, the capital of the kingdom.

As the Moghul army required some rest after their harassing journey, and the rainy season was approaching, Meer Joomla cantoned his troops in the vicinity of the river extending from Ghergong to Mutteapore, a distance of seven miles; and, as the Raja had fled at his appearance, and taken shelter in the mountains, he was under no apprehension of any molestation from the inhabitants of the country, to the principal of whom he had granted protection, and taken their promise of allegiance. Misled by this confidence, Meer Joomla despatched couriers to the Emperor, informing him, that he had opened a road to China, and hoped, next campaign, to display the Moghul standards in that rich country.

This intelligence afforded much pleasure to Aurungzebe, who flattered himself that his victorious banners would meet, in the distant region of China, those of his Tartar relations, the descendants of Jengiez Khan. He, in consequence, gave orders for a numerous levy of troops to be assembled at Dehly, for the purpose of supporting Meer Joomla, and maintaining

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. his conquests. The Emperor also conferred on Mohammed Ameen, the son of Joomla, an honorary dress, as a testimony of respect for his father: he also wrote to the General a letter, with his own hand, congratulating him on his success, and encouraging him to proceed: but, alas! these hopes were of a short-lived duration.

A. D. 1662. The rainy season of the year 1072 set in with uncommon violence; the rivers overflowed their banks, and laid the whole of the Valley of Assam under water; forage was nowhere procurable; and the Moghul cavalry, of whom the Assamese were so much afraid that hundreds of them often fled before ten horsemen, could no longer act.

The Raja returned, at the head of his troops, from the mountains; and, having surrounded the Moghuls on every side, cut off all supplies from the country. Provisions became scarce; and the dampness of the climate, or malignity of the air, occasioned a pestilential disorder, which swept off a number of the troops: distress in every form attacked the Moghuls; but, as it was impossible either to advance or retreat, there was no other remedy for them but patience.

During the period that the Moghul army was thus surrounded with misfortunes, the Assamese were incessant in their night attacks, and succeeded in cutting off several of the detached parties; they also, with poisoned arrows, severely wounded many of the principal officers, and killed a number of the men and horses.

At length, in the month Rubby al Avul (3d month) of
A. D. 1662-3. the year 1073, the rains began to subside, and the dry ground to appear. Meer Joomla lost not a moment in retaliating on his enemies; he sent out detachments to beat up their quarters;

Digitized by Google

and wherever an opportunity offered for the cavalry to act, they drove the Assamese before them, "like sheep before the wolf." The Raja again fled to the mountains, and sent an envoy to solicit peace. Meer Joomla either was, or pretended to be, averse to any other terms than absolute submission; but being attacked by a violent dysentery, and the troops mutinous to return to Bengal, he at length listened to the solicitations of Dilere Khan, and other officers, and agreed to withdraw his troops from Assam, on condition of the Raja paying a large sum of money, presenting a number of elephants, yielding up his daughter to be married to one of the Princes, and promising an annual tribute.

These terms having been accepted by the Raja, an envoy arrived in the Moghul camp on the 6th of the second Jemmad (6th month), and presented to Meer Joomla 20,000 tolahs of gold*, 1,008,000 tolahs in silver, forty elephants, and two young ladies; one said to be the daughter of the Raja, and the other the daughter of a powerful chief whose territories adjoined Assam: he also brought four young men, of good family, to remain as hostages for the payment of the annual tribute. A. D. 1663.

While Meer Joomla thus successfully conducted the war in Assam, Isfundiar Beg and the other officers whom he had left in charge of Couch Beyhar, by their oppressions and tyrannical conduct, so disgusted the inhabitants of that province, that they rose in a body, and solicited their expelled Raja, Beemnarain, to return among them, and again to assume the reins of government.

As soon as the Raja found himself sufficiently powerful, he sent a polite message to Isfundiar Beg, and Mohammed Saleh,

* A Tolah weighs about 400 grains.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. the governor and commander of the troops, that if they would retire peaceably and quietly from his dominions, they might do so unmolested: but if they persisted in remaining, they should have reason to repent their obstinacy.

The Moghul chiefs at first disregarded this menace; but after several skirmishes, in which they lost a number of men and officers, they found it advisable to retire to Ghowhatty, there to await the return of the army from Assam.

In the middle of Jemmad Assany (6th month), Meer Joomla commenced his return to Bengal. At this period his army was so much reduced by famine and sickness, that nine men out of ten were with difficulty transported; and many of them daily perished on the march; while the General himself was nearly exhausted by his disorder.

In the end of Shaban (8th month) the army arrived at Ghowhatty, on the confines of Couch Beyhar; and, notwithstanding the weak state of Meer Joomla, he selected all the efficient part of the army, and sent them, under the command of Rasheed Khan and Asghur Khan, to reconquer that province. He then proceeded, with the remainder of his forces, towards Dacca; but on his arrival at Khizerpore, his constitution being exhausted by fatigue and disease, he resigned his soul to the Angel of death, on the 2d of Ramzan (9th month)
A. D. 1663-4. of the year 1073.

Meer Joomla was one of those characters who have risen more in consequence of their own abilities than by any peculiar instance of good fortune. He possessed an excellent understanding, great coolness of mind, and undaunted courage. He was calculated for the intrigues of the cabinet, as well as for the stratagems of the field. In private life he was amiable and

Digitized by Google

humane; in his public transactions, dignified and just. He disdained to use ungenerous means against his adversaries, and even expressed his joy on the escape of Sultan Shujaa from his arms. Till his death he retained the title of Vizier, though the duties of the office were performed by his deputy, Raja Ragonath. His death was even regretted by the Europeans, who had formerly complained of his exactions. SECT. VI.

When the Emperor was informed of the death of Meer Joomla, and the unsuccessful termination of the expedition to Assam, he was greatly distressed; and sent the prince Mohammed Muazim to condole with the family of the deceased chief, and to assure his son, Ameen Khan, of the Imperial favour and support: but the enemies of Aurungzebe were of opinion that he was much pleased with the event, as he was excessively jealous of the abilities, and much feared the ambition, of that great man.

NUWAB SHAISTA KHAN AMEER AL OMRAH.

The Nuwab Shaista Khan appointed Governor; but permitted to manage the business, for some time, by deputy—Arrives at Dacca—Prepares to retaliate on the Raja of Arracan—Detaches a fleet of war-boats, with 3000 *men, under Hussen Beg, to recover the islands in the mouth of the Ganges—Sends the remainder of the army, under the command of his son, by land, to Chittagong—The fleet retakes Jugdea and Alumgeernagur—Invades Sundeep, and regains possession of that island—Hussen Beg writes to the Portuguese in the service of the Raja, offering them considerable advantages if they would desert to him—The Portuguese accede—The plot discovered—The Portuguese escape in their boats to Sundeep—The army arrives at the boundary of Chittagong—The Arracanners retreat to the city—An engagement takes place between the fleets, in which the Moghuls are worsted, but gain some advantage*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

the following day—The united forces lay siege to Chittagong—The garrison endeavour to make their escape—Pursued, taken, and sold as slaves—Shaista Khan, at his own request, recalled to Court—His Character—The Danes and French establish factories in Bengal.

AFTER the death of Meer Joomla, the government of Bengal was conferred on Shaista Khan, the Ameer al Omrah, son of the celebrated Vizier Asuf Jah, and nephew of the Empress Noor Jehan; but as that officer had not then recovered from the wounds he had received at Poona, in the Dekkan, from the assassins of the Mahratta chief Sevagee*, he was permitted to govern the province by his deputy, Daoud Khan, and did
A. D. 1663-4. not proceed thither until the year 1074.

The affairs of the province, at that period, required the presence of an able Governor; for the Raja of Arracan, finding that no notice was taken of his conduct to Sultan Shujaa, concluded that the Moghuls were afraid of his power; and when he heard of the death of Meer Joomla, he directed his troops to possess themselves of all the eastern coast, to the mouth of the Ganges. He also again took into his employment a number of the Portuguese adventurers, whose knowledge in maritime affairs enabled him to construct and navigate vessels of a sufficient size to carry cannon: with these, and his own swift-rowing war-boats, he extended his ravages to all the islands not in his possession, and seized a number of boats, richly laden, in different parts of the Ganges. Such was the extent of their depredations, that the inhabitants of Dacca trembled when they heard the name of the Mughs, whose general practice was to kill the men, and to carry off the women and children as slaves.

---

* See *History of Hindoostan*, vol. III. page 370.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

One of the first acts of Shaista Khan's authority was to assemble, in the year 1075, at Dacca, a numerous fleet of boats, and an army of 13,000 men†. Three thousand of these he immediately embarked on board the boats, under the command of an officer, named Hussen Beg, with orders to clear the river of the pirates, and to drive them from the islands of which they had taken possession. The remainder of the army he placed under the command of his own son, Buzurg Omeid Khan, whom he instructed to proceed by land, and co-operate with the fleet in punishing the Mughs. A. D. 1664-5.

The fleet sailed from Dacca; and entering the great river Megna, which is formed by the junction of the Burhampooter and Ganges, Hussen Beg took by storm the forts of Jugdea and Alumgeernagur, which were situated at the mouth of the river, and had been for some time in possession of the Raja. Hence he sailed to the island of Sundeep, of which the enemy had been for many years in possession, and where they had erected several strong stockades in various places. The Moghuls were fortunate in surprising, in that place, a part of the Arracan fleet, which they took with little trouble; but the capture of the stockades was not so easily effected; and several weeks were required to expel, or seize, the whole of the Mughs, who are celebrated for their dexterity, both in the construction and the defence of such fortifications. A. D. 1666.

Hussen Beg, having thus completed the object of his instructions, waited for the arrival of the army, which had proceeded by land: in the meantime, he wrote, with the sanction

† On this occasion he demanded the assistance of some European gunners, from the Dutch and English factories; and upon their pleading inability, he threatened to stop their traffic in saltpetre. *India Records*, vol. III. A. D. 1664.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1666. and in the name of the Governor, both to the Portuguese who were settled at Chittagong, and to those who were in the employment of the Raja; offering them, if they would enter his service, to give them more advantageous terms than they had from that chief, and a grant of lands for the settlement of their families in Bengal. He at the same time threatened, if they still adhered to the cause of the Raja, that he would, on the capture of Chittagong, destroy every person of their nation whom he found*. This letter had the desired effect on the Portuguese; they were terrified at the power of the Moghuls; and calling to mind the severe punishment inflicted on them at Hoogly, they agreed to his proposals, and promised to desert, with their vessels, the first opportunity.

The negociation was scarcely concluded, when one of the party communicated it to the Raja, who was much irritated, and resolved to take ample vengeance, by putting them all to the sword: the Portuguese were therefore under the necessity of abandoning their property, and of hurrying on board their

A. D. 1666. A. H. 1075-6. boats during the night. In the morning they set sail, and arrived safe at Sundeep, where they were most graciously

* The following horrible account of these people is given by Berneir, in his Travels.—"Rakan had been the refuge of all the runaway Portuguese from Goa, Cochin, Malacca, and other places which they had in the Indies; as well as of their slaves, and other Europeans. They consisted of such as had abandoned their monasteries; had been twice or thrice married; murderers, and the like. The King of Rakan kept them as a guard of his frontier against the Mogol, in the port called Chategon, which he had taken from Bengal; giving them lands and liberty to live as they pleased. Their usual trade was robbery and piracy: they not only scoured the sea-coasts, but entered the rivers, especially the Ganges; and often, penetrating forty or fifty leagues up the country, surprised and carried away whole towns and villages of people, with great cruelty, and burning all which they could not carry away. They ransomed the old people; but the young ones they made rowers of, and such Christians as they were themselves; boasting that they made more converts in one year, than the missionaries, through the Indies, did in ten." See *Modern Universal History*, vol. VI.

Digitized by Google

received by the Imperial General, who, having selected the most efficient of them to assist in the expedition against Arracan, sent the remainder to the Governor, who assigned for their residence a place twelve miles below Dacca, still called Fringy Bazar, or European town, where many of their descendants yet reside.

The army under Omeid Khan, having advanced by short marches on account of the badness of the roads, at length reached the river Phenny, which formerly constituted the south-east boundary of Bengal: here they found an army of Arracanners prepared to oppose their crossing; but the appearance of the Moghul cavalry, an object they had never before seen, alarmed them to such a degree, that they fled with precipitation to Chittagong.

In the mean time, Hussen Beg, having obtained intelligence that the army was arrived, set sail from Sundeep, and endeavoured to form a junction with it; but, opposite a place called Commorea, he was attacked by the Arracan fleet, consisting of three hundred armed vessels, of different sizes; and although, owing principally to the assistance of the Portuguese, he was enabled to repulse the enemy, and take or sink several of their vessels, yet he was so much alarmed by this new species of warfare, to which the Moghuls had not been accustomed, that he ran the fleet close to the shore, and sought protection from the army. Omeid Khan immediately detached to his assistance all the artillery and musqueteers; and when the Arracanners, early next morning, renewed the attack in shallow water, the guns opened a heavy and unexpected fire on them, and compelled them to retreat.

The united forces then proceeded to the city of Chittagong,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Chittagong taken, A. D. 1666.

to which they laid siege; and although it was well fortified, and defended by a number of cannon, the garrison, alarmed at the retreat of their fleet, endeavoured, during the night, to make their escape. They were pursued by the Moghul cavalry, and 2000 of them seized and sold as slaves. Twelve hundred and twenty-three pieces of cannon, of different calibres, and a number of stores, were found in the place; but the captors were disappointed in the quantity of wealth they expected to have shared. Omeid Khan changed the name of the city to Islamabad* (The Residence of the Faithful); and annexed it to the province of Bengal; leaving a considerable force to defend it, from the incursions of the Mughs.

A. D. 1666. A. H. 1076.

Shaista Khan governed Bengal, with great prudence and vigour, till the end of the year 1087; when, at his own request, he was recalled to Court. On his arrival, he presented the Emperor with thirty lacs of rupees (nearly 350,000*l.*) in specie, some elephants, and a number of curiosities. He was most graciously received, and soon after appointed Governor of the province of Agra.

A. D. 1677.

It is exceedingly difficult to do justice to the character of this officer. By the Mohammedan historians he is described as the Pattern of Excellence; but by the English he is vilified as the oppressor of the human race. The following facts are, however, strong presumptive proofs in favour of the veracity of the former. During the government of Shaista Khan, the commerce of the English, notwithstanding the alleged oppressions of the Governor, continued to flourish: besides their factories

* See page 246.

Digitized by Google

at Ballasore and Hoogly, they had established agents at Patna, Cossimbazar, and Dacca; and their exportation of saltpetre alone, in some years, amounted to 1000 tons; and their importation of bullion, in a single year, to 110,000*l.*: further, although no English vessels were allowed to sail up the Ganges before his time, viz. A. D. 1664, yet it appears that, in the year 1669, the East-India Company had, by his permission, formed a regular establishment of pilots, for conducting their ships up and down the river. He also, in the year 1672, granted them an order for freedom of trade throughout the province, without the payment of any duties†.

On the other hand, the Company's agents complained, that he frequently stopt their trade, and seized upon their saltpetre; that, instead of the annual present of 3000 rupees, settled in 1658, he exacted from them the same duties that were paid by the Hindoos; and that his officers were guilty of a thousand exactions‡. That, in Hoogly, the officers of government compelled the Hindoo merchants to take their money at 25 per cent. interest; and frequently called on them to repay the principal at the end of nine months, charging the full year's interest. That, in consequence of various confiscations, the public officers had frequently a quantity of goods on their hands, which they obliged the Hindoo merchants to take at a high price, and dispose of as they could; and that he compelled the English and Dutch soldiers to attend him in the war against Arracan. There is still extant a public letter from the Governor of Madras, to Shaista Khan, dated May 7, 1677,

† See Appendix.

‡ See Messrs. *Blake's and Clavel's Reports*, dated October 1668, and December 1676.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. threatening, that if the English are not better treated, they will entirely withdraw from Bengal*.

It was during the government of Shaista Khan, that is to
A. D. 1676. say, about the year 1676, that the French and Danes established themselves in Bengal. The precise period of the introduction of the Dutch is not recorded; but the agents of these nations prudently obtained ground, on which to erect their factories, at some distance below Hoogly, where the present towns of Chinsura, Chandernagore, and Serampore, now stand. The English agent, on the contrary, built his factory in the middle of the town of Hoogly, which was the cause of frequent disputes with the inhabitants, and terminated by their being expelled the country.

NUWAB FEDAI KHAN AAZIM KHAN.

On the resignation of Shaista Khan, the Emperor Aurungzebe was pleased to appoint his own *foster-brother*, Fedai Khan, to be Governor of Bengal, with the lofty title of Aazim Khan.
A. D. 1677. This officer arrived at Dacca in the year 1087, but died, in that city, early in the following year.

This person is described, by the English agents, of a covetous and tyrannical disposition: they further state, that he had quarrelled with Hajy Shuffy Khan, the Emperor's Dewan; that he gave much molestation to their commerce; and that his conduct made them regret the resignation of his predecessor: that, in consequence of such behaviour, an order had been received from Court for him to quit Dacca, and reside at

* *India Records*, 4th and 8th vols.

Digitized by Google

Kidderpore; but that his death, which occurred on the 25th of May, 1678, had saved him that mortification†. SECT. VI. A. D. 1678.

Upon the death of the Nuwab, the Emperor's Dewan, Hajy Shuffy, seized all his property, and took charge of the government; and being inimical to the English, he gave orders that they should pay three and a half per cent. duties upon their commerce, being the sum they paid at Surat‡.

SULTAN MOHAMMED AAZIM.

When intelligence of the death of Fedai Khan reached the Court, the Prince Mohammed Aazim, third son of Aurungzebe, who then governed Behar, was ordered to take charge of Bengal. He arrived at Dacca on the 19th of Jummad al Akhir of the year 1088; and, towards the end of that year, detached an army to repel the Assamese, who had been, for some time, troublesome on the frontier. June 30, 1678.

Upon this occasion, the Prince sent for the agents of the English and Dutch factories at Dacca; and having received them in the most gracious manner, he requested them to assist him with some Europeans, who understood the management of artillery; but, upon their pleading their inability, he did not enforce the demand: however, as he was in want of money, he accepted the sum of 21,000 rupees from the English; for which he granted them his Nishan, or order, for a free trade, without the payment of any duties‖.

† See *India Records*, vol. IX. 1677-8.

‡ Ibid. vol. XIV. p. 250.

‖ See Appendix.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1678. Upon the approach of the Imperial forces, the Assamese retired, and the Moghuls took possession of Ghowhatty, and the villages depending thereon. This transaction was magnified at Court into a new conquest; and an honorary dress, with a diamond necklace, valued at two lacs of rupees, was forwarded to the Prince, as a testimony of the Royal favour. This circumstance so flattered the vanity of the Prince, that he resolved on subjugating the kingdom of Arracan; and had commenced his preparations, when an event occurred which put a stop to all his projects.

A. D. 1678-9. In the year 1089, the Emperor Aurungzebe, having given great offence to all his Hindoo subjects, by the imposition of a capitation tax, by the destruction of their temples, and by his wanton attempt to despoil the orphan children of Raja Jeswont Sing of their inheritance of Joudpore, all the Rajepoot princes had recourse to arms: and so powerful were they in reputation and force, that Aurungzebe, who was then engaged in a war against the Mahratta chief Sevagee, found it requisite to order all his most confidential troops and distinguished officers to join him*.

Aug. 14, 1679. In consequence of this event, Sultan Aazim quitted Dacca on the 7th of Ramzan 1090; and proceeded on his route with an expedition never before evinced by any of the Princes of Hindoostan, unless by the Emperor Akbar, in his celebrated march from Agra to Guzerat in nine days.

The Prince's mode of travelling is thus described by one of his attendants. At midnight, he, and his son Bedar Bukht, then not nine years of age, got into their palanqueens, and were

* See *Orme's Historical Fragments.*—Transactions of the year 1678.

Digitized by Google

carried, by relays of *bearers*, till day-light: they then got out, performed their ablutions, and said their morning prayers; after which they mounted on horseback, and rode till mid-day. In this manner they arrived at Benaras in twenty-five days: but of a corps of 1000 chosen horse, which left Dacca with the princes, very few persons were able to keep up with them.

From Benaras they arrived in the Imperial camp, then between Ajmere and Joadpore, in twelve days: during this part of the journey, fresh horses were provided at every stage, by the public officers, for the Prince and his party; who on the last day rode seventy coss†.

One day, during the journey, the princes having outridden their attendants, and Bedar Bukht being overcome with thirst, they stopt at a well, and desired a villager to draw them some water. After they had drunk, the Prince gave the man two *ashrufies* (gold *mohrs*); which so much excited the fellow's cupidity, that, ignorant of the rank of the travellers, he demanded all their money, and refused to let them proceed. The Prince bore his insolence for some time; but, being at length irritated, he drew an arrow, and lodged it in the ill-fated wretch's breast: he then rode on; but one of the officers, who arrived at the spot soon after, recognising the arrow, cut off the man's head; and then hastening after the Prince, presented him with the arrow, and addressed him in an extemporary verse, purporting, that his Highness's orders would one day penetrate the four quarters of the globe with as much facility as that arrow had pierced the breast of his enemy.

The Prince was, however, sensible of his own rashness

† The coss are from a mile and a half to two miles long, but vary in different parts of the country.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1679.

and imprudence; and during the remainder of the journey was always provided with small coin, both of gold and silver, and even of copper, to pay for any trifling service he might require on the road.

As the expedition with which the Royal party proceeded would not permit them to have regular victuals dressed, they lived almost all the time on bread and dried fruits: but Bedar Bukht, being at length disgusted with that kind of food, requested to have some *kecheery** dressed. One of the attendants went into the caravanserai, and having procured some, brought it to the princes in a large wooden bowl: although they were both very hungry, neither of them could bring themselves to taste it out of such a vessel; and the father comforted the son by saying, "Please God, the bestower of all gifts, in a few days more we shall participate in the luxuries of the Imperial table!"

In short, Sultan Aazim, having joined the Emperor, was appointed to an important command in the army, then marching against the Rajepoot princes.

NUWAB SHAISTA KHAN AMEER AL OMRA.

SECOND TIME.

Shaista Khan re-appointed to the Government—Enforces the Jizia, or poll-tax—Destroys several Hindoo temples—The English obtain an Imperial Firmān, *or order for trade—The factories in Bengal made independent of Madras—Mr. Hedges appointed Governor of the Company's settlements in Bengal—The Royal firmān proves defective—Account of the rebellion of the Zemindar of Behar—The Company's Governor applies to the Nuwab for permission to erect a fort on the bank of the Ganges—The Nuwab refuses, and insists upon the English paying the same duties they did at Surat—Disputes in*

* A mixture of peas, rice, and butter, seasoned with pepper and salt.

Digitized by Google

consequence—The East-India Company obtain the sanction of King James II. to make war on the Nuwab of Bengal and the Emperor of Hindoostan—An expedition is fitted out, in England, to attack Chittagong—Instructions to the Admiral—Failure of the expedition—Causes explained—An affray between the English and Moghul troops at Hoogly—The Admiral cannonades and sets fire to the town—The Foujedar requests a suspension of hostilities, and enters into a convention—The Nuwab refuses to ratify the convention—Orders all the English factories to be confiscated, and sends an army to expel them from the country—The English retreat to Chuttanutty—The Dutch and French take advantage of the dispute—The English anxious to make peace—The Nuwab sends three Commissioners from Dacca to settle terms, but at the same time reinforces the army at Hoogly—The English retreat to Injelee—Description of that place—Consequences of the retreat—The Nuwab offers to make peace—Treaty signed—The English return to Chuttanutty—The Company disapprove of the treaty, and resolve to prosecute the war—A line-of-battle ship and a frigate despatched to India, under the command of Captain Heath—The Nuwab renews his oppression of the English—The reinforcement arrives from England—Captain Heath resolves, in opposition to the wishes of Mr. Charnock, to recommence the war—Orders all the Company's servants to embark on board the fleet—Sets sail, and arrives at Ballasore—Attacks and plunders that town—Sets sail for Chittagong—Finds that place too strong to be attacked—Agrees to enter into a negociation again with the Nuwab; but, before an answer could arrive, proceeds to Arracan, and offers proposals to the Raja—Without waiting for an answer, sails to Madras—The Emperor orders the English to be expelled from his dominions—The Nuwab Shaista Khan requests permission to resign his government—Quits Bengal—Dies.

On the same day that orders were despatched to recall Sultan Mohammed Aazim to Court, the Nuwab Shaista Khan was re-appointed to the government of Bengal; and arrived at Dacca about the end of the year 1090. A.D. 1679-80.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A.D. 1679-80.

Immediately after Shaista Khan's return to Bengal, he was compelled, in obedience to the regulations of Aurungzebe, to enforce the *Jizia*, or poll-tax, from the Hindoos*; which circumstance rendered both him and the Emperor very unpopular throughout the province. At Hoogly, his officers demanded payment of this tax by all Europeans and other Christians; but the Dutch and English refusing to pay it, the demand was modified into a present of Persian horses for the Nuwab's use.

About the same period, a number of the Hindoo temples were destroyed; and Roy Mullick Chand, a Hindoo of rank, who was accused of having committed some frauds in the revenue department, was confined in irons, and threatened to be sent in that state to the Emperor, unless he consented to turn Mohammedan. The object of this threat was merely to extort money; but the parsimonious and persevering Hindoo remained long in confinement, without complying with their wishes; and was at length liberated, at the intercession of Prince Mohammed Aazim, to whom he was known.

The factors of the English Company, having found it exceedingly troublesome and expensive to procure a fresh *order* for freedom of trade from every succeeding Governor, had, upon the removal of Shaista Khan, sent an agent with him to the Emperor's camp, to solicit an Imperial *firmān*, to settle this business for ever; and the agent, after much expense and perseverance, succeeded in procuring the Emperor's order, with which he returned to Hoogly, on the 8th of July 1680. The English factors, wishing to make a great display of their success, caused the firmān to be received with much ceremony,

The English East-India Company obtain an Imperial *Firmān*, A. D. 1677-8.

* The Jizia was 6½ per thousand on all property. The sick, lame, and blind, were excused. Christians paid 1½ per cent. additional duty on their commerce.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

and to be saluted with three hundred guns, from the factory and the ships anchored opposite the town. A. D. 1677-8.

The great increase of the Bengal investments, and the procuring of the Imperial firmān, induced the Company to render Bengal independent of Madras; and, in consequence, they appointed Mr. Hedges, one of their Directors, to be chief agent, or Governor, of all their affairs in the Bay of Bengal, and all other factories subordinate thereto. His residence was fixed at Hoogly; and, in order to give dignity to the office, a guard of a corporal and twenty European soldiers was sent from Fort St. George, for his protection. This was the first military establishment of the Company in Bengal, and the foundation of the English power in that country†. But as the Imperial firmān was purposely drawn out in a vague and obscure style, it soon gave rise to disputes, and involved their affairs in difficulty‡.

Mr. Hedges appointed Governor of the English settlements in Bengal, A. D. 16681-2.

Some other circumstances also occurred, about this time, which added much to the embarrassments of the English. In the year 1095, a young man, calling himself the son of Sultan Shujaa, made his appearance at Patna; who pretended he had, with much difficulty, effected his escape from Arracan; and called upon the people to espouse his cause: but Syf Khan, the governor of Behar, obtaining intelligence of the circumstance before he could procure any partizans in his favour, seized him, and put him in irons.

A. D. 1682.

A few days after this event, Gangeram, the zemindar of Behar, rebelled; and, having collected a number of followers,

† To avoid a repetition of references, the reader is informed, that nearly the whole of this chapter is taken from *Orme's Indostan*, *Bruce's Annals of the East-India Company*, and *India Records*.

‡ See Appendix.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1682.

plundered the city of Behar. Immediately after, he advanced to Patna; giving out that the Prince Akbar,* who in the preceding year had rebelled against his father, had taken refuge with him; and exhorting all those who were dissatisfied with the present government to join the standard of the young prince. The Nuwab, who was detested for his tyrannical disposition, and who had neglected to keep up a proper establishment of troops, was so much alarmed, that he had not the courage to meet the rebels, but shut himself up in the city; the fortifications of which being very deficient, the inhabitants were excessively alarmed, and the merchants sent off all their most valuable property. The siege continued for some time; but owing more to the awkwardness of the assailants than to the courage of the garrison, the former failed in their attempt, and were obliged to content themselves with the plunder of the adjacent villages. Some of the soldiers of the garrison, however, commiserating the situation of the pretended son of Shujaa, struck off his irons, and permitted him to escape to the rebels; which added strength to their party, and increased the suspicions and alarm of the Governor. At length, reinforcements arriving from Benaras and Dacca, the rebels dispersed, and the gates of the city were again opened.

During the period of this disturbance, Mr. Peacock, and the other English gentlemen, continued to reside unmolested at their factory at Singee, distant ten or twelve miles from Patna, among the saltpetre grounds; which circumstance inducing the Nuwab to suspect they were in league with the rebels, he not only forbad them purchasing any more saltpetre

* See *Orme's Historical Fragments*, A. D. 1681.

Digitized by Google

that year, but threw Mr. Peacock into prison; whence it was with much difficulty and intercession that he was released. SECT. VI.

The affairs of the Company had also, for several years, been much annoyed by the interference of other British subjects; in consequence of which, the Governor at Hoogly, Mr. Gyfford, in the year 1097, made an application, in the A. D. 1685. name of the Company, to the Nuwab Shaista Khan, for permission to erect a fortification in the mouth, or on the banks, of the Ganges—to prevent the ships of those persons, whom they denominated interlopers, from entering the river; and for the better protection of their own property. But the Nuwab was too experienced a statesman to trust foreigners with such power: he not only refused the request, but insisted, notwithstanding the Emperor's firmān, upon the English paying three and a half per cent. duties upon all their imports, instead of the annual sum of 3000 rupees, which they had formerly paid.

This circumstance, aggravated by the oppressions of the Foujedar † of Cossimbazar, brought on a dispute between the Nuwab and the English, which so injured the trade of the latter, that their ships were obliged to leave Bengal without obtaining cargoes. The Nuwab, nevertheless, stated the affair in such a light to the Emperor as much excited his anger against the English.

Whilst the minds of each party were thus exasperated, there seemed to be no other remedy for the English than—either to relinquish the trade to Bengal entirely; or, by having recourse to arms, to effect by force what they could not obtain by entreaty.

† Military Governor.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1685-6. The East-India Company censured their agent in Bengal for having been too submissive to the despot; and directed the Governor of Fort St. George to make strenuous application to the Emperor for a firmān, or order, permitting the English to occupy one of the uninhabited islands in the Ganges; also to fortify the port of Injelee, on the western bank of that river, that their agents, in future, might not be subjected to the impositions of the Nuwab, or his inferior officers.

James II. authorises the East-India Company to make war, A. D. 1685-6.

But as it was highly improbable that such a proposition would be acceded to, the Company obtained the sanction of King James II. to retaliate the injuries they had sustained, and to reimbure themselves for the loss of their privileges in Bengal, by hostilities against the Nuwab, and his master the great Aurungzebe.

To effect this object, an expedition was fitted out in England, consisting of ten ships of war, carrying from twelve to seventy guns each, under the command of Vice-admiral Nicholson; and on board these ships was embarked a regiment of six hundred soldiers, which, on its arrival at Madras, was to be augmented, from that garrison, to one thousand men.

Admiral Nicholson was instructed, first to proceed to Ballasore; and having brought away the Company's agents from thence, he was then to continue his voyage to Chittagong, on the eastern side of the Bay of Bengal; and, having taken possession of that port, to fortify it in the best possible manner; for which purpose two hundred pieces of cannon were sent on board the fleet: and in order to facilitate this enterprise, and to forward the future views of the Company, the Admiral was directed to enter into a treaty of alliance with the Raja of Arracan; who, it was supposed, would readily co-operate with

Digitized by Google

the English, from his animosity to the Moghul government, with whom he had been frequently engaged in war, and who had recently wrested from him that part of his dominions*. SECT. VI. A. D. 1685-6.

The Admiral was further instructed, to enter into terms with the Hindoo chiefs, or zemindars, in that neighbourhood; to establish a mint; to collect a revenue; and, in short, to render Chittagong *a place of arms* for the English on the eastern side of the Bay of Bengal, as Fort St. George was on the western shore.

As soon as this object should be accomplished, the troops, and smallest vessels, were to proceed against Dacca; and, as it was presumed the Nuwab and his army would abandon that city, peace was then to be offered to him, on the following conditions: That he should cede the city and territory of Chittagong to the Company, and pay the debts due to them by his subjects. That he should allow the rupees coined at Chittagong to pass current in Bengal; and restore to the English all the privileges they were entitled to from the firmāns of former Emperors. That each party should bear their respective losses and expenses in the war; and that this treaty should be ratified by the Emperor, and the President (of the English nation) at Surat.

But as it might be considered ungenerous to make such an attack without some previous notice, the Admiral was furnished with letters from the Company, addressed to the Nuwab and to the Emperor, explaining the grievances the English had sustained, by the breach of the firmāns under which they had so long acted; by the seizure of their

* See the year 1665 of this History.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. property; and by the repeated extortions made from their
A. D. 1686. agents.

This spirited, if not rash, enterprise was defeated by several unforeseen accidents: the fleet was long detained by contrary winds; it was dispersed during the voyage; and several of the ships, instead of proceeding to Chittagong, entered the western branch of the Ganges, and anchored at Hoogly.

In the meantime, the Madras government had sent round 400 soldiers; and had directed Mr. Charnock to raise a second company of Portuguese infantry, to be officered by the Company's servants.

The arrival of such a force in the Ganges immediately roused the suspicions and fears of Shaista Khan. He offered to compromise the differences with the English, and to submit the whole of their dispute to arbitrators appointed on both sides; but in order to be prepared against any acts of hostility, he ordered a considerable body of troops to encamp in the vicinity of Hoogly. These overtures and precautions were, however, rendered nugatory, and the intentions of the Company completely frustrated, by a petty affray between the troops of the opposite parties: for, after Mr. Charnock, the Governor, had been fully informed of the Company's designs, and after a considerable part of the fleet had arrived in the river, hostilities were brought on, in a premature manner, by the following unexpected circumstance.

A. D. 1686. On the 28th of October, three English soldiers quarrelled, in the market, with some of the Nuwab's troops, and were severely beaten: a company of soldiers were, in consequence, called out for their defence; afterwards a second company, and then the whole of the English troops: and as,

Digitized by Google

upon the first alarm, the Nuwab's forces, who were encamped outside the town, also joined their countrymen, a general action took place. Sixty of the Moghul troops were killed, and a considerable number of them wounded. During the conflict, Admiral Nicholson opened a cannonade on the town, and burnt five hundred houses; amongst which was the Company's factory, valued, with the goods therein, at 300,000*l.*; and a party of his seamen, having landed, spiked all the guns in the batteries. SECT. VI. A. D. 1686.

The Foujedar, much alarmed by these events, solicited a suspension of hostilities, which was granted, on condition of his giving assistance to convey the saltpetre, and other goods that might be saved from the conflagration, on board the ships: with this stipulation he immediately acquiesced; and, at a conference held between him and Mr. Charnock, agreed to restore to the English all their privileges of trade, until they could obtain a new firmān from the Emperor.

It is probable that this act of condescension, on the part of the Foujedar, was forced from him by his fears; or, that he sought merely to gain time; for as soon as the circumstances were made known to the Nuwab Shaista Khan, he directed the English factories at Patna, Malda, Dacca, and Cossimbazar, to be confiscated; and ordered a very considerable body, both of infantry and cavalry, to proceed immediately to Hoogly, and to expel the English from the country.

During this interval, the Agent and Council at Hoogly, considering that they were likely to be overpowered if they remained in that situation, retired, on the 20th of December, to Chuttanutty (part of the present Calcutta), as being a stronger and safer post; where, being under the protection A. D. 1686.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VII. A. D. 1686.

of their ships, they might remain in security, till matters could be accommodated with the Nuwab.

In this situation of the English affairs, the Dutch and French took advantage of the dispute, particularly the former, who having eleven ships in the river, obtained valuable investments of goods, and re-established their factories; which, in consequence of the various oppressions they had sustained, they had previously determined to abandon.

As that part of the English shipping, which had conveyed the expedition to Bengal, required considerable repairs; and as many apprehensions were entertained for the safety of the remainder of the fleet, on board of which was embarked the greater part of the troops; it was the opinion of both Admiral Nicholson, and the Council of Hoogly, that, instead of carrying into effect the Company's designs upon Chittagong, they might consider themselves extremely fortunate if they should be able to restore matters to the same footing they had been on, previous to the commencement of hostilities: and so strongly was President Gyfford, and the Government of Madras, persuaded of the untoward termination of the expedition, that they sent a petition to the Emperor, praying for forgiveness of what had passed, and soliciting a confirmation of their former firmāns.

In the end of December, three of the Nuwab's ministers came from Dacca to Hoogly, where, having been met by Mr. Charnock and the members of his council, a preliminary treaty, ceding particular advantages to the English, was agreed upon: but this measure seems to have been adopted by the Nuwab merely to give him an opportunity of assembling his troops; for early in the month of February, a numerous army,

A. D. 1687.

Digitized by Google

consisting principally of cavalry, arrived at Hoogly, with the avowed intention of driving the English out of the country. SECT. VI. A. D. 1687.

As soon as Mr. Charnock was informed of the circumstance, he judged it imprudent to remain longer at Chuttanutty, and immediately commenced a retreat to Injelee. On their route to that place, the troops stormed and plundered the fort of Tanna, ten miles below Chuttanutty, on the western bank of the river, and burned down several magazines of salt, and granaries of rice, belonging to the Moghul subjects. They also took several Moghul ships, which they found in the river.

Injelee is an island in the mouth of the river Ganges, but separated from the western bank only by a narrow stream: the greater part of it is covered with long grass, the habitation of tigers: nor does it produce a drop of good water. In this spot, perhaps the unhealthiest of the whole province, Mr. Charnock pitched his camp, and erected batteries on the most accessible parts of the island; whilst the ships, which he had caused to be anchored in the middle of the stream, completely commanded the passage of the river.

In this situation, Abdul Sumud Khan, the Moghul General, very prudently allowed them to remain, with little molestation; well convinced, that the pestilential air and brackish water of Injelee would prove to them a more formidable enemy than any force he could bring against them. His conjectures were completely verified; for in three months more than half of the European troops died, and the remainder were only fit subjects for an hospital.

At this critical period, overtures of peace were made by the Nuwab, and were joyfully accepted by Mr. Charnock and his council: hostilities ceased; and, on the 16th of August, a treaty A. D. 1687.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. was signed, by which the English were permitted to return to
A. D. 1687. all their factories in different parts of the province: the duty of 3½ per cent. was abrogated; and they were allowed to erect magazines and to construct docks for their shipping at Oulaberea, a populous village situated on the western bank, about eighty miles from the mouth of the river, and twenty below Calcutta. The only stipulation made, on the part of the Nuwab, was, that the English should restore the Moghul vessels they had taken, and that their ships of war should not again approach Hoogly. In order to account for this favourable change in the sentiments of the Nuwab Shaista Khan, it is requisite to state, that, at the same period Admiral Nicholson's fleet was fitted out in England for the attack on Chittagong, orders had been sent to the Governor at Bombay to withdraw the Company's factories from Surat, and the other Moghul ports on the western side of India, and to commence hostilities against the Emperor Aurungzebe, by directing the English cruisers to seize upon all the ships and vessels of the Moghul subjects, wherever they should be found.

In compliance with these orders, Sir John Child, and the
A. D. 1687. principal factors, left Surat on the 25th of April; and the English cruizers having in a short time captured a number of the Moghul vessels, the Emperor became solicitous for peace, and authorized the Governor of Surat to depute an envoy to Bombay, to learn on what terms it might be obtained. He also sent orders to Shaista Khan, to compromise matters with the English in Bengal, and to permit them to re-occupy all their factories. It was in consequence of these orders that Mr. Charnock obtained such favourable and unexpected terms.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1687.

In virtue of the treaty, Mr. Charnock, not wishing to return to Hoogly without the ships of war, took possession of Oulaberea, and commenced making docks for careening the vessels; but, after a residence of three months, he took a dislike to the place, and obtained permission to return to Chuttanutty, where the factors and troops lived in huts, till proper habitations could be erected.

When intelligence of the total failure of the expedition, and the disastrous consequences which ensued, reached England, the Company were much dissatisfied with the conduct of their servants abroad; and resolved, that unless a fortification, with a district round it, in Bengal, to be held as an independent sovereignty, should be ceded to them by the Emperor of Hindoostan, with permission to coin money which should be current throughout all his dominions, they would no longer carry on any commerce with that country, but annoy him and his subjects by every means in their power.

To effect this determination, a reinforcement of a line-of-battle ship and a frigate, on which were embarked one hundred and sixty soldiers, were despatched, under the command of Captain Heath, to Bengal, either to prosecute the war with vigour, or to bring away all the Company's servants, with whatever property might be saved from the general wreck; and to land them at Madras.

In the meantime, the Emperor's clemency to the English in Bengal not having put a stop to their hostilities on the coast of Malabar, the Nuwab found himself at liberty to recommence his oppressions on the agents of the Company. He ordered them to return and settle at Hoogly; and not to build, with either stone or brick, at Chuttanutty. He also granted

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1687. free permission to his troops to plunder all their property; and demanded from Mr. Charnock a large sum of money, as a recompence for the damage his country had sustained by the late hostilities. The agent, being neither in a condition to oppose him by arms, nor to appease him with money, sent two members of his Council to Dacca, to try if he might be softened by submission. They were directed to represent to him, that the object of settling at Chuttanutty was to avoid the frequent disputes which had arisen from the factory being situated in the town of Hoogly; and that the part of the river opposite that town allotted for the English vessels was choked up with sand, so as to be unfit for the purpose. They therefore requested permission to remain at Chuttanutty, and to be allowed to purchase from the Zemindar ground sufficient for their factory.

A. D. 1686. Such was the state of affairs in the month of October, when Captain Heath arrived with his reinforcements; but being a person of a very warm disposition, he was enraged at the duplicity of the Nuwab; and, notwithstanding the remonstrances of Mr. Charnock, he resolved to recommence the war.

To effect this measure, he ordered all the Company's servants to embark, with their moveable property, on board the fleet, at Chuttanutty; and, on the 8th of November, set sail for Ballasore. On his arrival in the roads, the Governor of the town offered to enter into terms with him, on the part of the Nuwab; but his proposition having been rejected, he seized two of the Company's factors, who resided there, and retained them as hostages against any acts of violence: notwithstanding which, and that the two English deputies were still at Dacca, as well as two other factors in different parts of

Digitized by Google

the country, Captain Heath landed with a party of soldiers and seamen on the 29th of November, attacked and took a redoubt of thirty guns, and plundered the town of Ballasore. The English factory, on this occasion, was burned by the Governor; and the Company's servants, who had been previously taken prisoners, were carried up the country, where all subsequent efforts for their release were unavailing. This outrage was unfortunately committed on the very day that the Governor of Ballasore received a copy of the treaty which the Nuwab had made with the two deputies at Dacca; by which it was stipulated, that the English ships should co-operate with the Moghul army, in an attack upon the dominions of the King of Arracan. SECT. VI. A. D. 1688.

After the troops and seamen had glutted themselves with the plunder of Ballasore, Captain Heath set sail with his fleet, on the 13th of December, for Chittagong, where they arrived on the 17th of the month of January; but finding the works and garrison much stronger than they expected, a council of war was assembled, in which it was agreed to delay proceeding to farther hostilities, and again to write to the Nuwab at Dacca, stating their grievances and demands, and to await his answer, whether he would redress them, or compel them to make use of the power then in their hands. A. D. 1689.

Captain Heath, however, instead of waiting for the Nuwab's answer, or endeavouring to seize on Chittagong, proceeded with the fleet to the entrance of the river which leads to the city of Arracan, where he arrived on the 31st of January; and, according to the instructions received from the Company, sent proposals to the King, offering to co-operate with him against the Moghuls, provided he would grant the English a settlement

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1689.

in his dominions. But nearly a fortnight having elapsed without his receiving an answer, and not being of a temper to brook the procrastination of an Indian administration, he as suddenly took disgust against this new ally; and, on the 13th of February, without waiting for the result of his proposals, sailed away with the whole fleet, consisting of fifteen ships, (having the Bengal Governor and Council, with the Company's effects, on board,) and arrived at Madras on the 4th of March, where he apologized to the Governor of Fort St. George for his conduct, by saying that nothing but falsehoods had been told on either side.

As the English had completely set at defiance the authority of the Emperor, Aurungzebe, by fortifying both Bombay and Madras, and by extending their territories in the vicinity of these places, and had also captured a number of his ships, and had even entered into an alliance with his most inveterate enemy, the Mahratta chief Sambagee, it cannot be deemed surprising that the haughty mind of that monarch was much incensed against them: he, in consequence, issued orders to his commanders to extirpate the English from his dominions; and to seize or destroy all their property, wherever it might be found. It was in obedience to these orders, that the factory at Masulipatam was seized by the governor of that district; and that the warehouses of Vizagapatam were plundered, and all the English gentlemen put to death.

The Nuwab, Shaista Khan, was also under the necessity of complying with the Emperor's orders, so far as to sequester the whole of the English property in Bengal, and to place the Company's agents at Dacca in irons. Other authorities, however, lead us to suppose, that it was not Shaista Khan, but the

Digitized by Google

person who officiated as Governor after his departure, named Behadur Khan, that committed this act of severity. SECT. VI. A. D. 1689.

We are not informed of the precise time, but it was about this period that the Nuwab, Shaista Khan, being far advanced in years, and anxious to return to his native country, obtained permission to resign the government of Bengal. Notwithstanding his harsh conduct to Europeans, his memory is to this day spoken of with the highest respect in that province. It is related, that, during his government, grain was so cheap that rice was sold at the rate of 640lbs. weight for the rupee; to commemorate which event, as he was leaving Dacca, he ordered the western gate, through which he departed, to be built up, and an inscription to be placed thereon, interdicting any future Governor from opening it, till he had reduced the price of grain to the same rate: in consequence of which injunction, the gate remained closed till the government of the Nuwab Serferaz Khan, as will hereafter be related.

Several of the public buildings erected by Shaista Khan are yet to be seen at Dacca; which city is still called, by the Mohammedans, Jehangirenagur.

Shaista Khan died at Agra in the year of the Hejira 1105, much regretted by the Emperor and a numerous circle of friends.

NUWAB IBRAHIM KHAN.

Ibrahim Khan appointed to the government—His character—Invites the English to return to Bengal—Mr. Charnock and his Council arrive at Chuttanutty, and are graciously received—The Nuwab forwards the Emperor's passport for the English to trade duty free—The English still dissatisfied—Soobha Sing Zemindar rebels—joined by

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

the Afghan chief, Rehim Khan—The rebel army advance to Burdwan —Defeat and kill the Raja—The circumstance reported to the Governor, who orders Nur Allah, Foujedar of Jessore, to punish the rebels —The Foujedar shuts himself up in Hoogly—The rebels lay siege to, and take, that town—The Dutch, French, and English, obtain permission to fortify their factories—The Dutch Governor of Chinsura assists the Royalists to retake Hoogly—The rebels retreat to Saatgong —Part of the rebel forces advance to Nuddeah—Anecdote of the daughter of the Raja of Burdwan—Kills the rebel Chief—Rehim Khan chosen Generalissimo of the rebels—Pusillanimous conduct of the Governor—Niamut Khan, a Jagierdar, opposes the rebels—engages Rehim Khan in single contest—is killed—The rebels take and plunder Mukhsoosabad—The Emperor appoints his grandson, Aazeem Ooshan, Governor of the three provinces; but directs Ibrahim Khan to send a force, under his son Zubberdust Khan, against the rebels—The Royal army moves from Dacca—The rebels take post at Bogwangola—Zubberdust Khan detaches his cavalry, who surprize the rebels at Rajemahel, and give them a compleat defeat—Attacks and defeats the rebels at Bogwangola—Retakes the town of Mukhsoosabad—Advances to Burdwan, and compels the rebels to seek their safety in flight—Superseded by the Prince Aazeem Ooshan.

A. D. 1689. UPON the final resignation of Shaista Khan, the Emperor selected, for the government of Bengal, Ibrahim Khan, son of the celebrated Persian nobleman, Aly Murdan Khan, who delivered up the fortress of Candehar to the Emperor Shah Jehan. This chief was, in character, the very reverse of his father; he administered justice with strict impartiality, and encouraged agriculture and commerce; but was totally deficient of all military abilities.

July, A. D. 1690. The first act of his authority, after assuming the government, was one most congenial to his feelings, viz. the liberation of the Company's agents who were confined at Dacca; for as

Digitized by Google

we have seen, in the preceding chapter, that the English, in consequence of the oppression they had sustained from the Nuwab Shaista Khan, had entirely abandoned Bengal, it now also became a pleasing part of his duty to conciliate and recall the merchants of that nation. SECT. VI.

It has been before stated, that the Emperor, being highly incensed against the English, had commanded them to be expelled from every part of his dominions: but as Aurungzebe ever made his passions subservient to his policy, and was sensible that he derived a considerable aid to his revenue by the commerce carried on by the English; also, that their ships of war could much annoy his subjects, and prevent all intercourse between his dominions and Arabia, thereby putting a stop to the pilgrims visiting Mecca,—impressed with these ideas, he, in the month of January, A. D. 1690. whilst encamped at Viziapore, in the Dekkan, authorized his ministers to form a treaty with Messrs. Weldon and Navarro, two English commissioners, who had been sent from Bombay by Sir John Child, the Director-general of the Company's settlements, to solicit peace; and upon the appointment of Ibrahim Khan to the government of Bengal, the Emperor instructed him* to invite the English to return to that province.

In consequence of this permission, the Nuwab wrote letters, addressed to Mr. Charnock at Madras, inviting him to return, and re-establish all the Company's factories; with an assurance of a perfect oblivion of every thing which had passed, and that the English should be placed on a footing

* See Appendix.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1690.

with the most-favoured foreign nation: but Mr. Charnock and his Council were aware, from the deceptions which had been before practised, that, admitting the Nuwab to be sincere in his offers, they should still be exposed to the vexatious demands of the inferior officers, and to the avarice and oppressions of his successors; and being also displeased at the humiliating firmān which had lately been issued for Surat*; they therefore replied, that they could not accede to the proposition, unless the Emperor would grant to the Company a *specific firmān* for Bengal, stating the precise terms upon which they were in future to carry on their trade.

A second letter was written by the Nuwab to Mr. Charnock, informing him, that he had made an application to the Emperor for the desired firmān; but that as several months must elapse before it could be procured, he might, in the meantime, return, and be assured of his friendship and protection. In consequence of this invitation, Mr. Charnock, with his Council and factors, attended by an escort of thirty soldiers, returned, on the 24th of the month of August, to Chuttanutty; where, in obedience to the Nuwab's orders, addressed to Meer Aly Akbar, the governor of Hoogly, they were received with much civility.

A. D. 1691.

The next year, the Nuwab forwarded to Mr. Charnock, according to his promise, a *husb al hookum*, or order, from the Emperor Aurungzebe, authorizing the English to trade to Bengal without paying any other duty than an annual present of 3000 rupees†. However advantageous this licence may be considered in a pecuniary light, it fell far short of the expec-

---

* See Appendix. † Ibid.

Digitized by Google

tation of the Company's agents, who were still left exposed to the oppressions of the Nuwab or his inferior officers, and had no security for their personal safety. It was therefore their opinion, that, unless a fortification could be procured, with a district round it, perfectly exempted from the jurisdiction of the Nuwab, the commerce of the Company could never prosper: they, for these reasons, only established a factory at Chuttanutty; and sent agents to make purchases in different parts of the country. SECT. VI. A. D. 1691.

The year of the Hejira 1104 was marked by an extraordinary circumstance. The Grand Signior, having been informed that the Europeans procured great quantities of one of the ingredients for making gunpowder from India, wrote to Aurungzebe, to desire he would no longer permit his subjects to dispose of that article to Christians, as it was frequently used by them in the destruction of the followers of Mohammed; that, therefore, whoever supplied them was accessary to the death of the true believers. In consequence of this request, the principal source of the East-India Company's commercial advantages was, for some time, cut off, by a strict injunction to the Governor of Bengal not to allow them to purchase or manufacture any more saltpetre. A. D. 1692.

Three years after this event, the commander of a large ship belonging to the interlopers, or persons not licensed to trade to India, arriving in the Indian seas, commenced that system of piracy which was afterwards carried to such a height, under the celebrated Captain Kyd and his associates. This person seized two of the Moghul ships, which were going to Judda and Mocha with pilgrims. So gross an insult drew down upon the agents of the Dutch, French, and English nations, the vengeance of the A. D. 1695.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A.D. 1695. Moghul government: their factories were all laid under sequestration, and a stop put to their trade: in Bengal alone, owing to the clemency of the governor, Ibrahim Khan, the English agents were allowed their personal freedom, and permitted to carry on their commercial proceedings in a secret manner*.

Such was the state of intercourse between the English and the Moghul government, when an incident occurred which enabled the former to obtain, without any remuneration, that object which neither bribes nor entreaties could before procure.

A.D. 1695-6. In the year 1107 of the Hejira, a Hindoo zemindar of Bengal, named Soobha Sing, who possessed the villages of Jetwa and Burdeh, in the district of Burdwan, being dissatisfied with the Raja of that place, invited Rehim Khan, an Afghan chief, who was then considered as the head of that clan remaining in Orissa, to join him in overturning the government. Having united their forces, they advanced to Burdwan, and, in a pitched battle, slew the Raja, Kishen Ram; and, with the exception of his son, seized his family and all his property.

This success inspired the rebels with great hopes, and induced a number of soldiers of fortune, and other vagabonds, to flock to their standard.

Juggut Rai, the son of the Raja, having effected his escape to Dacca, laid his complaints before the Governor, who not considering the matter of much importance, contented himself with ordering Nur Allah, the Foujedar or military commander of Jessore, to punish the insurgents.

---

* In January 1692, Mr. Charnock died, and was succeeded by Mr. Ellis; but Bengal was again, by the Company's orders, made subservient to Madras. Mr. Charnock's tomb is still to be seen, in good order, in the Calcutta church-yard.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1696.

But that officer, who, instead of attending to his own business, had long employed himself in commerce and in amassing wealth, and possessed nothing of the military character but the name, having, after much loss of time, collected a few of the 3000 horse of which he was the commandant, marched from Jessore, and crossed the river; but on the approach of the rebels, he shut himself up in the fort of Hoogly, and implored assistance from the governor of the Dutch settlement of Chinsura. The rebels, convinced by this pusillanimous conduct that they had little to fear from the *merchant soldier*, advanced boldly, and laid siege to Hoogly: they carried on their attacks with such vigour, that the Foujedar became alarmed for his personal safety, and during the night, having crossed the river in a boat, made his escape to Jessore. The garrison, finding their commandant had fled, opened the gates; and the rebels got quiet possession of that opulent city without any loss.

On the breaking out of the rebellion, the three European settlements, viz. the Dutch at Chinsura, the French at Chandernagore, and the English at Chuttanutty, hired a number of the native soldiery to guard their property; and, professing themselves the avowed friends of government, requested permission from the Nuwab to put their factories into a state of defence against an enemy whose resentment they must incur by their adherence to him. The Nuwab ordered them, in general terms, to defend themselves; and they, taking for granted what was not positively forbidden, with great diligence raised walls with bastions round their factories.

The Dutch, French, and English fortify their factories.

Such was the origin of the three European forts, or towns, of Chinsura, Chandernagore, and Calcutta; and they were the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1696.

first which the Moghul government suffered foreigners to build in any part of their empire; for neither the territories of Madras nor Bombay had been subdued by the Moghuls previous to these places having been ceded to the English.

The rebels now assumed a haughty tone, and sent out detachments to every part of the country, to plunder all those who refused to join them. This proceeding caused the greatest consternation among the rich and well-disposed inhabitants. All those on the western side of the river, who could obtain admittance, took refuge in Chinsura. At length, the Governor of that place, touched with compassion for their misery, and hoping to recommend himself and nation to the Emperor, fitted out two ships of war; and, having embarked a number of European soldiers on board them, anchored in a short time opposite Hoogly.

The Dutch assist in retaking Hoogly from the rebels.

The rebels, ignorant of the intentions of the Dutch, hurried to the ramparts, to watch the motions of the ships; but were saluted with such a shower of both cannon and musquet balls, that they hastily abandoned the town, and retreated to Saatgong, formerly the Royal port of Bengal*.

From Saatgong, the zemindar, Soobha Sing, detached Rehim Khan, with the principal part of his army, to take

* Saatgong is thus described by Major Rennel, in his Memoir of the Map of Hindoostan.

"Saatgong or Sattagong, now an inconsiderable village, on a small creek of the Hoogly river, about four miles to the north-west of Hoogly, was, in 1566, and probably later, a large trading city, in which the European merchants had their factories. At that time, Saatgong river was capable of bearing small vessels; and I suspect that its then course, after passing Saatgong, was by way of Adaumpore, Omptah, and Tamlook; and the river called the *Old Ganges* was a part of its course, and received that name whilst the circumstance was fresh in the memory of the people."—See also Note to page 243 of this History.

Digitized by Google

possession of Nuddeah, and Mukhsoosabad, now called Moorshedabad, and returned himself to Burdwan.

Anecdote of the daughter of the Raja of Burdwan.

Amongst the captives which were taken in Burdwan, was a beautiful virgin, a daughter of the Raja, whom the Zemindar kept in confinement until an opportunity should offer of sacrificing her to his lust. The time was now arrived, when he thought he might gratify his vile passion with impunity: he secretly entered her apartment, and endeavoured to obtain by force what he could not effect by flattery and entreaty: but when he folded her in his arms, the girl drew from her clothes a sharp knife which she had concealed for the purpose, and stabbed him in the belly; she then turned the weapon against herself, and, with mistaken heroism, but high sense of honour, pierced her own heart. The wretch lived but a few hours; and was succeeded in his estate and power by his brother, Himmut Sing, who exerted himself to the utmost in ravaging and plundering all those persons of opulence who would not join in the rebellion.

When intelligence of the death of Soobha Sing reached the rebel army, they unanimously chose the Afghan chief to be their leader; and he, in order to give dignity to the station, assumed the royal title of Rehim Shah. By this time all the country on the west side of the river, from Rajemahel to Midnapore, was in possession of the rebels; and no measures had yet been adopted to check their progress.

Day after day, news was brought to the Governor of the alarming progress and increase of the rebels; but he, as if infatuated, replied to the remonstrances of his son and counsellors, "That a civil war was a dreadful evil, in which the lives of God's creatures were wantonly expended: that the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1696.

rebels, if let alone, would shortly disperse of themselves; and the only consequence would be, the loss of a small portion of his Majesty's revenue."

What the Governor would not attempt had nearly been effected by the desperate hand of an individual.

Rehim Shah continued his progress through the country, everywhere plundering, or compelling the people to join him. Upon his arrival in the district of Mukhsoosabad, he summoned Niamut Khan, an officer who held a jagier, or Royal grant of lands, on which he, with his dependants, resided, to join his standard. Niamut replied, "That being an officer in the Imperial service, and a loyal subject, it was contrary both to his duty and inclination to espouse such a cause." The rebel chief, incensed at this reply, ordered a party to seize Niamut; but the friends and dependants of the latter, having by this time assembled in his defence, it was not so easily effected. Rehim Shah was therefore under the necessity of heading a body of his Afghan cavalry to effect his purpose. When he arrived at the estate of Niamut, he found a small, but united, band drawn up to receive him: as the combats in India were, even at that late period, more frequently decided by duels between the chiefs, or champions, of the contending armies, than by a general engagement, Tehuver Khan, a nephew of Niamut's, well mounted and armed, advanced into the plain, and challenged any of the Afghans to meet him. No single warrior daring to advance, a party of Afghans at once rushed forward, and, before his friends could go to his assistance, cut the youth to pieces. On hearing of this event, Niamut Khan, although only dressed in a single vest of fine muslin, without waiting to put on his helmet or armour, seized

Digitized by Google

his sword, and vaulting on his horse, which stood ready saddled, rushed into the field. His attention was soon attracted by the standard of Rehim Shah: he advanced towards him, and the Afghans receded to the right and left. Niamut saw his enemy, and boldly spurring on his horse, struck the rebel chief on the head. Dreadful must have been his sensations, when he saw the blade of his sword shivered by the impenetrable helmet of the chief, and his opponent still unmoved from his seat. Rage now strengthened his arm; he threw the handle of the sword at Rehim Shah; the knob or point of which, striking him with great violence on the side, felled him from his horse. Niamut instantly dismounted; and drawing the dagger of the rebel, attempted to pierce his throat; but the chain of the helmet again intervened; and before Niamut could effect his purpose, he was surrounded, and cut to pieces, by the Afghans: many of his friends were also slain, and all his property plundered.

The rebels then advanced to Mukhsoosabad; and after defeating 5000 of the Royal troops, took, and plundered, that town. The merchants of Cossimbazar having, however, sent a deputation to meet the rebel chief, he spared that place; but for this conduct, Golah Chund, the principal merchant, was afterwards severely fined.

About the same time, a party of the rebels approached Chuttanutty, and set fire to the villages; but the zemindars in the neighbourhood attacked, and killed, ninety of them. Another party of the rebels laid siege to the fort of Tanna*; but the English having, at the request of the Foujedar of Hoogly, sent a frigate to support the fort, the rebels were compelled to retreat.

* Ten miles west of Calcutta, on the opposite side of the river.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

In the meantime, the Europeans worked day and night in fortifying their factories at Chinsura, Chandernagore, and Chuttanutty: at the latter place, the English constructed regular bastions, capable of bearing cannon; but to avoid giving offence, the embrasures were filled up, on the outside, A. D. 1697. with a wall of single brick. In the month of March, the rebels took possession of Rajemahel and Malda, and seized upon the Dutch and English factories at the latter place, in which they found considerable property.

The first intelligence the Emperor received of these events was through the newspaper. His surprise and indignation at the conduct of the Governor was excessive; and to mark his displeasure, he immediately appointed his own grandson, the prince Azeem Ooshan, to the united government of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa. He, however, sent orders to the Nuwab, Ibrahim Khan, to remain till the arrival of his successor, but, in the meantime, to place his son, Zubberdust Khan, at the head of the Bengal forces, and send him immediately against the rebels. Orders were also issued to the Governors of Oude, Allahabad, and Behar, to co-operate, by every means in their power, with the Governor of Bengal, in quieting the insurrection, and extirpating the rebels.

The Emperor appoints Azeem Ooshan governor of the three provinces.

On the receipt of the Imperial orders, Zubberdust Khan, who had long beheld with regret the apathy of his father, quickly equipped an army, consisting of both cavalry and infantry, with a good train of artillery, and attended by a number of war-boats. As soon as every thing was in readiness, he marched from Dacca, and proceeded up the right bank of the Ganges.

In the meantime, the resources of Rehim Shah being greatly

Digitized by Google

increased*, he had much augmented his army; and assumed the dignity and style of a Prince. When informed of the approach of the Imperial troops from Dacca, he encamped his army on the banks of the river, in the vicinity of Bogwangola, resolving to risk his fate in a pitched battle.

But during the time that Zubberdust Khan was advancing, by short marches, with his artillery and infantry, he detached the greater part of his cavalry to beat up the quarters of the rebels, who were in possession of Rajemahel and Malda. This service was ably performed; the rebels were defeated at Rajemahel; an Afghan chief, named Ghyret Khan, was killed, and the greater part of their plunder retaken. That which belonged to the Dutch and English was reclaimed by the agents of those nations; but the Moghul commander refused to restore it without the orders of the Governor.

Zubberdust Khan defeats the rebels, A. D. 1697.

Zubberdust Khan, having arrived within a few miles of the rebel camp, landed his infantry and guns from the fleet; and, after reconnoitring the position of the enemy, ordered his war-boats to harass them from the river, while he attacked them by land. The first day was spent in a cannonade; during which the guns of the Imperial army, being served by the Portuguese in the Royal service, dismounted most of those of the enemy, and silenced the redoubts which he had thrown up along his front. The next morning, both armies being drawn out in battle array, the attack was commenced by the Imperial infantry; but in a short time the engagement became

* Governor Eyre, in his letter of December 1696, says, that the country in possession of the rebels was estimated at sixty lacs of rupees per annum; and that their force consisted of 12,000 cavalry, and 30,000 infantry. *East-India Records*, vol. XIX. page 263.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. general, and continued for several hours. At length the rebels were overcome, and compelled to retreat, leaving their camp to be plundered by the Royalists.

Zubberdust Khan encamped that night on the field of battle, and employed his infantry in burying the dead, and assisting the wounded of both parties.

May, A. D. 1697. The following day was employed in writing to all the zemindars and jagierdars, announcing to them the victory gained by his Majesty's troops, commanding them to cut off all communication with the rebels, and to prevent their receiving any supplies of provisions. The good effects of these orders, and of the victory, were immediately apparent; many of the zemindars in the vicinity of the field of battle hastened to the Royal camp, and offered to join the army with their quotas of troops.

Zubberdust Khan, having made all the requisite arrangements, marched to the neighbourhood of Mukhsoosabad, and encamped on an extensive plain, to the eastward of the town, intending to attack the rebels next morning; but during the night Rehim Shah crossed the river, and took the route of Burdwan. The Imperialists followed him to Burdwan; and having driven him thence, pursued him from place to place.

We must now take leave, for a short time, of Zubberdust Khan, to detail the operations of the prince Azeem Ooshan.

Digitized by Google

SULTAN AZEEM OOSHAN.

The prince Azeem Ooshan appointed to the government of the three provinces—Marches from the Dekkan to Allahabad—Orders the Governor of Oude, and Zemindars of Benaras and Behar, to join him—Arrives at Patna—Commands Zubberdust Khan not to risk another engagement with the rebels, till he should join him—Zubberdust Khan cantons his army at Burdwan—The Prince stops at Mongier—Advances to Burdwan—Affronts Zubberdust Khan by the coolness of his reception—The General quits the army in disgust—The rebels re-assemble, and encamp in the vicinity of Burdwan—The Dutch and English send agents to the Prince, to solicit further extension of their privileges—The Prince makes amicable overtures to the rebels, who agree to submit, provided Khuaje Anvur, the Prince's minister, is sent to assure them of safety—The rebels murder the Khuaje, and attack the Royal camp; but are defeated, and their chief, Rehim Shah, killed; after which the others submit—The Prince establishes his residence in Burdwan—Devotes his attention to the affairs of the province—Builds a mosque in Burdwan, and a new bazar in Hoogly—Regulates the customs of the port—Anecdote of a celebrated Derbeish—The Prince interferes between the Foujedar of Hoogly and the English, respecting the appointment of a Cazy, or Mohammedan Judge, to Calcutta—The Prince proceeds to Dacca—wishes to make a monopoly of the foreign trade—severely reprimanded by the Emperor—The King of England sends an Ambassador to the Court of Aurungzebe—The Ambassador lands at Masulipatam, but afterwards proceeds to Surat, and lands there—Sets out for the Moghul camp—Obtains an audience of the Emperor—graciously received, and orders issued for preparing the Firmāns—Intelligence received that an English pirate had taken three of the Moghul ships—The Ambassador required to give security against similar aggressions—refuses—The negociation broken off—The Ambassador quits the Moghul camp—sails from Surat—dies—The Emperor, incensed at the English, orders all the Europeans in his dominions to be confined—Origin and rise of Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan—Appointed Dewan of Bengal—Description of the officers of

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Nazim and of Dewan—Moorshud Cooly enters with assiduity upon his employment—Dissentions between him and the Prince—The latter accused of attempting to assassinate the Dewan—The Dewan removes his residence to Mukhsoosabad—The Emperor, displeased with the Prince, orders him to quit Bengal, and to reside in Behar—The Prince proceeds to Rajemahel, and afterwards to Patna, where he establishes his residence, and gives his own name to that city—In consequence of the Emperor's orders, the English at Patna and Rajemahel are confined—The inhabitants of Calcutta threatened—The Dewan demands the original firmāns—The English, having lost theirs, are obliged to bribe the Secretary—Benevolent conduct of the Prince—The Dewan proceeds to Court—Graciously received by the Emperor—Re-appointed Dewan of the three provinces, and deputy of the Prince in Bengal and Orissa—State of the English affairs in Bengal—Azeem Ooshan recalled to Court—Death of the Emperor Aurungzebe—Aazim Shah, the second son, mounts the throne, and marches towards Dehly—The prince Azeem Ooshan arrives at Agra—Receives intelligence of the Emperor's death—Endeavours to seize Agra for his father—Disappointed in getting the fort, but secures the district—Seizes the Bengal revenue—Levies an army—Meeting between him and his father, Shah Alum—The Governor delivers up the fort of Agra to the latter, who soon after marches to meet Aazim Shah—Battle between the brothers—Aazim Shah, and both his sons, killed—Shah Alum takes the title of Behadur Shah—Appoints his son, Azeem Ooshan, governor of the four provinces, of Allahabad, Behar, Bengal, and Orissa; but orders him to retain Moorshud Cooly Khan as his deputy in the two latter provinces—The Prince continues to reside at Court, but appoints Syed Abdullah Khan to be his deputy in Allahabad, and Syed Hussein Aly Khan to be his deputy in Behar—Behadur Shah dies—Contest between his four sons for the empire—Azeem Ooshan is killed, and Jehandar Shah succeeds to the throne.

Azeem Ooshan made Governor, A. D. 1696.

IT has been before stated, that when the Emperor Aurungzebe, in the year 1108, heard of the insurrection in Bengal, he immediately appointed his grandson, Azeem Ooshan, second son of Behadur Shah, to the government of that province.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1696.

The Prince was, at the period of his appointment, in the Royal camp, then in the Dekkan; and as soon as he received the investiture of his office, marched with a select corps of 12,000 cavalry towards Allahabad: but as that prince will make a conspicuous figure in the sequel of this history, it is presumed that the following short account, given of him, and of the policy of Aurungzebe, by an eye-witness of the events, will not be deemed impertinent.

"Azeem Ooshan, the second son of Behadur Shah, was a statesman of winning manners. Aulumgeer (the Emperor Aurungzebe) had always pursued the policy of encouraging his grandsons, and employing them in public affairs; for as his sons were ambitious of great power, and at the head of armies, he thus prudently controlled them, by opposing to them rivals in their own families; as Bedār Bukht to Aazim Shah; and Azeem Ooshan to Shah Alum Behadur Shah. To Azeem Ooshan he had given the advantageous government of the three provinces of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa*."

Upon the Prince's arrival at Allahabad, he sent orders to the Governor of Oude immediately to join him, with all his forces: he also issued his commands to all the zemindars in that neighbourhood, and to those of Benaras and Behar, to join his camp as soon as he should enter their respective territories, on his route to Bengal.

When the Prince arrived at Patna, he heard of the success of Zubberdust Khan; and fearing that so active an officer would gather all the laurels before his arrival at the scene of

---

* Vide Memoirs of the Moghul Empire, by Eradut Khan. *Scott's History of the Dekkan*, vol. II.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. May, A. D. 1697. action, and leave him nothing by which he might gain credit with the Emperor, he sent positive commands to the General not to risk another engagement until he should join him with his victorious army. Zubberdust Khan saw clearly the object of this order, and was much hurt at having his hands thus tied up; but as the rainy season was just setting in, he cantoned his army in the vicinity of Burdwan, and waited patiently the arrival of the Prince, who also cantoned his army at Mongier, and did not advance to Burdwan till the end of the year. Upon the approach of the Prince, Zubberdust Khan advanced several miles, to meet, and to pay his respects to, the grandson and representative of the Emperor: but so cool and distant was the reception he met with from his Highness, that he resolved immediately to quit the army, and to proceed with his father, the deposed Governor, to Court.

Having delivered over the command of the troops, he made known his request to his Royal Highness; who, jealous of the fame that Zubberdust Khan had so justly acquired, was graciously pleased to comply with his wishes; although, by so doing, he greatly reduced the strength of his own army; as nearly 8000 of the best troops were the dependants, or followers, of the General and his father, and went away with him.

A. D. 1698.

The departure of Zubberdust Khan was a subject of great joy and exultation to the rebels; they dreaded the activity and courage of that officer; and hoped to gain some advantage from the want of experience and local knowledge of the Prince. Rehim Shah immediately sent directions to all his followers; who, in order to conceal themselves, had dispersed in various parts of the country, to join him on a certain day.

Thus while the Prince was amusing himself at Burdwan,

Digitized by Google

and receiving the congratulations of the zemindars and principal men of the province, the rebels again collected in great force; and had the audacity, not only to plunder the districts of Nuddeah and Hoogly, but to encamp within a few miles of Burdwan. A. D. 1697.

During the time the Prince was at Burdwan, the Dutch chief, of Chinsura, sent an agent to the camp; who represented, that while his nation paid a duty of 3½ per cent. on all their commerce, the English only paid the petty sum of 3000 rupees per annum; and therefore solicited that the Dutch might be put on the same footing.

As it was notorious that the Prince was of a very indolent disposition, and would not give himself much trouble to ascertain the original cause of such a distinction; and that he had come into the province for the express purpose of amassing a fortune, in consequence of which no business could be transacted without a bribe, and that the judicious application of money might procure any favour; the English also deputed, as their envoy, one of the most intelligent of the Company's servants, a Mr. Walsh, not only to oppose the intrigues of the Dutch, but to procure from his Highness a grant of the villages of Chuttanutty, Gobindpore, and Calicotta; also to demand restitution of the Company's property, which was taken from the rebels at Rajemahel, and detained by the Moghul General: he was further authorized to solicit a confirmation of the English privileges, by the Prince's special Nishān, or order, for freedom of trade, without the payment of any duties.

Mr. Walsh arrived in the Prince's camp, at Burdwan, in January; but owing to the interruption of business by the war against the rebels, and various other procrastinations, he A. D. 1698.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

The English obtain further privileges, A. D. 1698.

did not effect the object of his mission till the month of July; when, at length, by the payment of a considerable sum of money, the Prince's order for the purchase of the lands was forwarded to Chuttanutty; but on being shewn to the zemindars of the three villages, they refused to make over the lands, as the order was not countersigned by the King's Dewan. This circumstance caused a further delay; and it was the end of the year before the business was settled to the satisfaction of the English: nor did they receive the Prince's order for freedom of trade till the month of January 1700*.

From this digression we return to the account of the war, as given by the native historian.

When Azeem Ooshan was informed of the proceedings of the rebels, instead of attacking them with vigour, he had the weakness to send a letter to Rehim Shah, admonishing him to return to his duty, with a promise of forgiveness, and of being taken into the Royal favour if he complied. The rebel received the letter with hypocritical marks of respect; and returned a verbal message, "That if the Prince would send to him Khuaje Anvur, his chief counsellor, with assurances of safety, he would come and pay his devoirs to his Royal Highness."†

* It was during this period that the great contest between the two English Companies took place in Bengal. The Prince could not understand the subject, but took bribes from both parties: from the Old Company he got 16,000 rupees; and from the New, 14,000.

† Governor Eyre, in his letter dated January 6, 1698, states, it was reported that the Prince sent the rebel chief a pair of shackles and a sword, desiring him to take his choice: that the rebel took the sword; but sent a polite message to the Prince, pointing out to him the great age of the Emperor, the contentions that must ensue upon his death, and the favourable opportunity that was now presented to his Highness, of securing for himself the rich province of Bengal, by taking into his favour and service the Afghans, whose friendship he would find not less serviceable than their enmity would prove formidable. *East-India Records*, vol. XIX. page 253.

Digitized by Google

The Prince, whose disposition was open and sincere, gave his enemy credit for an equal degree of candour; and ordered Khuaje Anvur to proceed early the next morning to the Afghan camp, and bring the rebel chief to his presence. The Khuaje reposing the same confidence as the Prince did in the assurances of Rehim Shah, advanced, with a small party of attendants, to the boundaries of his camp; and sent a message that he was there, ready to give him the required assurances of safety, and to conduct him to the presence of the Prince.

Whether Rehim Shah had changed his mind during the night, or wished to be more highly honoured in the sight of his followers, he insisted that the Khuaje should come to his tent; and there, in the presence of witnesses, repeat the Prince's invitation and assurances of safety. But the Khuaje, suspecting some treachery, declined going into the camp, and attempted to return home. He was pursued by a party of the Afghans; and after defending himself to the last extremity, he and all his attendants were cut to pieces.

After this atrocious act of villainy, Rehim Shah, convinced that he had nothing to expect from the clemency of the Prince, ordered his troops to mount, and to make a sudden and vigorous attack on the Royal camp.

This movement was executed with such rapidity, that Azeem Ooshan had barely time to mount his elephant before he was surrounded by a party of the Afghans, headed by their chief, Rehim Shah; and would certainly have been taken prisoner, had not a brave Arab officer, named Hamid Khan, called out, that he was the Prince, and challenged the Afghan to single combat; at the same moment discharging an arrow, which penetrated the rebel's side: a second arrow from his

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Rehim Shah slain in battle, A. D. 1698.

hand wounded his antagonist's horse in the head, who thereon reared up, and threw his rider on the ground: the Arab instantly dismounted, and, having cut off Rehim Shah's head, held it up on the point of his lance.

The Afghans, seeing the catastrophe of their chief, were struck with panic, and fled on all sides. After which they offered to submit to the Prince, provided he would take them into his service; which being agreed to, a general amnesty was passed, and peace restored to the harassed province.

After this unexpected victory, the Prince proceeded to the tomb of Shah Ibrahim Sukka*, in the vicinity of Burdwan: and having returned thanks to the Almighty for his success, he ordered a large sum of money to be distributed, in alms, to the poor and religious persons who attended on the shrine of the Saint. He then entered the city, and took up his residence in the fort, which at that period was considered a place of some strength.

The Prince continued to reside for a considerable time in Burdwan: during which period he directed his attention to repairing the injuries that had been committed by the rebels, and in bringing back the inhabitants of those districts, who had been compelled to abandon their homes. He restored Juggut Roy, the son of the murdered Raja, to his zemindary of Burdwan; and recompensed all those persons who, having remained firm in their allegiance, had been dispossessed of their lands by the rebels. For the brave Hamid Khan he procured, from the Emperor, the title of Shumshere Khan Behadur, and

* This person was originally a water-carrier; but having associated with the Soofies, he became a celebrated author of poems and religious works. After his death he was canonized, and his tomb is still resorted to by pilgrims.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1698.

the office of Foujedar, or military commander, of the districts of Bundasil and Silhet: he also liberally rewarded all the other officers who had distinguished themselves on this occasion. During the period that Azeem Ooshan resided at Burdwan, he built, in that city, a public mosque: he also caused to be constructed, in Hoogly, a new *bazar*, to which he gave the name of Shah Gunge; but the people, in compliment to him, called it Azeem Gunge. He regulated the customs of the port of Hoogly at two and a half per cent. on all goods belonging to Mohammedans; but compelled the Hindoos* to pay five, and the Christians three and a half, per cent. on their merchandise. He also established the inland duties, called *sair*, upon various commodities passing from one place to another, in the interior of the country. In short, the Prince devoted much of his time to the performance of the duties of his office, and to the improvement of the revenues. He also every day allotted several hours to the conversation of the learned and religious, and had frequently passages from the best authors read to him. He often visited the hermits and derveishes, and solicited their prayers for his succession to the throne.

Anecdote of a celebrated Derveish.

One day the Prince sent his two sons, Kereem Addeen and Ferrokhsere, to visit a celebrated Soofy†, named Bayezid, and to request that the holy man would take the trouble of coming to the palace. Upon their arrival near the Saint's dwelling, Ferrokhsere alighted from his horse; and approaching, in the most respectful manner, paid his compliments, and delivered his father's message, whilst the other brother scarcely deigned to return the Soofy's salutation.

* The English were exempted from this duty, as they paid a specific sum annually.

† Hermit, or Monk. There are several orders of them.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1698.

The Saint was much irritated at the conduct of Kereem Addeen, and highly pleased by the humility of Ferrokhsere: he therefore took the latter by the hand, and, causing him to sit down beside him, blessed him, and said to him, "To you is this day given the empire of Hindoostan." He soon after arose, and accompanied the youths to the palace.

When Azeem Ooshan was informed of the approach of the Soofy, he arose from his seat, and advanced to meet him; and after having made many apologies for the trouble he had given him, seated him on his own musnud. He shortly after communicated to the Saint the object of his wishes; and supplicated his prayers, that he might one day succeed to the throne. The Saint with great dignity replied, "Alas! what you desire has already been given to your son Ferrokhsere: the arrow of my prayer has been shot from the bow, and cannot be recalled." He then arose, bade the Prince adieu, and retired to his cell; leaving Azeem Ooshan quite discomfited by his prediction, to which he gave much credit, and which, in the sequel, was realized.

The villages of Chuttanutty, Govindpore, and Calicotta, which, in virtue of the Prince's Nishān, had been purchased from the zemindars, with their districts, extended about three miles on the eastern side of the Bhaggarutty river, and about one mile inland. The latter of these villages takes its name from a temple dedicated to Caly, the Hindoo goddess of time; and from it the English called their town Calcutta.

Fort William, Calcutta.

In the year 1699-1700, the factory of Calcutta, which, in consequence of the fortifications that had been added to it during the rebellion, was dignified by the appellation of a Fortress, was named, in compliment to the King of England,

Digitized by Google

Fort William: and, as a number of opulent natives, in consequence of the security given to their property, and facility to their trade, had been induced to build houses in the town, and make it their residence, its prosperity excited the jealousy of the Foujedar of Hoogly, who, pretending that he should be punished for suffering so many of the Moghul subjects to withdraw themselves from his jurisdiction, threatened to send a Cazy, or Mohammedan judge, and officers of the police, to administer justice amongst the natives living under the protection of the English flag: but as this measure would have submitted the English to the same inconveniences which they had formerly suffered at Hoogly, it was counteracted by a bribe sent to the Prince, who forbad the Governor of Hoogly from proceeding in his intentions. By this constant attention to the accumulation of wealth, Azeem Ooshan is said to have carried with him, out of the province, three millions of pounds sterling in specie, and jewels to a very great amount. SECT. VI.

The Prince, after a residence of nearly three years in Burdwan, having regulated the affairs of the western part of Bengal to his satisfaction, ordered the state-boats which had been built during the government of Sultan Shujaa, to be collected in the vicinity of Hoogly; and embarking at that place, proceeded with great pomp to Dacca, and took possession of the Royal palace. A. D. 1700-1.

By the advice of some narrow-sighted politician, the Prince was induced, about this time, to adopt a measure which not only gave great disgust to the commercial part of the community, but drew on him the displeasure of the Emperor Aurungzebe.

The Prince wished to become the sole merchant of all

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. European and foreign goods brought to Bengal; he therefore established agents at all the ports, with authority to purchase the cargo of every ship that arrived, at a low price; and afterwards retail the goods to the merchants at a considerable profit. To this species of commerce was assigned the epithets of *Soudai Khās* and *Soudai Ām*, special and general purchases.

He also, in order to gain popularity with the Hindoos, celebrated their holydays; putting on yellow and rose-coloured garments, and entering into the sports which are practised on the anniversary of the return of spring.

When, through the medium of the newspapers, the Emperor received information of the Prince's conduct, he wrote him, with his own hand, a letter replete with irony and sarcasm; observing, that a yellow turban, and rose-coloured garments, suited but ill with a beard of forty-six years' growth. He also
A. D. 1701. explained that the monopoly, which he had dignified with the name of *Soudai Khās*, was nothing less than individual insanity and public oppression*; and to evince to his subjects that he would not sanction any act of injustice, even by his sons or grandchildren, he struck off 500 horse from the Prince's military rank.

The great confusion occasioned in India by the contest between the rival English Companies, and the depredations of the pirates, induced his Majesty King William, in the year 1698-9, to depute Sir William Norris as his Ambassador to the Court of the Emperor of Hindoostan. The object of this mission was to solicit *firmāns*, or privileges, for the English nation; and to render the *New*, or English Company, its representative in India†.

* In Persian, *Souda* means *traffic*; but in Arabic, *madness*.

† See *Bruce's Annals of the East-India Company*, A. D. 1698-9.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

The King of England sends an Ambassador to Aurungzebe, A. D. 1699.

The Ambassador landed at Masulipatam on the 25th of Sept. 1699, where he was detained by various obstacles, arising chiefly from the jarring interests of two Companies belonging to the same nation, till the end of the following year: and not being permitted to pursue his journey to the Emperor's camp by Golcondah, he proceeded by sea to Surat, and landed at that port on the 10th of December; but owing to the A. D. 1700. intrigues of Sir John Gayer, the agent of the *Old* or London Company, the Governor of Surat refused to receive Sir William Norris as the Ambassador of the English nation, unless he could produce his credentials, signed by his Majesty. These having been produced, the Ambassador landed, and was received by Sir Nicholas Waite, the Consul of the *New* Company, with great respect.

On the 26th of January, the Ambassador set out on his A. D. 1701. journey towards the Emperor's camp, with a retinue of sixty Europeans and 300 natives‡. On the 3d of March he reached Brampore; at which place it became expedient to visit the vizier Gazy Addeen Khan, one of the viziers who happened to be there. Some time was spent in adjusting the ceremonies; but the Ambassador, requiring to be admitted to a conference, preceded by drums, trumpets, &c. which the Vizier refused, as being inconsistent with Eastern usages on such occasions, the Ambassador held this refusal to be derogatory from his dignity, and left Brampore without having any conference with the Vizier; and on the 7th of April reached Pernalla, near which the camp of Aurungzebe was situated: and as

‡ An account of the procession, and list of the presents, may be found in *Bruce's Annals of the East-India Company*, A. D. 1700-1, page 462.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1701.

soon as he had notified his arrival, he was permitted to pitch his tents in the vicinity of the Royal residence.

On the 28th of April the Ambassador obtained his first audience, and was most graciously received. He, in consequence, made an application to the Emperor to issue *firmāns* for freedom of trade to the New Company. His Majesty condescendingly promised that he would give orders to his viziers on the subject. Sometime after, the Ambassador had a second audience, and presented the Emperor with 200 gold *mohurs;* and the business seemed to be in a fair train of success, when intelligence arrived from Surat, that three Moghul ships, coming from Mocha, had been captured by an English pirate: in consequence of this information, the Viziers demanded that the Ambassador should not only give security for the return of these ships, but that he should guaranty the future safety of the Moghul commerce against pirates of every description. The Ambassador declined entering into this stipulation; and was thereon informed, that "he knew his way back to England." Considering this answer as a dismission from the Court, Sir William Norris desired passes to be issued for his safe return to Surat; and on the morning of the 5th of November quitted the Moghul camp.

Some efforts were made by the Viziers to induce the Ambassador to alter his resolution; and he was forcibly detained at Brampore, till a letter, and a sword, for the King of England, from Aurungzebe, arrived.

A. D. 1702. On the 7th of January, Sir William Norris was permitted to continue his journey, and arrived at Surat on the 12th of April. On the 29th of the same month, he embarked on

Digitized by Google

board the Scipio, and a few days afterwards sailed for England; but died before the ship reached St. Helena.

In consequence of the abrupt termination of the negociation, and the continued depredations of the pirates, the Emperor was much incensed, and gave command that every European in his dominions should be seized, and thrown into prison*.

It now becomes requisite to relinquish, for a time, the affairs of the English, and of Azeem Ooshan; and to introduce to the reader a character, who, in the sequel, will make a conspicuous figure in the transactions of Bengal. This person was the son of a poor Brahman†, and, during his youth, was purchased by a Persian merchant, named Hajy Shuffia, who took him to Ispahan, and, having circumcised him, changed his name to Mohammed Hady, and educated him as one of his own children. Upon the death of the merchant, his heirs manumitted the youth, and permitted him to proceed to the Dekkan; where, soon after his arrival, he obtained an inferior employment in the service of Hajy Abdullah, Dewan (superintendant of the revenues) of Berar: in this situation he evinced such a knowledge of accounts, and expertness in business, that within a few years he was recommended to the Emperor Aurungzebe, as a fit person to fill the office of Dewan of Hyderabad, then vacant: he was in consequence appointed to that office, and dignified with the title of Kar Tulb Khan.

Origin of Moorshud Cooly Khan.

* The failure of this embassy was, in part, owing to the animosity existing between the Old and New Companies; all of which are fully detailed in Mr. Bruce's *Annals*; and I have therefore purposely avoided entering into any discussion on the subject. Happily for the repose of all parties, these dissentions were terminated by the union of the two Companies in 1702-3; but the adjustment of their respective affairs was not completed till the year 1708, when they took the title of *The United Company of Merchants trading to the East Indies.*

† See *Muasir al Omrah.*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A continuation of the same line of conduct which had recommended him to the Emperor, induced that monarch to
A. D. 1701. nominate Kar Tulb Khan, in the year 1113, to the important office of Dewan of Bengal, with the title of Moorshud Cooly Khan; under which name he will be continued throughout this History*.

During the despotic reign of Aurungzebe, the offices of Nazim (military governor) and Dewan were kept perfectly distinct: the business of the former was to defend and protect the country from foreign insult or domestic insurrections, and to enforce a strict obedience to the laws: to the latter was assigned the collection of the revenues, and the disbursements of all the requisite expenses†. He was, in a certain degree, subject to the orders of the Nazim; being obliged to comply with all written orders, for money, from that officer, for the service of government: but the Nazim was responsible to to the exchequer for any improper use of that power: he received his regular salary from the Dewan, and was not entitled to any further emolument from his office. These two officers were, however, commanded to consult with each other, upon all important affairs: and to act in concert upon every public emergency, according to the regulations which from time to time were issued.

Moorshud Cooly Khan, soon after his appointment, proceeded to Dacca, and entered with alacrity upon the business of

* By Mr. Orme he is called Jaffier Khan; and by Mr. Gladwin, and the translator of the *Sier al Muhakhereen*, sometimes Jaffier Khan, and at other times Moorshud Cooly. But as a second Jaffier Khan will appear in the pages of this History, I have thought it better to let him retain the title of Moorshud Cooly Khan throughout.

† A copy of the Dewan's commission may be found in the Appendix to the 3d volume of *Dow's History of Hindoostan*.

Digitized by Google

his office. He found that the country was rich and productive, but that the public revenue had been absorbed in improper channels. He therefore appointed his own collectors to the different districts; and in a short period ascertained that the revenue of Bengal amounted to one crore (ten millions) of rupees. SECT. VI. A.D. 1701-2.

During the superintendance of former Dewans, the greater part of Bengal had, from the idea of its being an unhealthy and unproductive country, been made over to military jagierdars‡; and only a small proportion of it remained under the immediate controul of the exchequer: its revenue therefore had not even sufficed to pay the Nazim, and military and civil establishments; in consequence of which, money was frequently drawn from the other Soubahs, to liquidate the debts of Bengal. The first act of Moorshud Cooly's authority was, to request the Emperor to cancel all the jagiers of Bengal; and to assign to the officers lands in Orissa, and other districts; where the hand of authority, aided by private influence and superintendance, was required to enforce the collections.

His suggestions were readily attended to; and all the assignments on lands, except the stipends of the Nizamut and Dewany, were transferred to Orissa. By this means the whole of the zemindars, or Hindoo landholders, were placed under the immediate controul of the Dewan, who, by his authority, enforced a very considerable rise on their rents, and thereby much augmented the revenue of the state.

This conduct acquired for Moorshud Cooly Khan great celebrity at Court; but the haughty spirit of the Prince,

‡ Possessors of lands, held by assignment from the Crown for particular services.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1702. Azeem Ooshan, could ill brook the constant interference, in all pecuniary transactions, of the Dewan, and his frequent opposition to his Royal Highness's commands. Beside these causes, the Prince was exceedingly jealous of the high favour in which Moorshud Cooly stood with the Emperor; and the courtiers and favourites of the Prince, whose extravagance, or assumed powers, were constantly controuled by the Dewan, fanned the flame, and added fuel to his already exasperated temper: Azeem Ooshan was therefore exceedingly anxious to get rid of his rival, if it could be effected without risking the displeasure of the Emperor.

As in the East there have been at all times found people ready to commit the most daring acts, or to perpetrate the most atrocious murders, when supported by the hand of power, or bribed by the temptation of wealth; an officer, named Abdal Vahid, commanding a long-established corps of horse, called Nukedy, who were entitled to their pay monthly from the treasury, and therefore looked with contempt on the other troops paid by assignments on the zemindars,—and who were, besides, noted for their insolence and contempt of all authority,—proposed to the Prince to assassinate the Dewan, if he would ensure to him, or to his heirs, a large sum of money. The offer having been accepted, Abdal Vahid ordered his men to waylay the Dewan, the next time he came to pay his respects to the Prince.

A. D. 1702-3.

An opportunity soon after offered: the Dewan, who was never deficient in etiquette and respect to the Viceroy, left his house one morning, to pay his obeisance at the palace; but before he had gotten half way, his retinue was stopped in the street by a large body of the Nukedy regiment, who, in a

Digitized by Google

clamorous manner, demanded their pay. The Dewan, who always went abroad well armed, and was attended by a considerable number of armed followers, immediately jumped out of his palanquine; and, drawing his sword, commanded his attendants to clear the road, and drive those fellows away. The Nukedies, seeing his resolution and firmness, shrunk back, and allowed him to proceed unmolested to the palace*; where, as soon as he entered, he loudly accused the Prince of being the author of this conspiracy. He then seated himself, in a rude and indecorous manner, opposite to him; and putting his hand to his dagger, said, "If you want my life, here let us try the contest: if otherwise, take care that nothing of this kind ever again occurs." SECT. VI. A. D. 1702-3.

The Prince alarmed by his threats, and dreading the severe justice of the Emperor, was very much agitated; and after protesting his innocence in the most solemn manner, sent for Abdal Vahid, and severely reprimanded him for the flagitious conduct of his men, threatening him with the severest marks of his displeasure if they were ever again guilty of such disorderly behaviour: these excuses did not, however, satisfy the Dewan; he proceeded immediately to the Public Hall of Audience, and, having sent for Abdal Vahid, examined into the arrears due to the corps; and, after giving him an assignment for the amount, on one of the zemindars, discharged him and his regiment from the Imperial service.

Moorshud Cooly then returned home; and having drawn

* This building, called the Pooshteh, is still in existence, and is inhabited by the chief civil servant at Dacca.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1702-3. out a statement of all the circumstances, had it authenticated by the signatures of the public officers; and forwarded it, with a representation from himself, to the Emperor.

After acting in so spirited and independent a manner, Moorshud Cooly deemed it unadvisable to remain in the same place with the Prince; and having consulted with his friends on the most advantageous situation, he resolved to fix his residence at Mukhsoosabad, as being nearly in the center of the province, and equally convenient for collecting the revenues from all parts. Having decided on this measure, he left Dacca without taking leave of the Viceroy; and carrying with him all the public officers attached to the Dewany, proceeded to Mukhsoosabad; the name of which, in order to commemorate this event, he some years afterwards changed to Moorshudabad; thus to hand down his own name to posterity.

When the well-authenticated statement of the disturbance at Dacca, and the attempt on the life of the Dewan, reached the Emperor, who was then in the Dekkan, he sent an order to Azeem Ooshan, severely reprimanding him; and threatening him, that if the smallest injury was offered, either to the person or to the property of Moorshud Cooly Khan, he, although his grandchild, should be answerable for it. He further commanded the Prince immediately to quit Bengal, and to fix his residence in the province of Behar.

A. D. 1703. Azeem Ooshan knew too well the arbitrary disposition of his grandfather to attempt any justification of his conduct, or to procrastinate his departure: he therefore appointed his second son, Ferrokhsere, under the superintendance of Ser Balund Khan, to be his deputy in Dacca; and embarking with the remainder of his family, and all the public officers, on

Digitized by Google

board the government boats, proceeded to Rajemahel, and took possession of Sultan Shujaa's palace. The air of that place, however, not agreeing with his family, he sometime after removed to Patna, the castle and fortification of which he repaired, and, by permission of the Emperor, changed the name of the city to Azeemabad; by which appellation it is still distinguished by all the followers of Mohammed.

It has been before stated, that, on the abrupt termination of Sir William Norris's embassy, the Emperor had issued orders to seize and confine every European in his dominions: in consequence of which, in the month of February 1702, the whole of the English settled at Patna and Rajemahel, with all their effects, were seized, to make good the damages done by the pirates: the amount of the property, however, proving inconsiderable, the Company's servants were confined for fifty-one days in the public jail, but were afterwards liberated on their parole. On the 30th of March the order was extended to all the European factories; and the loss of the English Company, on this occasion, amounted to sixty-two thousand rupees. In this month, also, the Foujedar of Hoogly issued an order to seize all the Company's effects at Calcutta; but the President, Mr. Beard, having previous notice of his intentions, had so well prepared for his defence, that the Foujedar hesitated to attack the factory; and, by the private intervention of the Prince, who durst not openly oppose the Emperor's commands, at length desisted from his intentions. He, however, seized upon all the goods belonging to the Company which were coming down the river to Calcutta; but the spirited conduct of the English, on this occasion, by

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A.D. 1703.

preventing any of the Moghul ships from passing down the river, obliged him to release the property.

During the whole of this business, the Prince Azeem Ooshan evinced the greatest moderation; and would not have carried into effect the orders of the Emperor, had he not been goaded thereto by the Imperial Dewan. In the month of October, he sent orders to liberate the Company's agents confined at Rajemahel, and directed that they should be permitted to proceed to Calcutta; shortly after which an order arrived from Court to take off the embargo on trade. On this occasion the Dewan relaxed in his severity, and offered freedom of trade to all the Europeans, provided they would make him and the Prince handsome presents; which the English refused. The Dewan, however, insisted upon the agents of the three European nations producing the original firmāns upon which they claimed their privileges. The Dutch and French produced theirs; but the firmān of Sultan Shujaa, having been lost, by one of the English agents in going to Madras, forty years before, the English were obliged to bribe the Dewan's secretary to let the matter drop.

Moorshud Cooly Khan, having fixed his residence at Mukhsoosabad, assembled there all the public officers of his department; and at the end of the year, having made up his accounts, in which was clearly exhibited the great increase he had made to the revenue of the provinces, prepared to set out for Court, in order personally to lay them before the Emperor: on presenting the papers, however, to the two Canoungoes*, whose

* Officers in the revenue department, subordinate to the Dewan. The word means, literally, Explainer of the Regulations.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

counter-signatures were requisite for their being audited in the Imperial exchequer, one of them, named Dherp Narain, refused his signature, unless bribed by a present of three lacs of rupees; but the Dewan, conscious of the accuracy of his statement, refused his demand; and having obtained the signature of the other Canoungoe, notwithstanding his being on bad terms with the Prince, proceeded to the Imperial camp in the Dekkan; and having first presented the Emperor and his ministers with a very large sum of money, and a number of curiosities brought from Bengal, he then submitted his accounts to the Imperial exchequer: they were immediately audited by the Vizier, and much credit given to him for his exertions. He was, in consequence, dignified by the Emperor with a dress of honour, standards, and kettle-drums; and reappointed to Bengal, as Dewan of the three provinces, and deputy Nazim to the Prince in the provinces of Bengal and Orissa. This circumstance gave great offence to Azeem Ooshan; but knowing the despotic temper of his grandfather, he could only repine in silence. A.D. 1703-4.

State of English affairs in Bengal, A. D. 1705-6.

In the year 1705-6, the union of the two East-India Companies having been nearly completed, the whole of the united property was deposited in Fort William; the garrison of which was augmented to the number of one hundred and thirty European soldiers; and a number of guns were mounted on the works. This display of strength does not appear to have given any offence to the Moghul government; but it inspired the native merchants with confidence, and induced many of them to go and settle in Calcutta; which, in consequence, had become a regular and populous town, and produced a considerable revenue; and being rendered

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1706.

independent of Madras, by the Company, rose highly in the estimation of the commercial world.

Such was the state of affairs in Bengal, when, the great age and bodily infirmities of the Emperor Aurungzebe* having given rise to many intrigues for the succession to the empire, Sultan Mohammed Aazim, who for a short time governed Bengal, and who, although only the second surviving son of Aurungzebe, openly laid claim to the throne, and was, in fact, the favourite and intended heir of his father, being jealous of the great wealth possessed by his nephew, the Prince Azeem Ooshan, and the power which the government of the eastern provinces threw into his hands, procured his recall; and that prince, a few months before the death of the Emperor, havin appointed his own son, Ferrokhsere, to be his representative in Bengal and Orissa, and Ser Balund Khan to be deputy-governor of Behar, proceeded towards Court.

Azeem Ooshan recalled.

Although the connection between Azeem Ooshan and the history of Bengal terminates with his departure from Patna; yet as the fate of that prince is not recorded in any regular history of India, it is presumed that an account of it will not be considered as uninteresting in this place.

Death of Aurungzebe, Feb. 21, 1707.

The Emperor Aurungzebe Aalumgeer departed this life on the 28th of Zykaad (11th month) of the year of the Hejira 1118, in his camp, in the vicinity of Ahmednagur†, aged ninety-one years and thirteen days; having verbally made

---

* This monarch's title was properly *Aalumgeer* (Conqueror of the World); but as he is better known in Europe by the appellation he bore as prince, it is retained in this History.

† Taken by General Wellesley during the late Mahratta war. The Emperor was buried there, close to the tomb of a Saint named Zienal Abedeen.

Digitized by Google

a division of his empire amongst his three sons. To the eldest, Mohammed Muazim, he assigned the provinces of Cabul, Lahore, and Moultan; to the second, Mohammed Aazim (then called Aazim Shah), he gave the central parts of Hindoostan; and to the younger, Kam Bukhsh, the provinces of the South, or Dekkan. SECT. VI. A. D. 1707.

Aazim Shah mounts the throne of Hindoostan.

The day after the death of the Emperor, his second son, Aazim Shah, entered the Imperial camp, and took possession of the Royal tents and treasures; and as soon as the funereal rites were performed, he mounted the throne, and gave audience to all the nobility, and officers of the army. He confirmed all the ministers of the late reign in their appointments; and, shortly afterwards, commenced his march towards Dehly, in order to secure the capital against his elder brother.

The Prince Azeem Ooshan, who had, by the Emperor's orders, left his government of Bengal to proceed to the presence, had taken the precaution to bring with him a considerable detachment of his best troops, and had reached the vicinity of Agra when he heard of his grandfather's decease; upon which event, he marched, with all expedition, to secure that city for his father, Mohammed Muazim, then known by the title of Shah Alum; but the Governor of the province of Agra, having united his daughter in marriage to the son of the prince Aazim Shah, resolved to oppose him; and in order to impede his progress, sunk all the boats in the river Jumna, and erected batteries at the neighbouring fords. His efforts were, however, unavailing; for Azeem Ooshan, having marched some distance up the banks of the river, crossed it, and, in a general engagement, defeated and took the Governor prisoner; by which event, although he could not obtain

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1707.

possession of the fort, he became master of the province, through which all the contending armies must pass. A short time after this event, having obtained intelligence that a convoy, with the year's revenue of Bengal, amounting to one crore of rupees (1,250,000*l.*) was advancing towards Agra, he sent off a detachment of cavalry, and succeeded in seizing it; which circumstance proved, in the sequel, of the greatest importance to the success of his father.

Azeem Ooshan, having, besides, brought with him the immense sum of nearly eight crores of rupees* from Bengal, immediately commenced levying troops; and upon the arrival of his father at Agra, mustered before him 30,000 well mounted cavalry†. Although Bakir Khan, the governor of the citadel of Agra, had refused to deliver it up to Azeem Ooshan, he did not hesitate a moment to send the keys to Shah Aalum, who, as the eldest son, he considered the legitimate heir to the empire.

The possession of that fortress was of the utmost consequence to Shah Aalum; as it not only afforded him a place of refuge for his family, but contained the whole of Shah Jehan's treasures, with warlike stores of every kind; by the means of which he speedily refitted his army, and advanced to meet his rival and brother, the prince Aazim Shah.

The contending armies met on the plains of Jajoo, not many miles distant from Agra; and as the command of the first line, which bore the brunt of the battle, was entrusted

---

* A crore is 100 lacs, or 10,000,000.

† It may not be unnecessary here to remark, that the soldiers, under the native Princes of India, furnished their own horses and arms; and that a number of them were always ready to join the standard of any person who could pay them.

Digitized by Google

to Azeem Ooshan, much of the success of the day may be attributed to his exertions. The result was, the total defeat of Aazim Shah's army, and the death of himself and his two sons Bedar Bukht and Vala Jāh‡. This event occurred on the 11th of the month Rubby al Avul 1119.

Shah Aalum defeats his Brother; June 1707; and takes the title of Behadur Shah.

After this victory, Shah Aalum returned to Agra, and assumed the title of Behadur Shah; and, as a proof of his sense of the assistance he had received from his son Azeem Ooshan, re-appointed him Governor of the provinces of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, to which was added the province of Allahabad; but as the Emperor was desirous of retaining him near his person, during the war against his own younger brother, Kam Bukhsh, he directed him to confirm Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan as his deputy in Bengal and Orissa; and to appoint such persons as he most esteemed, to be his deputies in the other provinces. This circumstance enabled the Prince handsomely to reward two noblemen who had been useful to him on various occasions, and had particularly distinguished themselves in the late engagement. These two persons were brothers, and boasted the honour of being descended from the Arabian Prophet. To the eldest, named Syed Abdullah Khan, he gave the government of Allahabad; and to the younger, Syed Hussein Aly Khan, that of Behar. After these arrangements, the Prince constantly attended at Court; and, by his abilities and suavity of manners, gained a great influence over the mind of his father.

Azeem Ooshan re-appointed Governor of the three provinces.

In the year 1124, the Emperor, who was then at Lahore, A.D. 1712.

‡ These events are recorded in the *Muntakhub al Lebab* of Khafy Khan, the *Sier Mutakhereen* of Syed Ghoolam Hussein, and *Memoirs* of the Moghul Empire, by Eradut Khan. For the latter work, which is the best, see *Scott's History of the Dekkan*, in which the description of this battle will amuse every military reader.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1712.

was taken ill of a fever, which affected his brain, and rendered him totally incapable of business: and as his eldest son, Moizaddeen, had for some time declined coming to Court, on account of the preference which his father gave to Azeem Ooshan, all the affairs of the empire were, for some time, transacted by the Prince; which circumstance enabled him, upon the death of Behadur Shah, to take possession of the Royal treasure, jewels, and artillery, and to mount the throne. But having, by his pride and petulance, given offence to Zoolfecar Khan, the Ameer ul Omrah, and other officers, they took part with his three brothers*.

Death of Behadur Shah.

Contest between his sons for the empire.

At this time the whole of the Imperial army was encamped in the vicinity of Lahore: the Emperor's tents were upon one side of the river (Ravy), and those of Azeem Ooshan upon the opposite bank; but a constant communication was kept up between both, by means of boats: and as soon as the Emperor died, Azeem Ooshan took possession of the Imperial tents. The ground of encampment of the three other princes was between the Emperor's tents and the town.

Had Azeem Ooshan acted with promptitude, and immediately attacked his brothers, he would have probably been successful; but hoping that the army, finding he was in possession of the treasure and artillery, would flock to his standard, he resolved to remain on the defensive; and gave orders to have his camp entrenched.

While Azeem Ooshan thus flattered himself with an easy conquest, the three brothers, by the advice of the Ameer ul Omrah, drew several large pieces of artillery from the fort, and

* Their names were, Moizaddeen, Jehan Shah, and Ruffia Ooshan.

Digitized by Google

encamped their united forces in one line, making the city their defence to the rear.

In this situation affairs remained for four days; during which a heavy cannonade was kept up on both sides: but the advantage being manifestly on the part of the three brothers, and the troops of Azeem Ooshan beginning to desert, he found it requisite to alter his plan; and on the fifth morning marched from his camp, resolved to conquer, or to die.

As previous to this time most of his experienced generals had left him, the troops were drawn out without any proper arrangement; the artillery were placed in such a situation as to be perfectly useless, and were not supported by any body of regular troops. Kereem Addeen, the eldest son of the Prince, who was the nominal commander of the first line, remained in the reserve with his father; and none of the officers knew to whom they should apply for orders.

In the meantime the enemy advanced slowly, but in regular order, towards Azeem Ooshan, whose terrified troops began to disperse. The misguided, but truly brave Prince, when he saw his fortune thus adverse, (though he might have saved himself by quitting his elephant, and mounting a fleet horse, which would have carried him back to Bengal,) disdained the proposition, which had been suggested to him by Ameen Addowleh, one of his attached friends; and continuing to advance, although nearly abandoned by all his troops, his elephant driver was killed by a musquet shot; and the animal, having been severely wounded by a cannon-ball, became furious, and, rushing to the steep bank of the Ravy, precipitated himself and master into the stream. The dead body of the elephant was again found, but no trace of the Prince was

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

ever discovered; and for a time it was hoped, by his friends, that he had escaped. Such is the account given, both in the Sier al Mutakhereen, and the Muntakhub al Lebab; but by Eradut Khan's statement, the body of Azeem Ooshan was found on the field of battle, covered with wounds, and delivered to his brothers. Mohammed Kereem, the eldest son of the Prince, was made prisoner, and put to death by order of his uncle, Moizaddeen, who had then assumed the title of Jehāndar Shah. These events occurred in the end of Suffer (second month) of the year 1124.

Azeem Ooshan killed, A. D. 1712.

Such was the catastrophe of the unfortunate Prince Azeem Ooshan, who for eleven years governed the provinces of Behar and Bengal with much tolerance and moderation; and which conduct, contrasted with that of his successor, places his character in a very favourable point of view. It may, however, be remarked, that the princes of the house of Timour have evinced in India a mildness of disposition not corresponding with the idea we have of Tartars; and that the epithet of "Cruel Despot" has not been applicable to any of that family: for although Aurungzebe was a bigot, and persecuted the Hindoos, it may be doubted whether he was naturally of a cruel disposition: at all events, his countrymen entirely acquit him on the score of the murder of his brothers, as an act of self-preservation: and it has been justly observed, by a native of India, "That Princes should not be judged of by the rules of common life*."

* See Mirza Abu Taleb's Travels.

Digitized by Google

NUWAB MOORSHUD COOLY, MUTIMUN AL MOOLK, ALA ADDOWLEH, JAFFIER KHAN NESEERY, NASIR JUNG.

Continuation of the history of Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan—On his return to Bengal, changes the name of Mukhsoosabad to Moorshudabad—The English obtain permission to establish a factory at Cossimbazar—The Nuwab appoints deputy Dewans of Bengal and Orissa—Establishes a new system of polity with respect to the Zemindars—Takes the land entirely out of their hands, and appoints his own collectors of the revenue—The Rajas of Bheerbhoom and Bishenpore exempted from these regulations—The Rajas of Tipperah and Couch Beyhar agree to pay tribute—The Nuwab revenges himself on Derp Narain, one of the Imperial Canoungoes—Promotes the son of the deceased—Represents to the Emperor the impolicy of the Foujedar of Hoogly being independent of his authority—Ordered to appoint an officer of his own to that office—Nominates Wullee Beg—The deposed Foujedar refuses to leave behind his Peishkar—A dispute takes place—Zyn Addeen is assisted by the French and Dutch—The Nuwab sends a force, under Dilput Sing, to establish his officer—An accidental shot hills Dilput Sing—The insurgents drive the Nuwab's troops into the town, and march off towards Dehly—The Nuwab, some time after, takes revenge on the Peishkar—Reduces the military establishment—Preserves great dignity in his Court—Impartial in his conduct, but prefers the Hindoos as men of business—One of his principal Collectors commits suicide—Various instances of the Nuwab's cruelty in enforcing the collections—Observes great regularity in remitting the revenues—Jealous of any interference with the subordinate appointments in Bengal—Shews great partiality to Sief Khan, Foujedar of Purneah—Neglects Aboo Turab, the Foujedar of Bhoosnah, who is in consequence murdered—The Nuwab inflicts severe punishment on the rebels—Account of the Prince Ferrokhsere—Applies to the Nuwab for assistance—is refused—quits Moorshudabad, and proceeds to Patna—His cause espoused by Syed Hussein Aly, the Governor of Behar, who writes to Abdullah Khan, Governor of Allahabad, and prevails upon him to join in the rebellion—Abdullah, in consequence, seizes upon

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

the year's collections of Bengal, and levies troops—The Emperor supersedes Abdullah, and sends an army to dispossess him—The troops of Abdullah attack and defeat the Royal army—Ferrokhsere marches from Patna, and arrives at Allahabad, where he musters his army—Advances to Cudgwa—defeats the Royal army—proceeds towards Agra—engages the Imperial forces commanded by the Emperor in person—Hussein Aly Khan severely wounded in the engagement—Jehāndar Shah escapes to Dehly—is seized and confined by Assud ad Dowlah, the Vizier—Ferrokhsere proclaimed Emperor—proceeds to Dehly—causes Jehāndar Shah to be put to death—takes possession of the kingdom.—Affairs of Bengal resumed—Rasheed Khan, a favourite of the Prince, attempts to seize on the province of Bengal—Moorshud Cooly opposes, defeats, and kills Rasheed Khan—Confirmed in his government—Appoints his grandson deputy Dewan of Bengal—Sets aside the privileges of the English—They send an embassy to Dehly, to complain of his conduct—Proceedings of the embassy—Obtains various Firmāns from the Emperor—Returns to Calcutta—The Nuwab refuses to comply with some of the articles of the Emperor's firmān, and disputes with the English on the meaning of some of the other clauses—The English affairs prosperous—The Nuwab obtains the Government of Behar, in addition to that of Bengal and Orissa—Death of Ferrokhsere—Moorshud Cooly confirmed in his government by the Emperor Mohammed Shah—Two of the Zemindars of Bengal raise an insurrection—are seized, and confined for life—Anecdotes of the severity of Moorshud Cooly Khan—His justice, religion, charity, police, loyalty, abstemiousness, learning, impartiality—Specimen of Mohammedan bigotry—The Nuwab orders his tomb to be built—Endeavours to secure the succession for his grandson, Ser Afraz Khan—Opposed by his Son-in-law, and the Ameer al Omrah, Khan Dowran—The Nuwab appoints his grandson his heir and successor—Dies—His son-in-law, Shujaa Addeen Khan, takes possession of the government.

It was thought proper, in the foregoing chapter, not to interrupt the narrative of events; but to accompany the prince Azeem Ooshan to the end of his career.—We now return to the affairs of Bengal.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

It has been mentioned, in page 359, that Moorshud Cooly Khan, the Dewan, having waited upon the Emperor Aurungzebe, at his camp in the Dekkan, had been most graciously received by that monarch; and, in reward for his services, had been re-appointed Dewan of Bengal and Orissa, in his own right; and Deputy Nazim or governor of the two provinces, on the part of the Prince Azeem Ooshan. He was also honoured with the lofty titles of Nuwab Moorshud Cooly, Mutimun al Moolk, Ala Addowleh, Jaffier Khan Neseery, Nasir Jung. A. D. 1703-4.

The first act of the Nuwab, on his return to Bengal, was to change the name of the city of Mukhsoosabad to Moorshudabad; and, by establishing in it the mint, and by erecting a palace and other public offices of government, to render it the capital of the province.

We accordingly find, that, in the year 1118, the English East-India Company was induced to pay him 25,000 rupees, for permission to establish a factory at Cossimbazar, in the vicinity of the new city, for the convenience of having the bullion, which they sent from Europe, coined into rupees at the mint. A. D. 1706.

In this year, also, the departure of the Prince Azeem Ooshan from Behar threw the whole of the authority into the hands of the Nuwab, and gave him the unlimited controul over the three provinces: for although the Prince appointed his son, Ferrokhsere (afterwards Emperor), to be his representative in Bengal, it does not appear that he was authorized to do so by the Emperor; and the Dewan paid little attention to his nomination.

When, after the succession of Behadur Shah, he was

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1706. confirmed in the appointment of Deputy Nazim, by which the offices of Dewan and Nazim (which from the reign of Akbar had been separated) were now, by the absence of the Prince, united in his person, he appointed Syed Ikram Khan to be his deputy Dewan over the province of Bengal; and his son-in-law, Shujaa Addeen Mohammed Khan, to be his deputy Dewan in Orissa: he at the same time appointed Bhooput Roy, and Keisor Roy, two Brahmens, probably relations of his own, to confidential situations; the first, secretary to the treasury; and the latter his private secretary. He also annexed the district of Midnapore to Bengal, although it had always before constituted a part of Orissa.

He now commenced to put in practice a system of the greatest oppression upon the zemindars, or Hindoo land-holders; which, although it much augmented the revenue of the state, rendered his name dreaded and detested throughout the provinces.

In order to make a full investigation of the value of the lands, he placed the principal zemindars in close confinement, and gave the collection into the hands of expert Aumils, or collectors, who received the assessments from the farmers, and
A. D. 1707-8. paid the amount into the public treasury. He also ordered the whole of the lands to be re-measured; and having ascertained the quantity of fallow and waste ground belonging to every village, he caused a considerable proportion of it to be brought into cultivation; for which purpose the collectors were authorized to make advances of money to the lower order of husbandmen, to purchase stock, and to reimburse themselves by a certain portion of the produce.

When he had thus entirely dispossessed the zemindars of

Digitized by Google

all interference in the collection, he assigned to them an allowance, either in land or money, for the subsistence of their families, called *nankar;* to which was added the privilege of hunting, of cutting wood in the forests, and of fishing in the lakes and rivers: these immunities are called *bunkar* and *julkar**.

The only persons who were exempted from these despotic regulations were the zemindars of Bheerbhoom and Bishenpore. The first was a popular and virtuous character, named Asud Allah, whose ancestors had been Hindoos, but who had abandoned the worship of idols, and embraced the Mohammedan faith. This person dedicated half his income to charitable purposes, either in supporting the religious and learned, or in relieving the distresses of the poor and needy: he was besides attentive to all the duties of his religion, and deviated not from the ordinances of the law. To have attacked such a character would have exposed the Nuwab to great opprobrium, and would have incited against him the popular clamour; and possibly would have injured him in the esteem of every devout Mussulman.

The other zemindar owed his security to the nature of his country, which was full of woods, and adjoining to the mountains of Jarcund, whither, upon any invasion of the district, he retired to places inaccessible to his pursuers, and annoyed them severely in their retreat: the country was besides unproductive; and the expenses of collection, and of maintaining it, would have exceeded the amount of the revenue.

These two zemindars, therefore, having refused the summons to attend at the Court of Moorshubadab, were permitted

* The literal meaning of these three words is, The business of Bread, Wood, and Water.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1709.

to remain on their own estates, on condition of regularly remitting their assessment, through an agent stationed at Moorshudabad.

The Rajas of Tipperah, Couch Beyhar, and Assam, whose countries, although they had been overrun by the Mohammedan arms, had never been perfectly subdued, and who therefore continued to spread the umbrella of independence, and to stamp the coin in their own names, were so impressed with the idea of the power and abilities of Moorshud Cooly Khan, that they forwarded to him valuable presents, consisting of elephants, wrought and unwrought ivory, musk, amber, and various other articles, in token of their submission: in return for which, the Nuwab sent them *khelaats*, or honorary dresses, by the receipt and putting on of which they acknowledged his superiority. This interchange of presents and compliments became an annual custom during the whole time of his government, without either party attempting to recede from, or advance beyond, the implied line of conduct.

Moorshud Cooly devoted two days in the week to the administration of justice, presiding in person in court: and so impartial was he in his decisions, and so rigid in the execution of the sentence of the law, that he put his own son to death for an infraction of its regulations; and his decisions thereby became celebrated throughout Hindoostan. This, however, must be considered as respecting Mohammedans; for in the collection of the revenues he allowed his officers to be guilty of great cruelty and oppression; and wherever any person opposed his will, he marked him as the victim of his revenge.

It has been before mentioned, that, when he wished to lay his accounts in person before the Emperor, Derp Narain,

Digitized by Google

one of the chief Canoungoes, had refused to audit them by his signature. This circumstance rankled in the mind of Moorshud Cooly; but as the Canoungoe held his appointment independently of the Governor, and was only accountable to the Imperial exchequer for his conduct, the latter durst not make any open attack against him, without incurring the displeasure of the Emperor. He therefore treated him, for several years, with great respect and attention; and consulted him upon all business regarding the revenue. SECT. VI.

This behaviour gained the friendship of Derp Narain, and lulled him into fatal security; for upon the death of Bhooput Roy, the Peishkari Khalsah, first clerk of the treasury, and who, in fact, managed all the business of that office, he was prevailed upon, by the Nuwab, to undertake that employment.

Whilst in this dangerous situation, Moorshud Cooly narrowly watched all his actions, hoping, that by having thus extended his authority, he might be guilty of some misconduct, which should place him totally in his power. But Derp Narain, having a thorough knowledge of the business, and being well acquainted with every particular regarding the revenues of Bengal, and only anxious to recommend himself by the faithful discharge of his duty, by the most minute investigation, and by the reduction of expenses, increased the revenue from one crore and thirty lacks, (1,300,000*l.*) to one crore and fifty lacks of rupees, (1,500,000*l.*) which he caused to be actually paid into the public treasury; but, in so doing, he curtailed the allowances granted to the zemindars, and infringed upon the emoluments of people in office, which rendered him very unpopular, and gave the Nuwab. an opportunity of accusing him of malversation in his office: and,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. under pretence of scrutinizing his accounts, he kept him in close confinement, and deprived him of all the enjoyments of life; which severity so affected the health and spirits of Derp Narain, that he fell into a decline, and in a short time died. But as the Nuwab was suspected of having accelerated the fate of his prisoner, he attempted to efface that impression by his kindness to the son of the deceased; for whom he obtained, from the Emperor, his father's office of Canoungoe, with an addition of one fourth of the emoluments of the other Canoungoe; who, in consequence of his having signed Moorshud Cooly's accounts when Derp Narain refused his signature, expected to have had his salary increased, instead of being diminished.

For some years previous to the accession of Moorshud Cooly to the Dewanship of Bengal, the office of Foujedar, or Governor of the port of Hoogly, had been rendered independent both of the Dewan and of the Nazim of the province; but as soon as he had united both offices in his own person, he represented to the Emperor, Behadur Shah, the absurd policy of an *imperium in imperio*, or mixed authority in government; and requested that the Governor of Hoogly might be subjected to his orders, and rendered accountable to him for his conduct. The Emperor immediately saw the force of his argument; and Moorshud Cooly was permitted to appoint an officer in his own confidence to the superintendence of that town.

The person whom he selected for this purpose was a Moghul, named Wullee Beg; upon whose arrival at Hoogly, Zyn Addeen, the deposed Foujedar, encamped, with his retinue and dependants, outside of the town, intending, as soon as he had

Digitized by Google

delivered over the charge of his office, to proceed quietly to Court: but Wullee Beg, having demanded that Kinker Sein, the Peishkar or head clerk, should remain behind till the accounts were examined, the late Foujedar resisted the demand; and both parties appealed to arms. Zyn Addeen, having ingratiated himself with the Dutch at Chinsura, and the French at Chandernagore, was supported by them; and Wullee Beg, having applied for succour to the Nuwab, was in a short time reinforced by a considerable detachment, both of infantry and cavalry, under the command of a Hindoo officer, named Dilput Sing.

Both parties encamped in the vicinity of Chandernagore, and threw up entrenchments in front of their camps, which were distant a mile from each other; and although the Nuwab had, on the commencement of the disturbance, sent positive orders to all the European settlements not to interfere in the quarrel, nevertheless, both the French and Dutch continued to assist Zyn Addeen, and supplied him with an excellent train of artillery.

After a considerable time had elapsed in this state of inactivity, and each party was endeavouring to circumvent the other by stratagem, the deposed Governor sent an agent to Dilput Sing, the Nuwab's General, to negociate terms of peace; and previous to his departure, as a mark of his special favour, he threw over the shoulders of the agent a large scarlet shawl, which rendered him very conspicuous at a distance.

It happened that when the agent entered the opposite camp, Dilput Sing was employed in viewing the ramparts of his entrenchment; and directed that the agent might be

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. brought thither. He accordingly came; and while they two were standing conversing, on the top of the rampart, a French gunner discharged a cannon from one of the advanced batteries, the ball of which struck Dilput Sing, and tore him to pieces, without injuring the agent in the smallest degree.

Although the circumstance was probably accidental, it was considered as premeditated: much merit was assigned to the author of the contrivance, and a handsome reward given to the European for his dexterity. Whether intentional or accidental, it had the effect, however, of throwing the Nuwab's army into great confusion; of which Zyn Addeen taking advantage, attacked and drove them into the town of Hoogly: after which he, quietly and unmolested, proceeded with his deputy and retinue to Dehly, where he died a short time after his arrival, without any notice having been taken, by the Ministers, of the transaction.

After the death of his patron, Kinker Sein returned from Dehly to Moorshudabad; and, without betraying any signs of fear, waited upon the Nuwab; who, with his usual policy, apparently forgave him, and appointed him collector of the revenue of the district of Hoogly, but at the end of the year, when he came to settle his accounts at Moorshudabad, confined him, on pretence of malversation, and ordered him to be fed on buffaloe's milk mixed with salt, which occasioning a disorder in his bowels, he in a short time died.

Moorshud Cooly Khan continued to make the collections through his Aumils, by displacing the zemindars; with a few exceptions, where he found the latter worthy of trust and confidence. He admitted no charges for troops, but those paid and mustered by himself. Two thousand cavalry, and four thousand

Digitized by Google

infantry, under the command of Nazir Ahmed, who had been originally a private soldier, were found sufficient to enforce the payment of all the revenues of Bengal: for so severe were his regulations, and such the dread of his power and resolution, that his commands were implicitly obeyed; and it was sufficient for him to send a single messenger, to sequester a zemindary, or to seize on a culprit at the greatest distance. SECT. VI.

Such were the respect and dignity kept up by the Governor at his court, that, in his presence, no person was allowed to salute or speak to another; nor were any of his officers or Rajas allowed to sit before him.

He prohibited the zemindars, and other Hindoos of opulence, from riding in palanquins, obliging them to make use of an inferior kind of conveyance, called a Dooly, or Chowpaleh. Whoever deviated, in the smallest degree, from his general regulations was certain to experience the effects of his resentment.

In the affairs of government, he shewed favour to no one; and always rewarded merit wherever he found it. He employed none but Bengally Hindoos in the collection of the revenues, because they were most easily compelled, by threats or punishment, to disclose their mal-practices and their confederates; and their pusillanimity secured him from any insurrection or combination against the State. In the few instances in which he found that they had defrauded him, or had made away with the revenue, and were unable to make good the deficiency, he compelled the offender, with his wife and children, to become Mohammedans.

Raja Oudynarain, whose family had long enjoyed the zemindary of the district of Rajeshahy, was so distinguished

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. by his abilities and application, that the Nuwab entrusted him with the superintendence of the greater portion of the collections, and placed under his orders Gholaum Mohammed Jemmadar, with two hundred horse, who in a short time became a great favourite of his principal; but in consequence of his pay having been kept back for many months, the Jemmadar's people mutinied, and the Nuwab, without inquiring minutely into the matter, ordered a chosen detachment to quell the disturbance. A conflict ensued in the vicinity of the Raja's house, in which the Jemmadar was killed, and many of his people put to death. This circumstance so hurt and terrified Oudynarain, that he put an end to his own existence.

The zemindary of Rajeshahy was, in consequence, taken away from the family, and conferred on Ramjewun and Kanoo Kenoor, two zemindars who resided on the eastern side of the river, in consideration of their having been more punctual in the payment of their rents than the other zemindars of Bengal.

The Nuwab, however, never placed confidence in any man; he himself examined the accounts of the exchequer every day; and if he discovered any of the zemindars, or others, remiss in their payment, he placed either the principal or his agent in arrest, with a guard over him, to prevent his either eating or drinking till the business was settled: and, in order to prevent the guards from being bribed, or negligent in their duty, he placed spies over them, who informed him of the smallest deviation from his orders.

A principal instrument of the Nuwab's severity was Nazir Ahmed, to whom, when a district was in arrear, he used to deliver over the captive zemindar, to be tormented by every

Digitized by Google

species of cruelty; as hanging up by the feet; bastinadoing; setting them in the sun in summer; and by stripping them naked, and sprinkling them frequently with cold water, in winter.

But all these acts of severity were but trifles, compared with the wanton and cruel conduct of Syed Reza Khan, who was married to Nuffisah Begum, the granddaughter of the Nuwab, and who, upon the death of Syed Ikram Khan, had been appointed deputy Dewan of the province. In order to enforce the payment of the revenues, he ordered a pond to be dug, which was filled with every thing disgusting; and the stench of which was so offensive, as nearly to suffocate whoever approached it: to this shocking place, in contempt of the Hindoos, he gave the name of *Bickoont*, which, in their language, means *Paradise*; and, after the zemindars had undergone the usual punishments, if their rent was not forthcoming, he caused them to be drawn, by a rope tied under the arms, through this infernal pond. He is also stated to have compelled them to put on loose trowsers, into which were introduced live cats. By such cruel and horrid methods he extorted from the unhappy zemindars every thing they possessed, and made them weary of their lives.

The collections of the preceding year were always completed by the end of Cheyt (the first month of the new year); and in the beginning of Bysack (the second month) the Nuwab generally despatched to Dehly the royal revenue, amounting from one crore and thirty lacs to one crore and fifty lacs of rupees, (1,500,000*l.*) the greater part in specie. The boxes of treasure were laden upon two hundred or more carts, drawn by bullocks, and escorted by a guard of 300

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

cavalry and 500 infantry, accompanied by one of the sub-treasurers. Along with the revenue, he sent, as presents to the Emperor and Ministers, a number of elephants, Hill horses, antelopes, hawks, shields made of rhinoceros hides, sword-blades, Sylhet mats, filigree work of gold and silver, wrought ivory, Dacca muslins, and Cossimbazar silks; also a number of European articles procured at the Royal port of Hoogly.

The Nuwab, attended by his principal officers, accompanied the convoy some miles from Moorshudabad: and in order to take off any further responsibility from himself, independent of his own despatches to the Vizier, he had the event recorded in the Royal Gazettes, by which all the Governors on the route were apprized of the circumstance, and were obliged, by the regulations, to have carts and an escort ready to forward the treasure to the capital;—those of Bengal being relieved at Patna, and those of the latter place at Allahabad; the convoy, and its value, frequently increasing as it went on, by the collections of each province.

By such conduct, Moorshud Cooly Khan conciliated the favour of the Minister and of the Emperor; and the appointments in Bengal were made chiefly at his recommendation: but if, through any other interest, a person procured the nomination to an office in that province, every means was taken to thwart him, and to render his situation so unpleasant, as to induce him quickly to resign it. In proof of the former fact, it is stated, that Sief Khan, the grandson of the celebrated Amyr Khan, having been appointed to Bengal at the recommendation of the Governor, was, upon his arrival, received in the most gracious manner, and appointed Foujedar of Purneah, with absolute power over that district, and with

Digitized by Google

permission to conquer from the Raja of Morung as much territory as he pleased, without any increase of revenue to the State: it is also said, that the Nuwab offered him his granddaughter, Nuffisah Begum, in marriage; but that Sief Khan, being of an illustrious family, declined the connection; and she was therefore united to Syed Reza.

Shortly after Sief Khan had taken possession of his office, he expelled Beer Sāh, the zemindar of Beernagur, who ventured to oppose his will; after which, he imprisoned all the other zemindars of Purneah, and collected annually from that district eighteen lacs of rupees, the surplus of which, above the former revenue of ten or eleven lacs, he appropriated to his own use. He also considerably extended his boundary, by bringing into cultivation certain waste lands lying between Purneah and Morung as neutral ground, but to which the Raja of Morung, intimidated by Sief Khan's power, gave up his claim.

All these circumstances were well known to the Nuwab: yet having a great friendship for Sief Khan, he did not interfere; but annually invited him to spend some time with him at Moorshudabad, where he used to rally his guest on the peculiarities in his character, particularly on his mode of paying his troops, which was by giving half the amount in goods either plundered, sequestered, or purchased at a cheap rate, and the remainder in money; also for his manner of rewarding his companions and favourites, by giving them his cast-off concubines, on which account he conferred on him the title of Zen Bukhsh, *The Bestower of Women**.

* Zer Bukhsh, "Bestower of Gold," is a common appellation for a liberal man.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

In evidence of the other assertion, it is related, that a person of an illustrious family, named Syed Aboo Turab, having, through the interest of one of the Viziers, obtained the office of Foujedar of Bhoosnah in Bengal, adjacent to which resided a refractory zemindar, named Sittaram, who kept in his pay a band of robbers, with whom he used to infest the roads and plunder the boats on the rivers, and even carry off the cattle from the villages, setting at defiance the power of the Foujedar;—to extirpate this public depredator, Aboo Turab applied for assistance to the Nuwab; but, instead of affording him the required aid, he was supposed, in an underhand manner, to countenance and encourage Sittaram.

At length the Foujedar, finding he had nothing to expect from the Governor, took into his own pay an Afghan officer, named Peer Khan, with 200 of his followers, well mounted and armed, and sent him to beat up the quarters of the depredator; but Sittaram, having intelligence of the circumstance, moved to another part of the country, where by chance he fell in with the Foujedar, who was amusing himself in hunting, and attended by a very small escort. The robbers immediately attacked the Foujedar and his party, and, before their chief came up, killed Aboo Turab. When Sittaram found that it was the Foujedar he had slain, he much regretted the circumstance, and told his followers that the Nuwab would certainly revenge the insult offered to his government, by flaying them alive, and by desolating the pergunneh of Mahmoodabad: he then respectfully delivered the body to the Foujedar's attendants, who carried it to Bhoosnah, and interred it in the vicinity of that town.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

When the Nuwab received intelligence of the murder of Aboo Turab, he was greatly alarmed, being apprehensive of having incurred the displeasure of the Emperor by his neglect of so respectable a person; and whom he knew had many friends about the Court, who would not fail to represent the state of the case. He therefore appointed Bukhsh Aly Khan to succeed the deceased; and sent with him a considerable force, with instructions to seize Sittaram and all his party. Orders were also issued to all the neighbouring zemindars, to assist in seizing the offender; and they were informed, that if he was allowed to make his escape through any of their districts, they should be expelled from their lands, and suffer other grievous punishments. These orders had an instantaneous effect; the zemindars raised their *posse comitatus*, and hemmed the robbers in on every side, until Bukhsh Aly Khan arrived, who seized Sittaram, his women, children, and accomplices, and sent them in irons to Moorshudabad, where Sittaram and the robbers were impaled alive, and the women and children sold as slaves. These proceedings were entered in the public records; and the Governor wrote a particular representation of all the circumstances to the Emperor, placing his own conduct in the most favourable point of view.

From the disgusting detail of such transactions, we now turn to a more dignified subject.

Account of the Prince Ferrokhsere.

In the history of the Prince Azeem Ooshan, it was stated, that, upon his being summoned to Court, in the year of the Hejira 1118, he left his second son, Ferrokhsere, to be his agent in Bengal and Orissa. That Prince continued to reside for some time at Dacca; but after the demise of Aurungzebe, and the accession of his grandfather, Behadur Shah, to the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. throne, A.H. 1119, he removed to Moorshudabad, and took up his residence at the palace called the Lall Bāg, in that city, where he lived upon terms of much cordiality with Moorshud Cooly Khan, not interfering at all with the government; the whole management of which had been placed, by Behadur Shah's desire, in the hands of the Nuwab.

A. D. 1712. Upon the death of Behadur Shah, and the accession of the worthless Jehandar Shah, A. H. 1124, the Prince applied to Moorshud Cooly Khan to assist him in avenging the death of his father, and in his views upon the empire: but the Nuwab positively refused him, declaring that no consideration should make him depart from his duty to Jehandar Shah, whom he now considered as his lawful sovereign; but in a friendly manner advised the Prince immediately to quit Moorshudabad, lest an order should arrive for his being seized and sent prisoner to Dehly.

Ferrokhsere did not press the Nuwab any further; but, setting out with his family and a few attendants, took the route of Patna, hoping to obtain some assistance from Syed Hussein Aly Khan, who had been appointed Governor of Behar by his father*; and on his way was joined by a few of the adherents of his family, from Dacca.

Upon his arrival at Patna, instead of entering the city, he took up his residence in a caravanserai, near Jaffier Khan's gardens; whence he sent a respectful and doleful message to Hussein Aly, stating his deplorable situation; reminding him of the favours conferred on him by Azeem Ooshan, and entreating him to protect and support him. The Governor was

* See page 363.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1712.

much alarmed and distressed by this message: he was bound, by every tie of gratitude, to the family of Azeem Ooshan; but dreaded the power of Jehandar Shah, who seemed to be supported by the principal nobility, and securely fixed on the throne. He therefore returned a polite, but cold answer, to Ferrokhsere, expressive of his respect for the memory of the Prince's father, but lamenting his inability to be of any service to him; and conjuring him to depart from Behar immediately, otherwise he should be under the necessity of seizing him, conformably to the orders which he had received from Court. The Prince, however, not discouraged by this refusal, again solicited, that if he could not assist him, he would at least favour him with a visit, and advise him how he should act in the critical situation in which he was placed.

Hussein Aly Khan could not refuse such a request from the son of his patron: he therefore went privately to pay his respects to the Prince; and was introduced into the same tent where the females of the family were, and who were only concealed from view by a screen. He was received by the Prince in the most gracious and conciliating manner possible, and clothed in one of his Highness's superb dresses; after which they entered into a long conversation on the state of public affairs, in which Ferrokhsere represented, that the fate of his elder brother and the other princes, who had been put to death in cold blood, subsequent to the battle at Lahore, convinced him that he had nothing to expect from his uncle, Jehandar Shah, but death, or a lingering and wretched imprisonment: he therefore conjured Hussein Aly to support his cause; and if they succeeded, he should share the empire with him. The Governor still remaining unmoved by these

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1712. entreaties, Mileki Zeman, the daughter of the Prince, who had been tutored for the occasion, came from behind the screen, and, falling at his feet, besought him to have compassion on her father and his wretched family: she reminded him of the obligations he was under to her grandfather; and called on him, in the name of his ancestor, the Prophet Mohammed, who had commanded his followers "Never to forget benefits conferred," not to forsake them in their distress; and desired him to reflect on what posterity would say of his ingratitude and unmanly conduct, should he now abandon them, and, without an exertion, let them fall into the hands of their enemies. Before she had finished her speech, she was joined by the widow of Azeem Ooshan*; whilst the other ladies, from behind the curtain, combined their entreaties to prevail upon him; and from sobs and tears proceeded to screams and lamentations. The Governor could no longer resist such a scene; and, yielding to their supplications, said, "All I have to offer is my life; and I now devote it to your service." The Prince then presented him his own sword, and swore never to prove ungrateful for his kindness. The Governor, immediately after, returned home, and wrote all the circumstances to his elder brother, Syed Abdullah Khan, the governor of Allahabad, who also owed his elevation to Azeem Ooshan†.

The following day, the Prince Ferrokhsere was introduced

* The daughter of the Prince being a child, and his mother advanced in years, their appearing before a stranger, and especially a Syed, was not considered as any great departure from etiquette. Had the other ladies come forward, it would have been considered as derogating from the Prince's honour, which even the existing circumstances would not have warranted.

† This narrative is taken from the *Sier al Mutakhereen*. The circumstance is differently related by the author of the *Muntekhub al Lebab*; but I prefer this account.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1712.

into Patna with great pomp; and, upon his alighting at the palace, was placed by the Governor on the musnud, and saluted as Emperor of Hindoostan: a proclamation was also issued, and letters written to various parts of the country, inviting all officers and soldiers to join his Majesty's standard.

When Syed Abdullah Khan received his brother's letter, he was overwhelmed with astonishment; for besides the perils in which they were thus plunged, their wives and children were at Dehly, and consequently in the power of their enemies: but such was his affection for his brother, that he resolved to run all risks, and to rise or fall with him. He therefore commenced making military preparations: and as the convoy, with the year's collections of Bengal, had just arrived at Allahabad, under the charge of Shujaa Addeen Khan, the son-in-law of the Nuwab of Bengal, he seized the treasure for Ferrokhsere's use. This was a most fortunate event, both for the Prince and the brothers, as it enabled them not only to pay the arrears due to their own troops, but to recruit their army.

In the meantime, Hussein Aly, by his influence in Patna, borrowed a large sum of money from the bankers; and procured from the merchants all the materials requisite for the outfit of his army, without any other security than the Prince's bonds, payable, with a heavy interest, as soon as he should be fixed on the throne. Whilst the two brothers were thus actively employed in preparing to take the field, the Emperor was informed, by his spies, of all their transactions; and immediately superseded Abdullah Khan in his government; sending at the same time an active officer, named Syed Abdalghoffar, with 12,000 horse, to dispossess him.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1712.

Abdullah Khan, unable to oppose such a force in the field, took refuge in the fort of Allahabad; but encamped his troops, consisting of less than seven thousand cavalry and infantry, under the command of his three younger brothers, for the convenience of water and forage, at some miles' distance from the fort: of which circumstance the Imperial General having obtained intelligence, by a forced march got between them and the fort; and sent a taunting message to the Governor, that not wishing to play with children, he had left them behind him, being desirous of trying his, the Governor's, skill in the game of war. This message having been reported to the young men, inflamed them with rage; they immediately attacked the rear of the Imperial army; and, after a hard-fought battle, completely routed them; not, however, without the loss of a number of their own men, and that of one of their generals, Noor Addeen Khan, the favourite brother of the Governor.

This event caused much alarm at Dehly: and the Emperor, in hopes of detaching Abdullah Khan from the confederacy, meanly condescended to say, that he never had any intention of superseding him; and sent him a new commission for the government of Allahabad, which was accompanied by an honorary dress of the most splendid kind.

In the meantime, the Prince Ferrokhsere having arrived at Benaras, was enabled to borrow a large sum of money from the bankers of that city, on the same terms on which the loan had been negotiated at Patna; and, proceeding by easy marches, daily augmented his army by fresh levies, and was joined by several officers of distinction, who had taken disgust at the conduct of Jehandar Shah and his ministers; so that, on his

Digitized by Google

crossing the Ganges at Allahabad, and after his junction with Abdullah Khan, he mustered an army of 25,000 cavalry, and an excellent train of artillery. SECT. VI. A. D. 1712.

The Prince soon after advanced to Cudgwa*, attended by the two brothers, Syed Hussein Aly and Abdullah Khan, with all their friends and partisans; and on the 29th of the month Showal, A. H. 1124, defeated Aizaddeen, the eldest son of Jehandar Shah, and got possession of all his artillery and camp equipage. In consequence of this victory, many of the Imperial troops joined the standard of Ferrokhsere; and Abdullah Khan, who directed all the military movements, halted some days on the field of battle, to carry on his negotiations with several of the Omrahs, who were disgusted with Jehandar Shah and his infamous government. November, A. D. 1712.

The pusillanimous Emperor, having at length taken the field, the contending armies, on the 14th of Zilhije 1124, met in the vicinity of Agra; and after a confused battle, which lasted nearly the whole day, the Imperial army was completely routed; and the Emperor, accompanied by his mistress, Lāll Coar, fled upon his elephant to Agra; where, having changed his dress, and shaved his head and beard in the manner of the Hindoos, he, in the middle of the night, continued his flight towards Dehly. Upon his arrival in that city, instead of going to the fort, he stopt at the house of the Vizier Assud ad Dowlah, who had been left in charge of the capital. This circumstance was shortly known throughout the town; upon which the friends of Ferrokhsere surrounded the house, and demanded that the Royal fugitive should be delivered into The Royal army defeated by Prince Ferrokhsere, Jan. 1713.

* The place where the battle was fought between Shujaa and Aurungzebe.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1713. their hands. In order to suppress their clamours, the Vizier agreed to confine the Emperor; and making a virtue of necessity, he wrote a petition to Ferrokhsere, informing him, that he had imprisoned Jehandar Shah in his own house, and waited the Imperial orders concerning his disposal. In return, orders were despatched, applauding his conduct, and assuring him of the Royal favour.

During the late engagement, although fortune, in its termination, had favoured the cause of Ferrokhsere, yet that division of the army which had been placed under the command of his friend and principal support, Hussein Aly Khan, having been opposed to Zoolfecar Khan, the Ameer al Omrah, and his Tartar troops, was worsted, and their chief left for dead on the field: and as Zoolfecar Khan* continued to keep possession of the ground till it was dark, the body of Hussein Aly was not discovered till near midnight; and when found, was in a state of insensibility, and scarcely a spark of life remaining. On receiving some assistance, he so far recovered his senses, as to learn with pleasure the success of his party; nevertheless, it was with much difficulty that he could be placed in a palanquin, and conveyed to his brother; who, on seeing him still alive, prostrated himself on the ground, and returned thanks to God for so signal a favour: he afterwards took off the valuable jewels which he wore, and presented them to the man who had first discovered the body.

Ferrokhsere encamped that night on the field of battle; and

* This officer was the son of Assud ad Dowlah, the Vizier: at the desire of his father, he yielded himself up a prisoner, and trusted to the clemency of the Prince; but, as he had been the principal cause of the defeat and death of the father of Ferrokhsere, he had no reason to hope for pardon, and suffered accordingly.

Digitized by Google

next morning, being the 15th of the month Zilhije 1124, he mounted the throne of Hindoostan, and gave public audience to all the people. On this occasion were introduced to him a number of the Omrahs, who, in consequence of the negotiations of Abdullah Khan, had either remained neuter during the engagement, or had come over to the victorious side. After the inauguration of the Emperor, he proceeded to Sekundra, to offer up his devotions at the tomb of his illustrious ancestor, Akbar; and at noon returned to Agra, where he received the compliments of all the inhabitants of that city.

Ferrokhsere proclaimed Emperor, January, A. D. 1713.

The next day the Emperor proceeded towards Dehly; and, on his arrival in its vicinity, encamped outside the walls, and commanded the Vizier, Assud ad Dowlah, and his son, Zoolfecar Khan, to be brought to his presence. They were both received with the honours due to their high rank; after which, the former was allowed to return to his home: but the latter was led to a private tent; and after a few questions had been asked him, he was strangled, as a punishment for his crimes. His body was afterwards tied, with the head downwards, on an elephant, together with the body of Jehandar Shah, who had been put to death in prison; and they were thus exposed in the new Emperor's train, when he made his triumphal entry to the palace of the capital†.

Causes Jehandar Shah to be put to death.

Having thus conducted Ferrokhsere to the perilous pinnacle of his ambition, whence in a few years he was to be precipitated into the abyss of destruction, we now return to the affairs of Bengal.

---

† For the remaining history of Ferrokhsere, see Scott's valuable *History of the Dekkan*, second Volume.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A.D. 1712.

When Ferrokhsere assumed the Imperial titles at Patna, he was persuaded by one of his dependants, named Rasheed Khan, to appoint him Governor of Bengal: and knowing that Moorshud Cooly Khan did not keep up more troops than those employed in the collection of the revenues, he was in hopes that Rasheed Khan might, by an expeditious march, completely surprise the Nuwab and, without difficulty get possession of the province, which would serve as a place of refuge, should he be disappointed in his views on the empire. The matter was therefore kept a profound secret till the Prince commenced his march from Patna; when Rasheed Khan, instead of accompanying him, took the route of Moorshudabad; and before the Nuwab was aware of his intentions, had entered the passes of Terriagurhy and Sicklygully. The Nuwab, not at all intimidated by the circumstance, ordered his corps of 2000 cavalry to encamp outside the city; and, having joined to them as many of his infantry as he could collect, with a few guns, waited the approach of the enemy. When they had arrived within a few miles of Moorshudabad, he gave the command of his troops to two officers, named Meer Bengally and Syed Anwar, and ordered them to oppose Rasheed Khan: an engagement ensued, in which Syed Anwar was killed, and Meer Bengally compelled to retreat: the Nuwab, however, who was a stanch predestinarian, was not at all dismayed by the event; but collecting the palace-guards, and a few other troops, proceeded, on his elephant, to the assistance of his retreating army: his presence gave vigour to the troops; they returned to the attack; and an arrow, from the hand of Meer Bengally, having pierced Rasheed Khan, he fell from his horse: his army was, in consequence, totally

Digitized by Google

routed, and many of them taken prisoners. The Nuwab returned in triumph to the city; and gave orders that a pyramid should be immediately erected on the road to Dehly, with niches to contain the heads of Rasheed Khan and all his followers that were slain in the battle, that it might remain a monument of his victory. SECT. VI. A.D. 1712.

But as soon as Ferrokhsere was firmly established on the throne, Moorshud Cooly prepared the usual presents, and sent them to Court, with the amount of the year's collections, with the same punctuality as he had hitherto done: and the new Emperor, being either engaged with more interesting concerns, or considering Moorshud Cooly as an unambitious and useful servant, conferred on him the united offices of Nazim and Dewan; the former of which he had hitherto only held as deputy; and, at his recommendation, appointed the nephew of Manickchund to be the Imperial treasurer, or banker, with the title of Juggeet Seat.

Moorshud Cooly confirmed in his government, A.D. 1713.

On the death of Syed Reza Khan, the deputy Dewan of the province, the Nuwab procured that appointment for his grandson, Mirza Assud ad Dowlah, son of the deputy Nazim of Orissa, whom he intended for his heir, with the splendid title of Serferaz Khan. But, as it was the custom of Hindoostan, that on the death of any public officer, or immediate servant of the Crown, all his wealth and personal property were sequestered and taken possession of by Government, leaving the family frequently quite destitute,—in order to prevent such an occurrence in his family, the Nuwab took the precaution of purchasing, from the Talookdar of Chunacolly, the zemindary of the city of Moorshudabad; and had the transaction registered in the books of the Canoungoes and of the exchequer; changing

Appoints his Grandson deputy Dewan.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1713.

the name of the new purchase, in compliment to his grandson, to Assudnagur; that, in the event of his death, the profits of the estate, after paying the Royal revenue, might yield to his family the necessaries of life.

He also conferred the office of deputy Nazim of Dacca on Mirza Lutf-ullah, who married his grand-daughter; and procured for him his own title of Moorshud Cooly Khan; thus bestowing upon his own family all the lucrative offices of government, and endeavouring to render his name permanent in the province.

As a further proof of the influence which Moorshud Cooly had acquired at the court of Dehly, it is stated, that Nejum Addeen Aly Khan, a brother of the two celebrated Syeds who had raised Ferrokhsere to the throne, wished for the title of Nasir Jung, which had been formerly conferred on the Governor of Bengal, and who was, in consequence, now requested to exchange it for another equally honourable: but the Nuwab wrote, with his own hand, to the Emperor, that he would never part with the title conferred on him by the great Aurungzebe, but with his life.

Moorshud Cooly Khan was sensible that Bengal owed much of its wealth to its external commerce: he therefore gave every encouragement to foreign merchants, especially to the Moghuls and Arabians, from whom he only exacted the prescribed duties of $2\frac{1}{2}$ per cent. and did not permit the custom-house officers to take more than their regulated fees; but he was too keen a politician not to observe with jealousy the fortified factories of the Europeans, and the great advantages which the English had over the merchants, in consequence of the firmāns and nishāns; which they had obtained

Digitized by Google

(he said) by means of bribery and corruption; and which permitted them to trade either duty free, or for the paltry consideration of 3000 rupees per annum. When therefore he felt himself perfectly secure in his government, he set at nought the orders of the Prince Shujaa, and of the Emperor Aurungzebe; and demanded from the English, either the same duties that were paid by Hindoo subjects, or a constant renewal of presents, both to himself and to all the inferior departments. Such conduct, of course, irritated the English agents, who wrote a detail of their grievances to the Directors of the Company in England, and solicited permission to send an embassy to Dehly, to complain to the Emperor of the Nuwab's conduct. Their suggestion was approved of by the Company; and orders were sent to the Governors of Madras and Bombay, to unite their grievances in the same petition with those of Bengal.

The Governor sets aside the privileges of the English, A. D. 1713.

The nomination of the Ambassadors was left to Mr. Hedges, the Governor of Calcutta, who selected, for this purpose, Mr. John Surman, and Edward Stephenson, two of the ablest factors in the Bengal service; joining to them an Armenian, named Khoja Serhaud, who understood both the English and Persian languages, and who had been for many years the principal merchant in Calcutta. Mr. William Hamilton also accompanied the embassy, as surgeon.

English Embassy to Dehly.

At that period the government of Calcutta were very ignorant of the politics and intrigues of the Court of Dehly; and the Ambassadors had no other lights to direct their proceedings, than such as they obtained from the Armenian; who, although he had never been at Dehly, had procured a certain degree of information from some of his countrymen, whose extensive

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1715.

commercial concerns led them over every part of India; and who was very solicitous to be admitted into this honourable commission, in hopes of acquiring a large profit by the goods he should carry, free of charges and duties, in the train of the embassy. The presents designed for the Emperor and his officers consisted of curious glass ware, clockwork, brocades, and the finest manufactures of woollen-cloths and silks; valued, altogether, at 30,000*l.*; which Khoja Serhaud, in his letters to Dehly, magnified to 100,000*l.*; and gave such a description of the varieties which were coming, that Ferrokhsere ordered the embassy to be escorted by the Governors of the provinces through whose territories it might pass. The train proceeded on the Ganges, from Calcutta to Patna; and thence by land to Dehly; where they arrived on the 8th of July, after a march of three months.

The Ambassadors, upon their arrival at Court, very judiciously did not make their application though the Vizier, Syed Abdullah Khan, or his brother Hussein Aly Khan, the Ameer al Omrah; having discovered, that, notwithstanding the Emperor's obligations to these two chiefs, he was not attached to them, nor guided by their advice. The Ambassadors therefore chose for their patron a person named Khoja Hassen, who had accompanied Ferrokhsere from Bengal, and upon his accession to the throne had obtained the title of Khan Dowran. This person, who held the office of Paymaster-general, was a great favourite of the Emperor's, and was admitted to all his councils.

In the meantime, the Nuwab of Bengal, who had from the first instant beheld the embassy with great jealousy, and who considered it as an imputation against the integrity of his

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1715.

conduct, took much pains, by his interest with the Vizier and his brother the Ameer al Omrah, to thwart its success; and probably would have accomplished his object, if an accident had not placed the English gentlemen, at once, in a high degree of favour with the Emperor himself.

Ferrokhsere had been for some time engaged to marry the daughter of Raja Ajeet Sing, one of the Rajepoot Princes; and the bride had arrived, for that purpose, at the capital: but the Emperor, being afflicted with a complaint which all the skill of his own physicians could not cure, was under the necessity of postponing the marriage. At length, in consequence of the recommendation of Khan Dowran, he permitted Mr. Hamilton, the surgeon of the Embassy, to attend him; and that gentleman having, by a judicious operation, restored the Emperor to health, became, very deservedly, a great favourite with his Majesty, who, in addition to many proofs of the Royal munificence*, promised to grant any other favour he should ask. Mr. Hamilton, instead of requesting any further reward for himself, besought his Majesty to concede to the English Ambassadors the object of their mission. The Emperor, surprised

Mr. Hamilton, a surgeon, employed by the Emperor.

* Among the presents given to Mr. Hamilton on this occasion, were models of all his surgical instruments, made of pure gold.

In clearing away the ground for the foundation of the new church in Calcutta, about thirty years ago, the tombstone of Mr. Hamilton was discovered; which, in addition to an English epitaph, bore a Persian inscription, thus translated by Mr. Gladwin: "William "Hamilton, Physician in the service of the English Company, who had accompanied the "English Ambassador to the enlightened presence, and having made his own name famous "in the four quarters of the earth by the cure of the Emperor, the Asylum of the world, "Mohammed Ferrukheer the Victorious; and, with a thousand difficulties, having ob-"tained permission from the Court, which is the refuge of the universe, to return to his "country; by the Divine decree, on the fourth of December 1717, died in Calcutta, and "is buried here."

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1715. at Mr. Hamilton's disinterestedness, promised, that as soon as the marriage ceremonies were over, he would take the petition into his serious consideration, and grant the English every indulgence he could, consistent with the dignity of his own empire.

Shortly after this conversation, the marriage festivals commenced, and were celebrated with greater pomp and magnificence than had ever been witnessed in Hindoostan. This event interrupted all other business, and obliged the Ambassadors to wait for six months before they could procure a favourable opportunity of presenting their petition.

A. D. 1716. It was at length presented, in the month of January; and, besides various subjects of complaint from Bombay and Madras, stated the numerous impositions practised by the Nuwab of Bengal, and his inferior officers. It therefore prayed,

"That a *dustuck*, or passport, signed by the President of Calcutta, should exempt the goods it specified from being stopped or examined by the officers of the Bengal government, under any pretence.

"That the officers of the mint, at Moorshudabad, should at all times, when required, allow three days in the week for the coinage of the English Company's money.

"That all persons, whether Europeans or natives, who might be indebted or accountable to the Company, should be delivered up to the Presidency at Calcutta, on the first demand.

"That the English might purchase the lordship of thirty-eight towns, with the same immunities as the Prince Azeem Ooshan had permitted them to buy Calcutta, Chuttanutty, and Govindpore."

Khan Dowran, whom the Ambassadors had chosen as

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

their patron, not daring openly to espouse their cause, advised them to act as if they had no other reliance than on Syed Abdullah Khan, the Vizier: and even the Emperor, although he professed a general approbation of the petition, directed the several articles to be discussed by the different officers of the State, to whose cognizance they were deemed to belong. A. D. 1716.

This subjected the whole petition to the judgment of the Vizier; who, not without candour, disputed all the material articles, and readily allowed those of less importance. A second and a third petition were therefore presented to the Emperor; in consequence of which the Vizier was at length induced to give up all his objections: but, to the great disappointment of the ambassadors, the mandates were issued, not under the Emperor's, but under the seal of the Vizier; which, although carrying great authority in provinces near the capital, was likely to be little respected by the distant Viceroys, to whom these orders were addressed.

To increase the difficulties of the embassy, Khoja Sêrhaud, having been checked by his colleagues in some irregular proceedings, perplexed all their operations, and, as they thought, betrayed their councils. Nevertheless, Messrs. Stephenson and Surman, with great steadiness and becoming spirit, returned the mandates; and determined to wait until they should obtain patents under the Imperial seal.

In the meantime, the agents of the Nuwab of Bengal exerted themselves to thwart the measure as much as possible, and by their influence and bribery postponed the business for fourteen months. At length the Ambassadors were advised to bribe a favourite Eunuch in the Seraglio; and although not very sanguine in their expectations from this measure, were A. D. 1717.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

The English obtain various Firmans from the Emperor, A. D. 1717.

induced to comply: and to their great surprise, as soon as the money was paid, the Vizier, and all his dependants, appeared as much inclined to forward their views, as they had hitherto been averse; and soon after, thirty-four patents, embracing all the different subjects of the petition, were issued in the Emperor's name, and the principal ones authenticated by the Imperial seal*.

These papers were delivered to the Ambassadors before they had discovered the real cause of their success; which, however, was explained to them before they left Dehly, by one of Khan Dowran's officers.

In the year 1687†, a little while before the fleet from England began to take the Moghul ships, the English agents at Surat retired to Bombay, and continued there till peace was restored. During the period the Ambassadors were at Dehly, the president of Bombay, finding that the expenses of the factory at Surat, in consequence of the impositions practised by the Moghul officers, far exceeded the profits, had ordered it to be withdrawn; and the Governor of Surat, reasoning from former experience, took the alarm, and firmly believed that a fleet was on its way from England, to commit hostilities, as in 1687; which would have been attended with the same consequences, as many valuable ships, belonging to the Moghul merchants, were then at sea. He therefore wrote privately to the Eunuch, who he knew had great influence over the Emperor, and was highly respected by the Vizier, to represent to them the dangerous consequences of a farther refusal of the English petition. This suggestion was readily

* See Appendix. † See page 318.

Digitized by Google

listened to, both by the Emperor and Abdullah Khan; and the Eunuch, foreseeing the change that would shortly ensue, determined to reap some advantage from his intelligence, and imposed himself on the Ambassadors as the sole author and instigator of the measure.

The Ambassadors, having thus accomplished the object of their mission, took leave of the Emperor in the month of July, two years after their arrival at Dehly. The patents addressed to the Soubah of the Dekkan and the Nuwab of Guzerat took effect as soon as they were published, because they afforded no political pretext for opposition; but in Bengal their meaning was much disputed or evaded. A. D. 1717.

The article which permitted the English to purchase thirty-eight towns would have given them a district extending ten miles south of Calcutta, along the banks on each side of Hoogly river; of which the passage, in this extent, might have been easily commanded, by the erection of batteries or redoubts; at the same time that the revenue of the tract would have defrayed the expense: and the possession of such a tract would have brought under their subjection and authority a considerable number of the Moghul subjects.

The prudent foresight of Moorshud Cooly Khan, added to his resentment at the success of the embassy, made him behold with indignation the concession of this article; but not daring openly to oppose the Imperial mandate, he privately threatened the proprietors of the land with denunciations of his vengeance, if they parted with their ground to the English upon any terms that should be offered: and the Company's servants, confiding too much in the sanction of the Emperor's firmān, neglected the more efficacious means of bribing the Nuwab

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1717.

to compliance with their wishes. Thus the most important concession which had been obtained by the embassy was entirely frustrated.

The Nuwab, however, complied with the orders contained in the first article; and the privilege of granting *ductucks*, or passports, by the President of Calcutta, was recognised all over the province. This circumstance greatly augmented and facilitated the circulation of the English trade; which now no longer paid customs, nor was liable to be stopped by the officers of Government. But a question arose, whether the English were entitled, under this privilege, to participate in the internal commerce of Bengal, by carrying the manufacture or products of one part of the province to another. The Emperor's firmān implied no restrictions; but the Nuwab insisted, that the immunity extended only to such articles as were either imported, or intended to be exported, by *sea*; alleging, that as salt, betel-nut, tobacco, and several other articles of general consumption, were either farmed out in monopolies, or taxed with heavy duties, if the English were allowed to trade in these articles, it would not only be a great injury to all the other merchants, but a very considerable diminution of the public revenue.

Convinced as much by the reasoning of the Nuwab, as deterred by his power, the servants of the Company receded from their pretensions, and applied themselves to make the most advantage of those privileges which were not contested.

Flourishing state of Calcutta.

Success produced new adventurers; and besides a number of English private merchants licensed by the Company, Calcutta was, in a short time, peopled by Portuguese, Armenian, Moghul, and Hindoo merchants, who carried on their com-

Digitized by Google

merce under the protection of the English flag: thus the shipping belonging to the port, in the course of ten years after the embassy, amounted to ten thousand tons; and many individuals amassed fortunes, without injuring the Company's trade, or incurring the displeasure of the Moghul Government. The President, nevertheless, found it requisite to conciliate the Nuwab frequently, by presents, in order to secure the Company's investments, and to facilitate the course of their business at the subordinate factories; but the inhabitants of Calcutta enjoyed, after the return of the embassy, a degree of freedom and security unknown to the other subjects of the Moghul empire; and that city, in consequence, increased yearly, in extent, beauty, and riches.

In the year 1130, Moorshud Cooly Khan obtained from Court the patents he had long solicited; conferring on him the government of Behar*, in addition to the united offices of Nazim and Dewan of Bengal and Orissa; which threw into his hands greater powers than had been entrusted to any Governor, since the introduction of the Emperor Akbar's regulations. A. D. 1718.

In the year of the Hejira 1131, the unfortunate Ferrokhsere was put to a cruel death†, by the very persons who had raised him to the throne; and the two young princes, Ruffeh ad Dirjaut, and Ruffeh ad Dowlah, in the course of seven months occupied the throne and their coffins; scarcely affording time to the Governor of Bengal to manifest the loyalty of his Death of Ferrokhsere, A. D. 1719.

* See *Scott's History of the Dekkan*, A.D. 1719.

† For the two or three first years of Ferrokhsere's reign, the government of Behar was held by Ameer Jumlah; but was afterwards conferred on Ser Balund Khan, who at this time was removed to Cabul.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

The Nuwab confirmed in his government by Mohammed Shah, Feb. 1720.

intentions. But as soon as Mohammed Shah was firmly seated on the throne, the Nuwab prepared the usual presents, and forwarded them, with the collections of the year, to Dehly; and, in return, was confirmed in his government.

In the year 1135, after the murder of the two Syeds, Moorshud Cooly Khan again forwarded more valuable presents to the Emperor, with a congratulatory letter on his success. He at the same time remitted to the Viziers the collection for the last year; and by such conduct, at a time that the other Governors were very remiss in their duty, maintained his reputation and influence at Court.

About this period, the government of Bengal was in some measure disturbed by an attempt at insurrection, by two of the Afghan Zemindars of Mahmoodabad; who, having collected a number of followers, plundered the adjoining districts, and had even the audacity to seize upon 60,000 rupees of the public treasure which was on the way to Moorshudabad. As soon as intelligence of this circumstance reached the Nuwab, he ordered Ahsen Aly Khan, the foujedar of Hoogly, to march against the insurgents: and that officer having, by a rapid movement, surprised them, took them all prisoners, and sent them loaded with chains to the Nuwab, who confiscated all their property, transferred their zemindaries to Ramjiwun, his favourite Hindoo collector, and condemned them (being Mohammedans) to perpetual imprisonment: but in order that the government should not be losers by this disturbance, and to prevent a repetition of similar outrages, he caused all the zemindars in the vicinity of Mahmoodabad to pay their proportion of the 60,000 rupees, public money, which had been plundered.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Moorshud Cooly was indefatigable in the extirpation of robbers. Wherever a robbery was committed, he compelled the Foujedar, or the Zemindar, either to find out the thief, or to recover the property. The goods, or their equivalent in money, were always restored to the persons who had been robbed; and the thief, whenever caught, was impaled alive.

At Cutwah and Moorshudgunge he erected guard-houses, for the protection of travellers; and gave the command of the police guards to one of his slaves, named Mohammed Jan, who was of a savage disposition, and who was always attended by a band of executioners; and whenever he caught a thief, used to have the body split in two, and hung upon trees on the high road; from which circumstance he was nick-named the Kolhareh, or Axe.

By these severe means, during Moorshud Cooly Khan's government, travellers were protected on the roads, and every man slept securely in his own house.

Having, in the preceding pages, given what may be termed the dark side of Moorshud Cooly Khan's picture, we have now much pleasure in reversing the object; although we fear the portrait will still not be approved of by Englishmen. Both sides are however drawn by the same author; who, although anonymous, is allowed, by the Mohammedans, to have written with truth and impartiality*.

Character of the Nuwab.

"Excepting Shaisteh Khan there has not appeared in Bengal, nor indeed in any part of Hindoostan, an Ameer who

* This work was translated and published by F. Gladwin, Esq. in Calcutta, A. D. 1788, under the title of *a Narrative of the Transactions in Bengal*; but the greater part of it has been inserted in the *Ryuz Assulateen*; and some extracts from it are given in the *Araishi Muhafil*, a late Hindoostany work.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

can be compared with Moorshud Cooly; for zeal, in the propagation of the faith; for wisdom, in the establishment of laws and regulations; for munificence and liberality, in the encouragement and support given to men of family and eminence; for rigid and impartial justice, in redressing wrongs, and punishing offenders; in short, whose whole administration so much tended to the benefit of mankind, and the glory of the Creator.

"His judicial decisions were so rational and proper, that they were as much respected and obeyed as the decrees of those monarchs whose names are most renowned for equity and justice. He was such an observer of his word, that he never failed in the performance of any engagement: he slept but little, and carefully observed the stated times of prayer: from breakfast to noon he employed himself in copying the Koran, and in administering justice: and every year he sent Korans of his own writing, with valuable offerings, to Mecca, Medina, and other holy places.

"He maintained above two thousand readers, beadsmen, and chanters, who were constantly employed in reading the Koran, and in other acts of devotion. During the first twelve days of the month Rubby al Avul, which include the birth and death of the holy Prophet, he feasted people of all conditions: and on those nights, the road from Maheenagur to Loll Baugh, which is above three miles, was illuminated with lamps, representing verses of the Koran, mosques, trees, and other figures. Nearly a hundred thousand persons were employed on these occasions; and, on the firing of a gun, the whole was illuminated at once, exhibiting, in an instant, such a sheet of light as astonished the beholders. He also kept the festival of

Digitized by Google

the prophet Khizer, when paper boats, decorated with lighted lamps, are set afloat upon the river*.

" Besides feeding a multitude of people, he also provided food for the beasts of the field and the fowls of the air.

" He always provided against famine, and severely prohibited all monopolies of grain: he constantly made private inquiries concerning the market-price of grain; and, whenever he discovered any imposition, the offenders suffered the most exemplary punishments. If the importation of grain to the cities and towns fell short of what had been usual, he sent officers into the country, who broke open the hoards of individuals, and compelled them to carry their grain to the public markets. Rice was then commonly sold, at Moorshudabad, at four maunds for a rupee; and the prices of other provisions were in proportion. He also strictly prohibited the exportation of grain; and the Foujedar of Hoogly had express orders to see that no ship, belonging to Europeans or others, was suffered to carry away more than was sufficient for the victualling of the crew, during their intended voyage; neither were any merchants suffered to have any stores of grain.

" He was so punctual in the performance of all tokens of respect towards his Sovereign, that he would not sit down in a Royal boat; and when, in the rainy season, the Emperor's fleet of state boats came from Dacca, for an exhibition, he went out to meet it; and turning his face towards the seat of Government, made his obeisance, presented his *nuzzir*, and kissed the deck of the royal barge. Engagements between elephants being prohibited from Court, he did not allow them

* See Note, page 238.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. within his jurisdiction; but used to exhibit and be present at those between elephants and tigers, and other animals. He took no delight in hunting; he never indulged himself with spirituous liquors, nor any intoxicating drugs; neither did he amuse himself with singers or dancers: He always kept constant to one lawful wife; and, out of his excess of delicacy, would not suffer any strange women, or eunuchs, to enter the apartments of his seraglio.

"He despised all the refinements of luxury, and particularly in dress; and refrained from every thing that is prohibited in the law. No high-seasoned dishes were served up to his table; neither frozen sherbets, nor creams, but only plain ice. During the winter, Khyzir Khan, his house-steward, used to collect, in the mountains of Rajemahel, a sufficient stock of ice for the rest of the year; and the whole was done at the expense of the zemindars of that district. In the mangoe season, there was stationed at Rajemahel an overseer, who used to keep a regular account of the choicest mangoe-trees in Maldah, Kutwalee, and Husseinpoor; and his guards were placed over them, to see that no one purloined the fruit, and that it was regularly sent to Moorshudabad. The zemindars furnished every thing that was required for these purposes; and they durst not cut down a mangoe-tree, nor touch any of the fruit, that the overseer had appropriated to the use of the Nazim's table.

"He possessed very extensive learning, and paid great respect to men who were eminent for their piety or erudition: he wrote with great elegance, and was a remarkable fine penman: his skill in arithmetic enabled him to scrutinize all accounts himself: he signed all orders and accounts with red ink: he was a brave soldier, a liberal benefactor, upright and just in

Digitized by Google

all his dealings, the steady protector of the weak; so that, during his government, the meanest peasant was secured from injustice and oppression.

"He made no retrenchments in any Royal grants, or in those of former Soubahdars, for charitable purposes; but, on the contrary, increased them: no Zemindar or Aumil could, with impunity, oppress any one: vakeels were continually in search of complainants; and whenever they met with any person who had reason to be dissatisfied, they used every endeavour to pacify him; but if it happened that a well-founded complaint reached the ears of Moorshud Cooly, the offender was sure to suffer severely. If the officers of justice, out of partiality, or respect to rank, neglected to redress the meanest person, upon a representation thereof from the party aggrieved, the Nuwab tried the cause himself; and in his decisions shewed neither favour nor affection to any one, the rich and the poor bearing equal value in his sight*.

"In the beginning of the government of Moorshud Cooly, the Cutwal† of Hoogly forcibly took away a young girl from the house of her father, a Moghul; and Ahsenullah, the foujedar of that place, suffering the offence to pass unnoticed, the father carried his complaint before the Nuwab, who commanded that the offender should be stoned to death, conformably to the ordinance of the Koran; and notwithstanding all the entreaties of Ahsenullah, who was a great favourite, the sentence was actually executed.

* "Notwithstanding the high encomiums which are here bestowed upon the government of Moorshud Cooly, his memory is universally execrated by the Hindoos; who contemplate, with heartfelt joy, the happy influence of the British sway over these regions; whereby they have been relieved from the direful effects of Mohammedan superstition, and are permanently secured from the merciless hand of tyranny, rapacity, and oppression."

† Mayor of the town.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Mohammedan Bigotry.

"A Mohammedan beggar having asked charity of Bindrabund, a Hindoo landholder of Chunakholly, he was displeased at his manner, and turned him out of the house. The fakier collected together a number of bricks, with which he erected a wall on Bindrabund's road, and gave it the name of a mosque; and from it called the people to prayer. Whenever Bindrabund passed that way, he vociferated the summons to prayer, and so vexed him, that in rage he threw down some of the bricks, abused the fakier, and drove him away. The fakier complained to Moorshud Cooly; and Cazy Mohammed Sheref, in an assembly of men learned in the law, sentenced Bindrabund to be put to death. The Nuwab was not willing to take away his life; and asked the Cazy whether there was not any way of evading the strict letter of the law, to save the poor Hindoo. The Cazy answered, 'There may be so much delay, as to allow time for his intercessor to be put to death first; but after that, he must absolutely be executed.' All the endeavours of Moorshud Cooly, in his behalf, were ineffectual; and although Bindrabund was recommended to the Emperor's mercy by the Prince Azeem Ooshan, yet it was of no avail; for the Cazy killed him with an arrow from his own hand. After the execution, Azeem Ooshan complained to Aurungzebe, that Cazy Mohammed Sheref had killed Bindrabund in a fit of insanity; but the Emperor wrote with his own hand on the Prince's letter, 'Cazy Sheref is on the side of God.' At the death of Aurungzebe, Cazy Sheref applied for leave to resign; and all the entreaties of the Nuwab could not prevail upon him to continue in office.

"The Nuwab, being now far advanced in years, and finding his health decline very fast, gave orders for building his tomb,

Digitized by Google

with a mosque, and a *kehtareh* (a square, with shops, &c.) Morad Ferash, a confidential but menial servant, was the person employed to superintend the work. He pitched upon a spot situated in the Khass Talook, on the east side of the city. He pulled down all the neighbouring Hindoo temples, and used the materials for raising the new work. The zemindars, and other Hindoos, would have preserved their temples at any price; but no intreaties or bribes could prevail: not one was left standing in Moorshudabad, or at the distance of four days' journey from it. In the remote villages, many of the Hindoos' houses were threatened with destruction, upon pretence of their being dedicated to religious uses; and they were necessitated to redeem them by the payment of a sum of money. The servants of Hindoos of all ranks were compelled to work, unless their masters paid for their release. So great was the dread of Morad, that no one dared to complain; his written orders were circulated throughout the country, and implicitly obeyed. By these means, in the course of a year, the buildings were completed, and a *gunge* (a public market where duties are collected) annexed to the kehtareh, to keep the whole in repair." SECT. VI.

In the year 1138, Moorshud Cooly Khan, apprehensive that he had not long to live, exerted all his interest and influence at the Court of Dehly, to preserve the succession to his government for his grandson, Serferaz Khan; and in all probability might have succeeded*, had not a powerful rival A. D. 1724.

* At this period, Nizam al Moulk had rebelled, and had taken possession of the Dekkan. The province of Guzerat had also revolted; and the ministers of Mohammed Shah were at variance, and only jealous of each other. *See Scott's History of the Dekkan.*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1724.

opposed his views, in the person of Shujaa Addeen Khan, the father of the young man, then deputy governor of Orissa; who, by his equability of temper, generosity, and strict administration of justice, had rendered himself respected and beloved in the province which he governed.

This person, aware of the intentions of the Nuwab, privately employed intelligent agents to carry on a correspondence, and negotiate for him, with Khan Dowran, who had succeeded Syed Hussein Aly Khan as Ameer al Omrah, and who was a great favourite with the Emperor. Between these personages it was arranged, that Khan Dowran should procure the appointment of Soubahdar or Governor for himself, but that he would nominate Shujaa Addeen his deputy in the provinces of Bengal and Orissa.

Supported by so powerful a patron, Shujaa began to devise the means of success; and for this purpose, he, under various pretences, dismissed several of his bravest officers to Moorshudabad. He also collected a number of boats for the speedy conveyance of his troops, should the event occur in the rainy season; and he established a private post, to bring him, twice a day, intelligence of the state of the Nuwab's health. At length, having received authentic information that Moorshud Cooly could not survive more than a few days, he appointed Mohammed Tuckee Khan, his son by a concubine, to be his representative in Orissa; and, attended by his confidential officers and a select corps of cavalry, he quitted Cuttack; and before his arrival at Moorshudabad, he received, on the same day, positive accounts of the Nuwab's death, and his credentials from Khan Dowran, constituting him Deputy Governor of the provinces of Bengal and Orissa. Furnished with this docu-

Digitized by Google

ment, he proceeded with expedition to the seat of government; and alighting at the palace called the *Chehel Setoon* (Forty Pillars), summoned all the public officers to attend him; and upon their arrival produced his patents, which he caused to be read aloud, and without opposition took possession of the musnud; after which he received the congratulations of all the persons present, and caused the event to be notified by the shrill sounds of the Imperial music. This circumstance occurred early in the year of the Hejira 1139. A. D. 1725.

Previous to Moorshud Cooly Khan's decease, he appointed his grandson, Serferaz Khan, his public and private successor, and sole executor of his last testament; and, having delivered over to him the keys of all his treasures and valuable effects, he admonished him to behave with justice and humanity to all those who were placed under his authority: soon after which he departed this transitory life. Death of the Nuwab. Serferaz Khan immediately sent intelligence of this event to Dehly; he also wrote to his father (of whose intentions he had no suspicion), to acquaint him of the circumstance; and, conformably to instructions contained in his grandfather's will, deposited his remains in the tomb which had been previously prepared, under the steps of the newly-erected mosque. He then assured all the public officers of his intention to retain them in their stations, should he be confirmed in the government; and afterwards removed all the treasure and effects of the deceased from the palace to his own house.

Of the first interview between the father and son, after this event, there have been two accounts written. In the *Seir Mutakhereen* it is stated, that the first intelligence Serferaz Khan had of his father's arrival, was from the sound of the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1725.

Imperial music. Astonished by the noise, he inquired the cause, and, to his utter confusion, learned the unexpected event. He immediately called a council of his intimate friends, who unanimously advised him, that, as his father had received and proclaimed his commission, had taken possession of the palace, and was acknowledged by the public officers, he had only to submit with a good grace. The young man, either agreeing in opinion with his friends, or averse to oppose his parent, hastened without any retinue to the palace, fell at his father's feet, and congratulated him upon his accession to the government.

In the work translated by Mr. Gladwin, it is related, that Serferaz Khan received early intelligence of the approach of his father, and that he made preparations to oppose him; but that his mother and grandmother, both women remarkable for their prudence and great sagacity, and for whom he entertained the utmost affection and respect, interposed, and represented to him, that his father being an old man, could not keep him long out of the government, or, at least, from the inheritance to Moorshud Cooly Khan's private estate; and therefore advised him to be satisfied, for the present, with the office of Dewan of Bengal; and not to be guilty of the horrid impiety of appearing in arms against his father, which would fix a reproach upon his name to all eternity. These arguments prevailed so entirely over the ambition of Serferaz Khan, that he advanced to meet his father, and conducted him to Moorshudabad; and, after resigning to him the palace, retired to his own house at Nuktakhaly; and from that time never failed to pay his respects to him every morning.

Digitized by Google

NUWAB MOTIMUN AL MOOLK, SHUJAA ADDEEN MOHAMMED KHAN, SHUJAA AD DOWLAH, ASSUD JUNG, BEHADUR.

Origin of Shujaa Addeen Khan—Marries the daughter of Moorshud Cooly Khan—Appointed Deputy Governor of Orissa—Takes into his service two brothers, named Hajy Ahmed and Aly Verdy Khan—Shujaa Addeen obtains the deputy government of Bengal and Orissa—Appoints his son Dewan of the province—Releases the zemindars from their captivity—Sends a large sum of money, and various presents, to the Emperor Mohammed Shah—Distributes the subordinate appointments among his friends—Remits the amount of the revenues regularly to Dehly—Instances of his magnificence and charity—Increases his army—Becomes indolent and luxurious—Constructs a beautiful garden in the vicinity of Moorshudabad—The province of Behar again annexed to the government of Bengal—The Nuwab appoints Aly Verdy Khan to be his deputy in Behar—Aly Verdy proceeds to Patna—Takes into his service a corps of Afghans—Subdues the refractory zemindars—Promoted by the Emperor—Assassinates the Afghan Chief—Reasons assigned for this conduct—Origin of the Ostend East-India Company—One of their ships arrives in Bengal; the commander of which applies for, and obtains, ground to erect a Factory at Bankybazar—The trade flourishes—The agents surround the factory with a wall and bastions—The Emperor of Germany withdraws his Charter from the Company—The commerce still carried on by individuals—The English seize one of the Austrian ships—Prevail upon the Nuwab to order the fortifications of Bankybazar to be destroyed—The Germans oppose these measures—The Nuwab's troops lay siege to the factory—The native servants desert—The Agent wounded—embarks with the few Europeans on board one of their own ships, and quits Bengal—The factory destroyed—A dispute between the English of Calcutta and the Foujedar of Hoogly—The Kingdom of Tipperah made a province of the Moghul Empire—Dissentions between the Nuwab's sons—Death of Mohammed Tuckee Khan—The Nuwab appoints Moorshud Cooly Khan to be his deputy in Orissa; and Serferaz Khan governor of Dacca—Exemplary character of Jeswont Roy, Dewan of Dacca, who reduces the price of grain, and opens the western gate erected by

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Shaista Khan—resigns his office—Sayid Ahmed, foujedar of Rungpore, invades Dinagepore and Couch Beyhar, and obtains much treasure—The Nuwab appoints Serferaz Khan his Heir—his Death.

THIS officer was, by descent, an Afshar, of the tribe of Turcomans, who formerly inhabited Khorassan, the eastern province of Persia, and were esteemed the bravest soldiers in that kingdom. He was born in the city of Boorhanpore, in the Dekhan; and during his youth, having contracted an intimacy with Moorshud Cooly Khan, who was then Dewan of Hyderabad, married his only daughter, named Zynet al Nissa, Begum; by whom he had a son called Mirza Assudallah, whose title was Serferaz Khan: he had also another son, by a concubine, named Mohammed Tuckee.

When Moorshud Cooly was appointed Dewan of Bengal, his son-in-law accompanied him thither; and upon the former being promoted to the united governments of Bengal and Orissa, he sent the latter, as his deputy, to govern Orissa. In this situation Shujaa Addeen Khan conducted himself, as a public officer, with much propriety: but being of a luxurious disposition, and addicted to gallantry, he gave much offence to his wife; who in consequence separated from him, and, with her son, went to reside at Moorshudabad.

Shortly after this event, a person, named Mirza Mohammed, who had married a near relation of Shujaa Addeen Khan, came, with his two sons, from Dehly to Cuttack; and were all three admitted into the service of the Governor. The senior of the brothers was named Hajy* Ahmed; the junior, Mirza Mohammed Aly, better known by the title of Aly Verdy Khan. These were both men of liberal education and distinguished

* *Hajy* is a title conferred on all persons who have made the pilgrimage to Mecca: he had just returned from Arabia.

Digitized by Google

abilities; and, by their counsels, not only ingratiated themselves with the Governor, but rendered his government popular, respectable, and beneficial to the empire.

In the preceding chapter it has been stated, that when Moorshud Cooly Khan found his dissolution approaching, he had endeavoured to procure the succession to his government for his grandson, Serferaz Khan; but that Shujaa Addeen had, by the exertions of his agents at Dehly, effected a different arrangement; by which he was nominated the deputy of Khan Dowran, the Ameer al Omrah, who had procured from the Emperor the government for himself; and that Shujaa Addeen, by his dextrous management, had obtained possession of his office without any opposition.

The new Governor, in order to reward his son for his forbearance, and to reconcile himself to his wife, nominated the former, Dewan of Bengal; but as that office required an intricate knowledge of accounts, and much attention to business, he appointed Roy Alum Chund, the comptroller of the household, to be the deputy of the young man; by which the latter was relieved from all the toils and responsibility of the office, and his father was satisfied that the duty would be diligently performed. The Nuwab, immediately after, selected a Council, consisting of the two brothers, Hajy Ahmed and Aly Verdy Khan; Roy Alum Chund, for whom he procured the title of Roy Royan; and the Imperial banker, Juggut Seat; and by their advice conducted himself in all the measures of his government. The two latter were Hindoos, and were well acquainted with the minute details of business and all the intricacies of the revenue department.

Shujaa Addeen commenced his government by an act of

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1725.

clemency and justice, which does him the highest honour, and rendered him extremely popular through all the three provinces.

He gave orders that the unhappy zemindars, who had been kept in a miserable state of confinement during the long government of his predecessor, should, upon giving security for their good conduct, be permitted to return to their families and homes, and to the management of their farms.

He also immediately despatched the sum of forty lacs of rupees in specie, being part of the private fortune of his father-in-law, to the Court of Mohammed Shah; and sent also a number of elephants, and other valuable presents, to the Emperor and to his ministers; in return for which he received a confirmation of his appointment, as Governor of Bengal and Orissa; a commission of commander of 7000 horse; and the additional titles of Motimun al Moolk, Shujaa ad Dowlah, Assud Jung, Behadur.

The government of Behar was however again separated, and conferred on an officer named Nusserit yar Khan, and afterwards on Fakher ad Dowlah. As soon as Shujaa Addeen was confirmed in his government, he disposed of the public appointments amongst his connections and friends, in the following manner: to his son Serferaz Khan, as formerly mentioned, the office of Dewan; to his other son, Mohammed Tuckee, the government of Orissa. He confirmed Moorshud Cooly Khan, his son-in-law, in the deputy government of Dacca. To the three sons of his chief counsellor, Hajy Ahmed, viz. Nuazish Mohammed, Sayid Ahmed, and Zyn Addeen, he gave the offices of Paymaster-general, Foujedar of Rungpore, and Foujedar of Rajemahel; and upon Shujaa Cooly, an old servant, he conferred the office of Foujedar of Hoogly. His other

Digitized by Google

counsellor, Aly Verdy Khan, had not any sons, but his three daughters were married to the sons of his brother Hajy Ahmed. SECT. VI.

The new Governor imitated the conduct of his predecessor, in despatching to Court regularly, at the end of the year, the amount of the revenues; and had the satisfaction to find, that, notwithstanding his liberal treatment to the zemindars, the revenue, instead of being diminished, had increased: for whereas Moorshud Cooly had seldom remitted more than one crore and thirty lacs of rupees, the amount of his collections for the year 1141 amounted to one crore and forty-eight lacs, A. D. 1728. all of which was remitted to Moorshudabad by the agents of the Imperial banker, Juggat Seat, without any difficulty or oppression.

His mind being thus freed from public cares, he followed the natural bent of his inclinations, and lived in a style of splendor and munificence that far surpassed any of his predecessors. The palace of Moorshud Cooly Khan being too confined and ill-contrived, he ordered it to be pulled down, and erected another more suitable to his ideas of grandeur and comfort. He was very liberal to his servants, and paid great attention to men of learning and piety: he was also very charitable, and administered justice with great impartiality. He ordered the conduct of Nazir Ahmed and Morad, two of the oppressive instruments of his predecessor, to be closely investigated; and, having proved them guilty of various crimes and oppressions, condemned them to death. Being convinced that the very reduced military establishment kept up by Moorshud Cooly Khan was inadequate to the security and peace of the country, he augmented his army to 25,000, consisting of equal numbers of cavalry, and infantry armed with matchlocks.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. In short, by his general conduct in the early part of his government, Shujaa Addeen evinced to the world that he was deserving of his good fortune; but after some years he became indolent, and abandoned himself too much to luxury and pleasure, leaving the business to be managed by his Council.

In the village of Dehpareh, on the banks of the Bhaggarutty river, Nazir Ahmed had begun to build a mosque in the middle of a very extensive garden. After the execution of that person, the Governor finished the mosque in a superb style, and laid out the garden with great beauty and elegance. To this place he gave the name of *Ferreh Bāg* (the Garden of Happiness); and in the summer retired thither with his seraglio, and passed his time in the enjoyment of every luxury.

A.D. 1729-30. In the year 1143, Fakher ad Dowlah, the governor of Behar, having been guilty of some impropriety, was removed from that office; and through the influence of Khan Dowran, the Paymaster-general, the government of that province was again annexed to Bengal; and Shujaa Addeen Khan was, in consequence, ordered to appoint his own deputy to that important situation.

It was the wish of the Governor to have appointed one of his own sons; but Zinet al Nissa, his wife, who, as the heiress of Moorshud Cooly, interfered frequently in the government*, refused to part with her son Serferaz Khan; and was at the

* So strong an opinion had this lady of her own consequence, that, when it was determined Aly Verdy Khan should be appointed to Behar, she sent for him to the gate of her apartments, and conferred on him the *Khilaat* or robe of honour, as from herself; *after which* her husband presented him with his patent, and other insignia of office. This idea was however extremely erroneous, as there is no hereditary rank in Hindoostan, much less a right of succession to a government; nor was it, I believe, ever attempted with success, till the power of the Moghul Emperor was annihilated by the invasion of Nadir Shah and the events which ensued.

Digitized by Google

same time jealous of its being conferred on the son of the concubine, lest it should make him of too much consequence: the subject was therefore left to the consideration of the Council, who recommended Aly Verdy Khan, as the person best qualified to preserve the dignity of the situation, and to keep in subjection the zemindars of that province, who were noted for their independence and strong spirit of insurrection. Aly Verdy Khan was, in consequence, invested with the robes of office, and was sent to Patna, with an escort of 5000 troops. SECT. VI. A.D. 1729-30.

Upon the arrival of Aly Verdy Khan at Patna, he found the whole province of Behar in the greatest confusion: a band of robbers, called *Bunjareh*, who had entered it under the pretence of purchasing grain and other commodities, laid the country through which they passed under heavy contribution, and plundered the collectors of the revenue. The zemindars of Bettiah Phoolwareh, Chuckwar, and Boujepore, were also in a state of insurrection, and had for some time set at defiance the authority of the Governor.

To reduce these people to submission, Aly Verdy Khan found it requisite to take into his service a corps of Afghans, under the command of their chief, Abdul Kereem Khan. With these, and the forces he had taken from Moorshudabad, he first attacked and routed the Bunjarehs, taking from them all their plunder: after which, he, in succession, reduced the zemindars to obedience; and compelled them not only to liquidate the arrears of revenue, but to pay him large sums of money, under the denomination of *Nuzzeraneh* and *Peishkush* (offering and tribute). By these means Aly Verdy Khan acquired much wealth, and his troops were also enriched by plunder. In

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. consequence of these services, and at the recommendation of the Nuwab, he received from the Emperor an increase of his military rank, and the title of Mohabut Jung.

A.D. 1730. He however tarnished these honours shortly after, by the assassination of Abdul Kereem Khan, the commander of the Afghans, whose services had been so useful to him. This harsh measure he excused to his friends, by stating, that the overbearing conduct and insolence of that officer had risen to such a height, that he found he must either get rid of him, or have given up his own authority*.

It now becomes requisite to notice the introduction of another European nation into Bengal. About the year 1717, some merchants of the Austrian Netherlands, who had long wished to participate in the advantageous commerce of the East, fitted out two ships for India, which made a very successful voyage. This circumstance stimulated others; and application was made to the Court of Vienna for permission to establish an East-India Company at Ostend. Although this measure was strongly opposed by the English, French, and Dutch, the Emperor of Germany granted, in August 1723, to the merchants of the Austrian Netherlands†, his letters-patent, authorizing them to trade to the East Indies, under the denomination of the Ostend Company.

Origin of the Ostend Company.

In the mean time, one of the private ships arrived in the Ganges; and, by the assistance of the French at Chandernagore, succeeded in procuring a full cargo: and the captain of this

* After the dissolution of the Afghan empire, corps of these people were taken into the service of the Hindoo Princes and Moghul Governors: they are esteemed brave troops, but very mutinous; and unsteady in their attachment, unless to their own chiefs.

† See Modern Universal History, vol. XI. page 211.

Digitized by Google

ship, previous to his departure, made application to Moorshud Cooly Khan, then Governor of Bengal, for ground to erect a factory, should the Company be established. As the Nuwab was not only anxious to increase the trade of the province, but also desirous of introducing more rivals to the English, of whose privileges it has been already seen he was excessively jealous, he immediately complied with the request, and assigned the village of Bankybazar, situated on the eastern side of the river, fifteen miles above Calcutta, for the residence of the Germans. SECT. VI.

In 1724, being the first year after the establishment of the New Company, an Ostend ship, named The Emperor Charles, mounting thirty guns, arrived in Bengal, but was lost in going up the Ganges. The greater part of her cargo was however saved; and the officers and crew took possession of Banky-bazar, and erected temporary houses.

In the two following years, three ships, of a larger size than the first, arrived in Bengal, and completely established the Ostend trade in that province; and as they undersold the other Europeans in various articles, their factory quickly rose in estimation.

At first, the factors resided in houses constructed of mats and bamboos; but they afterwards built brick dwellings, and surrounded their factory with a wall, having bastions at the angles: they also cut a ditch, communicating with the river, of such a depth as to admit sloops of considerable burthen.

Thus the affairs of the Ostend Company seemed to be in a flourishing state: but, in the year 1727, the strong remonstrances of the three great maritime nations compelled the Emperor of Germany to withdraw his charter, and to agree

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. that all traffic between his subjects of the Austrian Netherlands and the East Indies should cease for seven years. Notwithstanding this prohibition, the private merchants occasionally sent out ships to India; and, as the Agent of the head of the factory in Bengal was a person of great activity and determination, he continued to furnish them with cargoes.

This traffic, although carried on clandestinely, could not escape the notice of the Dutch and English; the latter of
A. D. 1730. whom, in the year 1730, sent a squadron, under the command of Captain Gosfright, of the ship Fordwich, to blockade the river Ganges. The Commodore sailed up the river; and having obtained intelligence that two Ostend ships were anchored between Calcutta and Bankybazar, despatched two of his squadron to take them. On the first shot being fired, the Saint Theresa, the smallest of the Ostend ships, struck her colours, was immediately taken possession of, and carried to Calcutta; but the other slipped her cable, and took shelter under the guns of Bankybazar factory, whither it was not deemed expedient to follow her; and she afterwards had the good fortune to escape.

Sometime after this event, the Dutch and English united all their influence to prevail upon the Nuwab to prohibit the Germans from trading to Bengal; and, it is said, bribed the Foujedar of Hoogly to make a false representation of the great strength of the fortifications of Bankybazar, and the danger of allowing foreigners to retain a place of such strength within a few miles of the Royal port.

This representation induced the Governor to order the fortifications of Bankybazar to be dismantled: violent disputes in consequence ensued between the German agent and the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

The Nuwab's troops besiege the German factory, A. D. 1733.

Foujedar; and at length a considerable force was sent from Hoogly, under the command of an officer named Meer Jaffier, who surrounded the place on the land side; but acted with so much caution, that he threw up an entrenchment in front of his encampment, to defend his troops from the fire of the besieged; who, in the mean time, completely commanded the river, and only permitted such boats as they pleased to pass. The French at Chandernagore secretly aided the Germans with arms and ammunition, whilst they ostensibly pretended to assist in negotiating a treaty of peace.

Khojeh Fazel Cashmeery, one of the principal Moghul merchants of Hoogly, having also offered his services as a mediator, sent his son with a message to Bankybazar; but the Germans seized the young man, and detained him as a hostage for their own security: and the Foujedar had such an esteem for Khojeh Fazel, that, in order to procure the liberation of the youth, he for some days suspended hostilities: but having procured his liberation, he again renewed the siege with more vigour, both by land and by water; till, at length, provisions becoming very scarce in Bankybazar, all the natives of every description deserted, and left the Europeans to defend themselves. Notwithstanding the garrison was, by this means, reduced to fourteen persons, they continued to serve their guns with such efficacy, that not one of the Moghul troops durst venture out of the entrenchments. At length the Agent had the misfortune to lose his right arm by a cannon ball; after which he embarked, with his men, during the night, and reached in safety one of the ships belonging to his nation, which was at anchor down the river; and shortly after proceeded to Europe.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1733.

In the morning when the Moghul troops took possession of the factory, they found nothing of value in it, but the cannon and a few shells. After levelling the fortifications with the ground, and delivering over Bankybazar to the Zemindar, Meer Jaffier returned in triumph to Hoogly*.

Shujaa Addeen Khan, being of a liberal disposition, and averse to trouble, allowed the English and other Europeans to enjoy the privileges that had been granted to them by the Emperor Ferrokhsere, or by former Governors; and the only dispute that is recorded to have happened during his time, was occasioned by the Foujedar of Hoogly stopping a boat, laden with bales of silk, belonging to the English Company; in consequence of which a party of soldiers was despatched from Calcutta, who terrified the Foujedar, and carried away the silk and other goods which had been stopt. This transaction was represented to the Nuwab as a very heinous offence; and he, in consequence, prohibited the natives from supplying Calcutta, or any of the subordinate factories, with grain. The English were therefore compelled to purchase peace, by the payment of a large sum of money, and by apologising for their misconduct.

It has been previously stated, that on the succession of Shujaa Addeen Khan to the government, he confirmed his son-in-law, Moorshud Cooly, in the appointment of Deputy Nazim of Dacca. Moorshud Cooly employed, as his Dewan, a person

---

* The whole of these circumstances, respecting the Germans, is stated, by the author translated by Mr. Gladwin, to have happened during the government of Moorshud Cooly Khan; but by Mr. Orme their expulsion is postponed till A. D. 1748. It is however apparent, by the History of the Ostend Company, that their factory was in existence A. D. 1730, and that their last ships left Bengal in 1733. See *Universal History*, vol. XI.

Digitized by Google

named Meer Hubbeeb, a native of Shiraz in Persia, who had been a broker at Hoogly; and who, although he could neither read nor write, possessed great activity of mind and expertness in business. This man was very industrious in office, and made considerable retrenchments in the boat department and other expensive establishments. He also acquired large sums for his master, by the sale of monopolies; and is said to have treacherously put to death Noor Allah, the zemindar of Jillalpore, on account of his great wealth.

Sometime after this event, a nephew of the Raja of Tipperah, having displeased his uncle, was banished the country. The youth took refuge with a Mohammedan zemindar, named Aka Sadik, and entreated him to assist him in recovering the share of his inheritance. The zemindar being intimately acquainted with Meer Hubbeeb, recommended the cause of the young man to him; and pointed out the favourable opportunity it offered of subjecting Tipperah to the Mohammedan arms.

Tipperah becomes a province of the Moghul empire.

Meer Hubbeeb, having represented the circumstances to his master, obtained permission to proceed with all the troops that were then in the vicinity of Dacca, to effect the object. The Moghul troops crossed the Burhampooter, and entered Tipperah before the Raja was aware of their intentions; and having the young man with them whose cause they espoused, he pointed out to them the road by which they should advance. Aided by such a guide, they reached the capital before the Raja could make any preparation to oppose them: he was obliged to flee to the mountains; and the nephew was raised to the Raje, upon condition of paying a large portion of the revenue to the Governor of Bengal. The whole country, in consequence, quietly submitted: and thus the province of

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. Tipperah, which from time immemorial had been an independent kingdom, became annexed to the Moghul empire: and in order to support the young Raja against his uncle, and at the same time to secure his fealty, a considerable number of Mohammedan troops were left in the country, under the command of Aka Sadik, who was nominated Foujedar. On receiving intelligence of this event, the Nuwab was much pleased, and changed the name of Tipperah to Roshenabad* (the Country of Light), and gave to, or procured for, Moorshud Cooly the additional title of Behadur; and to Meer Hubbeeb that of Khan.

A. D. 1733. In the year 1146, Mohammed Tuckee, the illegitimate son of the Nuwab, went from Orissa, to pay his respects to his father; but during his residence at Moorshudabad, disputes ran so high between him and his brother, that each drew out their followers, and would actually have come to a pitched battle, had they not been prevented by the interposition of their father; whose authority, joined to the mediation of the females of the family, effected an apparent reconciliation; and Mohammed returned to Cuttack, where he died in the following year.

A. D. 1734. Upon the death of Mohammed Tuckee Khan, the Nuwab promoted his son-in-law, Moorshud Cooly Khan Behadur, for whom he procured the title of Rustem Jung (the Hercules in battle), to the deputy government of Orissa; who carried with him to that province, his Dewan, Meer Hubbeeb. Through the management of the latter, the revenues of Orissa were considerably increased, and the expenses diminished. During the government of Mohammed Tuckee,

* Probably from the Eastern limit of the Empire. It is still so called in the Public Records.

Digitized by Google

the Raja of Pursotem had carried away the idol of †Jagernaut across the river Jelkeh (Chilka Lake), beyond the boundary of Orissa, and placed it in a mountain; which circumstance injured the revenue of Orissa to the amount of nine lacs of rupees per annum, being the usual amount of the collection from the pilgrims.

The first care of the new Governor and his indefatigable Dewan, although strict Mohammedans, was to compel the Raja of Pursotem to restore the idol to its antient temple; where it has ever since remained undisturbed; and continues to attract a number of votaries to its shrine, and to enrich the rulers of the province.

When Moorshud Cooly Khan was removed to Orissa, the Nuwab gave the government of Dacca to his son Serferaz Khan; but ordered him to send thither, as his deputy, Syed Ghalib Aly Khan, a person who asserted his descent from the Kings of Persia: he also nominated Jeswont Roy, who had been preceptor to Serferaz Khan, to be Dewan, and to have the actual management of all affairs. The superintendance of the boat department was entrusted to Murad Aly Khan, who was married to a daughter of Serferaz Khan; and who had in his employment an accountant named Rajbullub, of whom more will be hereafter related.

When these officers arrived at Dacca, Jeswont Roy was, in obedience to the Nuwab's orders, invested with the entire management of the revenues. He had been educated under the late Nuwab, Moorshud Cooly Khan, whose example he emulated, in piety, integrity, and indefatigable attention to

† Properly *Jug Nath* (Lord of the World). The temple is situated in the town of Pursotem.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1735.

business; and in forming his arrangements for the benefit of the government, studied to render them conducive to the general ease and happiness of the people. He abolished the monopolies which had been introduced by Meer Hubbeeb, and also the impositions laid upon grain.

It was related, in the account of the government of Shaista Khan, that when he left Dacca to return to Dehly, he built up the western gate, and inscribed over it an execration against any future Governor who should presume to open it till he had reduced the price of grain to a *dumree* per seer, or 640 pounds weight for the rupee. The gate had continued closed to this time; when Jeswont Roy, having succeeded in reducing the price of grain to Shaista Khan's standard, ordered it to be opened.

By the prudent administration of a system of sound policy and humanity, the rich province of Dacca was cultivated in every part, and abounded in every thing requisite for the comfort and gratification of its inhabitants. Justice was administered with impartiality; and the conduct of Ghalib Aly Khan and Jeswont Roy gained great credit to their principal, Serferaz Khan.

As the Nuwab was far advanced in years, he relaxed in his attention to business, and entrusted the management of affairs much to his son; ordering him, however, constantly to consult with Hajy Ahmed, and the other members of his Council. The young man did not, however, comply with this injunction, and the circumstance caused a jealousy to arise between him and the Hajy.

After some time, Nuffeesa Begum, the sister of Serferaz Khan, persuaded her husband to recall Ghalib Aly Khan from

Digitized by Google

Dacca, and to promote his son-in-law, Murad Aly, to the government. This young man appointed Rajbullub to be Peishkar, or head clerk, of the boat department; and commenced his government with many acts of oppression. Jeswont Roy, the Dewan, who had gained so high a reputation for his conduct, beheld these measures with aversion; and resolving not to be a participator in them, resigned his appointment, and returned to Moorshudabad. Upon his resignation, the new government gave a loose to their rapacity and violence, till they reduced the country to a state of comparative poverty and desolation.

About this period, Sayid Ahmed, the second son of Hajy Ahmed, who, upon the succession of Shujaa Addeen Khan, had been appointed Foujedar of Rungpore, and who is accused of having ruled that district with great oppression, having procured from Moorshudabad a considerable army, invaded Dinagepore and Couch Beyhar; and after compelling the Rajas to take refuge in the woods and mountains, got possession of those countries, together with the immense treasures which the Rajas and their ancestors had amassed. When intelligence of this event was received at Moorshudabad, the Nuwab was pleased to confer the title of Khan Behadur on Sayid Ahmed*, a circumstance which was exceedingly flattering to the young man's father.

The enemies of this family have asserted, that notwithstanding the numerous benefits conferred on them by Shujaa Addeen Khan, they were constantly plotting to render themselves independent of his son, by sending their wealth to Patna, and by

* This was an assumed power on the part of the Nuwab; and can only be accounted for by the weak state of the Moghul Government, during the reign of Mohammed Shah.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

remitting large sums of money to Dehly, to procure for Aly Verdy Khan, upon the death of the Nuwab, the distinct government of Behar; but of this part of the accusation there does not appear to be any proof. Even had he done so, although moralists might condemn his conduct as a breach of private friendship, he would have been perfectly acquitted by those acquainted with the politics of Hindoostan and the conduct of public men; as it is evident that Serferaz Khan had no more *right* to the government, than the son of the Nobleman who *now* holds that important office has to the succession.

The only attempt at insurrection during the government of Shujaa Addeen Khan, was by the Zemindar of Bheerbhoom, named Budy al Zeman*, who was for a short time in a state of rebellion. He was however quickly reduced, and compelled to pay, in addition to his former revenue, the sum of three lacs of rupees.

At the period that the Persian usurper, Nadir Shah, entered into Hindoostan, and that the Court of Dehly was in a state of the greatest perturbation at his approach, Shujaa Addeen Khan, finding his infirmities daily increase, and that he had but a short time to live, sent to Orissa, Doordaneh Begum the wife, and Yahia the son, of Moorshud Cooly Khan, who, at the instigation of Serferaz Khan, had been detained as hostages for the good conduct of Moorshud Cooly. He then appointed Serferaz Khan his heir, on condition that he would regard the Hajy, the Roy Royan, and Juggut Seat, as the stedfast counsellors of his father, and follow their

* He was the son of Assud Allah, mentioned in page 371; and imitated the conduct of his father.

Digitized by Google

advice in all affairs of moment. Although Serferaz Khan bore SECT. VI.
no cordiality towards these men, yet, for fear of offending his dying parent, he promised to obey his commands. A very few days after this event, viz. on the 13th Zilhije 1151, Shujaa Ad- A. D. 1739.
deen resigned his soul to his Maker, universally regretted, as a man of strict veracity, general philanthropy, and unbounded liberality. Previous to his decease, he had erected a mosque and a mausoleum at Dehpareh, opposite to Moorshudabad, and was buried therein.

ALLA AD DOWLAH SERFERAZ KHAN.

Serferaz Khan takes possession of the government—Imitates the conduct of his grandfather, Moorshud Cooly Khan; but much addicted to the pleasures of the Haram—The envoys of Nadir Shah demand the arrears of revenue from Bengal—The Nuwab pays the amount, and coins money bearing Nadir Shah's titles—Dispute between the Nuwab and the banker Juggut Seat—The Nuwab quarrels also with Hajy Ahmed—Conspiracy against the Nuwab—He discovers the plot—Determines to displace Aly Verdy Khan and his connections—Postpones his resolution—Aly Verdy procures a Patent for the government—Marches from Patna—Instance of his policy—Writes to the Nuwab, accusing him of having insulted his family—Serferaz Khan calls his Council—Cunning of Hajy Ahmed—The Nuwab encamps his army—Sends agents to discover Aly Verdy Khan's intentions—Aly Verdy sends an envoy to the Nuwab, but continues his march—The Nuwab, deceived by his letters, allows him to approach within a few miles—Aly Verdy attacks the Nuwab's camp by surprise—The Nuwab mounts his elephant, and rushes into the heat of the engagement—killed by a musquet ball—His troops disperse—Aly Verdy Khan sends his brother, the Hajy, to take possession of Moorshudabad.

IMMEDIATELY on the decease of his father, Serferaz Khan took possession of the government; but notwithstanding his uncon-

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

son of Sayid Ahmed, who was also adopted by Aly Verdy Khan, and a daughter of Attah Allah the son-in-law of the Hajy, and to unite the young lady to his own son. These two circumstances were the cause of much discontent, and afforded the conspirators sufficient ground for complaint. Agents were sent off to Dehly, to bribe the flagitious ministers of Mohammed Shah, to set aside the appointment of Serferaz Khan, and to nominate Aly Verdy Khan to the government of the three provinces. To effect this scheme, they represented, in the blackest colours, the eagerness with which Serferaz Khan had coined the money in the name of, and had proclaimed, Nadir Shah Emperor of Hindoostan. They promised to pay a fine of one crore of rupees; and agreed to remit to Court the whole of the property of Serferaz Khan, amounting, as they supposed, to many crores of rupees; and to forward the amount of the revenues of the three provinces with the same regularity as had been practised in the time of the Nuwab Moorshud Cooly Khan.

Conspiracy against the Nuwab.

At the same time, Hajy Ahmed, and Juggut Seat, by their attention to the young Nuwab, endeavoured to lull him into security; and actually had the address to prevail on him, by way of retrenching his expenses, to disband a considerable part of his army; all of whom immediately repaired to Patna, and were enlisted by Aly Verdy Khan.

At length Serferaz Khan, having received intelligence, from his agents at Dehly, of the plot that was carrying on against him, resolved to counteract their designs; and determined not only to recall Aly Verdy Khan from Behar, but to displace every person of that family from the official situations which

Digitized by Google

they held*. But these intentions having been secretly discovered by the Hajy and his colleagues, they waited upon the Nuwab, and, with the most downright effrontery, denied the accusation; and, by their solemn protestations of inviolable duty and attachment to his family, prevailed upon him to postpone his new arrangements till the end of the year, when they promised to relinquish their appointments, and to deliver him a faithful account of all their pecuniary transactions. It is stated in the *Sier al Mutakhereen*, that ten months after the A.D. 1740. departure of Nadir Shah†, through the interest of Isaac Khan, one of the chief counsellors of the Emperor Mohammed Shah, the patents for the government of the three provinces were made out in the name of, and forwarded to, Aly Verdy Khan; who being now resolved on marching against Serferaz Khan, desired an eminent astrologer, on whose predictions he reposed an unlimited confidence, to fix the day for the commencement of his journey: but, in order to deceive the Nuwab, and the other persons to whom he did not yet wish to communicate the secret, he gave out that he was going to march against the refractory zemindars of Boujepore. In the meantime, he intercepted all correspondence between Patna and Moorshudabad, and stopped all travellers on the road.

Having appointed his son-in-law, Zyn Addeen, to be his deputy during his absence, and all things being prepared for

* It does not appear, in any of the authorities I have had access to, that Serferaz was ever confirmed in the Government.

† Nadir Shah quitted Dehly, by *Frazer's* Account, on the 6th of May 1739; but by *Scott's*, on the 14th of April, leaving the Government of Hindoostan in a most crippled state. See reign of Mohammed Shah, in vol. II. of *Dow's Hindoostan*, and vol. II. of *Scott's Dekkan*.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Aly Verdy Khan marches against the Nuwab, March 1740.

his departure, Aly Verdy Khan commenced his march towards Boujepore, in the end of Zilkaad, A. H. 1152; and encamped the first day at Varis Khan's reservoir, on the north-west side of Patna. In the evening, he gave orders to assemble all the principal officers of his army: and when they were collected in his tent, he introduced into the assembly two persons, the one a venerable Musselman of known piety, with the Koran in his hand; the other a Brahman, who held in his right hand a vase of the Ganges water, and in the left, a branch of the sacred *Toolsey*. After a short pause, he conjured the Mohammedans to swear by the glorious Koran; and the Hindoos to affirm, by placing their hands on those sacred emblems; that they would follow him wheresoever he led: that they should consider his enemies as their enemies; his friends as their friends: and that whatever might be his fate, they would stand by him inviolably with their lives and fortunes. So unexpected an address produced the desired effect: the old officers, who had long served under his command, and had received from him numerous favours, set the example, and readily took the oath; and the new ones, not suspecting the stratagem, bound themselves to do as he desired.

Aly Verdy Khan having satisfied his mind on this important subject, disclosed to them the secret of his expedition; and informed them; that forced by the injuries offered to himself, to his brother, and to every individual in their families, he was marching against their oppressor, Serferaz Khan, resolving to put an end to his tyranny. This speech startled many of the officers; but as they had all taken an unconditional oath, there was no room to retreat. It being already

Digitized by Google

night, the assembly was dismissed; and at day-break the next morning, the whole army marched round the city, and proceeded with much rapidity towards Bengal. Having, by a successful stratagem, gained possession of the passes of Terriagurhy and Sicklygully, Aly Verdy Khan then condescended to write to the Nuwab. The following is said to have been the purport of his letter.

" Exclusive of the many affronts you have offered to " my brother Hajy Ahmed, attempts have been lately " made upon the honour of our family. Your humble " servant, in order to save that family from further dis- " grace, has been obliged to come so far; but with no other " sentiments than those of fidelity and submission. Your " humble servant therefore entreats, that Hajy Ahmed may " be immediately permitted to come to him, with all his family " and dependants."

Serferaz Khan was surprised and confounded at this intelligence, and immediately called a general assembly of his ministers and officers; where having summoned Hajy Ahmed, he accused him of being in league with his brother, and threatened instantly to put him to death. The Hajy, with that coolness and apparent indifference for which he was noted, assured the Nuwab that Aly Verdy Khan had no other intentions than those expressed in the letter; and that if he would permit him to go to his brother, he would prevail on him immediately to return towards Patna. This proposal was variously received by the members of the Council: some of them were of opinion that the Hajy ought not to be trusted; but others, thinking that his detention could be of no consequence, and that it would be better to

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A.D. 1740.

put his veracity to the test, prevailed upon the Nuwab to let him depart.

The Hajy lost not a moment in quitting Moorshudabad with all his family; and whilst on his way to meet his brother, he wrote to the Nuwab a letter to the following purport:

"Be assured that Aly Verdy Khan is, in his heart, one "of your most faithful and attached servants; but as he is "now at the head of a powerful army devoted to his cause, "let me persuade your Highness not to oppose his wish, of "paying his respects to you, and of stating his complaints: "think not of moving from your palace, or of marching "against him in hostile array. He is sensible that he has "many enemies in your Court; and should you follow the "advice of those persons, I fear he may, in despair, and "for the preservation of his life and honour, venture upon "some rash step, the consequence of which may be fatal."

Hajy Ahmed joined his brother, while on the march, in the vicinity of Rajemahel; and in order nominally to fulfil the promise he had made the Nuwab, he prevailed upon Aly Verdy to turn his elephant, and to proceed a short distance on the way to Patna.

In the meantime, the Nuwab, having summoned all the Foujedars to his assistance, assembled his troops, and ordered them to encamp on the plain between Gheria and Comra, about twenty-two miles north of Moorshudabad. His army is said to have consisted of 30,000 cavalry and infantry, and a numerous train of artillery. His troops were, however, not equal in courage or discipline to those of Aly Verdy Khan; and the commander of the ordnance, named Shariar Khan,

Digitized by Google

a connection of the Hajy's, is accused of having treacherously neglected to take to camp any shot for the guns; but previous to the commencement of hostilities, the plot was discovered; and a Portuguese, named Panchoo, was appointed to command the artillery. On the 22d of Mohurrem, A. H. 1153, A. D. 1740. the Nuwab joined the camp at Comra, but halted there to receive the report of two agents whom he had sent to Aly Verdy Khan to discover his real intentions: these persons shortly returned, and represented that Aly Verdy still professed himself a faithful and attached servant: they were however accompanied by an agent of Aly Verdy's, named Mohammed Aly, who presented a petition from his master; which, after detailing various subjects of complaint, requested that certain persons belonging to the Court, who were his enemies, might be banished, after which he would advance unattended, and pay his respects to the Nuwab; and, in proof of his sincerity, he sent by the agent a case, said to contain a Koran upon which he had sworn to adhere to his engagement*.

SECT. VI.

Aly Verdy Khan having arrived within twelve miles of the Nuwab's camp without receiving any answer to his petition, again sent another messenger, to request the Nuwab's forgiveness, and to state his intention of paying his respects the following day: the Nuwab was deceived by this stratagem, and gave orders that an elegant entertainment should be prepared for the occasion: the troops of the Nuwab also, understanding that matters were to be amicably settled, were totally off their guard.

In the evening, Aly Verdy Khan issued orders to his troops for the attack: he divided his army into three columns; one

* The enemies of Aly Verdy state, that the case did not contain a Koran, but a brick covered with cloth of gold.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1740.

of which had directions to proceed during the night, and get into the rear of the Nuwab's camp; and upon hearing the attack of the other two columns in front, to unite their efforts. At the dawn of day, Aly Verdy Khan, having advanced to the skirts of the Nuwab's camp unperceived, opened a cannonade. One of the first balls, passing through Serferaz Khan's tent, rouzed him from his lethargy, and awakened him to a sense of his danger and the perfidy of his enemy: he however, in the most undaunted manner, mounted his elephant; and calling to his troops to follow him, advanced towards Aly Verdy Khan.

The elephant driver, seeing that very few of the troops were following him, represented to the Nuwab the danger of his situation, and requested permission to carry him off the field to Beerbhoom; the Zemindar of which district being very powerful, and the country by nature strong, would afford him a safe refuge till he could be joined by his friends. Serferaz Khan, who was worthy of a better fate, spurned at this advice, and ordered the driver to carry him into the thickest of the enemy. He had nearly expended the whole of his quiver of arrows, when a musquet ball struck him in the forehead, and sent his soul to the mansions of eternity. As soon as this event was known, the troops, with the exception of a body of Afghans under Ghows Khan, fled on all sides. Meer Hubbeeb, the Dewan of Moorshud Cooly, who had joined the army with the quota of troops from Orissa, immediately rode off, with his followers, towards home; literally fulfilling the proverb,—

The Nuwab slain in battle.

"He that fights and runs away,
May live to fight another day."

During the plundering of the camp, Serferaz Khan's elephant driver, unperceived by the enemy, conveyed the corpse to

Digitized by Google

Moorshudabad; and at midnight, his son Mirza Amany caused it to be buried in a private manner at Nekteh Kholly. Mirza Amany, and Yeasseen Khan the Foujedar, made preparations to defend the city; but the troops refusing to support them, they were obliged to submit to the conqueror, who immediately despatched his brother, Hajy Ahmed, to secure the family and treasures of the deceased, and to assure the inhabitants of his protection and favour.

NUWAB, SHUJAA AL MOOLK, HISSAM AD DOWLAH, MOHAMMED ALY VERDY KHAN BEHADUR, MOHABUT JUNG.

Aly Verdy Khan takes possession of the Government—His hypocritical conduct—Sends large sums of money and valuable presents to the Emperor, and to the Viziers, at Dehly—Confirmed in the government—Obtains additional titles for himself, his three Sons-in-law, and his Grandsons—Distributes the public offices to them and his other dependants—Assigns an allowance for the support of the family of the late Nuwab—Alarmed by the approach of a Messenger from Court to demand the treasure and effects of Serferaz Khan—Political conduct on this occasion—Resolves to place one of his own dependants in the deputy-government of Orissa—Gives notice to Moorshud Cooly Khan, brother-in-law of the late Nuwab, to quit that province—Moorshud Cooly refuses—Aly Verdy, in consequence, marches towards Orissa—Moorshud Cooly advances to Ballasore—An engagement takes place—Moorshud Cooly defeated—Retires on board a ship to Masulipatam—Aly Verdy proceeds to Cuttack—Settles the affairs of that province—Appoints his son-in-law, Sayid Ahmed, to the government—The new Governor gives offence to the people, who rise and take him prisoner; and choose for their governor, Baukir Khan—Aly Verdy Khan again marches to Orissa—Defeats the rebels, and retakes his Son-in-law—Appoints Mohammed Mausoom Deputy-governor of the province—Returns towards Bengal—The Mahrattas of Berar suddenly invade Bengal—Surround the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Nuwab at Burdwan—The Nuwab effects his retreat to Cutwa—The Mahrattas, led on by Meer Hubbeeb, plunder Moorshudabad—The Nuwab returns to Moorshudabad—The Mahrattas get possession of all the countries on the west of the Bhagarutty river—The English dig an entrenchment round Calcutta—The Nuwab unexpectedly attacks, and defeats, the Mahrattas—Pursues them to Midnapore—Again defeats them, and drives them out of Orissa—Suffder Junger, governor of Oude, ordered by the Emperor to assist Aly Verdy Khan—advances as far as Patna—Aly Verdy, jealous of his power, declines his assistance, and requests him to return home—Bengal at once invaded by two Mahratta armies—Aly Verdy bribes those of Poona, to assist him in expelling the Berar troops—They return the following year—The Nuwab enters into a treaty with them; and invites Boskar Raow, the General, to an interview—Assassinates him, and a number of the Berar officers—Hajy Ahmed quarrels with his brother, and retires to Patna—Mustapha Khan, the Nuwab's General, mutinies—Marches away without permission—Plunders Rajemahel, and takes possession of Mongeir—Advances towards Patna—Opposed by the Deputy-governor of Behar—Aly Verdy Khan pursues the rebels—Engagement between the Governor of Behar and the rebels—Mustapha Khan wounded—Retires to Chunar—The Berar Mahrattas again invade Bengal—Aly Verdy Khan returns to Moorshudabad—Enters into a feigned negotiation with the Mahratta Chief—The Mahrattas retreat—The Nuwab dismisses the remainder of the Afghans from his service—Celebrates the marriages of his Grandsons—Sends an army, under Meer Jaffier Khan, to expel the Afghans from Orissa—An Army of Mahrattas again invade Orissa, and compel Jaffier Khan to retreat—The Nuwab sends a reinforcement to him, under the command of Atta Allah—These two Chiefs conspire to depose Aly Verdy Khan—The Plot discovered—The two Chiefs compelled to quit the army—The Nuwab defeats the Mahrattas—An insurrection by the Afghans, in Behar—The insurgents murder the Nuwab's brother and son-in law, and plunder their property—Aly Verdy Khan marches against the rebels, although surrounded by the Mahrattas—The rebels unite with the Mahrattas—The Nuwab engages their united forces—Gives them a total defeat—

Digitized by Google

Advances to Patna, and appoints his grandson, Seraje ad Dowlah, Governor; Raja Janky Ram, Deputy-governor of Behar; and Sayid Ahmed, Foujedar of Purneah—Returns to Moorshudabad—The Mahrattas return to Berar, but leave a detachment in Cuttack—The Nuwab marches to Cuttack; but not being able to overtake the Mahrattas, returns to Midnapore—Seraje ad Dowlah rebels, and attemps to seize Patna—Defeated and taken prisoner—Delivered up to the Nuwab, who forgives him—Aly Verdy Khan returns to Moorshudabad; and, for two years, in vain pursues the Mahrattas—Agrees to yield to them the province of Cuttack; and to pay them twelve lacs of rupees per annum, as the Choute of Bengal—The Nuwab encourages the improvement of the country—His two sons, Nuazish Mohammed and Sayid Ahmed, die—The Nuwab taken ill—Dies—His character.

SECT. VI.

ALY VERDY KHAN was sensible that if he had marched his troops into the city of Moorshudabad, immediately after the victory, it would have been impossible to have restrained them from plundering the effects and treasure of Serferaz Khan. He therefore halted, that and the following day, on the field of battle; but on the morning of the third day, being about the 15th of Suffer 1153, proceeded in great state towards the city; A. D. 1740. and upon his entering it, instead of going to the palace, he went to the residence of Zynet al Nissa, the daughter of Moorshud Cooly, and mother of Serferaz Khan; and having, at the gate, alighted from his elephant, he made a profound obeisance; and sent, by one of the eunuchs, a most respectful message to the Begum, to solicit her forgiveness. The message is said to have been couched in the following terms:

"That which was predetermined in the book of Fate has "come to pass, and the ingratitude of your worthless servant "is now recorded on the unfading page of History; but he

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1740.

" swears, that as long as life shall last, he will never more " swerve from the path of respect, or the duties of submission. " He hopes that the vileness of his misdeeds shall in time be " effaced from your forgiving mind; and that you will conde- " scend to accept, in extenuation of his crimes, these demon- " strations of perfect obedience to your commands, and tokens " of his most dutiful attachment."

During the time he was delivering this message, he seemed greatly affected; but as no answer was returned, he again mounted his elephant, and proceeded to the *Chehel Setoon*, a palace built by Shujaa Addeen Khan for public ceremonies, which was surrounded by a colonnade of forty pillars; and immediately upon entering the hall of audience, he took possession of the musnud of state, and received the offerings and congratulations of all the persons present; while the event was proclaimed to the city by a royal salute from the artillery, and by the sounds of martial music.

Having taken possession of the treasures of the unfortunate Serferaz Khan, which had accumulated to an immense amount by the savings of his father and grandfather, Aly Verdy Khan sent a crore of rupees in specie, and to the amount of seventy lacs in jewels, plate, silks, and muslins, as offerings to the Emperor Mohammed Shah and his viziers: and the former, in return for this proof of his obedience and loyalty, shortly after confirmed him in the government of the three provinces, and conferred on him the rank of commander of 7000 horse, with the additional titles of Shujaa al Moolk, and Hissam ad Dowlah. Titles of honour were also conferred on his three sons-in-law; viz. on the eldest, Nuazish Mohammed, that of Shehamut Jung; on Sayid Ahmed, the second, that of

Digitized by Google

Sowlut Jung; and on Zyn Addeen, the youngest, that of Shokut Jung*. For his grandson, Mirza Mahmoud, son of Zyn Addeen, whom he had adopted as his heir, he procured the title of Seraje ad Dowlah, Shah Cooly Khan, Behadur; and for the younger brother of the latter, the title of Akrem ad Dowlah. And that these titles should be supported with proper dignity, the Nuwab conferred on Nuazish Mohammed the government of Dacca, to which he annexed the districts of Silhet, Tipperah, and Chittagong, with permission to perform the office by deputy. Zyn Addeen he confirmed in the government of Behar: and to Sayid Ahmed he promised the government of Orissa, as soon as it could be secured. To his other relations and dependants he gave various employments, and bestowed on them large sums of money, from the treasures of his predecessor.

The wives and two sons of Serferaz Khan were sent to Dacca, and a handsome allowance assigned for their support; but the numerous concubines of the deceased were permitted to provide for themselves. Nuffiesah Begum, the sister of the deceased, condescended to take on herself the office of superintendant of Nuazish Mohammed's seraglio, provided she was allowed to adopt for her heir a posthumous son of her brother, named Aka Baba. Her excuse for thus demeaning herself was, that she might thereby be of service to her brother's family; and so scrupulous was she in her conduct, that she was never seen by Nuazish, who used to converse with her on business through a curtain.

* These titles are all synonymous, meaning *the Formidable in War*. It is requisite these titles should be remembered by the Oriental scholar.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A. D. 1741.

After these arrangements, and when Aly Verdy Khan considered himself firmly fixed in his government, he was alarmed by intelligence, that Mohammed Shah, dissatisfied with the sum that had been remitted to Dehly as the amount of Serferaz Khan's estate, had despatched an officer, named Mureed Khan, not only to demand the whole of the treasures, but the amount of two years' revenues which were due; but being ever fertile in expedients, he immediately wrote to that officer, not to take the trouble of coming so far as Bengal, as he would do himself the honour of meeting him at Rajemahel, and deliver to him the residue of the late Governor's property. The letter, besides, is supposed to have contained a draft for a large sum of money on his banker at Patna, for Mureed Khan's private use, and had the desired effect of inducing him to halt there for some weeks.

Aly Verdy Khan took with him some lacs of rupees, in specie, seventy lacs in jewels, much gold and silver furniture, a quantity of precious stuffs, and a number of elephants and horses, and proceeded with considerable expedition to Rajemahel, where he delivered the above articles to Mureed Khan; and having made that officer some valuable presents, prevailed upon him to give a receipt for the effects, and to return to Dehly, without coming to any settlement with regard to the arrears of revenue.

The next object of the Nuwab's solicitude was, to dispossess Moorshud Cooly Khan, the son-in-law of Shujaa Addeen Khan, of the government of Orissa. It has been before stated, that when Serferaz Khan collected his army, to oppose Aly Verdy Khan, the troops of Orissa had joined him, under the command of Meer Hubbeeb, who had given such a specimen of

Digitized by Google

his abilities at Dacca; but that these troops had not taken any part in the battle of Gheria, and on the death of Serferaz Khan had retired precipitately to Orissa. SECT. VI. A. D. 1741.

Shortly after that event, Moorshud Cooly, sensible of his inability to oppose Aly Verdy Khan, sent an envoy to him, to discover what were his intentions, and to endeavour to negotiate a treaty of amity with him: but the Nuwab, entertaining suspicions of his sincerity, desired the envoy to inform his master, that he had no animosity against him, and that it was far from his inclination to injure him, but that his remaining in the government of Orissa was impossible: he therefore requested that he would retire from that province, with all his property and family, by whatever route he chose, and that he should meet with no molestation.

The Governor of Orissa, being an unambitious character, would willingly have accepted his offer; but his wife, Doordaneh Begum, and his courtiers, rejected it with disdain, and compelled Moorshud Cooly to send a letter of defiance to his adversary.

The challenge was immediately accepted; and Aly Verdy Khan, having selected from his army 12,000 of the most efficient troops, left his brother, the Hajy, in charge of the government, and proceeded towards Orissa.

On intelligence of his approach*, Moorshud Cooly Khan having summoned his friends to a consultation, laid his sabre

* Jonathan Scott, Esq. author of the *History of the Dekkan*, having compiled the Life of Aly Verdy Khan from the same materials as are in my possession, I have taken the liberty of using his narrative for a great part of the remainder of this Chapter; retaining the original names, instead of the titles, the number and frequent change of which are very perplexing in Oriental history. The Life of Aly Verdy Khan, as detailed in the *Sier al Mutakhereen*, would alone make a considerable-sized volume.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1741.

before them; and after inveighing against the usurpation and treachery of Aly Verdy Khan, declared his intentions of opposing him, should they be firm in their support and attachment; but otherwise, to retire to some place of security with his family. The assembly unanimously assured him of their fidelity, and readiness to engage in war; and the chiefs of the army, at his request, regirt the sabre round his waist. After this, having sent his family and treasure to the fort of Barabutty*, he moved from Cuttack; and advancing beyond Balasore, encamped in a strong situation, surrounded by thick woods and a river, fortifying his camp with nearly three hundred pieces of cannon.

Aly Verdy Khan speedily arrived on the bank of the river, within a few miles of the enemy; and halted long, being incapable of dislodging him from his secure position. In this situation his camp was but ill supplied with provisions, the zemindars being attached to Moorshud Cooly Khan, and cutting off the Nuwab's convoys, so that his troops soon began to murmur. Meerza Baukir Khan, learning the dissatisfaction of the Nuwab's army, imprudently moved from his camp, contrary to the remonstrances of Moorshud Cooly Khan, and offered battle; which was gladly accepted by Aly Verdy Khan. The engagement was long and bloody, but finally decided in favour of the latter. Moorshud Cooly Khan, his son-in-law, and chief dependants, made good their retreat to Balasore; from whence they embarked on board ships, and arrived safely at Massulipatam, on the coast of Coromandel, where they were generously received by the Foujedar, Anwer ad Dien Khan. The Raja of Ruttenpore, on the borders of Orissa, hearing of their

* This fort was taken by the British troops, on the 14th of October 1803. See *Annual Asiatic Register*, 1803.

Digitized by Google

flight, with a magnanimous humanity detached a force to Cuttack, and brought off their families and treasure in safety to his residence, where he delivered them to Baukir Khan, who was sent to receive them. SECT. VI. A. D. 1741.

Aly Verdy Khan, after his victory, marched to Cuttack; and having arranged the affairs of the province, entrusted the government to his nephew, Sayid Ahmed, the second son of Hajy Ahmed. He then returned to Moorshudabad, and employed himself in regulating the concerns of Bengal, in which he consulted the ease and satisfaction of the public.

Sayid Ahmed, in his government of Cuttack, did not act with that prudence becoming his situation. He vexed the adherents of Moorshud Cooly Khan, who had remained in the province under promise of not being molested in their estates by fines and extortion, on pretence that they had secreted money belonging to their late chief; and, being much addicted to pleasure, was guilty of excesses in procuring women for his *haram* from the inhabitants. To these oppressions he added an impolitic neglect of the troops stationed with him by his uncle, in lessening their pay to garrison allowance, which gave great disgust, so that numbers left his service. Their places he filled with natives of Cuttack, who, for the satisfaction of living at home, accepted of a trifling salary. These men were secretly attached to the late Governor, whose son-in-law now resided on the borders of the province, in hopes of opportunity offering to renew his attempts. The conduct of Sayid Ahmed becoming daily more oppressive to the people, they at length invited Moorshud Cooly Khan to return; but he was too fond of his present retirement to hazard his person, and rejected their offers. They then had recourse to Baukir Khan, who

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1741.

gladly accepted their promises of support; and measures were so secretly contrived, that the Governor was suddenly taken prisoner in his palace in a general insurrection of the people, and delivered to Baukir Khan, who assumed the government of Cuttack.

Aly Verdy Khan, on intelligence of this event, lost no time in preparing to remedy the disaster. His brother Hajy, and the mother of Sayid Ahmed, apprehensive for the safety of their son, would have prevailed upon him to give up Orissa to Baukir Khan, on promise of allegiance; and attributed the success of the latter to aids he had received from Nizam al Moolk, whom it would be impolitic to displease, as it might bring upon him the force of the Dekkan, and the loss of Bengal; but he paid no attention to their advice. In a short time his forces were ready; and having left his son-in-law, Nuazish, in the command of Moorshudabad, he began his march, at the head of twenty thousand horse and foot. As an encouragement to his chiefs, he had ordered them to make considerable additions to their corps; and promised a reward of a lac of rupees to the person who should recover Sayid Ahmed from captivity; and if he should be the commander of a corps, to give two months' pay additional to each man.

Baukir Khan, on the approach of the Nuwab, entrenched himself on the banks of the Mahanuddee; but having little hope of success against so powerful an enemy, sent off his baggage and family to the Dekkan. Resolved that Sayid Ahmed should not survive his defeat, he placed him in a covered *rutt**, under the charge of two Moghuls, who had orders to kill him,

* A carriage drawn by oxen.

Digitized by Google

should the troops of the Nuwab pursue and come up with them. To make his death the surer, he privately ordered the escort of horse who guarded the carriage, on the approach of an enemy, to thrust their spears into it, and destroy both the victim and the executioners. The Nuwab attacked the entrenchments of Baukir Khan, who was deserted in an instant by his troops, too much intimidated to make resistance; and the victors pursued so closely, that they speedily overtook the escort of Sayid Ahmed; when numerous spears were thrust into the carriage, and one of the Moghuls was killed; but Sayid Ahmed escaped unhurt, by the wounded man's falling upon him. The other Moghul was slightly wounded; and made his escape, while the pursuers were releasing their recovered prince. Aly Verdy Khan, having returned thanks for his easy victory, and the safety of his nephew from such imminent danger, sent him, with a considerable force for his protection, to his parents at Moorshudabad, not thinking it prudent to entrust him again with the government of Cuttack. The women and family of Sayid Ahmed, who had been detained prisoners in a fortress, were released, on news of the victory, by the garrison, and escorted safely to him. The Nuwab, having regulated the affairs of the recovered province, gave charge of it to an officer of experience, named Mohammed Masoom Khan; and apprehending no new danger near, very impolitically and unjustly disbanded his new levies, and permitted most of the troops to retire to their homes; while he, with only his principal chiefs and about five thousand horse, marched slowly towards his capital, enjoying the amusement of hunting on the way: but this calm was suddenly overcast by storms, which threatened his destruction, and the desolation of the provinces.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

The Mahrattas invade Bengal, A. D. 1741-2.

Aly Verdy Khan was encamped near Midnapore, when intelligence arrived that Boskar Pundit had been detached by Ragojee Bhoselah, the Mahratta chief of Berar, at the head of forty thousand horse, to demand the *choute* of Bengal, and was rapidly advancing toward him*; but the Nuwab, not expecting that they would enter by Orissa, was little alarmed at the report; as he had received advice of their intention to pass through Behar; and had intended, on his return to the capital, to take measures to resist them, for which he fancied he should have ample time, before they could reach that province. In this, however, he was mistaken, as an express suddenly arrived that the enemy was within twenty coss of his camp. The Nuwab upon this hastened his march to Burdwan, a considerable town, intending to place in it his heavy baggage, and engage the Mharattas. Shortly after his arrival, they appeared, and laid waste the environs of the camp with fire and sword. Some skirmishes took place, with little loss on either side; the enemy, whose object was plunder only, not chusing to risk a general action. Some days passed in this manner, when Boskar Raow proposed evacuating the country for a contribution of ten lacs of rupees; but this was refused; and Aly Verdy Khan resolved to push his way to Moorshudabad, where he could recruit his scattered force. He issued orders for the greatest part of the heavy baggage and camp followers to

* It does not appear what was the object of the Berar Mahrattas; whether to conquer Bengal, to plunder it, or to establish the *choute* or claim for the fourth part of the revenues, as, owing to the weakness of the Moghul government, they had done in several other provinces. Aly Verdy Khan suspected they had been instigated by the Nizam, who, a short time previous, had established his independent authority at Hyderabad, and was supposed to be jealous of the rising power of the Governor of Bengal. For the origin of the Berar Mahrattas, see Lord Wellesley's *Mahratta War*.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VII. A. D. 1741-8.

remain at Burdwan, but in vain, as they were too much alarmed to trust themselves in the town; but the consequence of their disobedience was nearly fatal. On the first day's march, the Mahrattas surrounded the line; and Aly Verdy Khan, unable to defend the numerous crowd of useless attendants, and market people of his army, now reduced to less than five thousand fighting men, had the mortification of losing the chief part of his baggage, artillery, and tents. When he halted for the night, only a small tent could be procured for his reception. He now despatched a messenger with offers to pay the ten lacs of rupees to the Mahrattas; but Boskar Raow refused, and demanded a crore†, with all the elephants belonging to the Nuwab. Aly Verdy refused such degrading concessions; and the next day proceeded on his march, which was harassed as usual; and what little baggage remained, fell a prey to the enemy, who, however, could make no impression on the main body, and were often repulsed from the charge. For three days a running fight was kept up, during which the greatest distress for provisions and shelter from heavy rain was experienced by the troops of Aly Verdy Khan. On the fourth he reached Cutwa, which the Mahrattas had laid waste, and had destroyed large magazines of grain by fire; but enough remained, though in a parched state, to be an acceptable supply to an army almost perishing with hunger. Here the Nuwab encamped, on the bank of the river Bhagarutty, secured by his position from further insult of the enemy; and having written to his capital of the situation he was in, Nuazish Mohammed joined him expeditiously with a considerable

† Upwards of a million sterling.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. reinforcement, and plentiful supplies of provisions from the opposite bank of the river, which was yet unmolested by the enemy.

Boskar Pundit, the Mahratta general, from the fear of passing the rains in the country of an enemy who had so gallantly opposed him, would have now retreated to Berar; but Meer Hubbeeb, who during the first invasion of Orissa had abandoned his former master, and taken employment with Aly Verdy Khan, and who, having been taken prisoner, had accepted the service of the Mahrattas, advised him to remain, offering to provide subsistence for his army, and to guide a detachment to Moorshudabad, which might easily be plundered, it being unfortified. Boskar relished his proposal, and en-
April, 1742. trusted him with the command of some thousand horse. The Nuwab, having intelligence of this design, left Cutwa, and hastened to the capital; where he arrived one day after Meer Hubbeeb, who had already plundered the suburbs, especially the bank of Juggut Seat, to the amount of three lacs of rupees. On the arrival of Aly Verdy Khan, he retreated, and prevailed on Boskar to encamp at Cutwa for the rainy season; and the Nuwab, satisfied with having preserved the city from plunder, deferred further operations till he could recruit his army, and strengthen the capital by new works. The enemy, while the fords permitted, advanced two or three times to Plassy and Daoodpore, not many miles distant from Moorshudabad; plundering the villages, till the swelling of the Bhagarutty confined them to the opposite shore. During the rains, Boskar Pundit, by means of Meer Hubbeeb, possessed himself of Hoogly, Injalee, and all the districts of Burdwan and Midnapore, as far as Balasore; also Bheerbhoom, Raje-

Digitized by Google

shahy, and Rajemahel; so that, except Moorshudabad and its environs, nothing remained to the Nuwab west of the Ganges; but the districts to the east of that river still afforded him ample resources. The inhabitants of the capital, during the rainy season, for the most part moved with their families and effects, for the greater security, across the Ganges. The families, treasures, and valuables of the Nuwab and his relations were also sent over that river to Godagauree, under the care of Nuazish Mohammed, who returned to the capital after he had provided a place of safety for them.

During the invasion of the Mahrattas, crowds of the inhabitants of the country on the western side of the river crossed over to Calcutta, and implored the protection of the English; who, in consequence of the general alarm, obtained permission from Aly Verdy Khan to dig an entrenchment round their territory. This work, had it been completed, would have extended seven miles. In six months, three miles of it were finished; when the inhabitants, finding that the Mahrattas did not approach Calcutta, desisted from the work; but the remains of it are still to be seen, and are called the Mahratta Ditch. The English at the same time obtained permission to build a brick wall round their factory at Cossimbazar, with bastions at the angles*.

Aly Verdy Khan passed the rainy season in raising new levies, and encouraging his troops; to whom he distributed ten lacs of rupees, which he had promised them when surrounded by the Mahrattas. The dry weather had not yet commenced, when he marched from Moorshudabad, and crossed the Bhagarutty over a bridge of boats, without opposition from the

October, 1742.

* *Orme's Indostan.*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1742.

enemy, who still continued in their camp at Cutwa, which was divided from the Nuwab's army by a deep rivulet, much swollen by the rains. Aly Verdy Khan during the night ordered a bridge of boats to be thrown across it, which was done without being perceived by the enemy. About midnight, Meer Jaffier Khan, Mustapha Khan, and other chiefs, at the head of a chosen body, began to cross. Half of this detachment had scarcely reached the opposite bank, when a boat in the middle of the bridge was loosened, and sunk by the weight of passengers; and the troops in the rear pressing on, numbers were pushed in and drowned, before the accident was discovered. Six hundred men are said to have perished in this manner; but such was the ardour of the troops and spirited conduct of the Nuwab, that the accident was soon repaired, and by daylight the whole army had crossed, and prepared to attack the enemy. Boskar Raow was so intimidated at this bold and unexpected measure, that he fled with the utmost precipitation, leaving great part of his baggage and tents behind him; but was so rapidly pursued, as to lose a considerable number of men within four miles of Cutwa, where he tried to make a stand, but in vain, his troops flying on the Nuwab's approach. He continued his retreat to the woods of Pacheet; and was followed by Aly Verdy Khan so closely, that finding it impossible to gain the passes by this route, he changed it, by advice of Meer Hubbeeb, and returned into the forests of Bishenpore; by which he deceived his pursuers, and gained the open country, by way of Chunderkoona into Midnapore. Here he encamped, and detached a force against Cuttack, which was but ill defended by troops; and the governor, Masoom Khan, rashly marching out with his small force, was defeated and slain.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Aly Verdy Khan having at last procured intelligence of the change of the enemy's route, marched back, and hastened to Burdwan. From thence he advanced to Midnapore, where Boskar Raow gave him battle, but was defeated with great slaughter, and fled, by way of Cuttack, to the borders of his own country. The Nuwab, not thinking it necessary to pursue beyond his own territories, now completely evacuated by the enemy, entrusted the government of Cuttack to Abd al Russool Khan, and returned triumphantly to his capital. A. D. 1742.

Aly Verdy Khan, on the first invasion of the Mahrattas, had applied to the Emperor for assistance; and Suffder Jung, Nuwab of Oude, was ordered with his troops into Bengal, but had advanced no farther than Patna, the capital of Behar, when Boskar Raow was defeated. Aly Verdy Khan, encouraged by victory, now thought himself fully equal to the defence of his provinces; and informing Suffder Jung that he had no further occasion for succours, requested him to quit Patna and return home; which he did, though with some reluctance, having intended, it is said, had Aly Verdy Khan been worsted by his enemy, to have added Behar to his own government. During his stay at Patna, he had selected some pieces of artillery and elephants belonging to the Deputy-governor, for his own use, without the consent of Aly Verdy Khan; and he, not relishing such acts of authority in an auxiliary, was much offended; so that a coolness took place between them; and had not Suffder Jung thought proper to retreat, in all probability an open rupture would have soon succeeded his refusal. Dec. 1742.

The attempts of the Mahrattas on Bengal did not end with the defeat of Boskar Raow. Ragojee Bhosela, enraged at the

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1743.

repulse of his general, immediately prepared a new army, at the head of which he entered Bengal. At the same time, Ballajee Raow*, the principal of the Mahratta chiefs of Poona, advanced with a considerable force, to receive payment of a draft of eleven† lacs of rupees, given by the Emperor on Aly Verdy Khan, but with professed declarations of affording his assistance to him against the Berar troops. Ragojee having entered the country by way of Bheerboom, fixed his head quarters in the district of Burdwan, while Ballajee marched through Behar to the bank of the Bhagarutty, not very far from the capital. Aly Verdy Khan advanced to meet him, and an interview took place, at which it was agreed that both armies should act in conjunction against Ragojee. It is supposed the Nuwab paid a great sum for his alliance with this Mahratta general, whose coming to Bengal is variously accounted for. Some attribute it to the Emperor's orders, in consequence of the request of Aly Verdy Khan; others, to the Royal anger at his usurpation of the government; but it is more probable that Ballajee was allured by the prospect of obtaining a considerable plunder in Bengal, and gratifying his enmity against the Berar chief, than that he shewed any regard to Mohammed Shah's approbation or dislike of the conduct of Aly Verdy Khan. Both armies now marched to expel Ragojee from Burdwan, and continued together for some days: when Ballajee, not liking the slow movement of the Bengal troops, took upon himself the punishment of the Berar chief, and left the Nuwab. Ragojee,

* Ballajee and Ragojee at this time were at enmity, as rivals for the Peshwaship, or ministry of the Mahratta states.

† One hundred and ten thousand pounds.

Digitized by Google

as his rival advanced, fled to his own country; and Aly Verdy Khan, having thus prudently cleared the provinces of his enemy, returned to Moorshudabad: but though he did not in this campaign suffer loss in the field, that of the revenue was great, as the unfortunate inhabitants of the defenceless villages were plundered without mercy by both the Mahratta armies; nor were their calamities yet at an end from the invaders. SECT. VI. A. D. 1743.

Ragojee, the year following, again sent Boskar Raow from Berar, at the head of twenty thousand horse, to invade Bengal; but with orders to offer peace, should the Nuwab submit to pay a heavy contribution, as he had done to Ballajee. Aly Verdy Khan, on their approach, moved with his army, and encamped at Munkirra, only ten miles from his capital; having A. D. 1744. it in contemplation to take advantage of the desire his enemy had for money, to allure the principal chiefs to an interview by promises of large sums, and to cut them off by treachery; which if effected, it would then be easy to vanquish an army deprived of its leaders. With such views, he despatched Mustapha Khan and Raja Janegee Ram to the Mahratta camp, with proposals of peace; and an invitation to Boskar Raow to come to an interview, should the terms of friendship be accepted. Boska Raow demanded heavy contributions; to which the agents readily consented, provided he would visit the Nuwab, who at the same time daily sent him friendly letters and valuable presents. At length, the Mahratta, blinded by avarice, consented, and a day was appointed. The Nuwab having communicated his intentions to his nephew Sayid Ahmed, Jaffier Khan, and Fakier Allah Beg, commanded them to select a confidential band of men, and draw them up within the skreens round the tent of audience, with orders to rush upon

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1744.

Boskar and his attendants, upon a signal which he appointed, promising liberal rewards for their obedience. At length, the day fixed being arrived, Boskar Raow moved from Cutwa with the greatest part of his army; and on his arrival near the Nuwab's encampment, leaving his troops drawn up in order of battle, advanced with other principal chiefs and his attendants. The Bengal troops were drawn up to receive him. Near the tent of audience he dismounted, and entered the inclosure of skreens with his companions, supported by Mustapha Khan and Raja Janegee Ram, who soon after, however, contrived to quit him. As the Mahratta chief advanced, Aly Verdy Khan eagerly inquired, which was Boskar Raow; and on his being pointed out, cried out with a loud voice, "Cut down the infidel!" In an instant, the appointed band rushed on their victims; and Boskar Raow, with nineteen officers of rank, were slaughtered. The Nuwab now mounted his elephant*; and putting himself at the head of his troops, furiously charged the Mahratta line; which, not expecting an attack, and deprived of their generals, was immediately routed. Aly Verdy Khan pursued the enemy to Cutwa, their standing camp, which had been left under the command of Ragoo Gicowaur, who had uniformly refused to accompany Boskar to the fatal interview. Being informed of the fate of his General, he fled with precipitation, and evacuated the provinces without attempting to revenge the massacre.

* The following anecdote is related, of Aly Verdy Khan's coolness. During the conflict in the tent, he was requested by his attendants to retire and mount his elephant; but one of his slippers could not be found, and he refused to go till it was brought. A person said, "Is this a time to look for slippers?" "No," replied he; "but were I to go without them, "it would hereafter be said—Aly Verdy Khan was in such a hurry to get away, that he "left his slippers behind him."

Digitized by Google

Aly Verdy Khan returned to Moorshudabad; and having distributed ten lacs of rupees, as a gratuity to the troops, conferred liberal rewards on those chiefs who had assisted mostly in the completion of his insidious and bloody victory. Hajy Ahmed, about this time, being offended at his brother for refusing him the foujedary of Hoogly, (though he had a greater revenue than he could expend; and the office he desired was conferred on his own son Sayid Ahmed, who had been without any consequential employment since his unfortunate administration at Cuttack,) retired in disgust to Patna, where he devoted himself, in his old age, to sensual enjoyments.

The Nuwab, now freed from foreign enemies, was assiduously employed in the regulation of his provinces, and forming plans for the repair of that desolation which the Mahrattas had spread through all the districts west of the river Ganges; but a storm soon arose within his own dominions, which was more threatening to his power than the armies of the Dekkan. He had, in order to attach his chiefs to his interest during the war, been lavish of his favours, and more so of promises of future rewards to them; but which, now finding inconvenient to fulfil, he broke, thereby giving offence to many, but particularly to his principal general Mustapha Khan.

This chief had been constantly the principal counsellor and agent of Aly Verdy Khan. To his fidelity and valour he in great measure owed his acquisition of the musnud of Bengal, and his success over the Mahratta invaders. To his address he was indebted also for the decisive but treacherous blow given to his enemies, by the late assassination of Boskar Raow and his officers: and it is said that for this last service he had

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1744.

promised him the government of Behar, which was held by his nephew and son-in-law, Zyn Addeen. The General was urgent for the performance of his promise; and made the demand in such a manner, as shewed he rather esteemed himself the partner in authority, than the servant of the Nuwab. He interfered also, by his recommendations of persons to office, with the plans of the Nuwab, who granted many favours to his importunity: but every compliance was instantly succeeded by new requests; so that the Nuwab was in danger of becoming a tool in the hands of his General, a situation which his high spirit could not brook. To such a pitch had Mustapha Khan carried his influence, that the zemindars of Bengal, when pushed for payment of the revenue by the collectors, or when they had been guilty of any breach of the regulations, bribed him to skreen them from the resentment of the Nuwab; who, to please the General, often repealed his own orders, to the injury of his treasury and authority, insomuch that the civil officers of government became of little consequence in the eyes of the renters. Aly Verdy Khan bore with the evil till it was becoming dangerous; but on the General's demanding the province of Behar, fearing, from his own conduct in a similar situation, that Mustapha Khan would finally direct the force which that government would give him against his patron, as he himself had done against the unfortunate Serferaz Khan, he positively refused. He however endeavoured, but in vain, by every other means, to satisfy him for his breach of promise. Mustapha Khan had resolved to establish himself in Behar, and would not be satisfied with any thing less. It is said, that he had even views upon Bengal, to accomplish which he would not have spared the life of his master. Jealousies now took

Digitized by Google

place; and each party became suspicious of the other's intentions, knowing that assassination was an engine they each could make use of without remorse, and which, perhaps, both watched an opportunity to employ. Appearances of regard were however kept up between the Nuwab and his General; but the latter now always went well guarded in his visits to court. At length, an accident brought affairs to a crisis, which produced an open rupture. SECT. VI. A. D. 1744.

Mustapha Khan, one day intending to pay his respects to the Nuwab, despatched before him two of his principal officers, to observe the state of the audience chamber, and remark if there were any signs of treachery against him; a precaution he had used since the coolness had taken place. The officers, having made their obeisance to the Prince, sat down to wait the arrival of the General; when, just as it was announced, a eunuch came from the interior apartments, and informed the Nuwab, that his *Begum* was suddenly taken ill, and desired to see him: the Nuwab rose up, and, retiring, desired that the officers would excuse him for a few minutes to their General. At this instant, the tread of feet and uncommon rustling were heard in the passage to the *haram*, which the officers, ever suspicious of treachery, supposing to proceed from armed men concealed to assassinate their lord, and the Nuwab's departure giving colour to their apprehensions, they rushed out, and informed Mustapha Khan, who was now alighting in the court, of their fears. The General, prepared for alarm by the consciousness of his own evil designs, remounted; and hastening precipitately to his cantonments, refused to return; though the Nuwab, who had almost instantaneously come back to the chamber of audience, despatched after him his nephew, Nuazish Mohammed, A. D. 1745.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1745.

to inform him that he was waiting to receive him, and anxious to inquire the cause of his sudden departure, with solemn assurances that no treachery had been intended. On the return of his nephew, Aly Verdy Khan would have gone in person to persuade him of his sincerity; but the entreaties of his family, who were alarmed for his safety, prevailed upon him to give up that hazardous design. Every trial was made to calm the apprehensions of the General, but in vain; and he now openly declared his intentions of quitting the Nuwab's service, and demanded the arrears of pay due to himself and followers. Aly Verdy Khan gladly complied with his wishes, and paid without delay seventeen lacs* of rupees, without examining his accounts; at the same time commanding him, as he was resolved to leave his service, to quit his dominions. Mustapha Khan, emboldened by the readiness with which the Nuwab satisfied his demands, and regarding it as a proof of weakness and fear, made proposals to the Afghan commanders of corps, to depose Aly Verdy Khan, and to divide his territories equally among them. Shumsheer Khan, a considerable chief, agreed to join him: but the rest, as Serdar Khan, Rahim Khan, and others, declined; saying, that if Aly Verdy Khan had injured him by withholding his just demands, they would readily have assisted him in enforcing redress; but to mutiny for no cause, or to behave ungratefully to their benefactor, they esteemed base and dishonourable. The Nuwab took care to improve this good disposition by present gratuities, and promises of favour to the loyal chiefs and their followers; but, not willing to hazard the safety of his capital by proceeding to

* One hundred and seventy thousand pounds.

Digitized by Google

extremities against the rebel, was content to guard the city from insult, and to wait patiently for his departure. At length, Mustapha Khan, having used every art, but without effect, to corrupt the army, marched from Moorshudabad with upwards of eight thousand horse and a great number of foot, with the intention of possessing himself of Behar. The inhabitants of the city, who during the quarrel had been under the greatest alarm for their persons and property, received new life from his departure. The Nuwab having liberally rewarded his troops for their fidelity, particularly Serdar Khan, Rahim Khan, and Shumsheer Khan, who had been gained over from joining the rebel, now prepared to pursue him. After a few days, leaving the city in charge of his nephew Nuazish, he began his march; at the same time writing to Zyn Addeen, governor of Patna, the capital of Behar, not to hazard an engagement in the field; and if he thought that city not defensible, to cross the river, and move down the opposite bank, till he could form a junction with his grand army.

Mustapha Khan having p,undered Rajemahel, and taken possession of some elephants and cannon stationed there, proceeded to Mongier, of which he gained possession with little loss, the fortress being in a ruinous state. He next advanced towards Patna, hoping to make an easy conquest of that city; but intelligence of his defection having reached Zyn Addeen, the son-in-law of the Nuwab, who was then engaged in some operations on the opposite bank of the Ganges, he returned expeditiously, and encamped near the town, resolved, notwithstanding the contrary advice of his uncle the Nuwab, to oppose the enemy, however superior in number. He despatched a

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1745.

messenger to Mustapha Khan, desiring to know his intentions; declaring, that if they were to seize the city, he must produce the Imperial orders to that effect; but if his design was only to pass through the province into Benaras or Oude, he was welcome to pursue his route any way but through the capital. The rebel insolently replied, "Territory is for him who can "conquer it: there is no occasion for an Imperial grant." He concluded by asking, "By what authority was his uncle "supported in seizing Bengal, and murdering his sovereign, "Serferaz Khan?"

Zyn Addeen, not intimidated at the rebel's approach, prepared to receive him, though his army did not consist of more than five or six thousand horse; great part of them raised in a hurry, and inexperienced. The enemy soon appeared, and attacked his camp; when Zyn Addeen was on the first onset deserted by all his troops, except a few hundred veterans who guarded his person. Mustapha Khan was furiously charging this small body; when his elephant driver being killed by a musquet shot, the animal became unruly, and at the same time two of his principal officers were mortally wounded. Unable to manage his elephant, he alighted in order to mount a horse; but his troops, on missing him from his *howdah**, supposing him slain, were seized with a panic, and retreated in confusion towards their own camp. Mustapha Khan endeavoured to rally, and convince them of their error, but was also obliged to retire. Zyn Addeen, not thinking it prudent to pursue, was contented with the repulse of the enemy, and remained within his lines. A distant

* A seat used on elephants.

Digitized by Google

cannonade and skirmishing was kept up for seven days between the two armies; but on the eighth, the rebel, after sending off his baggage and tents some miles to the westward of Patna, again attacked the lines of Zyn Addeen, who defended his post with gallantry and resolution. Mustapha Khan, still unfortunate, in the beginning of the assault was wounded in the eye with an arrow, which obliged him to retreat; and having now intelligence of the near approach of Aly Verdy Khan, he judged it best to give over his designs on Patna, and to march towards the frontier of Behar. He was pursued by the Nuwab and his nephew from place to place; but expecting soon to be joined by a body of Mahrattas, in conjunction with whom he hoped to be more successful; and not choosing to hazard an engagement with his own troops, dispirited by their late repulses and the loss of their two principal chiefs; he passed into the territories of the Nuwab of Oude, and took refuge under the walls of Chunar, whither Aly Verdy Khan, fearful of embroiling himself with Suffder Jung, did not choose to pursue him, but returned to Patna.

Scarcely had he reached that city, when he received intelligence, that Ragojee Bhosela, encouraged by assurances of assistance from Mustapha Khan, and eager to revenge the assassination of Boskar Raow and his officers, had marched towards Bengal with a large army, and was rapidly advancing. Aly Verdy Khan, leaving his son-in-law to defend Behar and watch the motions of the rebel, hastened to Moorshudabad, for the defence of that city, and to prevent, if possible, a junction of the Mahrattas with Mustapha Khan. At the same time he sent an ambassador to endeavour to divert

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1745.

Ragojee from his invasion; but that chief, supposing Bengal to be in a state of disaffection, and the offers of the Nuwab to proceed from fear, demanded the unreasonable sum of three crores of rupees as the price of his forbearance. The Nuwab, though resolved not to consent to terms so exorbitant and dishonourable, yet willing to gain time, in hopes that the rainy season, now near, would stop the Mahratta from action, and allow him effectually to punish Mustapha Khan, instructed his ambassador to amuse Ragojee with professions of compliance. In consequence of this, nearly two months were wasted in negotiation at Burdwan, where the enemy encamped; and, at the expiration of that time, Aly Verdy Khan received intelligence of the defeat and death of Mustapha Khan, who had, with great additions to his former force, invaded Behar, thinking to find it an easy conquest, whilst the attention of Aly Verdy Khan was engaged by the Mahratta invasion, but the abilities and good fortune of Zyn Addeen prevailed against him*.

The Nuwab, who had continued at his capital in order to convince Ragojee that he was sincere in his desire of peace, now ordered his ambassador to return, and sent him this vaunting message: "Those who seek peace from an enemy, are guided "either by a sense of their own loss or inferiority, or hopes of "advantage; but, praised be God! the heroes of the true faith "feel no dread of encountering infidels. Peace therefore depends "upon this: When the lions of Islaum shall so engage the "monsters of Idolatry, that they shall swim in the blood of

* They fought near Jugdispore. Mustapha was killed by a musquet-ball; and his body having been quartered, was hung at the four gates of Patna.

Digitized by Google

" each other, and struggle till one party shall, overpowered, " beg for quarter." Ragojee replied, " That, to obtain this crisis, " he had already advanced nearly a thousand miles from his " own country; but the Nuwab had not yet moved one " hundred to do him the honours of a meeting." Aly Verdy Khan rejoined, " That the rainy season being arrived, and Ra- " gojee having suffered fatigue and inconvenience from his " long march, it would be prudent for him to spend the incle- " ment months in some convenient spot, that his troops might " refresh and prepare for engagement in the dry season, when " he would respectfully wait upon him, even to his own do- " minions." Ragojee accordingly encamped in Bheerbhoom, and reduced the province of Cuttack, and most of Burdwan, by his detachments,

In the beginning of the cool season of 1158, Aly Verdy Khan marched from his capital, to offer battle to the enemy. But Ragojee, alarmed at his approach, moved into Behar, in order to form a junction with the remains of Mustapha Khan's adherents, who still continued to infest the hilly part of that province, under Mortuzza Khan, son to the deceased chief, although too weak to venture into the open country alone. The Nuwab, not being able to overtake the Mahrattas, encamped at Bankipore, a short distance west of Patna, for some time; but on hearing that the enemy had crossed the Soane to join the Afghans, he proceeded to Mohib Aleepore, on the banks of that river.

Ragojee having effected his purpose of joining the rebels, advanced towards the Nuwab's army in great force; and several engagements took place, in all which the latter was victorious; particularly in one, when the Mahratta general was so com-

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1745.

pletely surrounded, that he must have been taken prisoner, had not Shumsheer Khan and Serdar Khan, two of Aly Verdy Khan's Afghan officers, who were privately negotiating a treaty with the enemy, purposely let him escape. This discovery of treachery alarmed the Nuwab, and he again offered terms to the Mahratta: but Ragojee would not accept them; and seeing no advantage in opposing Aly Verdy Khan in the field, by advice of Meer Hubbeeb he proceeded rapidly towards Moorshudabad, in hopes of being able to plunder that city before the Nuwab could reach it with his army. Aly Verdy Khan, however, moved with such expedition, that he arrived only one day after the enemy, who had only time to ravage part of the suburbs, and, on his approach, retreated across the river Bhagarutty. The Nuwab followed Ragojee to Cutwa; near which he obliged him to engage, and defeated him with great slaughter, when the Mahrattas retreated towards Midnapore. Here, having received intelligence of insurrections in his own country, Ragojee returned hastily to Berar with the bulk of his army, leaving Meer Hubbeeb and the Afghan chiefs for the defence of Cuttack; upon which the Nuwab, giving up for the present the recovery of that province, returned to his capital, in order to refresh his troops, and to correct some misdoings which he had discovered among his principal officers.

It has been already mentioned, that Serdar Khan and Shumsheer Khan, during the campaign, had suffered Ragojee to escape, when they might have made him prisoner. The Nuwab had also, while the Mahrattas were in the neighbourhood of the capital, entrusted the protection of the roads between it and Bogwaungolah, from whence the city was furnished with

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

supplies from the districts eastward of the Ganges, to those officers who, either through neglect or design, allowed the marauders more than once to plunder the convoys. The Nuwab upon this removed them from that duty, which he entrusted to his nephew, Sayid Ahmed, who fulfilled it to his satisfaction, and intercepted letters from Ragojee to the former commanders, which proved their connivance. Aly Verdy Khan had concealed his suspicions till the retreat of the Mahrattas; but, upon his return to Moorshudabad, he dismissed them with their followers, about six thousand men, from his service, but allowed them to retire to their homes in the district of Durbunga, on the eastern side of the Ganges, in the province of Behar. In this season of temporary repose were celebrated the marriages of his grandson Seraje ad Dowlah, and Akrem ad Dowlah, sons of Zyn Addeen Ahmed, the latter of whom had been adopted by Nuazish Mohammed, who had no children. Upward of two thousand rich dresses were distributed on this occasion among the attendants at court; and, during a whole month, the populace were feasted at the expense of the Nuwab. The magnificence of these nuptials, the brilliant illuminations, splendid pageants, and grand processions of the bridegrooms, are still spoken of with admiration by the inhabitants of Bengal.

A. D. 1745.

A. D. 1746.

Aly Verdy Khan, having now resolved to attempt the expulsion of the Mahrattas and Afghans from Cuttack, appointed Meer Jaffier Khan* to the command of a considerable detachment for that service; giving him, by way of encouragement, the foujedaries of Injelee and Midnapore, in addition to the office of Paymaster-general. Meer Jaffier, on his ar-

* The same person who, after the decease of Aly Verdy Khan, by the assistance of the English, acquired the musnud of Bengal. He was married to a half-sister of Aly Verdy Khan.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1747.

rival at Midnapore, defeated a small body of the enemy; when, being much addicted to luxury and indolence, he did not pursue his advantage, but put his troops into cantonments; though the Nuwab had ordered him to proceed to Cuttack without delay, before the enemy could be reinforced from Berar, the chief's son of which, Janojee, was preparing for a fresh invasion. At length the expected Mahratta army entered Cuttack; and Meer Jaffier, not choosing to hazard the defence of Midnapore, retreated towards Burdwan; when the advanced party of the enemy, observing his pusillanimity, hung upon his rear, and plundered his baggage of several elephants. Aly Verdy Khan, upon this, despatched Attah Allah Khan with a reinforcement, to supersede him in the command; and moved also himself from the capital with his army, to support him, if necessary. Atta Allah engaged the enemy at Burdwan, and defeated them; but having secret designs on the government himself, the accession to which he had been foretold by a fanatic officer in his service who pretended to the gift of prophecy, he thought the present a proper occasion to assume independence. For this purpose, he endeavoured to corrupt Meer Jaffier by a promise of the government of Behar, if he would assist in deposing the Nuwab. Meer Jaffier at first listened to the proposal, but, at the remonstrances of his friends on the danger of the attempt, withdrew his concurrence. Intelligence of this treacherous combination, however, having reached Aly Verdy Khan, he determined to lessen their influence, and, on his arrival at Burdwan, reprimanded Meer Jaffier severely for his conduct in Midnapore; upon which that chief refrained from his usual attendance at the *durbar*. Atta Allah Khan, proud of his late victory, and not suspecting that his evil designs were known to the Nuwab, demanded the command of

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

a thousand horse for Meer Aly Asgir, the fanatic officer who had prophesied his exaltation, and had greatly distinguished himself in the action; but this the Nuwab refused; and Atta Allah, being disgusted, threatened to leave the army. Aly Verdy Khan was not to be moved, and he accordingly retired with his followers to Moorshudabad. The Nuwab would now have overlooked the faults of Meer Jaffier, and, on the death of a relation, condescendingly went to pay him a visit of condolence, as a mark of returning favour; but that chief, supposing this honour to proceed from a dread of his influence, insolently neglected the complimentary advance from his tent to meet him; on which the Nuwab, in great wrath, laid aside his intentions, after he had gone half way, and returned to his camp. He now ordered him to give in the accounts of his office, and to send Shujan Sing, his deputy, with them to the durbar. Meer Jaffier refused; upon which the Nuwab removed him from all his employments; and offered service to his followers in other corps, which they readily embraced. The General, finding himself deserted, would have made concessions; but the Nuwab ordered him to leave the army, and retire to the capital.

A. D. 1747.

Aly Verdy Khan, notwithstanding this dissention, and the loss of two of his generals, kept the field, and defeated the Mahrattas in several engagements. Janojee attempted, like his father, to plunder the capital; but the Nuwab followed him with such rapidity, that he had not time to execute his designs; and, on the approach of the rains, retired to Midnapore, where he cantoned; and Aly Verdy Khan marched to Moorshudabad, not choosing to pursue him farther till the dry season. Meer Aly Asgir, the prophesying fanatic, was now obliged by the Nuwab to quit the provinces; though Nuazish

A. D. 1748.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1748.

Mohammed used every entreaty with his uncle to allow him to remain in the city with Atta Allah Khan, whom the Nuwab yet permitted to reside there.

The rains had scarcely subsided, when the Nuwab prepared to march against the Mahrattas; and was encamped at Amaunee Gunge, not far from the capital, when he received sudden intelligence of an insurrection in Behar, the assassination of his nephew Zyn Addeen, and the captivity and disgraceful death of his brother Hajy Ahmed. It has been already remarked, that the Nuwab had discharged from his service the Afghan chiefs, Shumsheer Khan and Serdar Khan, with their followers. These generals had resided since that time in their jagiers in Durbunga; but the existence of such a body of armed men, free from any controul of the Governor of the province, could not long continue without endangering its safety. Zyn Addeen, according to some reports, dreading their rebellion, or, to others, by attaching the Afghans to his interests, meaning to insure his succession to his uncle, or to assume independence on his authority, had, during the rains, represented to him, by his agent, that the discharged chiefs were sorry for their past conduct, and desirous of being re-admitted to his service: he therefore requested that he might be allowed to entertain them, as the only mode of preventing a commotion, to which they would have recourse, should their petition be rejected. The Nuwab, with some reluctance, consented*; and Zyn Addeen made proposals to the two chiefs, which they received with seeming satisfaction. The terms of service being adjusted, in the end of the month Zilhije 1161, they marched from Durbunga

* Mr. Orme says, it was a plot of Aly Verdy Khan's to destroy all the Afghan chiefs by gunpowder. See vol. II., page 40.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1748.

to the bank of the Ganges, opposite Patna; and the Governor, to assure them of his confidence and sincerity, condescended to visit them with a few attendants. He was received with proper respect, and a day was fixed for their crossing the river with their followers. The Governor returned to his palace satisfied of their fidelity, and issued orders for the provision of boats for their conveyance. On the day appointed, the Afghans crossed the Ganges, and encamped near the city; when Zyn Addeen again visited Serdar Khan*. The two next days were chosen for the Generals to pay their respects to him separately, at the palace; and the Governor, in order to obviate any fears they might have of treachery, commanded that only his domestic servants should attend him, even to the exclusion of his usual body guards. Serdar Khan came the first day; and having received the customary tokens of esteem, returned to his camp. The following morning the Governor repaired to his hall of audience, to receive the promised visit of Shumsheer Khan; and, as on the day before, would not permit any guards to attend, allowing only a few officers of his household to be present. First came nearly a thousand of the Afghan infantry, with matchlocks and matches lighted, who, after saluting, arranged themselves in the square of the palace. A chief, named Morad Sheer Khan, next entered, with a crowd of officers, who filled the hall, and eagerly pressed to present their offerings. This being done, Zyn Addeen inquired for Shumsheer Khan, and was told he was not far off. Morād Sheer Khan now ordered his companions to take leave, and make room for others. They rose, and,

Dec. 1748.

* It is said, this chief was not a partner in the treason, as far as respected the assassination.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1748.

according to custom, received each a *betle** from the Governor, who was earnest in distributing it; when one of the Afghans, suddenly drawing a dagger, aimed a stroke at him, but without effect. One of the Nuwab's attendants immediately cried out "Treachery!" but Zyn Addeen had only time to draw his sabre, when Morād Sheer Khan cut him down, and he fell dead on the pillow of his musnud. Several of his attendants were slain: and the palace being filled with the traitors, also the streets of the city by the soldiers of Shumsheer Khan, no resistance could be made by the dependants of the Governor. The Afghans committed great excesses in the town, the inhabitants of which had no remedy but to submit to their authority. Shumsheer Khan ordered Hajy Ahmed to be brought before him, and demanded an account of his treasure; but declining a discovery, he was tortured in various modes for seventeen days, till at length he expired; not unjustly punished for his treachery, and share in the murder of the unfortunate Serferaz Khan. About seventy lacs of rupees were found buried in his house, besides jewels and other valuables to a great amount. The effects of Zyn Addeen were seized; and his Begum Ameena, the daughter of Aly Verdy Khan, with his other women, forcibly carried to the camp of Shumsheer Khan; who, leaving the city under charge of his deputy, fixed his head quarters at a little distance, and engaged in raising new levies with the plunder he had acquired, intending to invade Bengal. The wealthy inhabitants of Patna were obliged to pay large sums, to save their houses from being plundered; and a heavy contribution was exacted from the people at large by the rebels.

Aly Verdy Khan, though inwardly deeply affected at the,

* It is a compositson of various ingredients folded in an aromatic leaf, and is constantly chewed by the natives of Hindoostan. It is properly called *paun*.

Digitized by Google

death of his brother and nephew, the disgraceful captivity of his daughter, and the loss of Behar, threatened also with that of Bengal by the invasion of the Mahrattas at this alarming crisis, did not lose his intrepidity of mind; but sustained the storms of calamity with manly resolution, and prepared to combat the attacks of misfortune. He convened his principal officers, some of whom he had reason to suppose connected with the rebels, being of the same tribes; and desired their advice for his conduct in the present unhappy juncture of his affairs. They unanimously declared, that they would loyally obey his commands. He replied, that his beloved brother and nephew being slain, and their families plunged in disgraceful captivity, he found life, under such misfortunes unrevenged, intolerable; therefore knew no remedy but to punish the rebels, or die in the attempt. If therefore any wished to follow him to this extremity, he would spare nothing to reward them; but neither would he detain those who might choose to quit his service, having already received more obligations from them than he could repay: and as he had resolved to seek death rather than lead a dishonourable life, but few followers were necessary to enable him to obtain the former. The chiefs, one and all, exclaimed, "that they owed him inviolable gratitude, for his "long-experienced bounty towards them, and had no views "but to sacrifice their lives, if necessary, in his service;" to perform which, they bound themselves by oath on the Koran. Aly Verdy Khan, now convinced of their fidelity, paid up their arrears, and prepared to march against the rebels. The Mahrattas by this time had advanced from Burdwan, and began to lay waste the country within a short distance of the capital; but the Nuwab, knowing that to follow these marauders,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A.D. 1748. who always avoided coming to action, would be in vain, and would give time to the rebels in Behar to gather strength, was not to be diverted from his purpose. He stationed Sayid Ahmed at Bogwangolah, to preserve the communication for supplies open between the Ganges and the city, the defence of which he entrusted to Nuazish Mohammed and Atta Allah Khan, with a body of five thousand horse. A proclamation was also issued, that he found it necessary to march against the rebels, though the Mahrattas were in the environs of the city; and recommending, to such as chose it, to retire with their families to places of greater security, previous to his departure. Most of the inhabitants who could procure conveyance accordingly moved, with their families and effects, across the Ganges; so that scarcely any but the soldiery and poor remained. Having finished his preparations, he moved from Amaunee Gunge, with an army of twenty thousand horse, and as many foot. In order to secure provisions, he had collected a large fleet of boats, amply laden, to accompany his march up the banks of the Ganges. Meer Jaffier on this occasion was again taken into favour, restored to command, and to the office of Paymaster-general.

March 1749. Aly Verdy Khan reached Mongier without opposition, except in a trifling skirmish with some of the Mahrattas at Bhaugulpore, who had marched to join the rebels. Here a messenger was intercepted with letters from Atta Allah Khan* to the insurgents, in which he encouraged them to stand, and offered to embrace their cause at a convenient opportunity. The Nuwab was joined at Mongier by a few of the Behar zemindars, and dependants of the late Zyn Addeen, who informed

* His daughter had been betrothed to Seraje ad Dowlah, but died a few days before the marriage was to have taken place.

Digitized by Google

him that the rebels had left Patna, and were encamped at Bar, in number about fifty thousand horse and foot, expecting to be joined by the Mahrattas.

Janojee and Meer Hubbeeb having reached the vicinity of the rebels' camp, invited them to a conference, at which they embraced the service of the Mahratta chief; and Shumsheer Khan was invested by him with the *khelaut* of the soubahdary of Behar. The next day, Meer Hubbeeb visited Shumsheer Khan, who after his audience left him to repose; but privately directed the guard over the tents, when he should prepare to return to his own camp, to detain him, as a security for the payment of the expenses he had incurred in levying an army for the service of the Mahrattas, at whose instigation he pretended he had assassinated Zyn Addeen. This scheme by some means coming to the knowledge of an attendant of Meer Hubbeeb, he directed some of the horsemen who had accompanied him, to leave the camp, but to return suddenly, as if pursued by an enemy, and spread an alarm that the Nuwab's army was in sight; in hopes that, by this stratagem, he might save his master from the intended treachery. The horsemen spread the alarm, as directed, and much confusion occurred in the rebels' camp; but notwithstanding the representations of Meer Hubbeeb, that the present was no time for settling accounts, he was not allowed to depart till he had paid a considerable sum, and given the security of merchants for a much greater. This dispute proved highly favourable to Aly Verdy Khan, by preventing the Mahrattas from acting in conjunction with the rebels, as the former now resolved to watch only an opportunity for plundering either army. The following day the Nuwab offered battle to the enemy, and,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1749.

by his usual good fortune, Serdar Khan was killed by a matchlock ball in the beginning of the action, which involved one half of the rebels in confusion, and spread alarm through the troops of Shumsheer Khan. At this juncture the Mahrattas appeared in the rear, hoping to effect the plunder of the Nuwab's camp, while he was engaged. Upon Seraje ad Dowlah's representing that it was proper to detach a body to oppose them, he replied, "that he would first defeat his enemy in front, and then with ease disperse the Mahrattas." Having said this, he charged the rebels with great fury, and they fled panic-struck before him. Shumsheer Khan, being deserted by his troops, was attacked on his elephant by an officer named Hubbeeb Beg, who slew him, and cutting off his head, brought it to the Nuwab. The Mahrattas, seeing the defeat of the rebels, withdrew from the field without striking a blow, and the Nuwab quietly took possession of the Afghan camp; which they had left standing, with all their tents and baggage. Here the Nuwab found his daughter, the Begum of Zyn Addeen, and the rest of his family, who had been made prisoners at Patna. Having offered up thanks for this, on his side, almost bloodless victory, and the happy retrieval of his insulted honour, he proceded to Patna, where he distributed large sums to the religious and poor, in gratitude to God for his success, and took measures for repairing the losses of government in the late rebellion. Having sent for the women and children of the principal insurgents from Durbunga, on their arrival he lodged them in his own haram, treating them with humanity and kindness, and after a short time set them at liberty. At this time, also, he permitted the women and family of Meer Hubbeeb, who had been confined since his

Digitized by Google

joining the Mahrattas, to return to him, and furnished them with money, conveyances, and an escort for their protection to the enemy's camp. Having resettled the government of Behar, he appointed his grandson, Seraje ad Dowlah, Governor of that province; but nominated Raja Janky Ram to be his deputy, and to perform the duty; he also appointed his second son-in-law, Sayid Ahmed, Foujedar of Purneah: he then returned triumphantly to Moorshudabad; but, previously to entering the city, obliged Atta Allah Khan* to quit it, and, as soon as possible, his dominions; permitting him, however, to remove with all his effects, and nearly seventy lacs of rupees, which he had acquired in his service, though he had repeated proofs of his having conspired against his life and government. Atta Allah Khan retired into the province of Oude, and was soon afterwards slain, in an action in the service of Suffder Jung against the Patans of Ferokhabad. Janojee, the Mahratta chief, after the defeat of Shumsheer Khan, not thinking himself equal to Aly Verdy Khan in the field, retired with his army to Midnapore; and soon after, on receiving intelligence of the death of his mother, marched to Nagpore, leaving Meer Hubbeeb with a detachment for the defence of Cuttack.

The Nuwab, at the conclusion of the rains of 1162, moved again from his capital, in order to drive the Mahrattas from Cuttack; and, on his approach, they quitted the city. He followed them from place to place, during the dry season, without being able to bring them to action; and on his return to Moorshudabad, the enemy again obtained possession of that province.

* He was married to a daughter of Hajy Ahmed.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1750.

Bengal was this year free from their depredations; a point which the Nuwab esteemed an ample reward for the fatigues of his campaign. The next year he renewed his efforts, and the marauders evaded his pursuit as usual; which made the Nuwab resolve to canton for the rains at Midnapore: but buildings were scarcely erected, when he received intelligence that Seraje ad Dowlah, his favourite grandson, had left Moorshudabad, with intentions of taking possession of Patna, which was governed in his name by Janky Ram, and of assuming independence.

Aly Verdy Khan, who loved his grandson to distraction, was more alarmed for his personal safety in the opposition he might receive from the Governor of Patna, than any ill consequences to himself from the rebellion. He instantly left his army at Midnapore, and with a small force hastened to Moorshudabad, where he remained only one day to refresh his troops, and then followed the imprudent youth; to whom he wrote in terms of the greatest affection, assuring him that he meant him for his successor, and entreating him to return to his protection. Seraje ad Dowlah wrote an insolent reply, in which he accused the Nuwab of promoting his uncles to offices of trust, and treating him only with pretended fondness; that he was weary of being controuled like a child; and, since he would not give him a share in authority, he was resolved to seize what he regarded as his just right: therefore he hoped his grandfather would not attempt to oppose him, as the consequence must be, that one of them must fall in the contest. The Nuwab returned for answer, that Seraje ad Dowlah, through imprudence and want of judgment, had causelessly accused him of want of regard; for he not only intended him the

Digitized by Google

succession to his own dominions, but to the government of the empire, could he obtain it for him. He concluded his letter with the following sentences: "The religious champion, "eager for martyrdom, is unmindful that the martyr to love "exceeds him. In the last day they will not be compared "together, for one is slain by an enemy, but the other by "a friend." SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

Seraje ad Dowlah, on his arrival near Patna, in the month of Rejib 1163, summoned the Governor, Raja Janky Ram, to deliver up the city, and repair to his presence; assuring him of favour in case of his obedience. The Raja was at a loss how to act, being fearful of surrendering his charge without orders from the Nuwab; and alarmed, lest any accident should happen to Seraje ad Dowlah if he opposed him; but at length he resolved on defending the city, till he should hear from Aly Verdy Khan. The imprudent young man assaulted the town without delay; but Mhadee Nissar Khan, the principal adviser and leader of his rebellion, being killed early in the attack, his followers fled, and Seraje ad Dowlah with difficulty sheltered himself in a house in the suburbs. The Raja, rejoiced that he had escaped unhurt, immediately sent some of his principal officers to attend him to a residence befitting his rank: and by the persuasions of his friends, he consented to return to his grandfather. Aly Verdy Khan was overjoyed at the escape of the youth, and hastened to meet him. Instead of reproaches, he received him with the greatest affection, and a joy bordering on weakness, as it made Seraje ad Dowlah exert the influence he now saw he had over him to his discredit and dishonour. The Nuwab, having spent a few days at Patna, returned with his grandson to Moorshudabad; but was seized on the road by July 1750.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1751.

an intermitting fever, which continued long upon him. On his recovery in 1164, he marched against the Mahrattas, who yet infested the province of Cuttack, and, as usual, unable to bring them to a decisive engagement, spent the dry months in pursuing them from place to place. At length both parties, being tired of war, began equally to wish for an accommodation of their disputes. Aly Verdy Khan yielded to the Mahrattas the province of Cuttack, and agreed to pay annually twelve lacks of rupees, as the choute of Bengal*.

The Nuwab, by this peace, being freed from all his enemies, gradually discharged his superfluous troops, and employed himself in encouraging his people to rebuild the villages which had been destroyed, and to cultivate the lands which in many districts had long lain waste, from the desertion of the inhabitants during the repeated invasions. From this period we find nothing remarkable in his life, the remainder of his government being uninterrupted by vicissitude. As he had chosen Seraje ad Dowlah for his successor, he latterly

* The following is an abstract of the treaty, by which the dignity of the Nuwab was nominally preserved.

"1. That Meer Hubbeeb should be considered as the deputy of the Nuwab; that he should receive orders to appropriate the revenues of Orissa to the payment of the arrears due to the troops of Raja Ragojee Bhoosla, and that, over and above the said assignment, the sum of twelve lacs of rupees should be paid to the said Raja's agents, yearly, on condition that the Mahrattas should not again set foot in his Highness's territories.

"2. That the river Soonamooky†, which runs by Ballasore, should be considered as the boundary between the two dominions; and that the Mahrattas should never cross that river, nor even set a foot in its waters."

Meer Hubbeeb did not long enjoy the fruits of his labours; he was soon after assassinated by Janojee, the son of the Berar Raja.

† This is probably a mistake, as the river Subanreeka, which runs by Jellasore, was considered the boundary of Orissa, till October 1803, when the whole province was re-conquered by the English. See *Wellesley's Mahratta War.*

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

entrusted him with a power, which was too often employed for the destruction of those against whom he had any pique, or was jealous of their attachment to his uncles. Hussein Cooly Khan and his brother, the favourites of his uncle Nuazish Mohammed, he assassinated, in the year 1168; and A. D. 1754. put to death other persons of rank, without being punished by his grandfather: which acts of cruelty estranged from him the minds of the people, and prepared the way for his own future destruction.

In the year 1169 died Nuazish Mohammed, nephew to the A. D. 1756. Nuwab, and son to Hajy Ahmed. He possessed many good qualities, and was much esteemed by the people for his clemency, and charities to the friendless and poor. His death was speedily followed by that of his brother Sayid Ahmed, who had for many years governed the district of Purneah, with credit to himself and satisfaction to the inhabitants; his misfortune at Cuttack having corrected the warmth of his disposition, and taught him prudence and humanity. Both these princes are well spoken of by the natives of Bengal, and their memory respected. Nuazish Mohammed died without issue; and Sayid Ahmed left only one son, who succeeded him in his government, under the title of Shokut Jung.

Aly Verdy Khan did not long survive the death of his nephews. In the eightieth year of his age, being seized with a dropsy, he submitted for some days to the advice of his physicians; but finding himself growing worse, and judging that at his time of life a recovery was not to be expected, refrained from medicine, and refused longer to follow any regimen. The expectations of his death caused great disputes among his relations. His eldest daughter, Gheseety Begum,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756. widow of Nuazish Mohammed, retired with her treasures to Mooteejeel*, and distributed large sums among the followers of her late husband, in hopes that they would support her against her nephew Seraje ad Dowlah, on her father's demise. Such policy was only the influence of her declining fortune. When Aly Verdy Khan was in his last agonies, some of his women desired he would recommend them to the care of his intended successor; but the Nuwab, knowing his bad qualities, observed, smiling, to them, "that if he for three days should behave dutifully to his grandmother, then they might entertain hopes of his tenderness." Shortly after this, he departed to the April 9, 1756. Divine mercy, on the ninth of Rejib, 1169, after a government of sixteen years over the three provinces of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa. He was buried the following night, near the tomb of his mother, in the garden of Khoosh Baug.

Aly Verdy Khan from his early youth was not addicted to idle pleasures, as wine or opiates†, music, or the company of courtezans. He was regular in his devotions, and assiduously abstained from all things forbidden by the divine law. He generally rose two hours before day, and, after ablution and prayer, drank coffee with his select companions. At daybreak he gave public audience; when the commanders of his army, the civil officers, and persons of all ranks who had any applications to make, were admitted without reserve, to set forth their business, and received satisfaction from his bounty. At

* A country palace near Moorshudabad. The principal building stands in a piece of water called Mootee Jeel, or Pearl Lake. It was erected by Nuazish Mohammed; and is a stately pile, being ornamented with many pillars of black marble, brought from the ruins of Gour or Lucknowty, the antient capital of Bengal.

† Commonly used in India to intoxicate.

Digitized by Google

the expiration of two hours he retired to a private apartment, where such only as were invited came. These were generally his nephews, Nuazish Mohammed and Sayid Ahmed, his grandson Seraje ad Dowlah, and particular friends. Pieces of poetry were now recited, or history or anecdotes read to him; and sometimes he even amused himself with giving directions to his cooks, who prepared victuals before him according to his palate. The officers of different departments, if necessary, also came for orders. He then sat down to eat with his friends, and many shared the bounties of his table. When the meal was over, the company retired to repose. At this time, a story-teller always attended, to relate some amusing narrative. He generally rose about an hour after mid-day, performed his devotions, and read in the Korān till near four. After saying the prescribed prayers, and drinking a draught of water cooled with ice or saltpetre, he received several learned men, in whose company he daily spent an hour; hearing them discuss points of divinity and law, for his information. When they retired, the officers of the revenue, with Juggut Seat his banker, were admitted, and gave him the intelligence received from Dehly and every province of the empire, also of each district of his own government; after which he issued his orders to them, as the nature of the business required. An hour passed in this manner, and sometimes his near relations were allowed to be present. By this time night set in, lights were brought, and with them certain jesters and buffoons, who entertained him with their repartees on each other for a short time. He then retired to prayers; after which he sat in private with his own Begum, to receive the visits of near female relations, till nine o'clock. The

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

women then departed; and men were admitted who had business with him, till he retired to sleep, generally early, and without eating. In this manner he passed his time, having stated hours for every employment. He was unequalled in his benevolence to his relations, friends, and former acquaintance in his lower fortunes, particularly to those who had shewn him the smallest kindness when he was distressed at Dehly in his youth, sending for them or their children to his court, and conferring favours upon them beyond their expectation. The people at large, during his life, experienced such care and satisfaction from his gentle administration, as could not be exceeded by the indulgence of a parent; while at the same time the lowest of his officers grew rich in his service. He was intelligent in all affairs; and encouraged the deserving of every profession. Affable in manners, wise in state affairs, courageous as a general, he possessed also every noble quality. When the French general, Bussy, after the death of Nasir Jung*, wrote to him in pompous terms of his victory, and recommended the factory of Chandernagore to his protection, he reflected upon the similarity of disposition between his intended successor, Seraje ad Dowlah, whose enmity to the English he was apprised of, and the unfortunate Soubahdar of the Dekkan; at the same time saying, "He feared that after his death the Europeans would "become masters of many parts of Hindoostan." Mustapha Khan, his principal general, had endeavoured to prevail upon him to expel the English from Calcutta, and seize their wealth;

* Nasir Jung was Nizam of the Dekkan. He was surprised and slain in a conspiracy of his nobles, assisted by the French, in the year 1755.

Digitized by Google

but receiving no answer to his advice, urged it again, through the Nuwab's nephews, Nuazish Mohammed and Sayid Ahmed. Aly Verdy Khan returned no answer: but shortly after said, in private, to the latter, "My child, Mustapha Khan is a soldier, "and wishes us to be constantly in need of his service; but "how came you to join in his request? What have the English "done against me, that I should use them ill? It is now "difficult to extinguish fire on land; but should the sea be "in flames, who can put them out†? Never listen to such advice "as his, for the result would probably be fatal."

In consequence of these sentiments, the Europeans were little molested during his government; and were permitted to carry on their commerce, according to the tenor of the Firmāns they had received from the Emperor Ferrokhsere or from former governors, upon making the usual presents. The zemindars were so well pleased with his conduct, that during the war with the Mahrattas they advanced him a crore and a half of rupees, a circumstance unprecedented in Oriental history. It does not appear that he ever remitted any part of the revenues to Dehly‡; but the frequent invasions of the Mahrattas may be admitted as an excuse for his conduct.

† An allusion to the fleet.

‡ In the year 1746, Hindoostan was invaded by the Afghans of Cabul, under the command of Ahmed Shah Abdullah; and in the following year, the Emperor Mohammed Shah died: from which period the Monarchs of India have been entirely destitute of power, and their Governors of provinces have assumed independence. See *Dow's* and *Scott's Histories*, 2d vols.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

NUWAB, MUNSOOR AL MOOLK, SERAJE AD DOWLAH, SHAH COOLY KHAN, MIRZA MAHMOOD, HYBET JUNG, BEHADUR.

Origin of Seraje ad Dowlah—His character—Adopted by Aly Verdy Khan, and declared his heir—Seraje ad Dowlah causes Hussein Addeen and Hussein Cooly Khan to be murdered—Nuazish Mohammed, and Sayid Ahmed, the uncles of Seraje ad Dowlah, die, both extremely rich—Aly Verdy Khan gives the foujedary of Purneah to his grandson, Shokut Jung—Death of Aly Verdy Khan—Seraje ad Dowlah takes possession of the government—Sends a party to sequester the wealth of his uncle, Nuazish, and dispossesses his aunt of the palace of Mooty-jeel—Threatens Rajbullub, Deputy-governor of Dacca—Turns many of the old officers out of their employments, and appoints his own favourites—Shokut Jung plots against his Cousin, and solicits the Vizier to confer the government of Bengal on him—Seraje ad Dowlah marches towards Purneah—Stopped at Rajemahel, in consequence of intelligence received from Calcutta—returns to Cossimbazar, and takes possession of the English factory—Proceeds towards Calcutta—The English endeavour to avert his anger, but in vain—They enlist 1500 *native matchlock-men, and enrol the militia to defend the fort—The Nuwab arrives at Calcutta—Description of Fort William—The Nuwab's troops storm the outposts, and get possession of the houses near the fort—Mr. Drake defends the fort for some time with great resolution; but, finding there was no hope of holding out, retires on board a ship—Mr. Holwell takes the command of the fort—Endeavours to procure a ship, to take off the garrison, but is disappointed—Writes a letter to Manickchund, Foujedar of Hoogly, to intercede with the Nuwab—A flag of truce sent by the Nuwab; but while the garrison were employed in listening to the messenger, the Nuwab's troops escalade and enter the fort—The English lay down their arms—The Nuwab enters the fort—Severely reprimands Mr. Holwell—Description of the interior of the fort—The English prisoners forced into the Black Hole; and out of* 146 *persons,* 123 *die during the night—Mr. Holwell again summoned to the Nuwab; threatened with further punishment if he did not disclose*

Digitized by Google

where the Company's treasure was hidden—The name of Calcutta changed to Alynagur—Manickchund left with 3000 men to guard it—The Nuwab levies a fine from the French and Dutch—Returns to Moorshudabad—Writes an order to his Cousin, Shokut Jung, who refuses obedience to it, and returns a letter of defiance—The Nuwab takes the field—Orders Raja Mohun Loll to cross the river and invade Purneah from the east, while Ramnarain, deputy-governor of Behar, should attack it on the west—Character of the two Cousins—Shokut Jung forms an entrenched camp, but neglects to give the requisite orders to his troops—Joins the camp, but disgusts the officers by his conduct—Seraje ad Dowlah's army approaches, and commences a cannonade—Advice given by an old officer to Shokut Jung—The commander of artillery advances his guns beyond the morass—Shokut Jung orders his cavalry to cross the morass, and attack the enemy—Retires to his tent—Alarmed by intelligence of the success of the enemy—Mounts his elephant—Killed by a musquet ball, and his army routed—Mohun Loll advances to Purneah, and seizes the property and family of the deceased—Gives charge of the district to his son—Seraje ad Dowlah returns to Moorshudabad—Affairs of the English resumed—Mr. Drake, with those who had escaped from Calcutta, proceeds to Fulta—Sends an express to Madras—The Madras government thrown into great consternation—Resolve to make war on the Nuwab of Bengal—Fit out an expedition under the command of Admiral Watson and Colonel Clive—The fleet sails from Madras—Separated during a tedious voyage—Arrives at Fulta—Colonel Clive writes to the Nuwab—Resolves to attack the fort of Budgebudge—The detachment which was landed for that purpose attacked by surprise—A confused engagement ensues—The Nuwab's troops retire—A ship of war silences the guns of Budgebudge; but the assault having been delayed, a drunken sailor takes the fort—The English advance towards Calcutta—The Governor retreats, leaving only a garrison of 500 men—The English retake Fort William and Calcutta—Take Hoogly—Intelligence of the war with France—The number of the French troops at Chandernagore induces the English to make overtures of peace to the Nuwab, which are rejected with disdain—The Nuwab marches from Moorshudabad—Re-crosses the river above

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

Hoogly—Encamps in the vicinity of Calcutta—Colonel Clive attacks his camp—The Nuwab much alarmed—Offers to make peace—A treaty concluded—Terms of the treaty—The Nuwab marches from Calcutta—Alliance offensive and defensive formed—The English resolve to attack Chandernagore—The French apply to the Nuwab to protect them—He orders the English to desist; and sends a reinforcement to Hoogly—The French sink several ships in the channel of the river—The English troops enter the French territory—The ships, with much difficulty, brought opposite the fort—The French capitulate—Part of the garrison make their escape—Reasons why the Nuwab did not assist the French—The troops that had escaped from Chandernagore arrive at Cossimbazar, and are taken under the protection of the Nuwab—Colonel Clive demands their being delivered up to him—The Nuwab much irritated thereby—Orders the French to proceed to Behar—Meer Jaffier, and other conspirators, make overtures to Colonel Clive—These overtures accepted—Seraje ad Dowlah obtains intelligence of the proceedings of the English—Reinforces his army at Plassey—Orders piles to be driven across the river, and sends instructions to Mr. Law to halt at Bhaugulpore—Treaty between Meer Jaffier and the English—The troops march from Calcutta—Colonel Clive writes to the Nuwab, who endeavours to reconcile Meer Jaffier—Orders his army to assemble at Plassey—The English army proceeds up the river, and takes the fort of Cutwa—Letters received from Meer Jaffier—The Colonel calls a council of war—Resolves to cross the river—Informs Meer Jaffier of his intentions—The troops pass the river, and take possession of Plassey grove—The Nuwab encamps close to them—The armies draw out in battle-array—The engagement commences—Meer Muddeen, the Nuwab's general, killed—Seraje ad Dowlah sends for Meer Jaffier, and apologizes for his past conduct—Meer Jaffier advises the troops to be recalled to camp—Sends intelligence of the state of affairs to Colonel Clive—The retreat of the Nuwab's artillery causes much confusion in his camp—The English advance towards the entrenchments—Meer Jaffier's troops attempt to join the English—The Nuwab quits the field—Arrives at Moorshudabad—Escapes from thence, with a few of his women—Embarks on the

Digitized by Google

Ganges—Arrives opposite Rajemahel—Betrayed by a Derveish—Taken prisoner—Sent to Moorshudabad—Put to death by Meeran the son of Jaffier—The English enter the Nuwab's camp—Proceed to Daoodpore—Meeting between Colonel Clive and Meer Jaffier—The English march to Moidapore, in the vicinity of Moorshudabad—Colonel Clive enters the city—Visits Meer Jaffier, and places him on the musnud—Conclusion.

MIRZA MAHMOOD was the eldest son of Zyn Addeen, the youngest of Hajy Ahmed's sons, who married one of Aly Verdy Khan's daughters. He was born at the period that Aly Verdy was appointed to the government of Behar; and who, considering the birth of a grandson at that time as an auspicious event, declared his intention of adopting him as his own child.

The boy was therefore indulged in every caprice of his mind; and, being naturally of a cruel and perverse temper, his vices ripened with his age: as he grew up, he associated with none but infamous and profligate companions; and at their head, used to patrole the streets of Moorshudabad, and insult every person of respectability whom they met. It is scarcely possible that these circumstances could have been concealed from his grandfather: but the old man was so infatuated with the beauty and lively disposition of the youth, that he took no measures to correct his flagitious conduct.

This young man, in the year of the Hejira 1167, Aly Verdy Khan declared to be his successor: he seated him on the musnud, and, having made him the accustomary offerings and gratulations, obliged all the courtiers and officers to do the same; and from that time suffered him to interfere in the government of the provinces, and to make a very bad use of his authority. A. D. 1753.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

In the following year, Seraje ad Dowlah being jealous of the power and influence which his uncle, Nuazish Mohammed, possessed, as Governor of Dacca and the eastern districts, but not daring to extend his arm against him, caused both his deputies, Hussein Addeen, and Hussein Cooly Khan, to be
A. D. 1754. murdered. The former he effected by private assassination, at Dacca; but the latter was openly executed in the streets of Moorshudabad, in his presence. After this event, Nuazish Mohammed appointed Rajbullub (who, under the former government, had been employed as superintendant of the boat establishment at Dacca, and had thereby accumulated much wealth) to be his Deputy-governor of Dacca and the eastern districts.* About this time died Akram ad Dowlah, the younger brother of Seraje ad Dowlah, to whom a posthumous son was born some months after his decease, and was named Murad ad Dowlah. Nuazish Mohammed died at Moorshudabad, on the
Jan. 1756. 13th of Rubby Assany, 1169, much regretted by the poor, to whom he was exceedingly charitable; without leaving any sons. His brother, Sayid Ahmed, departed this life on the month following, being the 25th of Jemmad al Avul, at Purneah; leaving two sons, on the elder of whom had been conferred the title of Shokut Jung. Both of the brothers died extremely rich: the wealth of the former was never publickly ascertained, as it was taken possession of, first by his wife, Gheseety Begum, and was afterwards plundered by Seraje ad Dowlah: but in the

---

* As the subject of this Chapter has been already related by the accurate Mr. Orme, I shall endeavour to render it as concise as the nature of the case will admit; referring my Readers, for more particular information, to that celebrated historian. From his general correctness, I must, however, except his orthography of Oriental names.—Those points on which Mr. Orme was uninformed, are amply supplied by the *Sier al Mutakhereen* and the *Ryaz Assulateen*.

Digitized by Google

treasury of the latter was found sixty-one lacs of rupees, 762,050*l.* sterling, in gold and silver; and the value of his jewels, plate, elephants, &c. amounted to as much more. SECT. VI. A.D. 1756.

Previous to the demise of Sayid Ahmed, the Nuwab had been for some time labouring under a dropsy, and no hopes of his recovery were entertained. Sayid Ahmed had, therefore, made preparations to assert his claim to the succession, in opposition to the determination and will of Aly Verdy Khan: but his premature death left Seraje ad Dowlah without any other rival than his cousin, Shokut Jung; to quiet whom, Aly Verdy Khan bestowed the foujedary of Purneah as a jagier; at the same time, conjuring him to be content with his portion, to live upon amicable terms with all his relations, and to support his father's attendants: but as the youth was of a very similar disposition to Seraje ad Dowlah, and still more ignorant of the world, the advice of his grandfather was little attended to.

Upon the death of Aly Verdy Khan, Seraje ad Dowlah took undisputed possession of the government: and such was the miserable state to which the unfortunate Emperor of Hindoostan, Aalumgeer the Second, was then reduced†, that it is doubtful whether Seraje ad Dowlah ever went through the form of soliciting his confirmation of the appointment. April, 1756.

The first act of his government was to send a party of troops to dispossess his aunt, Gheseety Begum, of the palace of Mootyjeel, and to seize the treasures of her deceased husband, Nuazish Mohammed. These measures he easily effected, although the lady had hired a number of people to defend her against his oppressions. He also demanded a large

† See *Dow's* and *Scott's Histories*—reigns of Ahmed Shah, and Aalumgeer II.

Digitized by Google

SECT VI. A.D. 1756.

sum of money from Rajbullub the Deputy-governor of Dacca, and so alarmed him, that he sent off privately his property and family to Calcutta. He afterwards displaced many of the officers of government, and filled their appointments with young men, the companions of his pleasures. Mohun Loll, a Hindoo, who had been dewan or superintendant of his household, he promoted to be Dewan of the province, and his Prime Minister in all affairs. He conferred also on him the titles of Mahraja (Great Prince), and commander of 5000 horse*. Meer Mudden, another person of mean origin, he appointed Commander-in-chief of his forces. One of the principal persons who had been removed from his office, was Meer Jaffier Khan, the Bukhshy or Paymaster-general. This officer soon exhibited signs of discontent; and leaguing with several others who were disgusted with the infamous conduct of the young Nuwab, entered into a correspondence with Shokut Jung, the Governor of Purneah, and exhorted him to assert his claim to the musnud: the young man readily fell into their measures: but, by the prudent advice of some of his counsellors, he deemed it requisite first to procure from the Court of Dehly a commission, appointing him to the government; he, in consequence, applied to Ghazy Addeen, the Vizier of Aalumgeer the Second, from whom he obtained a promise of the patent he required, on condition of sending annually a crore of rupees to the Imperial treasury†.

---

* All these honours are said to have originated from the Hindoo having presented his sister to Seraje ad Dowlah. She was a lady of the most delicate form, and weighed only 64 lbs. English. He, however, proved himself a faithful servant.

† Mustapha's Translation of the *Sier al Mutakhereen*, p. 729.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

These transactions having been discovered by Seraje ad Dowlah, he placed himself at the head of his troops, and marched towards Purneah; but, upon his arrival at Rajemahel, he was diverted from his purpose, by letters received from Calcutta, respecting the refusal of the English to deliver up Kishen Bullub, the son of Rajbullub, who some months before had left Dacca with his family and property, and had taken refuge at Calcutta: also by intelligence that the English were adding to the fortifications of Fort William, and increasing the strength of the garrison.

This information irritated the Nuwab to a degree of rage which astonished his officers. He instantly changed his resolution of marching to Purneah, and ordered his army to return to Moorshudabad: where he arrived on the 1st of June, and laid siege to the factory of Cossimbazar; the garrison of which consisting only of forty-two men, it was delivered up to him by capitulation, on the fourth day. The terms of the capitulation were, however, immediately broken; and on the 10th of the month of Ramzan, 1169, the Nuwab proceeded towards Calcutta. During this time, letters were daily despatched by the Governor of Calcutta to Mr. Watts, the Chief of Cossimbazar, who was detained as a prisoner by the Nuwab, to offer every apology possible to mitigate his wrath. The good offices of the bankers and principal Moghul merchants were also employed, but all in vain. Seraje ad Dowlah replied, "That Mr. Drake, the Governor, had greivously offended him; "and that he would not suffer the English to remain in his "country on any other terms than were allowed them under "the government of the Nuwab Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan."

June 9, 1756.

In this dilemma, as no hopes of assistance could be

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

expected in time from Madras, Mr. Drake applied to the Dutch at Chinsura, and to the French at Chandernagore, to help him: but the former positively refused; and the latter added insult to the refusal, by desiring the English to abandon Calcutta, and to repair to Chandernagore, where they would protect them.

The English, finding that they had no other resource than in their own exertions, armed all the Europeans, native Portuguese, and Armenians, and took into their service 1500 Hindoo matchlock-men; they also laid in a store of grain and other provisions; and added such works for their defence as the shortness of the time would admit.

Upon the arrival of Seraje ad Dowlah in the vicinity of Chinsura and Chandernagore, he sent letters to the Dutch and French, commanding them to assist him with their forces in his designs against Calcutta: but they pleaded the treaties subsisting between their nations and the English in Europe, as a reason why they could not obey his commands. This refusal he highly resented; but at that time repressed his indignation, lest they should unite with the English.

The Nuwab attacks Calcutta, June 15.

On the 16th of Ramzan, the Nuwab's troops crossed the river at Hoogly, and on the following day came in sight of Calcutta; but not being aware that the Mahratta ditch had never been completed, they were stopped by that part of it which had been excavated to the north of the town, and a temporary advantage was that evening gained by the English.

The factory, or fort, was situated on the bank of the river: its length from east to west was 210 yards: its breadth on the south side was 130 yards, and on the north only 100 yards: it had four bastions, mounting each ten guns; but the

Digitized by Google

curtains were only four feet thick, and the terrace, which was the roof of the store rooms, formed the top of the ramparts: the gateway on the eastern side projected, and mounted five guns; and along the bank of the river was a line of heavy cannon, mounted in embrasures of solid masonry: so that the place might have made a long defence against such an enemy, had not the houses of the principal Europeans, and the church, overlooked and commanded the fort. SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

On the 19th, all the outposts were stormed by the Nuwab's forces; upon which the 1500 matchlock-men, and other native troops in the English service, deserted; whilst the Portuguese and other inhabitants of the town, who had been injudiciously admitted into the fort, caused great confusion and uproar. On the 21st, the besiegers renewed their attacks; and having erected a battery of three guns, began to cannonade the fort; whilst their matchlock-men, and others armed with small pieces, fired from the tops of the houses (which were all flat-roofed) upon the garrison. June 18.

Mr. Drake, the Governor, although not a military man, had not betrayed any signs of personal fear, but exposed his person on the ramparts, and wherever his presence was thought requisite, until he received intelligence that the remaining gunpowder in the magazine was damp and unfit for service: when, finding that there was no chance of much longer defending the place, and being very apprehensive of the resentment of the Nuwab, who had threatened to put him to death, he embarked on board a boat, and in a short time was conveyed on board one of the ships which were then anchored at Govindpore, nearly three miles down the river. The

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

example of the Governor was immediately followed by all those who could get on board the ships.

After this abandonment, the number of Europeans remaining in the fort were 190 persons, at the head of whom was Mr. Holwell, one of the members of Council; who, in order to prevent further desertion, directed the gate towards the river to be locked and guarded. It was however his intention to have embarked, with the remainder of the garrison, on board a ship which was still anchored above the fort. For this purpose, he sent orders to the captain to bring her close to the fort, as soon as the ebb-tide would permit: unfortunately, the ship, on her way down, struck on a sand-bank, where the crew, being exposed to the fire of the enemy from the tops of the houses, were obliged to abandon her.

The garrison continued to defend themselves with great vigour during the whole of that day and night; and made many signals to the ships anchored at Govindpore to return and take them on board, as all the boats had been either lost or carried away by the natives; but in this last expectation of relief they were disappointed, for not a single vessel moved to their assistance.

June 20.

On the 21st of Ramzan, the Nuwab's troops recommenced their attack with fresh vigour: and whilst some of the garrison exposed themselves with undaunted resolution, others were entreating Mr. Holwell to capitulate; who, to calm the minds of those who desponded, threw a letter from the rampart—written by Omichund, a Hindoo merchant of consequence, whom the English had, together with Kishenbullub, detained as prisoners on the approach of the Nuwab's army—addressed

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1756.

to Manickchund, the Foujedar of Hoogly, who commanded a body of troops before the fort, requesting him to intercede with the Nuwab to cease hostilities, as the English were ready to obey his commands, and only persisted in defending the fort to preserve their lives and honour. The letter was immediately taken up: but for many hours no answer was returned, whilst the enemy continued to push on the attack with vigour. At four o'clock in the evening a person was observed advancing to the fort with a flag of truce, which Mr. Holwell answered with another from the south-east bastion. A parley ensued, during which many of the Nuwab's troops approached to the walls of the fort, and endeavoured to escalade it; at the same time some of the soldiers of the garrison, having broken open the arrack cellars, had intoxicated themselves, and forced open the gate next the river-side, with an intention of seizing on whatever boats they could find, and of proceeding to the ships: just as they opened the gate, a party of the enemy, who had also got on that side, met them, and at once rushed into the fort; another party at the same moment mounted the walls of the warehouses. In this scene of confusion no resistance was made; and the English having surrendered their arms, the Nuwab's troops refrained from bloodshed.

Fort William taken.

At five o'clock on the 22d of Rāmzan, Seraje ad Dowlah, attended by Meer Jaffier, whom he had again restored to his office, and several other officers, entered the fort. He immediately ordered Omichund and Kishenbullub to be brought before him, and received them with civility. He next directed some of his officers to go and take possession of the Company's treasury: he then proceeded to the principal room of the factory, where he sat in state, and received the congratulations

June 21.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

of his courtiers on the important conquest. He soon after sent for Mr. Holwell: and expressed much resentment at the presumption of the English, in daring to defend the fort; and great dissatisfaction at the smallness of the sum found in the treasury, which did not exceed 50,000 rupees. Mr. Holwell had two other conferences with him on this subject before seven o'clock, when the Nuwab dismissed him with assurances of safety.

Mr. Holwell returning to his unfortunate companions, found them surrounded by a strong guard: he also perceived that several places in the fort had by accident been set on fire, and that the flames approached, on both sides, the spot on which they stood. On each side of the eastern gate of the fort extended a range of chambers, the roofs of which formed the rampart of the eastern curtain; and before the chambers was an arched verandah or gallery, which was intended to shelter the soldiers from sun and rain, but, being very low, obstructed the light and air from the chambers. The prisoners were at first ordered to draw up in the verandah: but the officer commanding the guard, not thinking they would be sufficiently secure there, inquired where was the prison of the fort; and one of the chambers before mentioned, which was used as the Black-hole, to confine disorderly soldiers, being pointed out to him, he, without examining the extent of the apartment, forced them all into it. The door was immediately closed and locked; and 146 persons were thus confined, in the month of June, and in the torrid zone, in a room not twenty feet square, with only two small windows to admit air. For the detail of the horrid sufferings of these unfortunate persons, the reader is referred to the historian mentioned in the beginning of this Chapter: suffice

Sufferings of Mr. Holwell and his companions.

Digitized by Google

say, that out of one hundred and forty-six persons, only twenty-three survived the fatal night; and these were so reduced they could barely stand*. SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

Mr. Holwell was carried to the Nuwab, who, so far from shewing any compassion for his situation, or remorse for the death of the other prisoners, only talked to him of the treasures which the English had buried, and threatened him with further punishment if he did not disclose where they were.

To perpetuate the memory of this conquest, the Nuwab ordered the name of Calcutta to be changed to Alynagur; and leaving a garrison in it of 3000 men, under the command of Manickchund, the Foujedar of Hoogly, he proceeded, on the 3d of Shual, towards Moorshudabad†. 2d of July.

As soon as his army had recrossed the river at Hoogly, he sent detachments to the French and Dutch settlements, threatening to extirpate them, as he had done the English, unless they would immediately pay him a large sum of money; but after receiving many assurances of their submission to his will, he consented to accept from the Dutch four lacs and a half of rupees, and from the French three and a half; which difference,

* For the credit of human-nature, we would fain believe the assertions of the native historians, who say the Nuwab knew nothing of this transaction; and that the conduct of the officer who confined them proceeded entirely from stupidity, and not from malevolence or cruelty.

† The capture of Fort William, and the sufferings of its inhabitants, strongly evince the fallacy of all human speculations. For nearly a century, it had been the constant object of the East-India Company to procure a fortification on the Ganges for the protection of their servants and property: had they never obtained it, the catastrophe would not have happened. On the other hand, the Nuwab supposed, that, from the capture of the fort, and the destruction of the garrison, he had rendered his government secure, and expelled the English from the country: whereas that very circumstance drew on him the vengeance of an inveterate foe, caused his death, and transferred the government to the hands of strangers.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756. it is said, he made because the latter had supplied him with two hundred barrels of gunpowder, as he was marching towards Calcutta.

July 11. On his arrival at Moorshudabad, he issued orders commanding the sequestration of all the effects and merchandise belonging to the English in all parts of his dominions. However, finding that no discoveries could be obtained concerning the treasures which he supposed to be buried in Calcutta, he, in compliance with the intercession of the widow of Aly Verdy Khan, released Mr. Holwell and the other English prisoners.

Soon after Seraje ad Dowlah's return to Moorshudabad, he, in order to try the allegiance of his cousin, appointed a person named Rasbehary to the foujedary of Birnagur in Purneah, and ordered Shokut Jung to put him immediately in possession of the office. Nothing could exceed the rage of Shokut Jung on the receipt of the order: he directed the bearer of it to be beaten: he then called for the Vizier's letter containing the promise of the patent; and having caused it to be read aloud in open court, commanded one of his secretaries to write a letter to the following purport. "Know, that I have received from "the Imperial Court the commission of Governor of the three "provinces. On account of our family connection, I have no "wish to do you any personal injury; and you may make choice "of any of the Eastern districts for your residence, where you "shall receive an ample allowance; but I desire that you will "immediately quit Moorshudabad, and do not presume to take "with you any of the treasure, or other valuables. Send me an "answer quickly, as I am waiting with one foot in the stirrup."

This letter would have irritated a less passionate man than Seraje ad Dowlah. He issued his commands for his army imme-

Digitized by Google

diately to take the field; and sent orders to Raja Ramnarain, whom Aly Verdy Khan had made Deputy-governor of Behar, to assemble his forces, and, having crossed the river, to enter Purneah. His own army marched in two divisions; that under his immediate command proceeded on the south-west side of the Ganges to Rajemahel; while the other, under the orders of Raja Mohun Loll, crossed that river at Surdah, and marched towards the appointed place on the north-east side.

Whilst these two young men were actually engaged in hostilities against each other, they could not restrain the violence and perverseness of their dispositions: they each of them gave offence to the old officers, who had long served under their fathers or grandfather: and though neither of them was capable of directing even his own domestics, they would not listen to the advice of the sensible persons in their courts, who were sincere well-wishers of their family, respecting the government of the countries under their charge, but consulted only the rash and profligate beings of their own creation. Such conduct induced the author of the *Sier Mutakhereen*, although a relation of the family, to say: "It having been decreed by "Providence that the guilty race of Aly Verdy Khan should "be deprived of a dominion that had cost so much toil in "acquiring, it was for a time consigned to the hands of two "young men, Seraje ad Dowlah, and Shokut Jung; both "equally vain, cruel, and incapable of government; and who, "by their flagitious conduct, shortly caused the flames of "destruction to burst forth from the edifice erected by their "progenitor."

When Shokut Jung was informed of the advance of Seraje ad Dowlah, he ordered his officers to fix on a proper

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. October, A. D. 1756.

spot for the rendezvous of his army, where he might be able to oppose his adversary with the greatest effect. Some of the officers who had served under his father, and possessed good abilities, selected a situation near Nuwabgunge, on the confines of Purneah, which was strong by nature, and might easily be defended against a superior force: it was covered in front by deep morasses of many miles extent, across which there was only one causeway; whilst the rear of the position, being open to a productive country, insured an ample supply of provisions to the camp. In drawing up the troops, however, the greatest irregularity was practised; for as Shokut Jung knew nothing of the matter himself, and would not entrust the command to any other person, the commandant of each corps encamped in what he considered the most convenient situation; thus parts of the army which was not very numerous were separated by an interval of four miles: and Shokut Jung, instead of daily reviewing the troops, did not join the army till the advanced parties of the enemy appeared in sight.

At length Shokut Jung came to the camp: he was attended by a body-guard of cavalry which he had raised himself, another corps of horse commanded by his brother, and a regiment of 1000 matchlock-men. As soon as he arrived, the principal officers waited on him to pay their respects; but even at that time, instead of ingratiating himself with them by his complaisance, he added to their disgust by the moroseness of his behaviour; nor would he give them any orders for their conduct, but desired them to return to their respective encampments, and there await his commands. About nine o'clock, the division of Seraje

Digitized by Google

ad Dowlah's army, under the command of Raja Mohun Loll and Meer Jaffier, came in sight, but drew up at a very considerable distance, whence they commenced a cannonade. The balls of the smaller pieces fell into the lake or morass, but those of the heavy guns lodged in the camp; and one of them passing near Shokut Jung, he was much alarmed, and ordered the standards and other insignia of his rank to be lowered down. An old Afghan officer, who had seen much service, and was standing near, said, "My lord and master, "what kind of a battle is this? I never saw any thing like "it, when I served in the Dekkan, under Nizam al Moolk: "this is not the way: here every man does as he pleases. The "army should be drawn out in lines, and ranged in battle-array; "and the artillery should be placed in front: the troops must "be united in compact bodies, and act together: then only "can victory be expected." Shokut Jung took this remonstrance very ill. He abused Nizam al Moolk as a blockhead, and said, "I have no occasion to be taught what I am to do, for "I have myself fought three hundred battles." SECT. VI. A.D. 1756.

In the meantime, Sham Sunder, the Hindoo commander of the artillery, who was possessed of much bravery but no experience, finding that his guns would not reach those of the enemy, quitted his entrenchment behind the morass, and advanced over the causeway to the other side, where he commenced a cannonade. On seeing this, Shokut Jung sent orders to the cavalry also to cross the morass and attack the enemy. The commanders of the cavalry remonstrated, that he was giving up the advantages of his situation; and that he should wait the attack; as whoever crossed the morass must engage to great disadvantage. He sent them another message,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756.

that they were a set of cowards: that they ought to take example by Sham Sunder, who although a Hindoo *scribe*, was bravely pouring his balls into the ranks of the enemy, while they talked of prudence and caution. These taunts provoked the commanders of the cavalry, and they ordered their men to mount and to cross the lake.

It being then about three o'clock in the day, Shokut Jung, having taken his inebriating draught, retired to his tent, to amuse himself with the songs of his women. After some time, intelligence was brought to him, that the cavalry, having waded through the mud, were engaged with the enemy, who had killed a number of them, and were pressing on the artillery. At this time he was so much intoxicated that he could not sit erect: but as his presence was requisite to encourage the troops, some of the officers placed him on his elephant, with a servant to support him; and caused the driver to advance towards the causeway, where in a short time a musquet-ball struck Shokut Jung in the forehead, and sent his soul to the other world. On beholding this event, the rout became general, and every man made the best of his way to Purneah. The troops of Seraje ad Dowlah, having had a long march that day, did not pursue: but two days after, Raja Mohun Loll entered Purneah, and took possession of all the wealth and property of Shokut Jung; which he despatched, with the women and children belonging to the deceased, or of his father Sayid Ahmed, to Moorshudabad. He then regulated the country: and, having placed his own son in charge of Purneah, he went to join his master, who had not proceeded further than Rajemahel. Seraje ad Dowlah, however, assumed great merit from

Digitized by Google

this conquest, and returned with great pomp and rejoicing to Moorshudabad. SECT. VI.

It now becomes requisite to revert to the affairs of the English.

Affairs of the English Company, June 1756.

It has been before stated, that Mr. Drake, the Governor of Calcutta, having, with part of the garrison, effected his escape to the ships which were anchored at Govindpore, as soon as he found the fort was in possession of the enemy, proceeded down the river to Fulta, where he was joined by several vessels coming from sea: the Company's agents, likewise, from the subordinate factories at Dacca, Jugdea, and other places, having, on the first alarm, escaped from those situations, resorted to the fleet. For some time no provisions could be procured: but as soon as the Nuwab's army left Calcutta, the country people ventured to supply them. The want of convenient shelter, and the fear of being surprised, obliged them all to sleep on board the vessels; which were so much crowded, that all lay promiscuously on the decks, without shelter from the heavy rain of the season; and the lower part of Bengal, between the arms of the Ganges, being perhaps one of the most unhealthy countries in the world, a malignant fever shortly broke out amongst them, from which none of the ships were exempted.

Mr. Drake having resolved to remain in that situation till he should receive orders from Madras, had early in July despatched Mr. Manningham in a small vessel to the coast. Upon the arrival of that gentleman at Madras, the government of Fort St. George, which had just received intelligence of the breaking out of a war with France, were overwhelmed with regret and astonishment; but, after some time spent in debate and consultation, they at length, in concert with Admiral

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1756. Watson, the commander-in-chief of his Majesty's ships in India, resolved to make war on the Nuwab of Bengal; and not only to compel him to restore Calcutta and the other factories, but to make him pay for the losses the Company had sustained, and all the expenses of the war.

As soon as this point was determined, a quick-sailing sloop was despatched to Mr. Drake, to inform him of the intentions of the Madras government, and to desire him to take such steps as he thought might conduce to the success of the enterprise.

The English, under Adm. Watson and Col. Clive, make war on the Nuwab.

Notwithstanding all the exertions of Governor Pigot and Admiral Watson, it was the month of October before the expedition could be equipped: it consisted of three line-of-battle ships, one of fifty and one of twenty guns, with a fire-ship, and three of the Company's vessels and two smaller transports. The land-forces consisted of 900 European soldiers, and 1500 Sepoys, under the command of the celebrated Colonel Clive. The Colonel carried letters, written by Salabut Jung the Soubahdar of the Dekkan, Mohammed Aly the Nuwab of Arcot, and Governor Pigot, exhorting Seraje ad Dowlah to make reparation to the English for the injuries they had suffered from his unprovoked hostility. The instructions to Colonel Clive recommended the attack of Moorshudabad itself, if the Nuwab continued obstinate; and the capture of the French settlement of Chandernagore, if news of the war should arrive whilst the troops remained in Bengal.

The fleet sailed from Madras the 16th of October; but as the north-west monsoon had by that time set in, they were obliged to cross the Bay of Bengal, and to beat up against it, along the western shore: by this adverse circumstance, half

Digitized by Google

the fleet was separated, and the remainder were six weeks in making the voyage, which at a favourable season is done in six or seven days; and it was the 20th of December before they could reach Fulta, and even then with the absence of two of the vessels of most consequence; viz. the Cumberland of seventy guns, on which was embarked 250 of the best soldiers; and the Marlborough, the Company's ship, on which had been embarked all the field artillery. Upon the arrival of the expedition at Fulta, Colonel Clive sent the letters he had brought from Madras to Manickchund, the governor of Calcutta, accompanied by one from himself and the Admiral; but the latter being couched in threatening and indecorous terms, the Governor refused to forward it.

On the 27th of December the whole fleet got under weigh, and on the following day reached Myapore, ten miles below Budgebudge. Colonel Clive having resolved to attack that fort, landed his men during the night, and some hours before day, of the 29th, commenced his march; but the roads being excessively bad, and the guide, having led them astray, the sun had been risen above an hour before they reached the vicinity of the fort: it therefore became requisite to allow the troops some time to rest themselves; and as no suspicion was entertained of there being any armed force, except the garrison, in that neighbourhood, the usual precautions of posting picquets and sentries were not observed. In a short time, the men, being much fatigued, fell asleep: in this situation they were attacked by Manickchund, governor of Calcutta, with 1500 cavalry and 2000 infantry; and if the former had done their duty, might have cut off the English to a man.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

A. D. 1756. A scene of great confusion ensued; but the English, having at length opened their field-pieces, and directed them towards Manickchund, who was rendered very conspicuous by being mounted on an elephant, and one of the balls passing close to his head, he was alarmed, and gave the signal for a general retreat. About this time, the Kent, of sixty-four guns, having anchored opposite the fort, quickly silenced the cannon thereof; but the troops being much fatigued, it was determined to delay the assault till next morning: as soon, however, as it was dark, the garrison abandoned the place; and in the night, one of the sailors, having got drunk, straggled to the ditch, which he crossed, and climbed up the rampart; where finding no person, he called out, to the nearest English guard, that he had taken the fort.

On the 30th of December the fleet took possession of the forts of Aly Ghur and Tanna, without any opposition.

In the meantime, Manickchund, the governor of Calcutta and Hoogly, having been much alarmed by the engagement at Budgebudge, hastened to meet the Nuwab, leaving only a garrison of 500 men in Calcutta.

The English retake Fort-William and Calcutta.

On the 1st of January, Colonel Clive, with the greatest part of the troops, landed, and marched along the high road from Aly Ghur to Calcutta; but the ships, having reached the

A. D. 1757. fort some time before him, in two hours compelled the garrison to retreat: it was then taken possession of by Captain Coote, with a detachment from the ships; and on the following day Mr. Drake was restored to his government.

On the 4th of the month, a detachment, consisting of 150 Europeans and 200 Sepoys, was embarked on board the twenty-gun ship, a sloop of war, and three other vessels, and

Digitized by Google

proceeded to the attack of Hoogly. Owing to the twenty-gun ship striking on a sand-bank, it was the 10th before they reached their destination. The troops were then landed; and the ships having in a few hours made a breach, it was stormed, and the garrison, consisting of 2000 men, made a precipitate retreat.

About this time intelligence reached Calcutta, that war had been declared between France and Great Britain, in the preceding month of May. As there were 300 soldiers and a good train of field artillery in Chandernagore, the Governor and Council of Calcutta were very apprehensive that the French would immediately join the Nuwab, with whom it was thought the English force would not then be able to contend. In this persuasion, they determined to open a negotiation for peace: accordingly, Colonel Clive wrote a letter to the bankers of Moorshudabad, named Seat, and to Omichund the Calcutta merchant, requesting them to act as mediators.

It is probable, that if these overtures had been made previous to the capture of Hoogly, they would have been attended to; but after that event, the Nuwab was so exasperated, that he vowed vengeance against the English; and even his most favourite courtiers durst not mention to him the subject of peace; whilst his secret enemies were anxious to see him embroiled with a foe, through whose assistance they might hope for a revolution.

The Nuwab therefore, after the usual delay of Eastern courts, commenced his march, with a numerous army, for Calcutta; and on the 30th of January recrossed the river, about ten miles above Hoogly.

In the meantime, the English had not been negligent in making preparations to oppose his progress. They withdrew

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

their troops from Hoogly; and fortified a camp, with several out-posts around it, a mile to the north of Calcutta, and half a mile from the bank of the river. There was, however, a space left unguarded of nearly two miles, between the right flank of the camp and the salt-water lake: through this opening the Nuwab passed with his army, and encamped with his own troops withinside of the Mahratta ditch; but the greater part of his forces lay between the Mahratta ditch and the lake.

The proximity of so large a force determined Colonel Clive to make an attack upon the Nuwab's camp at midnight. The troops destined for this enterprise were 600 sailors, armed with musquets; the European battalion, consisting of 650 rank and file; 100 artillery-men, with six field-pieces; and 800 Sepoys; but as there were neither horses nor bullocks with the army, the guns were dragged, and the ammunition carried, by *Lascars* and sailors. A little before dawn of day the English line entered the Nuwab's camp, and commenced firing to the right and left; but a thick fog coming on, they lost the road, and wandered about the encampment for several hours, without effecting any thing of consequence, and returned to their own camp about noon.

The Nuwab was however so much alarmed, that the day after he moved his camp several miles distant; and desired Runjeet Roy, the agent of the Seats, who attended him on the expedition, to write to Colonel Clive that he was willing to enter into a negotiation. In consequence of this communication, several messages were brought and carried by Omichund and Runjeet Roy; and on the 9th of February a treaty was concluded*.

* See Appendix.

Digitized by Google

On the 11th, the Nuwab removed a few miles further off, and sent *khelaats*, or dresses of honour, to the Admiral and Colonel Clive; and through his agents, Omichund and Runjeet Roy, proposed an alliance, offensive and defensive, against all enemies. This proposal was accepted without hesitation, and the treaty was ratified and sent back the same day.

At the request of the Nuwab, a party of twenty artillery-men was sent to him, as an escort; and Mr. Watts was appointed to reside at his court. This business being settled, the Nuwab proceeded towards Moorshudabad.

It has been before stated, that when Colonel Clive took charge of the expedition, he was instructed by the Madras government, that should intelligence arrive, whilst he was in Bengal, of the actual commencement of hostilities between the French and English, he should endeavour to seize upon the French settlement of Chandernagore. The above intelligence did arrive while the English army were employed in the capture of Hoogly; but so formidable was the French force at Chandernagore, that, instead of attacking it, the Governor and Council of Calcutta were very apprehensive that the French would join the Nuwab.

But as soon as peace was concluded between the Nuwab and the English, and the treaty of alliance offensive and defensive ratified, the latter, through their agent Omichund, asked his permission to attack Chandernagore. This application appears to have been quite unexpected by the Nuwab, and very contrary to his inclinations: but as he was afraid of another rupture with the English, he declined giving any orders on the subject. Colonel Clive therefore determined to prosecute the enterprise; and on the 18th of February crossed the river,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

a few miles above Calcutta, and encamped on the opposite shore.

Previous to this overt act of hostility, the French had obtained intelligence of Colonel Clive's designs; and immediately sent letters to the Nuwab, as he valued his own safety to protect their settlement. Their messengers overtook him at Aguadeep, a town forty miles south of Moorshudabad; where he halted, and immediately wrote a letter peremptorily commanding the English to desist from their intention. He also sent to the French a present of 100,000 rupees, and directed Nuncomar, the Governor of Hoogly, to assist them. He also directed a reinforcement to be sent from his army to Hoogly. All these circumstances he afterwards denied; and Colonel Clive, finding him so wavering in his disposition, after a considerable delay occasioned by objections and scruples on the part of Admiral Watson, gave orders for the attack of Chandernagore.

The principal difficulty in this undertaking was, to get the ships of war up the river; for the French had taken the precaution of sinking several vessels laden with bricks in the channel: but by the assistance of a Monsieur Terrano, a deserter, who pointed out the places where the vessels were sunk, and the extreme precaution and skill of Captain Speke, the difficulty was overcome.

On the 14th of March, the English army entered the French territory, and commenced hostilities: but the attack on the fort did not commence till the 22d; when the batteries having been completed, and two of the ships destined for the attack, viz. the Kent of 64 and the Tiger of 60, (for the Salisbury could not gain her station,) being anchored opposite the fort, the contest began at sun-rise, by the fire from the two batteries on the land

Digitized by Google

side, which was shortly followed by that from the ships. The cannonade was very fierce on both parts, as the garrison fought with great bravery; but at nine o'clock the French hung out a flag of truce, and at three Chandernagore was taken. During the time that messages were passing concerning the terms of surrender, a part of the garrison marched away, to offer their services to the Nuwab.

Chandernagore taken.

In order to account for Seraje ad Dowlah's having thus abandoned the French to their fate, it is requisite to state, that about this period the Afghans of Cabul, under their king Ahmed Shah Abdally, again invaded Hindoostan, and, by the invitation of Aalumgeer the Second, came to Dehly, to rescue him out of the power of his servants*; and it was reported that Abdally intended to pay the Eastern provinces a visit, and to call the Governors to account for the many years' revenue they had neglected to send to the Imperial treasury.

This circumstance was taken hold of by the partisans of the English, and the other enemies of the Nuwab, to work upon his fears, and to prevent him from doing that which was so obviously his interest; for, at this time, Meer Jaffier Khan, Roy Dullub the Dewan, the Seats, and Gheseety Begum, were all so disgusted with Seraje ad Dowlah's conduct, that they were anxious for an opportunity of deposing him.

The part of the garrison which had escaped from Chandernagore reached the French factory at Cossimbazar in safety, and were immediately taken under the Nuwab's protection. On this, Colonel Clive wrote to him, to demand not only their being delivered up, but also that the English should be allowed

* See *Dow's Hindoostan*, vol. II. Reign of Aalumgeer the Second.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

to take possession of the French factory at Cossimbazar. So bold a demand provoked Seraje ad Dowlah to an excess of passion, and he threatened Mr. Watts with instant death; but soon recollecting the imprudence of this threat, which would doubtless bring on him the vengeance of the English, and being at the same time solicitous of preserving the French for future contingencies, he furnished Mr. Law, the chief of the Cossimbazar factory, with money, arms, and ammunition; and ordered him to march, with all his men, as if proceeding to Patna, but with a promise of recalling him, should his services be required.

Mr. Law, who appears to have been well acquainted with the politics of Moorshudabad, told the Nuwab, that most of his chiefs were dissatisfied with him, that they were leaguing with the English against him, and that, on the departure of the French, the smothered flame would burst forth and destroy him. Seraje ad Dowlah felt the truth of his observation, but had not resolution to detain him: he however promised to send for him, should any thing occur: but Mr. Law prophetically said, "I know we shall never meet again." Accordingly, this body of adventurers, consisting of 100 Europeans, sixty Coromandel sepoys, with thirty small carriages and four elephants, passed through Moorshudabad on the 16th of April, and, having crossed the river, proceeded towards Behar.

By this time, the mutual suspicions between the Nuwab and the English were so much increased, that Colonel Clive thought a rupture inevitable, and therefore determined to send a detachment in pursuit of the French; but before he had time to carry his resolution into effect, he received intelligence from Mr. Watts, that the conspirators had made overtures to

Digitized by Google

him. The person first employed in this negotiation was named Yar Luttief Khan, an officer who commanded 2000 horse in the service of Seraje ad Dowlah, but who received a monthly allowance from the Seats, to defend them against any act of oppression, even from the Nuwab. This overture seems to have been made merely to sound the disposition of the English, but was soon after followed by a specific proposal from Meer Jaffier Khan. It stated, that being in daily fear of his life, he was, from self-defence, compelled to take measures for deposing the Nuwab; that he was well supported by the Dewan Roy Dullub, Gheseety Begum, the Seats, and many principal officers of the army; and had no doubt of success, if the English would join him: and that for such assistance he would recompense them in the most ample manner, and grant them every privilege, with regard to trade, that they might desire. SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

The Governor and Council of Calcutta considered the proposal made by Meer Jaffier as the most fortunate event which could happen; as, in the embarrassed and perplexed state of their affairs, it was impossible for them to make any advances of money on account of the Company's mercantile concerns, or to re-establish their subordinate factories: they therefore directed Mr. Watts to carry on the negotiation, with the assistance of Omichund the merchant; on whose fidelity, as he had a large property in houses in Calcutta, they thought they might depend.

In the mean time, Seraje ad Dowlah received intelligence, from his spies, that the English were making military preparations; and suspecting that they intended to march towards Moorshudabad, he ordered the division of his army which was encamped near Plassey to be reinforced; and believing that the English ships of war might proceed up the eastern branch of

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

the Ganges, to the northern point of the Cossimbazar island, and come down the Bhagarutty to Moorshudabad, he commanded immense piles to be driven in the river at Sooty, by which the passage of that river has been rendered merely navigable by boats, and that only during half the year. He also commanded Mr. Law to halt, with the French detachment, at Bhaugulpore, and directed his Aumils to supply them with every thing they required. He further endeavoured to ingratiate himself again with Meer Jaffier and other officers; and they, in order to cover their designs, frequented his court as formerly, and flattered him by their attention.

After a great deal of intrigue, and much personal risk to Mr. Watts, the Resident at the Nuwab's court, the annexed treaty, written in Persian, was signed and sworn to by Meer Jaffier Khan*.

On the 10th of June, the treaty was brought to Calcutta; and by some inadvertency the circumstance became known. Colonel Clive therefore found it requisite either to relinquish the confederacy, and abandon the conspirators to their fate, or to commence hostilities without delay. On the 12th, the troops which were at Calcutta, with 150 sailors from the squadron, proceeded and joined that part of the army which was quartered at Chandernagore. All the necessary preparations having been previously made, the whole army marched from Chandernagore on the following day, leaving a hundred sailors to garrison that place. The Europeans and artillery proceeded by water, on board of two hundred large boats; and the sepoys marched by a road which ran near the river side.

* See Appendix.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.

June 1757.

Upon the boats approaching Hoogly, the Governor refused to let them pass; but the 20-gun ship coming up, and anchoring before the fort, together with a threatening letter sent to him by Colonel Clive, induced him to forego his intention, and the fleet passed on.

As soon as the army had passed Hoogly, the Colonel sent away two of the Nuwab's messengers, who were in his camp, with a letter; accusing his Highness of not having fulfilled the treaty of February; and of having invited and given encouragement to the French, and oppressed and insulted the English. He concluded by saying, he was on his way to Moorshudabad, to demand justice.

Previous to the delivery of this letter, the Nuwab had received some confused intelligence of the intrigues of Meer Jaffier, and resolved to seize him: for this purpose, he ordered a party of troops to surround his house; and many messages of threats and defiance passed between them. As soon, however, as the Nuwab was informed of the march of the English troops, and the desertion of Mr. Watts, he was overwhelmed with astonishment and dismay; but hoping still to be able to detach Meer Jaffier from his confederacy with the English, he revoked the orders he had given for attacking him, and employed several officers to bring about a reconciliation between them. But Meer Jaffier continuing long untractable, and refusing to visit the Nuwab, the latter got into his palanquin, and, attended by a small retinue, proceeded to Meer Jaffier's house. This visit produced an agreement, sanctified, as usual, by mutual oaths on the Koran. Jaffier promised neither to join or give assistance to the English in the impending contest; and the Nuwab agreed to permit him, as soon as peace should

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. June 1757.

be restored, to depart with his family and wealth, wherever he chose to go.

The Nuwab, the day following this interview, ordered his whole army, in which was included the troops of Meer Jaffier, to assemble, with the utmost diligence, in the vicinity of Plassey; and sent orders to Mr. Law, who was waiting with his party at Bhaugulpore, to come to his assistance with the utmost expedition.

The English army arrived and halted on the 16th at Puttolee, a village where the high road to Moorshudabad, on the south side of the river, terminates; but as it was then the rainy season, and the greater part of the army proceeded by water, it was still requisite to keep by the river side, and to pass the fort of Cutwa, famous for the defeat of the Mahrattas by Aly Verdy Khan. The Governor of this place was in the interest of Meer Jaffier, and had promised to surrender it after a pretended resistance: Major Coote was therefore sent forward on the 17th, with 200 Europeans, 500 sepoys, one field-piece, and a small mortar, to summon the fort; but on the Major's arrival at Cutwa, he found the Governor had changed his mind: it therefore became necessary to attack it, and orders were accordingly given: but as soon as the garrison saw the troops advancing, they set fire to the mat buildings in the fort, and absconded. The main body of the English army arrived in the evening at Cutwa, and encamped on the plain; but on that night the rains set in with such violence, that the troops were obliged to take shelter in the town and adjacent villages.

Colonel Clive had despatched a letter every day, from his leaving Chandernagore, to Meer Jaffier; but had only received

Digitized by Google

an answer to one of them: it was dated the 16th; and in this Meer Jaffier acknowledged his seeming reconciliation with the Nuwab, but said he would still carry into execution his covenant with the English. The coldness of this letter, at so important a time, caused suspicions in the mind of the Colonel that treachery was intended: he therefore determined not to cross the river until his doubts should be removed. The two next days were spent in a state of suspense; but on the 19th a messenger arrived with two letters from Meer Jaffier; one of them addressed to his agent, Ameer Beg; the other to the Colonel: the contents were similar, viz. that the Nuwab's army would march from Moorshudabad on that day, and that his post would be on one flank of the army, whence he would send more explicit intelligence. This communication, although it abated Colonel Clive's suspicions of treachery, did not point out any mode by which their plans were to be effected; nor did it give him a high opinion of Meer Jaffier's resolution or energy. He therefore determined to consult his officers, the number of whom were twenty; and having assembled them, he proposed to their consideration, whether the army should immediately cross the river, and at all risks attack the Nuwab, or whether, availing themselves of the great quantity of rice they had taken in Cutwa, they should remain there during the rainy season, and invite the Mahrattas to enter the province and join them.

After much debate, the majority of the officers decided for the latter plan, there being only seven who voted for the immediate attack.

The sanction of the council of war did not, however, alleviate the anxiety of the Colonel; for as soon as it broke up,

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D 1757.

he retired alone to an adjoining grove, where he remained nearly an hour in deep meditation; which convinced him of the absurdity of stopping where he was: and acting now entirely from the dictates of his own mind, he gave orders that the army should cross the river next morning.

The sick were lodged in the fort of Cutwa; and at sun-rise, on the 22d, the army began to cross, and all were landed on the opposite side by four in the afternoon; at which time another messenger arrived from Meer Jaffier, to inform the Colonel that the Nuwab had halted at Muncara, a village only six miles south of Cossimbazar, and intended to entrench his camp, and wait the event at that place; where Meer Jaffier proposed that the English, by taking a circuitous route, and getting in his rear, should attack him by surprise.

Colonel Clive immediately sent back the messenger with an answer, That he would march to Plassey without delay; and the next morning would advance to Daoodpore; where, if Meer Jaffier did not meet him, he should make peace with the Nuwab.

At sun-set the troops got under arms; and, after a fatiguing march, arrived, at one o'clock in the morning, at Plassey; and immediately took possession of a mango-grove, eight hundred yards in length, and three hundred in breadth, which was surrounded by a slight bank and ditch: but, to their great surprise, they found, by the frequent sound of drums and trumpets, that they were at a very little distance from the enemy's camp.

It appears that the Nuwab had changed his determination of entrenching his camp at Muncara, and had arrived in the vicinity of Plassey the preceding evening. After giving his orders for the security of his camp, he dismissed the officers,

Digitized by Google

and sat ruminating in his tent on the events that were likely to ensue. It chanced that his attendants quitted him, one after another, to say their evening prayers; when a thief entered the tent unperceived, till he had nearly approached the Nuwab; who, starting up from his reverie, called out to his attendants; and, on their coming, abused them for their negligence, and asked them if they considered him as already dead?

As soon as it was day, both armies drew out in line of battle. The English force consisted of 800 European infantry, 100 artillery-men, and fifty sailors attached to the guns, which consisted only of eight six-pounders, and two howitzers: there were also 100 Topasses, or Indian Portuguese, and 2100 sepoys. The Nuwab's army consisted of 18,000 well-mounted and armed horse, 50,000 infantry armed with various weapons, as matchlocks, bows, rockets, spears and swords, and fifty pieces of cannon, chiefly twenty-four and thirty-two pounders. He had also forty Frenchmen, with four pieces of light artillery.

The engagement commenced by a distant cannonade, without much advantage on either side; but about noon a very heavy shower of rain came on, which damaged the Nuwab's powder, and caused the enemy's fire to slacken: whilst that of the English continued without interruption; and although few of the shot struck the cannon against which they were directed, they had made considerable impression on the troops which were drawn up in the rear of the artillery.

During all this time, no message or intelligence arrived from Meer Jaffier, and the Colonel began to be suspicious of his intentions: he therefore sent for Ameer Beg, and questioned him on the subject. The Agent replied, that the troops who engaged the English were those under Meer Mudden

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

and Raja Mohun Loll; and as soon as they should be defeated, he was certain his master would join the Colonel.

The Nuwab had remained in his tent, out of the reach of danger, continually flattered by his attendants with assurances of victory; but soon after twelve o'clock a cannon-ball struck Meer Mudden, who was truly a brave man and faithful servant. He was immediately carried to the Nuwab; and having uttered a few words, expressive of his own loyalty, and the want of it in others, died in his presence. This affecting sight quite overcame the courage of Seraje ad Dowlah: he was involved in despair, and knew not what to do. He at length sent for Meer Jaffier; and placing his turban at his feet, said, "I now "truly repent of my behaviour towards you; and call upon "you, in the name of your respected brother-in-law, and my "grandfather, the late Nuwab Aly Verdy Khan, to forgive "what has passed: I now regard you as his representative; "and conjure you, out of respect to his memory, and as a "descendant of the Prophet, to protect my life and my honour." Meer Jaffier promised he would do so; but advised, as much of the day was spent, and the troops had been long under arms, that they should be recalled to camp, and that in the morning he would repulse the enemy. The Nuwab expressed his fears that the English would attack him during the night; but Jaffier assuring him that he would guard against that event, he sent orders to his Dewan, Raja Mohun Loll, to return to the camp. The Raja returned a polite but determined refusal, saying, that if he should retire, alarm would thereby be spread among the troops, who would probably take to flight, and throw the whole army into confusion. Meer Jaffier, however, insisted on the retreat, and

Digitized by Google

Mohun Loll reluctantly returned to the camp about two o'clock in the day.

As soon as Meer Jaffier returned to his own tent, he wrote a letter to Colonel Clive, informing him of what had passed; and advising him either to push forward immediately, or to attack the camp at night: but the messenger, fearing to proceed while the firing continued, did not deliver the letter.

The ponderous cannon of the Nuwab, which during the engagement had been advanced a considerable distance in front of the camp, were mounted on platforms of a very large size placed on wheels, and not only conveyed all the ammunition, but afforded space for the men to work the gun: each of these required forty or fifty yoke of oxen to move them: great therefore was the confusion when they commenced their return to camp, exposed to the unremitting fire of the field-pieces of the English; who, taking advantage of the circumstance, advanced towards the entrenchment of the camp, but were some time kept in check by the four light guns managed by Sinfray and the other Frenchmen, and by showers of matchlock-balls from the entrenchment. About the same time, the troops of Meer Jaffier approached towards the right flank of the English, with an intention of joining them; but their signals not being understood, they were fired at, and compelled to keep aloof. At length Colonel Clive, being convinced that they were friends, ordered his troops to push on to the camp; and at five o'clock entered the entrenchments, which he found abandoned, and the enemy flying on all sides.

The Nuwab's troops, as Raja Mohun Loll had predicted, on seeing their artillery returning to the camp, concluded that a general retreat was ordered: they therefore began to quit

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

the field in large bodies; and Seraje ad Dowlah, observing this desertion, and much alarmed by the approach of the English, mounted a camel, and, accompanied by 2000 horse, retreated towards Moorshudabad. He arrived at his palace early next morning; where, although he besought those who had accompanied him from the camp to remain till he could prepare for his escape, and fix upon some place of refuge, he could not prevail on them to stay with him. Fortune had turned her back, and mankind abandoned him. He remained at Munsoorgunge till midnight; when, taking with him his jewels and a large sum of money upon elephants, accompanied by his wife Lootf al Nissa, and one or two other women, in covered carriages, he hastened to Bogwangola; where he embarked upon some of his own boats which were stationed there, and proceeded up the river, in hopes of meeting Mr. Law with the French detachment whom he had ordered to join him, or of effecting his escape to Purneah; but on his arrival opposite to Rajemahel, he and his women being oppressed with hunger, they stopt at the cell of a Mohammedan derveish, named Dana Shah, and requested him to procure them some food. To this man Seraje ad Dowlah, in the days of his prosperity, had offered an affront, the remembrance of which still rankled in his mind: he, however, received them courteously, and set about preparing some *kecheery* for them; but privately despatched one of his servants across the river, to Meer Cossim, the brother of Meer Jaffier Khan, who commanded the troops at Rajemahel; and who, upon the receipt of the intelligence, immediately proceeded to the cell of the derveish, and seized upon the unfortunate fugitive. They first conveyed him to Rajemahel, and then proceeded with him to Jaffier Khan's

The Nuwab seized.

Digitized by Google

house in Moorshudabad, where he arrived on the 15th of Showal 1170. Meer Jaffier being then absent at Munsoorgunge, he was delivered to Meerun the son of Jaffier, a young man of a very worthless character, who immediately offered a sum of money to any of his attendants who would go and put an end to Seraje ad Dowlah. For some time they all refused; but at length a wretch, named Mohammed Beg, who from his infancy had been nourished by the favour of Aly Verdy Khan's family, offered to execute the horrid deed. SECT. VI. July 1757.

At the time they seized Seraje ad Dowlah, and while they were conveying him to Moorshudabad, he requested the officer commanding the guard to make it known, that if they would spare his life, he would willingly retire to any part of the province upon a small pension. When therefore the assassin entered his apartment, he said, "Art thou come to kill me? "What! will they not let me live in obscurity?" he added, "No, no, it cannot be! I must die, to atone for the murder "of Hussein Cooly Khan*." Time was not given him to say more. After the assassin had inflicted several wounds, he sunk to the ground, and said, "Enough, enough! Hussein "Cooly, thou art revenged!" Immediately after which he yielded up his soul to his Maker†. Thus perished Seraje ad Dowlah, in the 20th year of his age, and the 15th month of his government. He was remarkable for the beauty of his person; and perhaps owed his misfortunes to a neglected education, and the doating fondness of his grandfather. Death of the Nuwab.

* See page 496.

† This is, perhaps, a solitary instance of a native of Hindoostan expressing a consciousness of guilt on his death-bed. Being absolute predestinarians, they lay the fault to fate; and, after a life spent in every species of atrocity, pass their last moments in tranquillity.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI.
A.D. 1757.

We must now leave this melancholy scene, and return to the successful party. As soon as the English army entered the Nuwab's camp, they were met by the messenger whom Meer Jaffier had despatched soon after noon. A second letter was shortly delivered to Colonel Clive from him, apologizing for not having sooner joined him; but that he was now ready to wait on him, if agreeable. The Colonel fearing to halt in the camp, where the troops would certainly be tempted to separate, in search of the rich plunder which was scattered all around them, and be liable to be thus cut off by the enemy, informed Meer Jaffier's messenger, that he meant to proceed that night to Daoodpore, about six miles further, where he should be happy to see his master in the morning.

The English troops having been told that they should be rewarded with a handsome donation of money, in lieu of the plunder of the camp, received the order to march on with loud acclamations, leaving an immense property to be taken possession of by Meer Jaffier's forces; and at eight o'clock the whole army arrived at Daoodpore. This important victory was gained with very little loss; the number of Europeans killed and wounded were only twenty; and of the Sepoys and Lascars, fifty-two; many of whom were very slightly injured.

On the morning of the 24th of June, Colonel Clive sent Mr. Scrafton, and Ameer Beg, to Meer Jaffier, who had encamped about a mile from Daoodpore, to say he should be happy then to see him. Meer Jaffier received the deputies with much reserve, and an air of anxiety; as if he apprehended that the English would resent his conduct, in not having joined, and having allowed them to bear all the brunt of the battle without any assistance or encouragement. He,

Digitized by Google

however, accompanied them to the English camp, attended by his son Meerun, and his usual retinue. On approaching the Colonel's tent, he alighted from his elephant, and the guard drew out and saluted him in the usual manner. Not knowing the meaning of this compliment, he started back, fearing it was a plot to assassinate him. Colonel Clive, however, advanced immediately, and, taking him in his arms, saluted him as Nuwab of the three provinces, which removed his fears. They conferred about an hour; during which the Colonel advised him to proceed immediately to Moorshudabad, to endeavour to secure Seraje ad Dowlah, and to prevent the treasury being plundered. Meer Jaffier returned to his camp, and immediately marched towards the city. He arrived in the evening; but did not take any measures to prevent the departure of Seraje ad Dowlah, who left his palace, as has been before related, six hours after the arrival of Meer Jaffier. SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

The English troops made a short march on the evening of the 24th; and on the following day, about noon, arrived at Moidapore, in the vicinity of Moorshudabad.

As soon as the army was encamped, Colonel Clive sent Mr. Watts and Mr. Walsh, attended by a hundred sepoys, to pay Meer Jaffier a visit of ceremony. This visit confirmed the hopes of all the partisans of Meer Jaffier, and clearly pointed out to the inhabitants of the city whom they were to consider as their future master.

Some difficulties having occurred respecting the payment of the compensation due to the English, which amounted to 2,750,000*l.* sterling, Colonel Clive did not enter the city till the morning of the 29th; when, escorted by a guard of 200 Europeans, and 300 sepoys, he took possession of the palace and June.

Digitized by Google

SECT. VI. A. D. 1757.

garden of Moraud Baug, which had been allotted for his residence.

Here he was immediately waited upon by Meerun the son of Jaffier, whom he shortly after accompanied to the palace at Munsoorgunge; and, upon entering the hall of audience, he there found Meer Jaffier, with a number of officers and the principal inhabitants of the city, expecting his arrival.

The English raise Meer Jaffier to the musnud. June 29.

At one end of the hall was placed the musnud of Seraje ad Dowlah; which Meer Jaffier appearing to avoid, Colonel Clive took him by the hand, and, leading him to it, seated him thereon. He then presented him with a salver of gold mohrs, and congratulated him on his accession to the musnud of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa. This example was immediately followed by all the persons present; and the event was announced to the public by the discharge of cannon and the sounds of martial music.

From this period, the power and influence of the English became paramount in Bengal*: and were we further to continue this History, it would be requisite to commence a new section, under the title of *The Native Governors under the English Dynasty*.

---

* A very few months after Meer Jaffier's accession, he was nick-named, by one of the wits of the court, "Colonel Clive's ass," and retained the title till his death.

In justice to the memory of Colonel Clive, I think it requisite to state, that none of the Native Historians impute any participation in the death of Seraje ad Dowlah, to him. It is generally believed, that the capture of the Nuwab was kept a secret from the Colonel, till after he had suffered.

Digitized by Google

LIST of the NUWABS of BENGAL

SINCE THE YEAR 1757.

Oct. 1760. COSSIM ALY KHAN succeeded as Deputy to MEER JAFFIER, who retired upon an ample pension.

July 1763. MEER JAFFIER was again appointed, in the room of COSSIM ALY KHAN expelled.

Jan. 1765. NEJIM AD DOWLAH, eldest son of MEER JAFFIER, succeeded on the death of his father.

This year the EAST-INDIA COMPANY received, from the Emperor SHAH AALUM (King of the World), the appointment of DEWAN of the Three Provinces.

May 1766. SIEF AD DOWLAH (to whom a pension was granted, and the business of Nazim managed by Deputy) succeeded his Brother, NEJIM AD DOWLAH, who died of the small-pox.

Mar. 1770. MUBARIC AD DOWLAH, on the same terms, succeeded his Brother, SIEF AD DOWLAH, who died of an epidemic disease†.

Sept. 1793. NAZIR AL MOOLK succeeded his father, MUBARIC AD DOWLAH.

April 1810. ZYN ADDEEN ALY KHAN (the present Nuwab) succeeded NAZIR AL MOOLK. He receives a pension from the English, but has nothing to do with the Government.

---

† The Office of Deputy Nazim was annulled in 1790; and Courts of Justice, with English Judges, appointed to every district.

Digitized by Google

Digitized by Google

APPENDIX.

IT may be necessary to premise, that the following Documents are copied *verbatim* from the ancient Records; and that the Translations were made by Armenians, or other Foreigners, as none of the Company's Servants at that time understood Persian.

It appears extraordinary, that as the East-India Company were then supplied with WRITERS from CHRIST'S-CHURCH HOSPITAL, they did not select a few of them to learn the Oriental Languages. It would have saved much money, and prevented many quarrels.

APPENDIX, No. I. (referred to in p. 244.)

Extract of a Letter from William Methwold, &c. dated Surat, 21st February, 1633, to the Company.

THE 2d present, we received from Agra the King's Firmand, which gives liberty of trade unto us in his whole Country of Bengala; but restrains our shipping only unto the Port of Piply; which Firmand was sent unto us by a servant of our own, which was dispeeded unto Agra.

[No. 989.]

[N.B. The Firmān not being procurable, Mr. Bruce obligingly favoured me with the above Letter, in which it is mentioned.—*C. S.*

The reference at the bottom of page 244 should have been February 1633-4.]

Digitized by Google

APPENDIX, No. II. (referred to in p. 255.)

Translate of Sultan Shauh Shujacs Neshaun, Letters Patent to the English in Bengala. A.D. 1656. A.H. 1066.

THE Neshaun, or Letters Patent of the most magnificent Prince Sultan Shujah, given the sixth month in the year of Hegira, one thousand sixty-six, in the 28th year of the Emperor Shah Jehaun his glorious reign.

BE IT KNOWN to all Great Governors, Chancellors, Farmers of the King's Rents, Colonels, Captains, Rent Gatherers, Farmers of Customs, Watchmen, Ferrymen, and other Petty Officers, that now are in place, and hereafter shall be, in the Kingdoms of Bengala and Orixa, that this day Thomas Billidge, an Englishman, humbly presented his suit before our splendid throne, acquainting us that the English Company's goods, according to the Great Emperor's Letters Patent, which are unalterable, are, by His free grant therein specified, custom free all over his great Empire; humbly desiring us that there may a privilege be granted them, by us, to trade custom free in these parts; as also complaining that at present their trade with the Country Merchants, our subjects, is much hindered by our Governors of Port, Towns, &c. demanding the English goods at their own rates, and forbidding any merchants to buy or sell with them, unless they condescend to their actions; and that the Officers in the port, town, &c. demand four in the hundred custom on all goods imported and exported, as also anchorage in the roads belonging to these kingdoms of Bengala and Orixa.

Upon due consideration had of all which, we were pleased to grant, and hereby command you, that, according to the above-mentioned Letters Patent of the Great Emperor, whose words no man dare presume to reverse, the factory of the English Company be no more troubled with demands of custom for goods imported or exported either by land or by water, nor that their goods be opened and forced from them at under rates in any places of government by which they shall pass or repass up and down the Country; but that they buy and sell freely, and without impediment, neither let any molestation be given them about anchorage, as formerly has been; also, wherever they have order to build factories or warehouses in any part of these Kingdoms, that they be not hindered, but forwarded; as also where there shall any just and due debts be coming to them from our subjects, that all persons in office be helpful to them in their recovery, giving protection to no weavers, merchants, or any other that shall appear to be really indebted to them. In all the aforesaid matters, especial regard is to be had that you carry yourselves strictly in obedience to the Great Emperor's Letters Patent, and this my Neshan now given the English Company, having an especial care that you fail not a little in your full compliance with our commands therein contained.

[*Diary kept by Streynsham Master, p.* 346 *to* 347. No. 120.]

Digitized by Google

APPENDIX, No. III. (referred to in p. 301.)

Translate of Nabob Shausteth Caune, Lord of the Noblemen, his Confirmation of the English Privileges in the Kingdom of Bengala. A. H. 1083. June, A. D. 1672.

THE Phyrwana, or Order, of Shasta Ckauns, the Lord of Noblemen, dated this third day of the 3d month, in the 15th year of the glorious reign of Aurungzeeb, Emperor of the World;

To all Great Officers, Chancellors, Farmers of the King's Customs, Farmers of the King's Rent, Colonels, Captains, Rent-Gatherers, Custom-Gatherers, Watchmen, and all Under Officers, now in being, and that shall be, in these kingdoms of Bengala and Orixa, DECLARETH, that Walter Clavell, the English Captain, this day presented his suit before me, averring, according to Letters Patent of the mighty Emperor (Shah Jehan) and Prince Sultan Shah Sujah, as also by the Phyrwana, or Order, of Meer Jumbla, the Cawne of Cawnes, deceased, the custom of all goods exported and imported, bought or sold, belonging to the English Company, to be released.

WHEREUPON I also give my confirmation of the same; and order, that according to the said Letters Patent, &c. you govern yourselves: And whatsoever goods the said Company shall import from Ballasore, or any other place near the sea-side, up to Hugly, Cossimbuzar, Patana, or any other place in these two kingdoms; as also what saltpetre, or any other goods, they shall export from Patana, or any other place, to Ballasore, or any other port to the sea; that you let them pass custom free, without any let, impediment, or demands whatsoever: And wherever they have factories or warehouses, that you help their factors in getting in their due debts from any weavers, merchants, &c. that really appear to be indebted to them, without giving protection to any such person so indebted whereby they may any ways be wronged. And whatsoever boats, &c. whether their own or freighted, let them not be stopped on any pretence whatsoever, but suffered to pass without molestation. And notwithstanding I have lately, by reason of a great outrage committed by the Dutch, absolutely forbidden them any trade in these kingdoms aforesaid, so that Governors and other officers have took occasion to stop and hinder the English trade, which I have not interdicted, with that of the Dutch, which I have strictly forbidden, I do declare that the English never committed any offence of so high a nature that their trade should be hindered; and therefore I resolve and order, as before, that, according to the above-mentioned Order, and as their trade has for so many years quietly and without impediment gone on in these kingdoms aforesaid, that it now also be not hindered, but that whatever their factors and other servants shall buy or sell as aforesaid be no ways letted or impeded. And that I may hear no more complaints from the English in this matter, see that this my Order be strictly observed.

[*A Diary kept by Streynsham Master*, 1675 *to* 1676. No. 120, p. 348-49.]

Digitized by Google

APPENDIX, No. IV. (referred to in p. 303),

Being the *Nishan of Sultan Mohammed Azim*, is nearly a copy of the above, therefore not inserted.

APPENDIX, No. V. (referred to in p. 309.)

Copy of the Emperor Aurungzebe's Firmaun.

A. D. 1680. A. H. 1091.

IN the name of GOD, Amen.

TO all present and future Rulers in Surat, that remain in hopes of the Emperor's favour,

Be it known, that at this happy birth of time it is agreed, of the English Nation, besides their usual custom of 2 per cent for their goods, more 1½ jezia, or poll-money, shall be taken.

Wherefore it is commanded, That in the said place, from the first day of Shuvaal, in the 23d year of our reign, of the said people, 3 and a half rupees per cent. of all their goods, on account of custom and poll-money, be taken for the future. And at all other places, upon this account, let no one hinder or molest them for custom, rawdarree, peashcus, phirmaish, and other matters by the Emperor's Court forbidden, nor to make any demands in these particulars: observe. Written on the 23d day of the month Suffer, in the year twenty-three.

[N.B. The obscure part of this paper, and which gave rise to the disputes, commences with "And at all other."—*C. S.*]

APPENDIX, No. VI. (referred to in p. 325.)

Copy of the Phirmaund given by the Mogul Aurungzebe to Nabob Ebrahim Caun for Bengal, dated the 23d of April, 1690, and in the 33d year of the King's reign. A. H. 1101.

YOU must understand, that it has been the good fortune of the English to repent them of their irregular past proceedings; and their not being in their former greatness, have, by

Digitized by Google

their vackeels, petitioned for their lives, and a pardon for their faults, which, out of my extraordinary favour towards them, have accordingly granted: Therefore, upon receipt hereof, my Phirmaund, you must not create them any further trouble, but let them trade freely in your Government as formerly: And this order I expect you see strictly observed.

[No. 274, page 122.]

APPENDIX, No. VII. (referred to in p. 326.)

Copy of a Phirmaun of the Emperor Aurungzebe, dated the 23d of the month Jummaudee Auvull, in the 33d year of the most glorious reign, A. H. 1101. *Sent from Surat* 1690.

ALL the English having made a most humble, submissive Petition, that the ill crimes they have done may be pardoned, and requested a noble Phirmaun, to make their being forgiven manifest, and sent their vacqueel to the heavenly palace, the most illustrious in the world, to get the royal favour; and Ettimatt Caun, the Governor of Surat,'s Petition to the famous court equal to the sky, being arrived, that they would present the Great King with a fine of 150,000 rupees to his noble treasury, resembling the sun, and would restore the merchants' goods they took away to the owners of them, and would walk by the ancient customs of the Port, and behave themselves for the future no more in such a shameful manner: Therefore His Majesty, according to his daily favours to all the people of the world, hath pardoned their faults, mercifully forgiving them: and out of his princely condescensions agrees, that the present be put into the treasury of the Port; the goods of the merchants returned; the town flourishing; and they follow their trade as in former times; and Mr. Child, who did the disgrace, be turned out and expelled. This order is irreversible.

[No. 274. p. 38, 39.]

APPENDIX, No. VIII. (referred to in p. 326.)

Translate of the Nabob Ebrahim Cawn and King's Duan's General Perwanna, for the English their paying only Rupees 3000 *yearly for their Trade.* A. H. 1002-3. A. D. 1691-2.

TO all Mutsuddies, Carrowries, Jaggerdars, Gomastehs, Phousdars, Jimmedars, Conongees, belonging to the Subahship of Bengal, now in service or that shall be hereafter,

Be it known, that, before this, an ample Husbullhookum for the pardoning all the faults of the English has arrived to me from the King, under the seal of Lutfullah Cawne; since that, another Husbullhookum, under the seal of Assud Cawne, arrived from the King to Kafait Cawne, his Duan, the copy of which is arrived in my Secretary's office from said Kafait Cawne, which is, viz. That he should, according to ancient custom, take rupees 3000, as a

Digitized by Google

pishcash of the English in lieu of custom, yearly; and not demand, or ask, on any account whatever, more than that: the copy of which Husbullhookum is writ on the back side of this Perwanna. For this reason I write you, That, from the beginning of the 34th year of Jeloose (or the King's reign), according to the King's order, ye, instead of custom, take but rupees 3000 of them yearly; and that in their buying and selling, you take not a pice more; that they may contentedly continue their trade in the places of their former residence, as Hugley, Ballasore, &c. under the government of this subahship; and that ye assist their gomastehs in their lawful and just business upon all accounts: And that not one, upon the account of Rawdari, Jimmedare, or Firmashe, &c. be suffered to defraud or molest them, it being forbidden by the King. God forbid that in any one's government robberies be committed; but if so, that the Phousdars of said places use their endeavours to find and restore said goods to the owner. Dated the second day of the moon, in the 35th year of Jeloose.

[*Received per Orange* 1692. No. 265. A.]

APPENDIX, No. IX. (referred to in p. 326.)

Translate of an Husbullhookum, under Assid Cawn's Seal, upon Kefait Cawne, Duan of Dacca, for the English's paying Three Thousand Rupees annual Pishcash, in lieu of Custom, (procured by the aforesaid Kefait Cawn's Letter), dated the Twenty-first of Jemadestanny, in the Thirty-fourth Year of the King's reign, or February the Tenth, 1691. A. H. 1002.

PETITION being made, That you writ that an Husbullhookum, under the seal of Lutfoola Cawn, was come to the Viceroy, that the English should trade according to ancient usage; that of that nation two or three were arrived in the port of Hugley; and that Mahmoud Eckbar, officer of said port, had given them encouragement, and taken an obligation from them that they would give custom on their merchandize, as hereafter should be determined; that in said Husbullhookum nothing was mentioned concerning the receipt of custom, neither was it under the Vizier's seal what had been determined; that their ancient usage, to your knowledge, was rupees 3000 annual pishcash, for which they carried on their trade and business; that after that, it was determined for them to pay custom 3½ per cent. as they did in Surat; and that now, for the receipt of custom from this nation, you would act according to order; and that it was agreed on formerly for them to pay 3000 rupees annual pishcash; that in the year 1090 it was resolved they should pay 3½ per cent. including poll-money, and that in Surat they pay the same now. What would His Majesty please to order? Upon which the King gave order, that pishcash should be received of them according to ancient usage. Therefore I write you, That you act according to the Phirmaund; and advise of the contents hereof.

[*Received per Orange* 1692. No. 275. A.]

Digitized by Google

APPENDIX, No. X. (referred to in p. 342.)

Translate of a Dustuck granted to Sir Edward Littleton, by Order of the Prince Sultan Mahmood Assam Ooshan, given under the Seal of his Duan, Allee Reza, for Trade in the Province of Bengala, dated the 12th Day of Rajebe, in the 43d Year of the King's Reign, Anno Hedgero iiii. *January 26th, Anno Christi* 1700.

DUSTUCK to the Fousdars, Jaggerdars, and all of the Government under Dacca, Hughly, Cassimbazar, Balasore and Rajahmaul, &c. in the Province of Bengal.

Know ye, that the request of Sir Edward Littleton, Consul and President for the New English Company, is to settle factories and commerce in this province; for that end he hath sent a Vackeel to procure the King's Phirmaund, and is ready at present with the King's Duan to settle his piscash; and that now is the monsoon for his shipping; therefore he requests and hopes the Prince will grant him an order to trade and carry on his business. It is therefore ordered, that they merchandize and commerce in the same method as the Old Company does in this province with satisfaction; and that when his piscash is agreed on, and paid in, then he shall have a Neshaun. This is therefore an Order to you, the Fousdars, Jaggerdars, &c. of the Government, that you do not any way hinder them, or molest them, in their merchandize.

[Vol. XXI. p. 391-393. No. 443, 223, p. 102, 103.]

[N.B. This is in favour of the New Company. The Nishān to the Old Company does not appear in the Records, but the substance of it is repeated in the following Number.]

APPENDIX, No. XI. (referred to in p. 400.)

The Emperor Ferrokhsere's Phirmaund for Bengal, Bahar, and Orixa. A. D. 1717. A. H. 1129.

TO all Governors and their Assistants, Intelligencers, Jaggerdars, Phousdars, Collectors, Guardians of the Ways, Keepers of the Passages, and Zemeendars, that are at present or hereafter may come in the provinces of Bengal, Bahar, and Orixa, at the port of Hugly, &c. ports in the provinces aforesaid;

By these presents know ye, from the favour of the Imperial Majesty, that, at this time of conquest, and in this flourishing reign, Mr. John Surman and Coja Surhaud, gomashtahs

Digitized by Google

(factors) of the English Company, have humbly presented their petition, setting forth, That, according to Sultain Azzim Shah Bahauder his, and former, Sunods, they are free of customs throughout the whole conquered empire, the port of Surat excepted; and that they do annually pay into the treasury, at the port of Hugly, a pishcash of 3000 rupees, in lieu of customs; they hope that, according to the tenor of former Sunods, they may be favoured with a gracious Phirmaund confirming them. COMMANDED AND ORDERED, That all their mercantile affairs, together with their gomastahs, have free liberty, in all Subahships, to pass and repass to and fro, either by land or water, in any port or district throughout the several provinces abovesaid. And Know, they are custom free; that they have full power and liberty to buy and sell at their will and pleasure; and that there yearly be received into the treasury a pishcash of 3000 rupees, as has been customary heretofore: that if in any place, or at any time, robberies are committed on their goods, they be assisted in the getting of them again, that the robbers be brought to justice, and the goods be delivered to the proprietors of them. In whatsoever place they have a mind to settle a factory, fairly to buy and sell goods in, they have liberty; and be assisted. That on whomsoever, merchants, weavers, &c. they have any demands, on whatsoever account, let them be aided, and their debtors brought to a true and fair account, and be made to give their gomashtahs their right and just demands. That no persons be suffered to injure and molest their gomashtahs wrongfully and unjustly. And for customs on hired boats (*cutcarrah*), &c. belonging to them, that they be not in any manner molested or obstructed.

They further petition, That if the petty Duans of Subahships demand sight of the original Sunods and Perwannas, under the seals of the Duans and Subahs, the original Sunods cannot possibly be produced in any place without a great deal of difficulty, they desire that a copy from under the seal of the Chief Cauzee be sufficient, sight of the original Sunods not being demanded, nor they forced to take Sunods and Perwannas under the Duan and Subah their seals. That the rentings of Calcutta, Chuttanutty, and Govindpore, in the Purgana of Ameirabaud, &c. in Bengal, were formerly granted them, and bought by consent from the Zemeendars of them, and are now in the Company's possession, for which they yearly pay the sum of 1195*R.* 6*A.* That thirty-eight towns more, amounting to 8121*R.* 8*A.* adjoining to the aforesaid towns, which they hope the renting of may be granted, and added to those they are already in possession of; that they will pay annually the same amount of them. COMMANDED, That the copy under the seal of the Chief Cauzee be regarded; that the old towns formerly bought by them remain in their hands as heretofore; and that they have the renting of the adjacent towns petitioned for, which they are to buy from the respective owners of them; and that the Duan and Subah give permission.

They still petition, That from the reign of Aurengzebe, Madras coins were received into the Subaship's treasuries for under value, and are still, notwithstanding they are full as valuable as Surat rupees are, whereby they are great losers; they hope the Imperial order may be given for them to be received into the treasuries as Surat rupees are, in case they are as good. That any person, being servant to the Company, eloping from them, from whom debts and accounts are due, they desire that whosoever so deserts be delivered back to the Chief of their Factory. That their gomashtahs and servants are molested and troubled for phousdarry, (*abuab mumnua,*) &c. impositions which they request they may be exempted from.

Digitized by Google

COMMANDED AND ORDERED, That from the fifth year of this blessed reign, if Madras rupees are made the same goodness as Surat siccas, there be no discount on them. That whosoever of the Company's servants, being debtors, desert them; seize them, and deliver them to the chief of their Factory. That they be not molested for phirmaushs and impositions.

They petition, That in Bengal, Bahar, and Orissa, the Company have Factories; and that in other places they likewise design to settle Factories: they accordingly desire, that in any place where they have a mind to settle Factories they may have forty begaes of ground given them for the same. That it often happens ships at sea meet with tempestuous winds, and are forced into ports, and are sometimes driven ashore and wrecked, the Governors of the ports injuriously seize on the cargoes of them, and in some places demand a quarter part salvage. That in the island of Bombay, belonging to the English, European siccas are current; they request that, according to the custom of Madras, they may at Bombay coin siccas. COMMANDED AND ORDERED, That, according to the custom of their Factories in other subahships, execute; these people having their Factories in several ports of the kingdom, and commerce to the place of the royal residence, and have obtained very favourable Phirmāns custom free. Let there be particular care taken that there be duly assistance given them about goods and wrecks, on all occasions. On the island of Bombay, let there be the glorious stamp upon the siccas coined there; passing them current, as all other siccas are, throughout the whole empire. To all these render punctual obedience, observing and acting pursuant to the tenor of this gracious Phirmān, and not contrary in any respect whatsoever; nor demand yearly new sunods. Regard this particularly well.

Written the 27th of the moon Mohurum, in the fifth year of this glorious and ever happy reign.

[*East-India Records*, Book No. 593.]

APPENDIX, No. XII. (referred to in p. 516.)

Treaty and Agreements with Serajah Dowla, dated Feb. 7, 1757.

A. H. 1170.

Monsoor ul Mulck Serajah Dowla Shah
Kuly Khan Behauder, Hybut Jung,
Servant of King Aalum Geer the Invincible.

ARTICLE I.

THAT the Company be not molested upon account of such privileges as have been granted them by the King's Firmaund and Husbulhookums, and the Firmaund and Husbulhookums in full force.

That the thirty-eight Villages, which were given to the Company by the Firmaund, but detained from them by the Soubah, be likewise allowed them, nor let any impediment or restriction be put upon the Zemindars.

Digitized by Google

ARTICLE II.

That all goods belonging to the English Company, and having their Dustuck, do pass freely by land or water, in Bengal, Bahar, and Orissa, without paying any duties or fees of any kind whatsoever; and that the Zemindars, Chokeydars, Guzerbauns, &c. offer them no kind of molestation upon this account.

ARTICLE III.

That restitution be made the Company of their Factories and Settlements at Calcutta, Cossimbuzar, Dacca, &c. which have been taken from them.

That all money and effects, taken from the English Company, their factors and dependents, at the several Settlements and Aurungs, be restored in the same condition: that an equivalent, in money, be given for such goods as are damaged, plundered, or lost, which shall be left to the Nabob's justice to determine.

ARTICLE IV.

That the Company be allowed to fortify Calcutta, in such manner as they shall esteem proper for their defence, without any hindrance or obstruction.

ARTICLE V.

That siccas be coined at Allenagur (Calcutta) in the same manner as at Moorshedabad, and that the money, struck in Calcutta, be of equal weight and fineness with that of Moorshedabad. There shall be no demand made for a deduction of Batta.

ARTICLE VI.

That these proposals be ratified in the strongest manner, in the presence of God and his Prophet, and signed and sealed to by the Nabob, and some of his principal people.

ARTICLE VII.

And Admiral Charles Watson and Col. Clive promise, in behalf of the English Nation, and of the English Company, that from henceforth all hostilities shall cease, in Bengal; and the English will always remain in peace and friendship with the Nabob, as long as these articles are kept in force, and remain unviolated.

Aaz ul Mulck Morad ul Dowla
Nowazish Ally Khan Behauder, Zahooar Jung,
a Servant of King Aalum Geer the Invincible.

Witness,
Lucki Narain Canongo.

Meer Jaffier Khan Behauder,
a Servant of King Aalum Geer
the Invincible.

Rajah Doolubram Behauder,
a Servant of King Aalum Geer
the Invincible.

Witness,
Mohindar Narain Canongo.

Digitized by Google

APPENDIX, No. XIII. (referred to in p. 522.)

Treaty with Jaffier Ally Khan.

* *I swear, by God and the Prophet of God, to abide by the terms of this Treaty whilst I have life.*

Meer Mahomed Jaffier Khan Behauder,
Servant of King Aalum Geer.

Treaty made with the Admiral, and Colonel Clive [Sabut Jung Behauder], Governor Drake, and Mr. Watts.

ARTICLE I.

Whatever articles were agreed upon in the time of peace with the Nabob, Serajah Dowla Monsoor ul Mulck Shah Kuly Khan Behauder, Hybut Jung, I agree to comply with.

ARTICLE II. *

The enemies of the English are my enemies, whether they be Indians or Europeans.

ARTICLE III.

All the Effects and Factories, belonging to the French, in the province of Bengal (the Paradise of nations), and Bahar, and Orissa, shall remain in the possession of the English; nor will I ever allow them any more to settle in the Three Provinces.

ARTICLE IV.

In consideration of the losses which the English Company have sustained, by the capture and plunder of Calcutta, by the Nabob, and the charges occasioned by the maintenance of the forces, I will give them one crore of rupees.

ARTICLE V.

For the effects plundered from the English inhabitants of Calcutta, I agree to give fifty lacks of rupees.

ARTICLE VI.

For the effects plundered from the Gentoos, Mussulmen, and other subjects of Calcutta, twenty lacks of rupees shall be given.

ARTICLE VII.

For the effects plundered from the Armenian inhabitants of Calcutta, I will give the sum of seven lacks of rupees. The distribution of the sums, allotted the natives, English inhabitants, Gentoos, and Mussulmen, shall be left to the Admiral and Colonel Clive (Sabut Jung Behauder) and the rest of the Council, to be disposed of by them to whom they think proper.

ARTICLE VIII.

Within the ditch, which surrounds the borders of Calcutta, are tracts of land belonging to several Zemindars; besides this, I will grant the English Company six hundred yards without the ditch.

---

* These words were written in his own hand.

Digitized by Google

ARTICLE IX.

All the land laying to the South of Calcutta, as far as Culpee, shall be under the Zemindarry of the English Company; and all the officers of those parts shall be under their jurisdiction. The revenues to be paid by them (the Company) in the same manner with other Zemindars.

ARTICLE X.

Whenever I demand the English assistance, I will be at the charge of the maintenance of them.

ARTICLE XI.

I will not erect any new fortifications below Hughley, near the River Ganges.

ARTICLE XII.

As soon as I am established in the Government of the Three Provinces, the aforesaid sums shall be faithfully paid.

Dated the 15th Ramzan, in the 4th Year of the Reign. A. D. 1757. A. H. 1170.

ADDITIONAL ARTICLE.—ARTICLE XIII.

On condition that Meer Jaffier Khan Behauder shall solemnly ratify, confirm by oath, and execute all the above Articles, which the underwritten, on behalf of the Honourable East India Company, do, declaring on the Holy Gospels, and before God, that we will assist Meer Jaffier Khan Behauder with all our force, to obtain the Soubahship of the province of Bengal, Bahar, and Orissa; and further, that we will assist him to the utmost, against all his enemies whatever, as soon as he calls upon us for that end; provided that he, on his coming to be Nabob, shall fulfil the aforesaid Articles.

[N.B. The last two Numbers are taken from a Book, entitled "Treaties and Grants from the Country Powers to the East-India Company," published A. D. 1774.]

Digitized by Google

EXPLANATION

OF

THE TITLES OF THE GOVERNORS

UNDER THE

MOGHUL DYNASTY

SECT. VI.

No.		Page
1.	*The Slave of Hussein*, the Lord of the World*	166
2.	*The Victorious Lord*	167
3.	No particular meaning. He was a Hindoo	171
4.	*The Most Illustrious Lord, and Foster Brother*	175
5.	*The Falcon Lord*	178
6.	No meaning. He was a Hindoo Prince	180
7.	*The Pole Star of Religion, and Foster Brother*	192
8.	*The Slave of the Emperor Jehanghire*	205
9.	*The Glory of the Religion of Islam*	207
10.	No applicable meaning	217
11.	*The Victorious in War*	221
12.	*King of the World*	230
13.	*The Adopted Son*; literally "Born in the house"	236
14.	*The Respected Lord*	237
15.	*The Devoted Lord*	238
16.	No applicable meaning	239
17.	*The Most Illustrious Lord*	244
18.	*Lord of the True Faith*	245
19.	*The Praise-worthy and Brave Prince*	248
20.	†*The Viceroy, The Noble Lord, The Lord of Lords, The Generalissimo*	282

* Hussein was the grandson of Mohammed, and is adored by the Persians.

† Nuwab is the plural of Naib, a deputy; and may possibly mean the King's Deputy in all Departments. It is a modern title.

Digitized by Google

EXPLANATION OF THE TITLES OF THE GOVERNORS.

No.		Page
21.	*The Viceroy, The Worthy Lord, The Chief of the Nobility*	295
22.	*The Viceroy, The Devoted, and Most Illustrious Lord*	302
23.	*The Praise-worthy and Most Illustrious Prince*	303
24.	The same person as No. 21	307
25.	*The Viceroy Lord Abraham*	323
26.	*The Prince of High Dignity*	337
27.	*The Viceroy, The Slave of Majesty, The Trust-worthy of the Kingdom, The Exalted of the State, The Supporter of Battle**	367
28.	*The Viceroy, The Trust-worthy of the Kingdom, The Hero of the Faith of Mohammed, The Champion of the State, The Lion of War, The Valiant*†	415
29.	*The Illustrious of the State, The Head-exalted Lord*	433
30.	*The Hero of the Kingdom, The Sword of the State, The Formidable in War, The Valiant*	443
31.	*The Victorious of the Kingdom, The Lamp of the State, The Slave of the Emperor, The Formidable in War, The Valiant*	492

---

* Jaffier has no meaning, but was the name of a celebrated Vizier under the Birmecide Princes. Moorshud means, literally, a Spiritual Guide, but is often applied to Kings.

† Behadur is said to be a Tartar word, and the precise meaning not understood: but it now accompanies every Military title. If it were a Persian word, the meaning of it would be (Valuable as a Pearl).

Digitized by Google

INDEX.

A.

AALUMGEER, the title of Aurungzebe, 360, *n.*

Aalumgeer II. Emperor of Hindoostan, 497, 519.

Aazim Khan, Governor of Bengal under Shah Jehan, 244—Recalled for suffering the Mughs and Assamese to ravage his dominions, *ib.*

Aazim Shah, Emperor of Hindoostan, 361—Defeated and slain in a battle with his brother, Shah Aalum, 363.

Abdul Mujeed Asuf Khan, Governor of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa under Akbar, 190.

Abdul Rezack, Critical situation of, 189.

Abistagy, Governor of Khorassan, revolts against Abul Munsur, and becomes absolute Sovereign of Zabulistan, 3.

Abu Isaac, son of Abistagy, 3.

Abul Munsur, the last of the Samanian dynasty, 2.

Abyssinians, introduced into Bengal by Barbek Shah—Frequently rise in India to places of trust, 100, 104—Reduced by Futteh Shah to a level with his subjects, 102—An Abyssinian, Sultan of Bengal, 106; another, 108—Abyssinian troops dismissed by Hussein Shah, 111—Procure employment in the Guzerat and Dekkan, and acquire the name of *Siddees*, *ib.*

Adjodin, 20.

Afghanistan, 38.

Afghans—Dynasty of the Lody family terminated with Ibrahim on his defeat by Baber, 115—Empire of Hindoostan again transferred from the Moghuls to the Afghans, by the victory of Shere Shah over the Emperor Homayon, 143. Sovereignty of the Afghans over Bengal, nature of, 164—Terminated with Daood Khan, *ib. supra*—The scattered Afghans collect in Orissa, 176—Retain a remnant of power in Orissa, 179, 183—Reduced to feudatories in Cuttack, 185—The Afghans obtain a transient authority in Bengal, 188. Having rallied in great force in Orissa, invade the Moghul Governor of Bengal, 212—Submit unconditionally, 215.

Agmahel—See *Rajemahel.*

Agra, City of, 116, 143—Government of, 141.

Aguadeep, Town of, 518.

Ahmed Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 96—His character, *ib.*—His dominions invaded by Ibrahim, Sultan of Joanpore *ib.*—Sends for aid to Shah Rookh, 97; who, by a Letter to Ibrahim, influences him to desist from invading Bengal, *ib.*—Death of Ahmed Shah, 99.

Ahmed Shah Abdally, King of Cabul, invades Hindoostan, 519.

Ahmednagur, fort of, 360.

Ajmire, 29, 188, 307.

Akbar, Emperor of Hindoostan, conquers Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, 152--167.

Akbarnagur, 186—See *Rajemahel.*

Akdala, Fortress of, 84, *ib.* 87, 111.

Alla, Emperor of Dehly, 79.

Allahabad, Fort of, 146—Joint government of, (formerly Joosy,) 174.

Altumsh, Emperor of Dehly, takes Behar, 58—Conquers Bengal, *ib.*

Alumgeernagur, Moghul name of the capital of Couch Beyhar, 289.

Alumgeernagur (at the mouth of the Megna), Fort of, 297.

Aly, King of Ghizne, 20.

Aly Ghur, Fort of, 514.

Aly Miekh, 46, 49.

Aly Mubarick, (*Alla Addeen*), Governor of Bengal, unites the divisions of Lucknowty and Sunergong, 82, 83—Assassinated, 83.

Aly Murdan Khulijy, Sultan of Bengal, independent of the Court of Dehly, 54—His previous history, 50, 51, 52, 53—Character, 54, 50 *supra*—Assassinated, 55.

Aly Verdy Mohabut Jung, Governor of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, under Mohammed Shah, 446—His previous history, 416, 417, 419, 420, *n.* 421, 436--445—Surrenders to the Emperor's messenger the treasures of the late Nuwab, but evades the demand for the revenue, 448—Expels the Deputy-governor of Orissa, *ib.* 450—In regulating Bengal, consults the good of the public, 451—Recovers Orissa, which had revolted, 453—Meets an army of Mahrattas invading Bengal, 454—His line surrounded, 455—Retreats to Cutwa, *ib.*—Surprises the Mahratta camp, 458—Defeats Boskar Raow, 459—Sends to the Emperor for aid, *ib.*—Induces the Nuwab of Oude, who had entered Behar as an auxiliary, to return, *ib.*—On the invasion of Bengal by two Mahratta armies, prevails on the Poona Chief to act against the Berar Chief, 460—Defeats another invasion of the Berar Mahrattas, by treacherously assassinating their principal officers, 462—Mustapha Khan's defection, 463-466, and unsuccessful attempt to seize the government of Behar, 467-470—The Nuwab, by an embassy, amuses the Berar Mahratta, 469—Defeats him in several engagements, 472, and recovers all the dependencies, except Cuttack, *ib.*—His proceedings for the recovery of Cuttack, 473-475—Defeats the Mahrattas, 475—Insurrection in Behar, 476—The

Digitized by Google

Nuwab overthrows the rebels, and re-establishes his own Deputy, 482—Drives the Mahrattas from Cuttack, who again occupy it, 483—Rebellion of his grandson Seraje ad Dowlah, 484, 485—Yields Cuttack to the Berar Mahrattas, and agrees to pay them a *choute* for Bengal, 486—His death, 487—Character, 488.

Amaunee Gunge, 480.

Aphorisms—of Shere Shah, 145—Of Aly Verdy Khan, 490, 491.

Arcot, 512.

Arracan, river, 219.

Arracan, territory of, 207, 215, 280, *n.*—Raja of, joins the Portuguese pirates, to invade Bengal, 210—His coast plundered by the pirates, 218—Repels a Portuguese armament, 219—Dislodges the pirates, *ib.*—The Arracanners plunder the lower parts of Bengal, 221-240.—Seize the eastern coast to the mouth of the Ganges, 296.

Arsilla, King of Ghizne, 21—Confines his brothers, *ib.*—Defeated by Sinjir, Sultan of Khorassan, and flies to Hindoostan, 22—Attempts to recover his dominions, is taken and put to death, *ib.*

Assam, kingdom of, 187, 287—Assamese invade Bengal, 246, 287—Assam invaded by Meer Joomla, 290—Its Raja sends presents to the Nuwab of Bengal, 372.

Assam (South), 48.

Aurungzebe, (*Aalumgeer*,) Emperor of Hindoostan, 259-264, 272, 276, 327, 334, 348, 352, 360—His death, 360—Division of the empire amongst his sons, 361.

Azeem Oushan, Governor of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, under Aurungzebe, 334, 339—His character, 339, 366—His proceedings till the province of Bengal is tranquillized, 339-344; including his transactions with the English Trading Companies, 341, 342, *n.*—He repairs the injuries done by the rebels, 344—His public works, 345—He attempts to monopolize the foreign commerce of Bengal, 348—Adopts several customs of the Hindoos, *ib.*—Reprehended by Aurungzebe, *ib.*—Office of Dewan separated from that of Nazim, 352—The Nazim suborns an attempt on the life of the Dewan, 354—Ordered to reside in Behar, 356—Alleviates the situation of the English under the violent measures of Aurungzebe, 357—Recalled, 360—His subsequent history, *ib.* until his re-appointment to the government of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, 363—Directed to confirm Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan his deputy in Bengal and Orissa, 363—On the death of his father, Behadur Shah, mounts the Imperial throne, 364—Opposed by his three brothers, *ib.*—Killed in battle, 365.

Azeemabad, Mohammedan name of Patna, 357.

Azmurdun (Silhet?)—province of, 65. *et n.*

Azo—See *Semyle*.

B.

Baber (Emperor of the Moghuls), 115, 116.

Bagmutty, river, 66.

Bagora Khan (Nasir Addeen) made Sultan of Bengal by his father the Emperor Balin, 74—Previous notice of him, 72—Governs Bengal with reputation, 75—Called to the presence of the aged Emperor, *ib.*—Returning clandestinely to his kingdom of Bengal, loses the succession to the throne of Dehly, 76—The nobles make his son Kiekobad emperor, to the exclusion of Ky Khusero, his nephew, whom Balin's will had nominated, 76—Bagora Khan admonishes his son, *ib.*—Their interview and reconciliation, 77—The father to retain Bengal as a distinct kingdom, on condition of not interfering with the government of Dehly, 78—His son assassinated, and the Imperial throne usurped by Feroze, *ib.*—Bagora, as Sultan of Bengal, unmolested during the whole reign of Feroze, *ib.*—Intimidated by the Emperor Alla's power, voluntarily resigns the kingdom of Bengal, retaining Lucknowty and the south-west district in fief, 79—Confirmed in his reduced dominion by the Emperor Tughlik, and permitted to use the insignia of royalty, 80.

Bahram Shah, King of Ghizne, 22—His previous History, 21—Character, 22—Rebellions and fall of Mohammed Bahlim, *ib.*—The King puts to death prince Mohammed Hussein, 23—Is driven from Ghizne by the prince's brother, Sief Addeen Soury, *ib.*—Recovers that city, and destroys Sief Addeen, *ib.*—Is thrice defeated by Alla Addeen, 24—Flies towards Lahore, and, overwhelmed by these reverses, dies, *ib.*

Balasore, town and district of, 244, 251, 312, 320, 450.

Balin, Emperor of Dehly, 70—76.

Balkh, city of, 16.

Bankipore, 471.

Bankybazar, German factory at, 423, 424.

Bar, Town of, 481.

Barabutty, Fort of, 450.

Barbek Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 100—Introduces Abyssinian and Negro slaves into his army, some of whom he promoted to places of trust, 100—His death, 101.

Bareek Shahzadeh, Sultan of Bengal, 103—Notice of his previous situation as chief eunuch of the palace, 102—He promotes the eunuchs to important commands, and fills the offices with persons of the lowest description, 103—Is assassinated by Mulk Andiel, the Commander-in-chief, 104, 105.

Barsool, Government of, 51.

Batecala, Raje of, 209.

Bathendeh, City of, 4, 7.

Bayezid, Sultan of Bengal, put to death, 151.

Beernagur, Zemindar of, 381.

Behadur Khan, first Governor of the Eastern (or Sunergong) division of Bengal, under the Emperor Alla, 79—In the reign of Mubarick Shah, assumes independence, *ib.*—Submitting to the Emperor Tughlik, is pardoned, but superseded as Imperial governor, 80.

Behadur Shah, Emperor of Hindoostan, 363, 364.

Behadur Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 146—Totally defeats the Emperor Mohammed Adil, 147—Rules Bengal and part of Behar, in absolute sovereignty, *ibid.*—His death, *ibid.*

Behar, conquered by the Mohammedans, 39—Taken from the Khulijy sovereign of Bengal by the Emperor Altumsh, 58, 59—Hostilities between the king of Behar and the king of Bengal, 119, ter-

Digitized by Google

minate in the reduction of Bengal by the Behar forces, 139—Behar and Bengal a united kingdom under Shere Shah, 139—Merged into the empire, 143—Government of, united by Ferrokhsere to that of Bengal and Orissa, 403—Separated from that of Bengal and Orissa, 418—(And see *Bengal.*)

———Territory of, 39, and *n.* 116, 119, 467, 476—Fort of, 119.

———*North*, included in the boundaries of Bengal, 86.

Beloli, Emperor of Dehly, 113, 126.

Benaras, Raje and province of, 36, 84—City of, 305—And see *Cuttack Benaras.*

Bengal, History of the last Hindoo raja of, 41—Conquered by the Mohammedans, 44—New division of the districts among the Khulijy chiefs, by Cuttub Addeen, 52—Imperial Dewan appointed over, *ib.*—Taken by the Emperor Altumsh from the Khulijy chiefs, 59, and made a provincial government, *ib.*—The emperor Balin makes his younger son Bagora independent Sultan of, 74—A distinct kingdom by treaty with the Emperor of Dehly, 78—Bengal divided into two districts, one a vassal kingdom, and the other a provincial government under the Emperors of Dehly, 79, 80—The eastern and western districts reunited under an Imperial governor, 83—By treaty between the Sultan and the Emperor, Bengal acknowledged an independent kingdom, 86—The independent line of kings terminates with Mahmood Shah, 122—United, with Behar, into one kingdom, under Shere Shah, 139—Merged into the Imperial dominions on Shere Shah's becoming Emperor of Hindoostan, 143—Divided into provinces by the Emperor Shere Shah, *ib.*—Made an integral government, as a province of the empire, under Selim Shah, 145—With part of Behar, an independent kingdom under Behadur Shah, 147—Falls, with Behar, under the dominion of Soliman Shah, an Afghan of the Kerany tribe, 149—who affects to hold his kingdom of the Emperor Akbar, 151—Sultan Daood Khan, having assumed independence, is defeated and executed as a rebel, 164; and Bengal, with Behar, and Orissa, are annexed to the empire under Akbar, as separate governments, 163, 166—Division of the provincial executive government under Akbar, 167—New regulation of the Moghul jagierdars, 168—Rebellion in Bengal and Behar, 168—170—Government of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, united under Akbar, 175—Having been alternately combined and separated according to the policy of different emperors, the three provinces are again united under one government by Ferrokhsere, 403—Again separated, 418—The Nuwabs of Bengal govern independently from the death of the Emperor Mohammed Shah till the ascendancy of the English; a period including only part of the reign of Aly Verdy Mohabut Jung, 491, *n.* and the entire reign of Seraje ad Dowlah, 497—The Nuwab of Bengal derives his power from the ascendancy of the English, 534.

———, Boundaries of, extended to the Gunduk, so as to include North Behar, 86—Territories annexed to, viz. Kurrah Manikpore, 61, Chittagong, 300, 370—Midnapore, 370.

———The following cities have been successively the capital of, viz. Nuddeah, 41—Gour, 44—Pundua, 84, 86—Gour again, 95—Tondah, 149—Gour, a third time, 162—Rajemahel, 184—Dacca, 207—Rajemahel a second time, 250—Dacca again, 286—Moorshudabad, 369.

Berar, 454.

Berar Mahrattas, Authority for the origin of, 454, *n.*

Berkis, Raja, master of the impregnable fort of Rhotas, circumvented by Shere Shah, 139, *et seq.*

Bettiah (Gunduk), river, 113.

Beyhar, capital of Couch Beyhar, 288.

Bhagalpore, 182.

Bhaggarutty, river, 240, 346, 455.

Bhatteah, 7, 8.

Bheemnagur, 9.

Bheerbhoom, 156, 371, 432, 460.

Bhendereek, 188.

Bhetourieh, Zemindary of, 93.

Bhimé, 9.

Bhiram Khan, Governor of the Lucknowty division of Bengal under Alla, 80—His death, *ib.*

Bhoosnah, Foujedary of, 382.

Biana, Fort of, 32—Government of, 96.

Bijore, 127.

Bishenpore, 371.

Bisnuntpore, District of, 177, 265.

Black Hole (at Calcutta), 504.

Bogwangola, 335, 412, 480.

Bokhara, City of, 2, 3.

Bootan, Territory of, 46, 48, note.

Bost, capital of Khorassan, 22.

Boujepore, Fort and raje of, 147, 148, 247.

Brampore, (Burhanpore), 349.

Budgebudge, Fort of, 513.

Bukharast, 127.—And see *Bokhara.*

Bukhtore, 158.

Bulloah, 211.

Bundelcund, 13.

Bungmutty, river, 46.

Burdehun or *Murdehun*, City of, 46.

Burdwan, 157, 178, 182, 226—District of, 328.

Burhampooter, river, 48, note, 287, 297.

Burhanpore, 224, 359, 416.

Byram Shah, Emperor of Hindoostan, 64.

C.

Cabul, 253.

Calcutta, Origin of, 346—Flourishing state of, 402—Taken by Seraje ad Dowlah, 503—Retaken by Col. Clive, 514.

Calicotta, 341, 346.

Calicut, 99.

Callinger, capital of Bundelcund, 12—Fort of, 144—Country of, 68.

Candahar, 224.

Cannouge, 36—Raja of, submits to Mahmood Ghazy, 11—Government of, 65—Subah of, assumes independence, 96.

Carnatic Bala Ghaut, Territory of, 284.

Chaja Aias, (otherwise *Ghyas Beg*), History of, 193.

Chandernugore, 302, 329, 334, 500.

Chietmul Jelal Addeen, Sultan of Bengal, 94—Different causes assigned for his becoming a Mohammedan, *ib.*—Again removes the seat of government from Pundua to Gour, 95.

Digitized by Google

Chinderi, 133.
Chinsura, Town of, 302, 329, 334, 500.
Chitor, 136.
Chittagong, 207, 227—Territory of, surrendered to Shah Jehan, 245—Authorities respecting its history and boundaries, *ib. n.*—A dependancy on Arracan, 277—Annexed to Bengal, 300, 447—Port of, 312.
Chond, District of, 129, 132.
Choppergotta, near Calpie, 146.
Chowsar, 124, 142.
Chunar, Fort of, 120, 121, 136, 138.
Chuttanutty, part of the present Calcutta, 315, 327, 347—Fortified by the English, 329, 334.
Colgong, 122.
Commorea, 299.
Comra, 440.
Coosq, river, 54.
Cossim Khan, Governor of Bengal under Jehangire, 217—Recalled for not repelling the invasions of the Mughs, 221.
Cossim Khan (Brother of Meer Jaffier) seizes Seraje ad Dowlah, in his flight after the battle of Plassey, 530.
Cossim Khan Jobuny, Governor of Bengal under Shah Jehan, 239 *supra*—Expels the Portuguese from Hoogly, 240-243.
Cossimbazar, 301, 311, 369, 499.
Couch Beyhar, 166—Boundaries of, 187—First entrance of the Moghuls into, *ib.*—Reduced by Islam Khan Mushhedy, 246—Incursion of its chief into Kamroop, 287—Conquered by Meer Joomla, 288—Its Raja again expels the Moghuls, 294—Sends presents to the Nuwab of Bengal, 372—Invaded and subdued by a Bengalese force, 431.
Cudgwa, 260, 389.
Currah, see *Kurrah*.
Currumnassa, river, 124, 142.
Cutlickpore, see *Tugliekpore*.
Cuttack, District of, 158—Included in Orissa, 167—Afterwards same as province of Orissa, 472, 486, *n.*—Fort of (Saringghur), 159, 185; capital of Orissa, 186, 451.
Cuttack Benaras, 158.
Cuttub, an impostor, personating Prince Khusero, raises a rebellion in Behar, 215—Slain 216.
Cuttub Addeen Abiek, Sultan of Lahore under Mahmood, 33—First Mohammedan king of Hindoostan, 37—His previous history, 33-36; and see in 31, 32, his services as General under Mohammed Ghory—His death, 37.
Cuttub Addeen Kokultash, Governor of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, under Jehangire, 192—Having led a party to Burdwan to assassinate Shere Afgun, is slain by Shere, 203.
Cutwa, 182, 405.

D.

Dacca, 72, *n.*—Made the capital of Bengal, 207, 237, 286.
Dalkisor, river, 182.
Danes—Date of their establishment in Bengal, 302.
Daood Khan, Sultan of Bengal, 151—Assumes independence, *ib.*—Invades the Imperial territories, 152—Besieged in Patna, 153—Abandons that city, 154—Evacuates Tondah, and retreats to Orissa, 156, 158—Defeated by the Moghul army, 159—Becomes a vassal of the Emperor, and is suffered to retain Orissa, 161—Recovers Bengal, 162—Vanquished and put to death as a rebel, 164.
Debalpore, Government of, 96.
Deccan Shabazpore 287.
Dehly, Hindoo kingdom of, 19, 28—Raja of, slain in a battle with Mohammed Ghory, 30.
———City of, 30, 31, since its capture by Cuttub Abiek considered the capital of Hindoostan, 35, 36, although deserted by individual emperors for other seats of government, 81, 97, 117.
———Empire of, 36, 53, 65, 97.
Dehpareh, 433.
Dekkan, Territory of, 81, 188, 512—Conquest of, by Jehangire, 223—Revolt of, repressed, *ib.*—Soubahdar of, 512.
Deocote, 50, 56.
Derriapore, 155.
Derveish, Anecdote of a, 345.
Dherpore, 182.
Dinagepore, Raje of, invaded from Bengal, 431.
Dirhem, a small silver coin, 5, *n.*
Diu, Island of, 15.
Dooab, Territory of, 11.
Dowletabad, the capital of the Emperor Mohammed Shah, 81.
Dummooda, river, 177.
Durbunga, District of, 477.
Dutch—Date of their establishment in Bengal, said to be 1625—See CORRIGENDA, Note to be added to p. 302—Unite with the English against the Ostend Company, 424.

E.

East-India Company (English), establish a factory at Agra, 222—Abandon the trade by land from Patna to Surat, 223—Permitted to send ships to Pipley, and establish at that port their first factory in Bengal, 244—Acquire further privileges in Balasore and Hoogly, 251—Notice of Shah Jehan's *firman*, 252, 254, and the *nishan* of Sultan Shujaa, 255—Dispute with Meer Joomla, 286—English vessels allowed to sail up the Ganges, 301—Imposts on the English factories, 303—Their agents purchase, for 21,000 rupees, a *nishan* for a free trade exempt from duties, *ib.*—Impost in lieu of the *jizia*, 308—The Company procure a *firman* from Aurungzebe, *ib.*—The Directors make Bengal independent of Madras, 309—The Nuwab of Behar restricts the factory at Patna, 310—The Company annoyed by unchartered interlopers, 311—Oppressed by the Nuwab of Bengal, 312—Authorized by James II. to make war on the Nuwab, and on Aurungzebe, *ib.*—History of their affairs in Bengal till the death of Shaista Khan, 312-323—The Company invited to re-establish their factories in Bengal by Ibrahim Khan, 325—Involved in the vengeance of the Moghul government by the piracies of unlicensed traders, 327—Bengal again made subservient to Madras by the Directors, 328, *n.*—The English fortify their factory at Chuttanutty, 329—Purchase Chuttanutty, Govindpore, and Calicotta, 341, 342, 346—Ill effects of rival Companies, 348—Embassy from the King of England to

Digitized by Google

Aurungzebe, 349—The capture of three Moghul ships by an English pirate causes the negotiation to break off, 350—Animosity between the two Companies conduced to its miscarriage, 351, *n.*—Date of the union of the Companies, *ib.*—Aurungzebe imprisons all the English in his dominions, to make them answer for the damages of the pirates, 357; and seizes the Company's property, *ib.*—Calcutta made independent of Madras, 359—Factory established at Cossimbazar, 369—The privileges assured to the English by Shujaa and Aurungzebe invaded by Moorshud Cooly, 395—Embassy in consequence to Dehly, *ib.*—Thirty-four firmans granted by the Emperor Ferrokhsere, confirming and extending the immunities and powers of the Company, 400—The liberty to purchase thirty-eight towns on the banks of the Hoogly, 401, frustrated by Moorshud Cooly, *ib.*—During the invasion of Bengal by the Mahrattas, the English are permitted by Aly Verdy Khan to strengthen the defences of Calcutta, and to fortify their factory at Cossimbazar, 457—Causes of Seraje ad Dowlah's hostility, 499—Factory of Cossimbazar capitulates to the Nuwab, *ib.*—Calcutta taken, 503—Sufferings of the prisoners in the Black Hole, 504—The survivors released, 506—The Company's agents at subordinate factories escape to the fleet, 511—Expedition from Madras to recover the settlements in Bengal, 512—Colonel Clive takes the forts of Budgebudge, Aly Ghur, and Tanna, 514—Retakes Calcutta, *ib.*—Reduces Hoogly, 515—Attack on the Nuwab's camp, 516—Treaty of peace, *ib.*; and of alliance with Seraje, 517—The English take the French settlement of Chandernagore, 519—The Company's agents conclude a secret treaty with Meer Jaffier Khan, general of the Nuwab, 522—Colonel Clive commences hostilities against the Nuwab, *ib.*—Doubtful tone of Meer Jaffier's correspondence with Col. Clive, 525—Decision of the Colonel, 526—Battle of Plassey, 527—Retreat of the enemy influenced by Meer Jaffier, 528—The English enter the enemy's camp, 529—Advance to Moorshudabad, 532, 533: meanwhile the Nuwab, a deserted fugitive, falls into the power of his enemies among the natives, and is put to death, 530, 531—Colonel Clive raises Meer Jaffier to the musnud, 534.

F.

Fakher Addeen Sekunder, proclaims himself Sultan of Bengal, 82—His previous usurpation of the government of Sunergong; defeat; and recovery of that district, 81—Fails in an attempt to reduce Lucknowty, 82—Taken prisoner and put to death, 83.

Fedai Khan, Governor of Bengal under Jehangire, 238—Remits a stipulated revenue, 239—Superseded on the accession of Shah Jehan, *ib.*

Fedai Khan, Governor of Bengal under Aurungzebe, 302—Oppresses the English commerce, *ib.*—His death, 303.

Ferid Addeen Soor—see *Shere Shah.*

Ferokhabad, 483.

Ferose, Emperor of Dehly, 84 — His unsuccessful attempts to reduce Bengal, *ib.* 85, 87.

Ferose Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 118—Murdered by his uncle, *ib.*

Feroseporeabad, 84.

Feroze, Emperor of Dehly, 78.

Feroz Koh, 25.

Ferrokhsere, Emperor of Hindoostan, 391—His previous history, 345, 356, 383--391—His death, 403.

Ferrokhzad, King of Ghizne, 20.

French, Date of their establishment in Bengal, 302—Their settlement at Chandernagore taken by the English, 519.

Fringy Bazar, Town of, 299.

Fulta, 511, 513.

Futteh Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 102—Reduces the Abyssinian slaves, and eunuchs of the palace, *ib.*—murdered in the Seraglio, *ib.*

G.

Ganges, river, 21, 72, 297—Changes its bed, 250—Annual offering to, 237, 238, *n.*

Gazypore, 216.

Ghergong, capital of Assam, 291.

Gheria, 440, 449.

Ghizne, capital of Zabulistan, held by the Anook tribe of Afghans, 3. *n.*—Afterwards capital of the Ghiznean empire, embracing part of Hindoostan, 4, 17, 24—Some time in the possession of the Ghorian dynasty, 27, 53.

Ghiznean, Dynasty, 4--25.

Ghor, 20, 23, 38, 132.

Ghor, Kings of, their genealogy can be traced to the Khalifat of Aly, 25.

Ghorian dynasty, 25, *et seq.*

Ghoragot, 161, 168, 178, 187.

Ghowhatty, 294, *ib.* 304.

Ghyas Addeen, Prince of Ghor, 27—Appoints his brother, Mohammed Ghory, generallissimo, *ib.*

Ghyas Addeen, assassinates the young King of Bengal, and usurps the government for a short time, 147, 149.

Ghyas Addeen (son of Sekundeh Shah), Sultan of Bengal, 89—His previous history, 88, 89, 92, 93—Anecdote of his deference to the authority of the law, 90—Anecdote of his three favourite concubines, 91—His death, 93.

Gickers, Tribe of, 32.

Godagauree, 457.

Gogra, river, 76.

Golconda, 226, 283.

Goompty, river, 162, *n.*

Gorackpore, Raje of, 205.

Gour (called also *Lucknowty*), City of, 43, *et n.* 56, 86, 100, 161.

Govindpore, Village of, 347, 501.

Gualier, Fortress of, 13, 157, 276.

Gualpareh, 89.

Gunduck, river, 48, *n.* 86, 112.

Gungowtry or *Kuthoury*, District of, 52, 56.

Gunjy Kotta, Fortress of, 284.

Gurmseir, District of, 38.

Guzerat, Province of, 14, 27, 96—City of, 304.

H.

Hafiz, the Poet, Anecdote of, 92.

Hajypore, City of, said to be founded by Ilyas Khaje Shums Addeen, 86, 120, 153—District of, 115, 118.—Zemindary of, 180.

Digitized by Google

INDEX.

Hamilton Mr., Surgeon to an embassy from the English Presidencies in India to the Emperor Ferrokhsere, 395, greatly promotes its success, 397.
Hansi, Fortress of, 18, 30, 35.
Haroun al Rashid, Year of his death, 2.
Herat (in Persia), City of, 97.
Hideri (on the Ganges), 116.
Hindoo Zemindars, oppressed by Moorshud Cooly Khan, and his officers, 371, 372, 377--379.
Hindoostan, Frontier provinces of, overrun by Subactageen, king of Ghizne, 4—The countries of Lumghan and Paishawur taken by Subactageen, 5—[For the subsequent conquests of the Ghizneans in Hindoostan, see *Mahmood Ghory*, and *Musaood the First*]—The Princes of the Punjab, allied with the Raja of Dehly, recover all the places, except Lahore, which the Ghizneans had taken, 19.
————The Moultan, Paishawur, and other provinces of, conquered by Mohammed Ghory, 27—Raja Bim Deo expels Mohammed Ghory from the Guzerat, 27—The possession of Lahore passes from the Ghiznean to the Ghorian dynasty, 27—Pittu Rai, prince of Ajmire, and Candu Rai, king of Dehly, defeat Mohammed Ghory, 28—In a second engagement, they are totally overthrown, 30—Gola, son of Pittu Rai, holds Dehly, as a vassal to Mohammed Ghory, *ib.*—Jychund, Raja of Benaras, totally defeated by Cuttub, general of Mohammed Ghory, 36—[And see *Afghans.*]
————Moghuls, under Zingis Khan, make incursions into the northern provinces of, 70, *n.*—Tartars, under Timour, defeat Mohammed III. Afghan Emperor of Dehly, 96—Meanwhile, many of the subahs assumed independence, *ib.*—Shah Rookh, son of Timour, considered Emperor of Hindoostan, 97—Ibrahim, Afghan Emperor of Joanpore, defeated by Baber, Emperor of the Moghuls, 115—Homayon, Moghul Emperor of Agra, vanquished by Shere Shah, an Afghan, 143—The empire of Hindoostan reverts to the Moghuls under Akbar, 149—The governors of provinces assumed independence from the time of Mohammed Shah's death, 491, *n.*
Hissam Addeen Avuz, raised by the Khulijy chiefs to the throne of Bengal, 55—His previous history, 56—Improves the city of Gour, *ib.*—His character, 57—He compels the Rajas of Kamroop, Tirhoot, and Jagernaut, to pay tribute, 58.—Driven from Behar by the Emperor Altumsh, 58—Allowed to retain the government of Bengal on conditions, *ib.*—Expels the Imperial troops from Behar, *ib.*—Defeated by Nasir Addeen, the Emperor's son, and falls either in battle, or by the executioner, 59.
Homayon (Moghul Emperor of Agra), protects Mahmood Shah, 121—Expels Shere Khan from Bengal, *ib.* 122, 123—Leaves Jehangire Cooly governor, 124—On his return to Agra, intercepted by Shere Khan, *ib.*—Resigns Behar and Bengal to Shere, by treaty, 125—Treacherously attacked by Shere, escapes with difficulty, *ib.*—Totally overthrown, 142, 143.
Hoogly, Town of, 186, 226, 302—Authorities respecting its origin, 243, *n.*
Hussin, 127.
Hyderabad, City of, 285, 454, *n.*

I.

Ibrahim, King of Ghizne, 20—Invades Hindoostan, *ib.*—Plunders Adjodin, and takes Rupal, *ib.*—Appoints Sham Soury to the government of Ghor, *ib.*—His death, *ib.*
Ibrahim, (Sultan of Joanpore, and last Afghan Emperor in Hindoostan of the Lody Dynasty), invades Bengal, 96—Induced to desist by a menacing letter from Shah Rookh, 97—Defeated and slain by Baber, Emperor of the Moghuls, 115—Retrospective notice of, 129.
Ibrahim, Emperor of Dehly, 150,—afterwards Sultan of Orissa, *ib.*—Dispossessed of this province by Soliman Shah Kerany, and treacherously slain, *ib.*
Ibrahim Khan, Governor of Bengal under Aurungzebe, 324—Invites the English to return to Bengal, 325—Order from Aurungzebe, allowing the Company free trade with that province for an annual present of 3000 rupees in lieu of duties, 327—Rebellion in Burdwan, 328—During its progress, the Dutch, French, and English fortify their factories, 329—The Nuwab, to avoid a civil war, weakly forbears to oppose the rebels, 331—Superseded by Azeem Ooshan, 334—Zubberdust Khan, the Nuwab's son, twice defeats the rebels, 335, 336.
Ibrahim Khan Futteh Jung, Governor of Bengal and Orissa under Jehangire, 221—Character of his government, 222.
Ilyas Khaje (*Shums Addeen*), Sultan of Bengal, 83—His successful expedition to Jagenagur, *ib.*—Attacked by the Emperor Ferose, loses his new capital, Pundua, 84—Is besieged in Akdala, *ib.*—Enters the enemy's camp in disguise, 85—Obtains a favourable peace from the Emperor, acknowledging the independence of Bengal, *ib.*—His death, 86.
Injelee, port and island of, 312, 317, *ib.* 456.
Irsilan Khan, usurps the government of Bengal, 68—His previous history, *ib. supra, et* 67—His death, 68.
Islam Khan Ala Addeen, Governor of Bengal under Jehangire, 206—Makes Dacca the capital, 207—Endeavours to conciliate the Afghans of Orissa, 211—Sends an army against them, 212—Defeat of the Afghans, 214—They submit to the Imperial authority, 215—Death of Islam Khan, 217.
Islam Khan Mushhedy, Governor of Bengal under Shah Jehan, 245—Receives the Mugh Chief of Chittagong as vassal to the Emperor, 245—Repels an invasion of the Assamese, 246—In an expedition to Assam, reduces Couch Beyhar, 246—Recalled to act as Vizier, 247.
Islamabad, the Mohammedan name of Chittagong, 246, 300.

J.

Jaffier Khan, See *Moorshud Cooly Khan.*
Jagenagur, Town of, 72—Its situation doubtful, *ib. n.*
Jagenagur (Tippera), Territory of, 70, 83.
Jagepore (Orissa), 61, 65.
Jagernaut, province of, 43, 58.
————Temple of, 44, 183, 429.
Jajoo, plains of, 362.
Janveh, 136.
Jarcund, mountains of, 123, 265.
Jats, a tribe of Hindoos on the Sinde, 14, 35.
Jehanabad, 182.

Digitized by Google

Jehandar Shah, Emperor of Hindoostan, 366, 384, 385, 388—Defeated by Ferrokhsere, 389—Put to death, 391.
Jehangire Cooly Khan, Governor of Bengal under Jehangire the Emperor, 205—His character, *ib.*—Death, 206.
Jehangire Selim, Emperor of Hindoostan, 191, 196, 198, 204.
Jehangirenagur, the Mohammedan name of Dacca, 207, 323.
Jelkek, river, 429.
Jellal Addeen, Sultan of Bengal, 147—Assassinated, *ibid.*
Jellal Addeen Khany, Governor of Bengal under Nasir Addeen Mohammed, 67—Supplanted and slain by the Imperial Governor of Kurrah, 68.
Jellasir, District of, formerly Midnapore, 157.
Jellasore, City of, 185.
Jenghiez Khan—See *Zingis Khan*.
Jennetabad, Gour, so named by the Emperor Homayon, 124.
Jessore, District of, 181, 328.
Jeswont Roy, Dewan in Dacca—Reduces the price of grain, 430.
Jillalpore, Zemindary of, 427.
Joanpore, 96, 97, *n.*, 117, 146.
Joosy, Village of, 146, 232—District of, 174.
Jorwe, Fort of, 186.
Joudpore, Raje of, 304—City of, 305.
Jugdea, Fort of, 297—Factory at, 511.
Jugdispore, 470, *n.*
Jumna, river, 71.
Jypaal, twice defeated by Subuctageen, devotes himself on a funeral pile, 7.

K.

Kakeshalan, Tribe of, 168, 176, *et n.*
Kamroop, Territory of, 46, 48, *n.* 58, 66, 112—Raja of, intercepts Mohammed Bukhtyar's retreat, 48.
Kanis, (Raja), usurps the throne of Bengal, 93; having rebelled against Shums Addeen II. 93 *supra*—Although a Hindoo, by policy gains the Afghan Chiefs, 94—His death, *ib.*
Ketasun, in Jagepore, 61.
Khaleefabad, 186.
Khan Aazim Mirza Koke, Governor of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, under Akbar, 175—Re-establishes the Imperial authority in Bengal, 176—Fails to tranquillize Orissa, 176-178—After settling Behar and Bengal, resigns his employments, 178.
Khan Dowran, Governor of Bengal under Mohammed Shah, 412, 417—His deputy, Shujaa Addeen Khan, the acting governor, *ib.*
Khan Jehan, Governor of Bengal under Akbar, 163, 166—By his services, all Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, are annexed to the empire, 167.
Khanezad Khan, Governor of Bengal under Jehangire, 236—Resigns, 237.
Khareghur, Fort of, 186.
Khizerpore, 294.
Khoorum—See *Shah Jehan*.
Khorana, Fort of, 30.
Khorassan, 2, 3.
Khota, in Tartary, 60.
Khuarism, kingdom of, 34.
Khuaspore Tondah—See Tondah.
Khulijy, Tribe of, 38, 50—Khulijy chiefs settled in Bengal, 52—Their power in electing the sultans, 54, 55—Reduced, 59—A Khulijy chief usurps the throne of Dehly, 78—And see *Afghans*.
Khusero, (eldest son of Jehangire), conspires to supplant his father, 191.
Khusero I. King of Ghizne, 24, abandons the western provinces, and makes Lahore his capital, *ib.*—His death and character, *ib.*
Khusero II. last of the Ghiznean dynasty, reigned thirteen years at Lahore, 25—Taken prisoner by Mohammed Ghory, *ib.*—Assassinated, *ib.*
Kidderpore, 302.
Kiekobad, Emperor of Dehly, 76—78.
Kinnouge—See *Cannouge*.
Kipchak, (north of the Caspian Sea), 63.
Koh Kote, Fortress of, 11, 13.
Kole, (now *Ally Ghur*), Fortress of, 31, 35.
Kooneh, Tribe of, 46—Territory of, 49.
Kudder Khan, Governor of the Lucknowty division of Bengal, 80—Defeats Fakher Addeen the rebel governor of Sunnergong, 81—His own troops, corrupted by the latter, murder him, *ib.*
Kudgwa, see *Cudgwa*.
Kurmputtun, City of, 47.
Kurrah, City of, 61.
Kurrah Manikpore, Province of, 61, 62, 67, 96, 132.
Kuthoury—See *Gungowtry*.

L.

Lahore, City of, 12, 20, 65, 96.
Loll Baugh, 406.
Luckipore, 211.
Luckmunyah, last Raja of Bengal, History of, 41—44.
Lucknow, 137.
Lucknowty, (Gour), City of, 44, 51, 54—And see *Gour*—District of, 79, 80, 82.
Lumghan, 5.

M.

Mabin, Fort of, 11.
Madras, 311, 328, *n.* 511.
Mahanuddee, river, 452.
Mahsenagur, 406.
Mahmood Ghazy, King of Ghizne, 7—Invades Hindoostan, *ib.*—Takes the capital of Raja Jypaal, *ib.*—and of Raja Bajerao, *ib.*—Compels the Afghan chief of Moultan to pay tribute, 8—Defeats Annundpaal a second time, *ib.*—Seizes the treasure in the sacred territory of Nagorkote, *ib.* 9—Obtains the title of Sultan, 9—Conquers Moultan, *ib.*—Pillages Thannasar in the raje of Dehly, and destroys the Hindoo idols, 10—Expels Pitteraou Jypaal, and plunders Cashmire, *ib.*—His unsuccessful siege of Koh Kote, 11—Reduces the Raja of Cannouge, *ib.*—Plunders the Hindoo temples at Muttra, *ib.*—His expedition against the Princes of India, 12—Besieges Koh Kote, 13—Takes Lahore, and annexes the Punjab to his dominions, *ib.*—Reduces Guzerat, 14—Plunders the temple of Som Naat, *ib.*—Defeats the Jats, *ib.*
Mahmood Lody, (Brother of Ibrahim,) a fugitive at the court of Gour, 115—Recovers Joanpore, 116 *infra*.
Mahmood Shah, nominally Sultan of Bengal, 107—Assassinated, 108.

Digitized by Google

Mahmood Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 118—Rebellion of Mukhdoom Aalum, governor of Hajypore, supported by Shere Khan, regent of Behar, *ib.* 119—Mahmood sends an army to invade Behar, which is defeated, 119—Is joined by the King of Behar against the Regent, *ib.*—Besieges Shere in Behar, 120—Mahmood's army defeated, *ib.*—Bengal invaded by Shere Khan, *ib.*—Mahmood retreats to his capital, *ib.*—Afterwards takes refuge in the camp of the Emperor Homayon, who promises to reinstate him, 121—Homayon, after taking Chunar, advances towards Bengal, *ib.*, and gains the passes, 122—Death of Mahmood, and termination of the independent line of Kings, *ib.*

Mahmoodabad, 404.

Mahratta Ditch, 457.

Mahrattas (*Berar*), invade Bengal, 454—Plunder Moorshudabad, 456—Overrun the districts named, *ib.*—Surprised in their camp, 458—On their retreat take Cuttack, *ib.*—Defeated by Aly Verdy Khan, evacuate all the dependencies of Bengal, 459 *supra*—History of subsequent Mahratta invasions, 459 *infra*—462, 469, 472, 473, 476, 479, 480, *ib.* 481, 482, 483—They obtain from the Nuwab Aly Verdy Khan the cession of Cuttack, and a stipulated annuity, as the *choute* of Bengal, 486.

————(*Poona*,) join Aly Verdy, Nuwab of Bengal, against the Berar raja, 460.

Maldah, 84, 315.

Malibar, Coast of, 99.

Malwa, 68, 96, 232.

Man Sing, *Raja Kenore*, Governor of Bengal and Behar, under Akbar, 180—Reduces the Zemindar of Hajypore, *ib.*—Disperses the predatory Moghuls in Ghoragot, 182—His expedition to Orissa, *ib.*—Compromises the dominion of that province, 183—The Afghans having seized the territory of Jagernaut, he again invades Orissa, 184; and re-annexes it to the empire, 186—Quells a fresh rebellion in Orissa, 187—Receives the Raja of Couch Beyhar as a vassal to the Emperor, *ib.*—Succours that prince against his revolted subjects, *ib.*—Attends Akbar in an expedition to the Dekkan, 188—The Afghans having conquered great part of Bengal, he returns and defeats them, *ib.*—Resigns, 189—Conspires against Jehangire, 191—Re-appointed by that Emperor, *ib.*—Recalled, *ib.*—His death, *ib.n.*

Manikpore, 233—See *Kurrah*.

Masulipatam, Factory at, 322.

Medarun, 156—See *Bheerbhoom*.

Meer Hubbeeb, Deputy-dewan of Orissa, 442—Taken prisoner by the Mahrattas, enters their service, 456—On the cession of Cuttack to the Mahrattas, named as Dewan for the province, 486, *n.*—Assassinated by a Mahratta chief, *ib.*

Meer Jaffier Khan, Nuwab of Bengal under the protection of the English, 534—His previous history until his conspiracy for deposing Seraje ad Dowlah, 473—475, 498, 503, 509, 519—His overtures to the Company's Resident, 521—Secret treaty with the English, 522—Remainder of his history until Col. Clive seats him on the musnud, 523—534.

Megna, river, 211, 297.

Menhaj Seraje Addeen Giorjany, author of the Takbat Nassery, 61, 63.

Merat, Fort of, 11, 31.

Mewat, Government of, 141.

Midnapore, Town of, gives name to the district formerly Jellasir, 157, 177—Annexed to Bengal, 370.

Mikeh, Tribe of, 46.

Mindu, Fort of, 117.

Modood, King of Ghizne, 18—Occupied by an invasion of the Siljokian Tartars, and by civil wars, *ib.*—Dispossessed by the Hindoo princes of all the Ghiznean conquests east of the Indus, except Lahore, 19, 20—His death, 20.

Moghul Dynasty, Governors of Bengal under the, 166 *et seq.*

Moghuls, attack the northern frontier of the Afghan Empire of Delhi, 69, 70, *n.*—Baber defeats Ibrahim Afghan emperor of Joanpore, 115—Homayon, Moghul emperor of Agra, overthrown by Shere Shah, 143—The empire of Hindoostan reverts to the Moghuls under Akbar, 149—The Moghul jagierdars in Bengal and Behar rebel against Akbar, 168—170: subdued chiefly by the agency of Hindoo commanders, 171—176.

Mohaba, Territory of, 96.

Mohammed, son of Mahmood Ghazy, 16.

Mohammed (son of Aurungzebe), detached in pursuit of his uncle Shujaa, 264—His love for the daughter of Shujaa, 266—He deserts to that prince, and marries her, 268—270—Unintentionally conduces to the defeat at Tondah, 271—Conclusion of his history, 272,—276, *n.*

Mohammed Aazim. see *Aazim Shah*.

Mohammed Aazim, Governor of Bengal under Aurungzebe, 303—Recovers Ghowhatty from the Assamese, 304—Recalled to command under Aurungzebe against the Rajepoots, *ib.*

————, re-appointed to Bengal, 307—Enforces the poll-tax from the Hindoos, 308—His dispute with the English governor at Hoogly, 311—War with the Company, 312—History of it in relation to Bengal till the death of Shaista Khan, 323—His character, *ib.*

Mohammed Adil, Emperor of Dehly, 146.

Mohammed Bukhtyar Khulijy, first Mohammedan conqueror of Bengal, 38—His previous history, 38—41, including the reduction of Behar, 39—Invades Bengal, 43—Surprises Nuddeah, 44—Makes Gour the capital, *ib.*—Destroys the Hindoo temples, 45—Stamps the coin in the name of the Sultan of Ghor, *ib.*—His unsuccessful expedition to the countries of Bootan (or rather South Assam, see 48, *n.*) and Thibet, 45—49—His army destroyed, 49—Dies on his return, 50.

Mohammed Ghory (founder of the Ghorian dynasty), takes prisoner, by a mean stratagem, and dethrones Khusero the Second, 25, 27—His previous history, 27—Generalissimo to his brother Ghyas Addeen, *ib.*—Takes the city of Tiberhind, 28—Defeated by Pittu Rai, and Candu Rai, 28, 29—In a second engagement totally overthrows those princes, 30—Assigns Ajmire to Gola, son of Pittu Rai, on a promise of tribute, 30—Seizes Dehly, 31—Defeats the prince of Cannouge, *ib.*—Destroys the temples at Benaras, *ib.* 36—Plunders the Guzerat, 32—Takes Biana, 32—Becomes Sultan by the death of his brother, *ib.*—Assassinated by the tribe of Gickers, *ib.*

Mohammed Hady, 351—See *Moorshud Cooly Khan*.

Digitized by Google

Mohammed Khan Soor, Governor of Bengal under Selim Shah, 145—On the usurpation of the Imperial throne by Mohammed Adil, assumes independence, 146—Slain in an engagement with Himu, vizier of Mohammed Adil, *ib.*

Mohammed Meer Joomla, Governor of Bengal under Aurungzebe, 264, 286 *infra*—His previous history, 283--286 *supra*—Makes Dacca again the capital of Bengal, 286—Invades Couch Beyhar, 288—Appoints there a civil administration, 289—Joined by the son of the Raja, *ib.*—Advances to Assam, 290—Distress of his army, 292—Treaty with the Assamese king, 293—He commences his return, 294—Detaches a force to reconquer Couch Beyhar, *ib.*—Dies, *ib.*—His character, *ib.*

Mohammed Muazim—See *Shah Aalum*.

Mohammed Shah, Emperor of Hindoostan, 404—Notice of his death, 491, *n.*

Mohammed Sheran, Deputy-governor of Bengal under Mohammed Bukhtyar, 46.

Mohammed Sheran, elected chief by the Mussulman commanders in Bengal, assumes the ensigns of royalty, 51—Resists a new division of the districts, 52—Defeated, and falls in an affray, *ib.*

Mohammed Shujaa (second son of Shah Jehan), Imperial Governor of Bengal, 249—Again makes Rajemahel the capital, 250—Allows the English to establish factories in Balasore, and at Hoogly 252—Removed to the government of Cabul, 253—Reinstated in that of Bengal, *ib.*—His character, 254, 263—Asserts his claim to the Imperial throne, 256—During a negotiation is surprised by his nephew Soliman, the general of his elder brother Dara, 257—Retreats to Mongier, 258—On the defeat of Dara by another rival brother, Aurungzebe, endeavours to conciliate the latter, 259—Takes the field as his competitor, *ib.*—Defeated by Aurungzebe, 262—Retreats successively to Mongier, 264, Rajemahel, 266, and Tondah, *ib.*—Joined by prince Mohammed, son of Aurungzebe, 268—Defeated by Meer Joomla, 271—Escapes, with Mohammed, to Dacca, *ib.*—By an artifice of Aurungzebe rendered suspicious of Mohammed, 273—Dismisses that prince with his daughter, 274—Abandons Bengal, 277—Hospitably received by the Raja of Arracan, 278—Besieged in the house assigned for his residence, 280—Taken prisoner, and drowned, 281.

Mohammed Tatar Khan, Governor of Bengal under Balin, 69—His death, *ib.*

Mohib Aleepore, 471.

Moidapore, 533.

Monaim Khan, Governor of Bengal under the Emperor Akbar, 161—Removes the capital from Tondah back to Gour, 162—His death, *ib.*

Mongier, Fort and district of, 115, 172, 135, 258.

Mooneer, Town of, 116.

Moorshud Cooly Jaffier Khan, Dewan, Deputy-Nazim, and Nuwab, of Bengal and Orissa under Aurungzebe, 369—His previous history, including his services as Dewan of Bengal, 351--359—On the succession of Behadur Shah confirmed as Deputy-Nizam, and Dewan, 370—His despotic regulation of the zemindaries, and assumption of the collections, 371—He receives embassies of submission from the rajas of Tipperah, Couch Beyhar, and Assam, 372—Defeats Rasheed Khan appointed governor by Ferrokhsere, 392—On the establishment of Ferrokhsere, remits to that Emperor the revenue, and obtains the united offices of Nizam and Dewan, 393—Encourages the Moghul and Arabian merchants, 392—Refuses to acknowledge the firmans granted to the English, 394—Intrigues to thwart an embassy from the English Presidencies to the Emperor, 395, 399—Frustrates the most important concession made to the Embassy, 401—Obtains the government of Behar, 403—Is confirmed in his viceroyalties by Mohammed Shah, 404—Represses a commotion in Bengal, *ib.*—Character of his government, illustrated by a detail of particular acts, 372--383, 405—Favourable view of his character, 405—His death, 413.

Moorshud Cooly Khan, Deputy-governor of Orissa under Serferaz Khan, 428—Expelled by Aly Verdy Khan, 450.

Moorshudabad, formerly (*Mukhsoosabad*), 331—Made the capital of Bengal, 369, 456.

Moorshudgunge, 405.

Mootecjeel, 488.

Morung, Raje of, 381.

Moultan, City of, 8, 9—Territory of, 96.

Mubarick Shah, Emperor of Dehly, 79.

Mughs (of Pegu and Arracan), 215.—And see *Arracan*.

Mukhsoosabad, 241, now called Moorshudabad, 331.

Mukurrem Khan, Governor of Bengal under Jehangire, 237—Accidentally drowned, 238.

Mulk Ala Addeen, Governor of Bengal under Altumsh, 60—Superseded, *ib.*

Mulk Andiel Feroze Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 106—His previous history, 102--106—Character of his reign, 106—His death, 107.

Mulk Yusbek, Governor of Bengal under Musaood, 65—His previous history, 64—Unsuccessful expedition against Orissa, 65—Invades and plunders Azmurdun, *ib.*—Assumes independence, *ib.*—Invades Oude, *ib.*—Retreats to Bengal, 66—In an expedition to Kamroop, defeated and mortally wounded, 67.

Muncara, Village of, 526.

Murdehun, City of—See *Burdehun*.

Musaood I. King of Ghizne, 16.—Makes Balkh the seat of empire, *ib.*—His character, *ib.*—Removes his court to Ghizne, 17—Reduces the Persian provinces of Kutch and Makeran, *ib.*—Storms Sursutty in Cashmire, *ib.*—Enters Sewalic, and takes the fort of Hansi, 18—Destroys the Hindoo idols at Sunput, *ib.*—Deposed and murdered, *ib.*

Musaood II. King of Ghizne, 20.

Musaood III. King of Ghizne, 21—Marries a princess of Siljoky, *ib.*—His general, Toghan Sien, carries the Mohammedan conquests across the Ganges, *ib.*—Musaood's death, *ib.*

Mustapha Khan, attempts to seize the government of Behar, 467—Slain in battle, 470.

Mutteapore, 291.

Muttra, a celebrated place of Hindoo worship, 11.

Muzuffir Khan Tirbutty, Governor of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, under Akbar, 167—Remits a great revenue, 168—Enforcing the new system of Akbar, causes a rebellion of the Moghul Jagierdars, *ib.*—The Emperor's officers are expelled from Bengal and Behar, 169, 170—The Governor murdered by the insurgents, 170.

Myapore, 513.

Digitized by Google

N.

Naaf, river, 245, *n.* 278.
Nadir Shah, the Persian Usurper, 432—Date of his entrance into Dehly, 434, *n.*—Date of his departure, 437, *n.*
Nadoune, Fort of, 10.
Naghore, Capital of Bheerbhoom, 56, 62, 93.
Nagore (in the mountains of Sewalic), Fort of, 23.
Nagorkote, Sacred territory of, 8.
Nasir, a slave, usurps the government of Bengal after the death of Ahmed Shah, 99—Put to death by the nobles, *ib.*
Nasir Addeen, Viceroy of Bengal and Behar under Altumsh, 59—Had previously defeated and dethroned Ghyas Addeen, 58—His death, 59.
Nasir Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 99—His Mohammedan adherents give stability to his throne, *ib.*—His death, *ib.*
Negro Slaves, frequently promoted in India to important situations, 100.
Neharu, Tribe of, 46.
Neherwala, 35.
Nerbudda, river, 226.
Niamut Khan, Gallant conduct of, 332.
Nidurbira, Forest of, 198.
Nilab, or *Sinde*, river, 5.
Noor Jehan, (the beautiful), originally named Mherul-Nissa, 196—On the assassination of her husband, marries the emperor Jehangire, 204—interferes in regard to the succession, 224—Her influence on the fashions and arts of India, 222, *n.*
Nuddeah, City of, 41—District of, 341.
Nusserit Shah, (*Naseeb Shah*) Sultan of Bengal, 114—Subdues the countries of Tirhoot, Hajypore, and Mongier, *ib.*—Hospitably receives Mahmood Lody after the overthrow of the Afghan dynasty by the Emperor Baber; and marries the daughter of the late Sultan Ibrahim, *ib.*—Conciliates Baber, who had sent an army to invade Bengal, 116; and promises to give no further assistance to Mahmood Lody, *ib.*—On the death of Baber disregards that engagement, 117—His character, *ib.*—Assassinated by the eunuchs, *ib.*

O.

Orissa (Jagepore), The Raja of, defeats Toghan Khan governor of Bengal, 61: invades Bengal, and takes Naghore, 62: repels a Bengalese army under Mulk Yusbek, 65—Conquered by Soliman Shah Kerany, sultan of Bengal, 150—Left in the power of the Afghan chief Daood Khan, as vassal to Akbar, after he had been deprived of Behar and Bengal, 161—Relinquished to the Afghans by the Moghul governor of Bengal under Akbar, 179—The dominion of the province compromised, 183—Re-annexed to the Moghul empire, 186—The Afghans in Orissa rebel, but are reduced by an Imperial army from Bengal, 213, 214—War between the governor of Orissa and the Nuwab of Bengal, terminates in the expulsion of the former, 450—Insurrection of the province subdued, 452, 453—The Mahrattas invade the province, 471; and, after being repeatedly expelled, 471--475, at length obtain it by cession from Aly Verdy, Nuwab of the three provinces, 486, *n.*—[And see *Cuttack*; *Bengal*; and *Behar*.]
Ostend Company, Account of the, 422, *et seq.*
Oude, Government of, 52, 96, 459.
Oudé, Plain of, 77.
Oulaberea, Village of, 319.

P.

Paiks, infantry armed with swords and spears, 102.
Paishawur, 5, 7, 8, 27, 180.
Patan Empire, another name for the *Afghan*, 164, *n.*
Patelbanga, Island of, 209.
Patna, City of, 153, 173, 301.
Pegu, Territory of, 215.
Phenny, river, 299.
Pipley, Port of, 244.
Plassey, 521, 524, 526.
Poona, 296, 460.
Poonpoon river, 154.
Portuguese Pirates, Account of, 207, *et seq.*—Continuation of their history, 218--221, 298, *n.*
——— *Settlers*, at Fringy Bazar, 299.
——— *Settlement at Hoogly*, The Governor of, refuses to assist Shah Jehan, 227—Siege of Hoogly, and expulsion of the Portuguese, 241--243.
Priag, now called *Allahabad*, 174.
Pundua, made the capital of Bengal, 84, 86, 94.
Punjab, 10, 19, 20, 27.
Purneah, District of, 380, 487.
Pursotem, seat of the idol Jagernaut, 429, *n.*
Puttolee, Village of, 524.

R.

Rabul, 127.
Raje Girhé, ancient Hindoo name of Rajemahel, 186, *n.*
Rajemahel, (formerly Agmahel), made by Man Sing the capital of Bengal, Behar, and Orissa, 184, 186, 202—Court removed from, 207—Again made the capital of Bengal, 250.
Rajepoot, Tribe of, 190—Rajepoots, 35—Rajepoot princes, 304.
Rangamutty, Town of, 48, *n.* 290.
Rashy, King of Ghizne, 20.
Ravy, river, 364.
Rentimpore, Fort of, 225.
Rhotas, Fort of, 123, 182—Described, 141—Stratagem of Shere Shah to obtain it, 139.
Roh, mountainous country between Persia and India, 126, 127.
Roshenabad, Moghul name of Tipperah, 428.
Rungpore, Foujedary of, 431.
Rupal, Fort of, 20.
Ruttenpore, Raje of, 451.
Ryn Kesary, 157.

S.

Saad-ullapore, a place of Mohammedan worship, 118, 122.
Saatgong, Port of, 186, 240—Its ancient grandeur 243, *n.*—Date when it was the seat of European factories, 330, *n.*
Sal Kote, Fortress of, 27.
Samana, 30, 96.
Samanian Dynasty, Ishmael Samany, the founder of, reigns in Bokhara, independent of the Khalifat, 2.
Saringghur, Fort of, 185.
Sarun, Sircar of, 76, 114.

Digitized by Google

INDEX.

Seerpore (probably Serampore), 241.
Seerpore Attaya, 188.
Sehsaram, District of, 123, 127, 137.
Seistan, 22.
Sekunder, (Emperor of Dehly), 113, 115.
Sekunder Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 86—Refuses to acknowledge himself vassal to the Emperor Ferose, 87—Invaded, takes refuge in Akdala—Obtains peace by a present and the promise of a tribute, 87—His favourite son, Ghyas Addeen having rebelled, the aged monarch in an engagement with the rebels is mortally wounded, 89.
Sekunder Shah, Sultan of Bengal, deposed for incapacity two months after being placed on the throne, 101.
Sekundra, 391.
Semyle, Fort of, 290.
Seraje ad Dowlah, Nuwab of Bengal and Behar, independent of Aalumgeer II. 497, 491, *n.*—His previous history, 495, 496, 484-487.—His character, 495—First acts of his government, 497.—Irritated at some proceedings of the English, 499—Takes Cossimbazar, *ib.*—Besieges and carries Fort William, Calcutta, 500-503—The English prisoners inhumanly crowded into the Black Hole, 504—He releases the survivors, 506—Obtains contributions from the French and Dutch settlements, 505—His mandate to Shokut Jung, governor of Purneah, produces a defiance, 506—Defeat and death of Shokut Jung, 510—History of the Nuwab's war with the English under Colonel Clive, till the treaty of 9th of February, 512--516—Vacillation of the Nuwab, while the English are reducing the French settlements, 517--520—Influence of the Afghan invasion on his councils, 519—His chief officers make secret overtures to the English, 520—He reinforces his army near Plassey, 521—Courts Meer Jaffier, and other discontented Chiefs, 522—Sends a party to seize Meer Jaffier, 523—On the hostile advance of the English, visits that officer, *ib.*—Their compact, *ib.*—Assembles his army, 524—Sends for the French detachment, *ib.*—Battle of Plassey, 527; pending which, the Nuwab throws himself on the protection of Meer Jaffier, 528—Retreat ordered by the advice of Meer Jaffier, *ib.*—The English enter the Nuwab's camp, 529—His troops desert in bodies, *ib.*—He retreats to Moorshudabad, 530—His flight to Rajemahel, *ib.*—Betrayed by a derveish, 531—His death, *ib.*
Serampore, 302.
Serferaz Khan, Nuwab of Bengal and Orissa under Mohammed Shah, 433—His character, 434—Remits the revenues of three years to the Persian invader Nadir Shah, 435—Two instances of the Nuwab's despotism, *ib.*—Conspiracy against him, 436—Menaced by Aly Verdy Khan, governor of Behar, he assembles the Bengal army, 440—Perfidiously attacked, 441—Is slain in battle, 442.
Serhungs, a regiment of body-guards raised by Hussein Shah, 111.
Sewad, 127.
Sewalic, 23, 31.
Shabazpore, Island of, 209.
Shah Aalum, 361—Competitor with Aazim Shah for the empire of Hindoostan, 362—Defeats his brother, and takes the title of Behadur Shah, 363.
Shah Hussein, King of Joanpore, overthrown by the Emperor Sekunder, a fugitive at the court of Gour, 113.
Shah Jehan (third son of Jehangire), usurps the sovereignty of Bengal in the course of a rebellion against his father, 230—Previous history of this rebellion, 224; including the surprise of Orissa, 226—Reduces the province of Behar, 231—Advances to Allahabad, Joanpore, and Benaras, 233—Is defeated by the Imperial army, 234—Retreats to the Dekkan from Bengal, 235—Submits to his father's authority, and is forgiven, *ib.*—Succeeds to the Imperial throne, 239—Deposed by his son Aurungzebe, 259, 282.
Shabaz Khan Kumbo, Governor of Bengal and Behar under Akbar, 179—His previous history, 178—Relinquishes Orissa to the Afghans, 179—Superseded and confined, *ib.*
Shaikh Ala Addeen—See *Islam Khan.*
Shaista Khan, Governor of Bengal under Aurungzebe, 296—Drives the Arracanners from their positions on the Ganges, 297—Invades Chittagong, 299, and annexes it to Bengal, 300—Recalled, *ib.*—His character, *ib.*
Sham Soury (first Prince of Ghor), his history, 26.
Shere Afgun, Prowess of, 197--203—Slain, 204.
Shere Shah, Sovereign of Bengal and Behar, 142—His origin, 126—Domestic history, 127, *et seq.*—Education, 128—Employments and actions until he becomes Regent of Behar, 128--134; including anecdotes of him when attending the Emperor Baber, 133—By the desertion of the young king of Behar, he becomes sovereign of that country, 135, 136—Obtains the fort of Chunar by marriage, 136—His compromise with Mahmood Lody, respecting the dominion of Behar, 137—Deserts Mahmood in a battle with the Emperor Homayon, 138—Eludes the Emperor's demand of the fort of Chunar, *ib.*—Expels Mahmood Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 139—By a stratagem obtains the fort of Rhotas, *ib.*—Annihilates the Emperor Homayon's transient authority in Bengal, 142—Unites the kingdoms of Bengal and Behar, assuming the title of Shere Shah, *ib.*—Totally defeats Homayon, and becomes Emperor of Hindoostan, 142, 143—Divides Bengal into provinces, 143—Killed at the siege of Callinger, 144—His character, and public works, *ib.*
Sheregotty, 265.
Shokut Jung (Governor of Purneah), his defiance to Seraje ad Dowlah, 506—Slain in battle, 510.
Shujaa Addeen Khan, Deputy-governor of Bengal and Orissa under Mohammed Shah, 412 *infra*, 417—His previous history, 416, 417, 412 *supra.*—He liberates the zemindars, 418—Confirmed Governor of Bengal, *ib.*—Revenue of the province, 419—His character, *ib.* 420, 433—Increases the military establishment, 419—Allowed to appoint the governor of Behar, 420—His deputy, in Orissa, restores the idol Jagernaut, 429—The Nuwab appoints Serferaz Khan his heir, 432—His death, 433.
Shums Addeen II. Sultan of Bengal, 93—Defeated by the rebel zemindar Kanis, loses his life, *ib.*
Shumsheer Khan, one of the generals of Aly Verdy Khan, suffers the Berar Mahratta Chief, whose line had been surrounded, to escape, 472—Dis-

Digitized by Google

missed by Aly Verdy, 473—Usurps the government of Behar, 477, 478—Defeated by Aly Verdy, and slain, 482.
Sicklygully, Pass of, 120, 121.
Siddee Buddee Dewaneh (*Muzuffir Shah*), Sultan of Bengal, 108—His previous history, *ib. supra*—His reign cruel and tyrannical, 108—Rebellion against him, headed by the Vizier, *ib.*—Different accounts of his death, 109.
Sief Addeen Assulateen, Sultan of Bengal, 93—His character, and death, *ib.*
Sief Addeen Toork, Governor of Bengal under Altumsh, 60—Dies by poison, *ib.*
Silhet, District of, 65, *n.* 447.
Siljokian Tartars, 18, 21.
Sinde, river, 5, 14.
Singee, English factory at, 310.
Sirve, river, 76.
Soane, river, 116, 471.
Soliman Shah Kerany, Sultan of Bengal, 149—His previous history, 147, 148—He makes Tondah his capital, 149—Conciliates the Emperor Akbar, *ib.*—Subdues Orissa, 150: treacherously assassinates Ibrahim, formerly emperor of Dehly, *ib.*—Invades and plunders Couch Beyhar, *ib.*—Quells an insurrection in Orissa, *ib.*—Affects to hold his dominions of Akbar, 149, 151—His death, *ib.*
Som Naat, an Hindoo idol, 14.
Soonamooky, river, 486, *n.*
Sooty, 229, 271, 522.
Subanreeka, river, 212, 486, *n.*
Subhal, Fort of, 186.
Subuctageen, mounts the throne of Ghizne, 4 *supra*—Invades Hindoostan, 4—Takes the countries of Lumghan and Paishawur, 5—His death, 6.
Sui, Town of, 127.
Sumundy, Hindoo name of the Indian Sea, 46.
Sunarcote, 89.
Sundeep, Island of, 208, 297.
Sunergong, City of, 72 *et n.* 79, 89—Government of, 79, 80.
Sunput, a place of Hindoo worship, 18.
Surat, 232, 303, 318, 327.
Sursutty, Fort of, 17, 30,
———, river, 28, 29.
Syed Hussein Ala Addeen, Sultan of Bengal, 109—His previous history, 110, *ib.*—On his elevation, permits Gour to be plundered, *ib.*—Reduces the Paiks, raises another regiment of body-guards, and dismisses the Abyssinian troops, 111—Character of his reign, *ib.*—Invades and plunders the kingdom of Assam, 112—His unsuccessful expedition to Kamroop, *ib.*—Builds a Fort on the Gunduk, 113—His public works, *ib.*—He affords an asylum to Shah Hussein, *ib.*—Averts the intended hostilities of the Emperor Sekunder, and obtains a peace acknowledging the independence of Bengal, *ib.*—His death, 114.

T.

Tanna, Fort of, 317, 333, *n.* 514.
Tanyan, or *Tangan*, a species of horse, 47, 48, *n.*
Tartars, under Timour, notice of their defeating Mohammed III. 96.
Telingana, Territory of, 284, 285.
Terriagurry, Pass of, 120, 121.
Thannasar, Town of, seat of the idol Jug Soom, 9.
Thibet, 46, 47, 187.
Tiberhind, City of, 28, 29—Government of, 65.
Timour, invades India, 95.
Timour Khan Keran, Governor of Bengal, 64—His previous history, 63, 62. His death, 64.
Tippera, Rajah of, sends presents to the Nuwab of Bengal, 372—Territory of, 70, (see *Jagenagur*)—Becomes a province of the Moghul empire, 427, 447.
Tirhoot, 58—Government of, 80, 115, 187.
Todermul Raja, Commissioned by Akbar to reduce the rebellion in Bengal and Behar, 171—Recovers Behar, 173—Is superseded, 175.
Toghan Khan, Viceroy of Bengal, 61—His previous history, 60—Invades Tirhoot, 61—Annexes Kurrah Manikpore to Bengal, *ib.*—His unsuccessful expedition to Jagepore, *ib.*—Besieged in Gour by the Orissians, 62—Relieved by the army of Oude, *ib.*—Battle between the two Mohammedan armies, *ib.*—Toghan resigns Bengal to Timour Khan, 63—Appointed governor of Oude, *ib.*—His death, *ib.*
Toghril (*Mogies Addeen*), Governor of Bengal under Balin, 70—Reduces the Rajas on the north-east, *ib.*—Invades and plunders Jagenagur, *ib.*—Proclaims himself King of Bengal, 71—Defeats two armies sent against him, *ib.*—On the approach of the Emperor with a third army, retires to Jagenagur, 72—Surprised in his camp, and slain, 73.
Tondah, District of, 127, 132, 149, *n.*—City of, made the capital of Bengal, 149—Deserted, *ib. n.*
Tonse, river, 233, 234.
Toorkestan, 33, 56.
Topasses, Indian Portuguese, 327.
Travelling, in India—Mohammed Aazim's expeditious mode of, 304.
Tughlik, Emperor of Dehly, 79.
Tughlikabad (Tughlikpore), 225.
Tughlikpore or *Cutlickpore*, 113, 229.
Turryana, mountains, 112.

V.

Vizagapatam, 322.
Viziapore, 325.

Y.

Yugan Tunt, Governor of Bengal, 64—His death, *ib.*
Yusuf Shah, Sultan of Bengal, 101—A just administrator of the laws, *ib.*—His death, *ib.*

Z.

Zabulistan, Kingdom of, 3.
Zemanieh, Fort of, 152.
Zingis Khan, 70, *n.*
Zufferabad, 87.
Zyn Addeen, Deputy-governor of Behar, 437, 447—Defeats Mustapha Khan, who falls in an attempt to usurp the government of the province, 470—Is assassinated, 478.

THE END.

Printed by R. Watts, Broxbourne, Herts.

Digitized by Google

Digitized by Google

Digitized by Google



Digitized by Google

Digitized by Google